

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Development and Social Progress - Complete Learning Session

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Development and Social Progress - Complete Learning Session

Syllabus, verbatim: *Development and Social Progress*. - UPSC Philosophy Paper II, Section A, item 8. The clause prints one broad pair and no sub-heads at all, which is exactly why it is misread. It does not own economic policy, poverty data, welfare schemes or environmental administration. It owns the prior philosophical questions: **what development is, how it is to be measured, who counts as its agent, and what would entitle anyone to call a social change progress rather than merely change**. Amartya Sen, Martha Nussbaum, Mahbub ul Haq, M. K. Gandhi, B. R. Ambedkar, Arne Naess, the Brundtland Commission, and Ramachandra Guha with Joan Martinez-Alier enter because each executes a distinction the owned previous-year parts actually require. Full theories of justice, equality and liberty belong to **Social and Political Ideals**; complete liberalism, Marxism, socialism and anarchism to **Political Ideologies**; cultural recognition and plural belonging to **Humanism, Secularism and Multiculturalism**; women's empowerment as a gender doctrine to **Gender Discrimination**; graded hierarchy and its annihilation to **Caste Discrimination: Gandhi and Ambedkar**; participation, rights and accountability as a state-citizen relation to **Individual and State**. Those are routed here, never developed. Current growth, poverty, health, education, employment and climate figures, together with scheme design and environmental administration, belong to the Economy, Governance and Environment areas of this repository and lie outside this owner entirely.

Evidence discipline: FACT: marks doctrine on which the standard sources converge, ANALYSIS: marks analytical reconstruction offered for exam use, and CAUTION: marks a live scholarly dispute or a contested empirical claim. Model answers in this package are independent learner practice and are **never** official UPSC keys: UPSC publishes no descriptive model answer for Philosophy Paper II. Works are cited by author and title only - **Sen, Development as Freedom and Commodities and Capabilities**; **Nussbaum, Creating Capabilities and Women and Human Development**; **Mahbub ul Haq, Reflections on Human Development with the UNDP human-development framework**; **Gandhi, Hind Swaraj** and his writings on trusteeship, self-rule (*swarāj*) and welfare of all (*sarvodaya*); **Ambedkar's** writings on caste, democracy and the Indian village; **O. P. Gauba, An Introduction to Political Theory**; **Guha and Martinez-Alier, Varieties of Environmentalism (1997)**; and the World Commission on Environment and Development, **Our Common Future***, the **Brundtland Report (1987)**. No page, chapter, edition or verbatim wording is asserted for any of them, and no author is quoted anywhere in this package. Seven dated facts are used, each classified before it is used: **Naess's shallow/deep ecology distinction (1973)**, a scholarly position; the **Brundtland Report (1987)**, an international commission report, always paraphrased and never reproduced verbatim; **Guha and Martinez-Alier (1997)**, a scholarly work; the **Provisions of the Panchayats (Extension to the Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996**, an enacted statute; the **Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006**, an enacted rights-recognition statute; **Orissa Mining Corporation v. Ministry of Environment & Forest (2013)**, a Supreme Court judgment; and **Articles 48A and 51A(g)** of the Constitution of India, both **non-justiciable**. **WRONG:** No growth rate, income figure, poverty count, index score, emission quantum, target, scheme, project, company, movement, region or country is named anywhere in this package, and no statute, judgment or constitutional provision is used as evidence that a philosophical position is correct.

Terminology rule: the English concept leads and the technical term follows immediately in parentheses - *increase in aggregate or per-capita output (economic growth), structural and qualitative change in the productive economy (economic development), expansion of longevity, knowledge and a decent material standard (human development), an achieved being or doing such as being nourished or participating (functioning), the real opportunity to achieve alternative functionings (capability), the personal, environmental and social conditions that decide how much freedom a given resource yields (conversion factors), the downward adjustment of reported satisfaction under long deprivation (adaptive preferences), the ability to pursue goals one has reason to value, including goals beyond one's own welfare (agency), justified improvement in the quality of social relations, institutions and lives (social progress), the claim that societies pass through broadly comparable stages toward one modern form (modernisation theory), the claim that underdevelopment is produced through unequal incorporation rather than inherited from an earlier stage (dependency), the challenge to the authority by which external experts define whole societies as deficient (post-development), present improvement that does not destroy the ecological conditions and options of future persons (sustainable development), duties owed to those not yet born (intergenerational justice), the objection that different policies produce different future people (the non-identity problem), counting a person's interests for less merely because she exists later (pure time preference), moral standing confined to human beings (anthropocentrism), moral standing extended to every individual living thing (biocentrism), moral standing extended to species, habitats and ecological wholes (ecocentrism), pollution and depletion policy pursued for the health and affluence of the developed world (shallow ecology), the questioning of the framework that generates those symptoms, with intrinsic value affirmed in non-human life (deep ecology), the assumption that expanding production is the master objective of social organisation (productivism), planned reduction in the throughput of energy and materials with provisioning reorganised around sufficiency (degrowth), reduction where consumption is far above a defensible threshold and expansion where it is far below (contraction and convergence), struggles over access to forests, water, grazing, fisheries and clean air by communities whose subsistence depends on them (the environmentalism of the poor), the claim that ecological survival may require insulating decisions from democratic contestation (eco-authoritarianism), ecological restructuring conditioned on prior guarantees of livelihood, retraining, compensation and participation (just transition), welfare of all (sarvodaya), self-rule (swarāj), and the moral delegitimation of absolute ownership in favour of stewardship for the community (trusteeship). A technical term may sharpen an English explanation; it may never replace one.*

What this package contains

Component	Count
Progressive teaching sessions in the Basic block	20
Original diagnostic MCQs - 24 core plus 8 remedial drills	32
Question-specific option explanations	128
Unique examiner traps	32
Directly owned verified PYQs solved in full, 2018-2025	6
Original solved Mains models - two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks	6
Consolidated register parts	16 (A-P)
ASCII master flow panels authored	22

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

CONCEPT SPINE - ENGLISH FIRST, TECHNICAL TERM IMMEDIATELY AFTER

THE ONE THING THIS CLAUSE IS ABOUT
WHAT ENTITLES ANYONE TO CALL A SOCIAL CHANGE AN IMPROVEMENT --
AND WHAT WOULD HAVE TO BE TRUE OF A SOCIETY FOR THE CLAIM TO HOLD?
THE PAPER PRINTS TWO WORDS AND NO SUB-HEADS. THE TWO WORDS ARE NOT
SYNONYMS, AND THE WHOLE CLAUSE TURNS ON REFUSING TO TREAT THEM AS ONE.

|
+-----+
| THE FIVE-RUNG LADDER THAT MUST NEVER BE COLLAPSED |
+-----+

- |
R1 . ECONOMIC GROWTH more output or income per head.
MEASURE: aggregate product. QUESTION: is more being produced?
R2 . ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT structural and qualitative change in
production, technology, institutions and social relations.
R3 . HUMAN DEVELOPMENT longevity, knowledge and a decent
material standard -- people rather than output.
R4 . CAPABILITY DEVELOPMENT ... substantive freedoms to be and to do;
what persons can ACTUALLY achieve, not what they own.
R5 . SOCIAL PROGRESS JUSTIFIED improvement in social
relations and institutions, judged by freedom, equality, justice,
dignity, participation, sustainability and solidarity.

|
EACH RUNG CORRECTS A DEFECT IN THE ONE BELOW IT AND ACQUIRES A NEW ONE.
AN ANSWER THAT USES THE FIVE WORDS INTERCHANGEABLY HAS NO ARGUMENT LEFT.

v
THE DISCRIMINATING TEST -- ONE SENTENCE THAT SEPARATES ALL FIVE

+-----+
| IF INCOME RISES WHILE PREVENTABLE UNFREEDOM, HUMILIATION OR |
| ECOLOGICAL DESTRUCTION INTENSIFIES, THERE IS GROWTH WITHOUT SOCIAL |
| PROGRESS. THE CASE IS NOT EXOTIC; IT IS THE ORDINARY CASE. |
+-----+

|
+-----+
| THE FIVE FAILURE MODES THIS CLAUSE NAMES |
+-----+

GROWTH WITHOUT DISTRIBUTION output rises, the gains are captured
DEVELOPMENT WITHOUT CONSENT beneficiaries are counted, not asked
TECHNOLOGY WITHOUT ETHICS capacity enlarges, ends are unexamined
WELFARE WITHOUT AGENCY persons are recipients, never authors
PROGRESS AS FORCED ASSIMILATION . one form of life is imposed as "modern"

v
THE THREE CONTESTS THAT GENERATE EVERY OWNED QUESTION IN THIS CLAUSE

1. THE METRIC CONTEST ... what is the right informational space --
output, needs, welfare, human development, capability, relations,
or ecology? Each DISCLOSES something and CONCEALS something.
2. THE AGENCY CONTEST ... is the person a BENEFICIARY of development or
its AUTHOR? Information -> consultation -> participation ->
co-decision -> EMPOWERMENT is a ladder, not a synonym list.
3. THE LIMIT CONTEST what may development not do? Ecological
irreversibility, cultural destruction and the foreclosure of future
options are limits, not costs to be priced.

v
THE WORKING THESIS THAT SURVIVES EVERY OWNED QUESTION IN THIS CLAUSE

+-----+
| GROWTH CAN FINANCE DEVELOPMENT, BUT ONLY CAPABILITIES, JUSTICE, |
| PARTICIPATION AND ECOLOGICAL LIMITS CONVERT MATERIAL CHANGE INTO |
| SOCIAL PROGRESS. EVERY VERDICT IN THIS CLAUSE IS THEREFORE |
| CONDITION-SPECIFYING: IT NAMES THE CONVERSION CONDITIONS. |
+-----+

|
THE SECOND GRID THAT CUTS ACROSS THE FIRST -- AND WINS MARKS
THE FIVE BOUNDED EVALUATIVE LENSES. USE AS CRITERIA; NEVER RE-EXPOUND.
LIBERAL / WELFARE resources, opportunity, rights, public goods
WARNING: formal opportunity, unequal conversion
MARXIST production, class power, control of surplus
WARNING: growth can reproduce exploitation
HUMANISTIC / CAPABILITY each person as an end and an agent <- OWNED
WARNING: beneficiaries counted, agency denied
GANDHIAN need, non-violence, local self-rule <- OWNED

WARNING: scale multiplies wants and domination
 AMBEDKARITE BRIDGE constitutional rights, social democracy
 WARNING: a village is not progress if caste
 power survives inside it
 THE MATRIX SUPPLIES EVALUATION CRITERIA. IT IS NOT FIVE IDEOLOGIES, AND
 IMPORTING THE FULL DOCTRINE OF ANY OF THEM BREACHES THIS OWNER'S FENCE.

Caption: the whole clause on one screen. One question, the five-rung ladder that must never be collapsed, the single discriminating test that separates every rung, the five failure modes the clause names, the three contests - metric, agency and limit - that generate every owned question, the condition-specifying thesis this owner always demands, and the five bounded evaluative lenses that supply criteria without importing another owner's doctrine.

ANSWER-WORTHINESS - WHAT EARNS MARKS AND WHAT DOES NOT

Move	Earns marks	Loses marks
Opening any development answer	Naming which conception of development the stem assumes - economistic, human-development or capability - and fixing the informational space in which the judgment will be made, inside the first three lines	"Development is essential for the progress of any nation and India has made great strides..."
Distinguishing the terms	The five-rung ladder stated as five different measures answering five different questions, with the discriminating test attached	Using growth, development, human development and progress as interchangeable words
Choosing a metric	Naming the informational space an indicator occupies, what it discloses and what it conceals - output hides distribution, welfare hides adaptive preference, composite indices hide within-group inequality	"A human-development composite is a better measure than output per head", asserted with no account of what either measures
Using Sen	Capability as real opportunity , distinguished from achieved functioning and from resources, with conversion factors doing the work	Reducing Sen to "income plus health and education", which loses the entire argument
Using adaptive preference	The evidential point : satisfaction reports adjust downward under long deprivation, so subjective welfare cannot be the metric	Treating happiness surveys as a straightforward measure of well-being
Using Nussbaum	The threshold of central capabilities as a political-constitutional minimum, with the reply that capability protects opportunity rather than compelling functioning	Presenting Nussbaum as merely "Sen with a list", which misses the dignity threshold
Handling modernisation	Its four assumptions named - linear sequence, convergence, diffusion, expert direction - so that the critique has something to attack	Treating modernisation as a neutral description of what happens when countries industrialise
Handling dependency and post-development	Underdevelopment as produced rather than inherited, and the challenge to the authority to diagnose , each with its own limitation	Rejecting all development as Western imposition, which cannot explain demands for health, schooling and mobility
Handling sustainability	Intergenerational justice, precaution under irreversibility and non-substitutable ecological limits , with the honest concession that the phrase can legitimise a green version of the same growth model	"Development must be sustainable", asserted as a slogan and never specified

Move	Earns marks	Loses marks
Handling necessary and sufficient	The two modal tests run separately and explicitly , with a threshold qualification on necessity and a named counter-case on sufficiency	Answering a necessary/sufficient stem with "economic development is very important"
Handling progress	Progress as weakly teleological - directional only after the valued ends are stated - and explicitly not an automatic law of history	Assuming that history moves forward, or that science and technology carry moral improvement with them
Handling technology	Technology expands power without supplying ends , joined to the honest concession that it reshapes which moral problems arise	Asserting either that technology has improved morality or that it has destroyed it
Handling skill education	Skill as capability and conversion , with the four limits - frustrated capability without decent work, narrow employability, unequal access, obsolescence	Answering with employment percentages and scheme names, which is an Economy answer
Handling Gandhi	Welfare of all (<i>sarvodaya</i>), self-rule (<i>swarāj</i>), restraint of wants, dignity of labour and trusteeship as a test of scale, control and need , with Ambedkar's objection treated as compulsory	Presenting Gandhi as nostalgia for village life, or omitting the caste objection entirely
Handling tribal development	The question restated as distributive - who defines benefit, who bears cost, whose knowledge counts, whether consent is real - then the four-test conclusion	"Tribal culture must be preserved while ensuring development", which decides nothing
Handling ecology	Moral standing first - anthropocentric, biocentric, ecocentric - then the shallow/deep distinction as a difference in depth of questioning , not degree of concern	Invoking "harmony with nature" as though it were an argument
Handling degrowth	The asymmetric form: contraction where consumption is far above a defensible threshold, expansion where it is far below	Prescribing degrowth uniformly, which misapplies the argument in a society below the deprivation threshold
Using the Indian material	Each item classified before use : PESA and the Forest Rights Act as enacted statutes, the 2013 case as a Supreme Court judgment, Articles 48A and 51A(g) as non-justiciable provisions	Citing a statute or judgment as proof that a philosophical position is correct, or treating enactment as implementation
Closing	A condition-specifying verdict : what the position secures, the conversion condition on which it holds, and what it cannot do even when it holds	"Thus development should be inclusive, sustainable and people-centric."

HOW TO READ THIS SESSION

1. **Every session opens with a picture.** Read the diagram or table before the prose; the visual carries the argument's shape and the prose only names its parts.
2. **Read the Basic block straight through.** It is deliberately answer-complete: after Session 20 you can write any of the six owned previous-year parts without opening the Advanced block.
3. **Do not import the Advanced block into a core answer.** It exists for a second reading and for the rare stem that rewards a refinement; nothing in it is a prerequisite for the core.
4. **Work the practice apparatus in order** - twenty-four core MCQs, then eight remedial drills, then the six owned previous-year parts, then the six original models.

5. **The register notes are last on purpose.** They are compressed recall, not a second exposition; use them the night before, not instead of the sessions.

ORIGIN AND CHRONOLOGY - THE MINIMUM NEEDED TO AVOID ANACHRONISM

WHY THIS CLAUSE HAS A CHRONOLOGY AT ALL

=====

The words "development" and "progress" changed meaning inside living memory. Using a later meaning to read an earlier argument -- or the reverse -- is the commonest source of confusion in this clause.

STAGE 1 . THE ENLIGHTENMENT INHERITANCE

Reason, science and social evolution are associated with cumulative improvement. PROGRESS is treated as broadly automatic.

|

- v DEFEATED BY: twentieth-century war, genocide and ecological crisis. Capacity grew; moral improvement did not follow.

STAGE 2 . THE ECONOMISTIC / MODERNISATION PERIOD

Development is identified with industrialisation, investment, productivity and rising income; a linear transition from "traditional" to "modern" is assumed, driven by diffusion and expert direction.

|

- v ATTACKED FROM FOUR SIDES: dependency (underdevelopment is produced), post-development (who authorises the diagnosis?), cultural and Gandhian critique (whose good life?), Marxist critique (who owns production and takes the surplus?).

STAGE 3 . THE HUMAN-DEVELOPMENT SHIFT

MAHBUB UL HAQ and the UNDP framework move the focus from the wealth of the economy to the lives of people -- longevity, knowledge and a decent material standard.

|

- v LIMIT: composite national measures conceal distribution, gender, disability, political freedom and ecological dependence.

STAGE 4 . THE CAPABILITY TURN

SEN reconstructs development as the expansion of substantive freedom, with resources valued through CONVERSION into capability. NUSSBAUM adds a threshold of central capabilities tied to dignity.

|

- v LIVE DISPUTE: a fixed list against open public reasoning.

STAGE 5 . THE ECOLOGICAL LIMIT

1973 . NAESS distinguishes SHALLOW from DEEP ecology -- a difference in depth of questioning, not in degree of concern.

1987 . The BRUNDTLAND REPORT builds duties to future persons into the concept of sustainable development itself (paraphrased, never quoted).

1997 . GUHA and MARTINEZ-ALIER name the ENVIRONMENTALISM OF THE POOR: in the global South, environmental conflict is typically a struggle over livelihood, not a post-material taste for wilderness.

|

- v CONSEQUENCE: "environment versus development" is exposed as a framing available only to those whose subsistence is not at stake. The real question is DISTRIBUTIVE.

STAGE 6 . THE INDIAN INSTITUTIONAL RECOGNITIONS (dated legal facts)

1996 . PESA -- ENACTED STATUTE extending adapted panchayat arrangements to Scheduled Areas, with a role for the Gram Sabha.

2006 . FOREST RIGHTS ACT -- ENACTED RIGHTS-RECOGNITION STATUTE recognising individual and community forest rights.

2013 . ORISSA MINING CORPORATION v. MINISTRY OF ENVIRONMENT & FOREST -- SUPREME COURT JUDGMENT involving Gram Sabha consideration of community and religious claims.

Articles 48A and 51A(g) -- NON-JUSTICIABLE constitutional provisions on protection of environment, forests and wildlife.

|

- v DISCIPLINE: enactment, judgment and constitutional commitment are DATED LEGAL FACTS. None of them is evidence that a philosophical position is correct, and none proves implementation or reconciliation.

Caption: six stages, each defined by the defect it corrects in the stage before. The chronology is the minimum needed to avoid anachronism - it prevents an answer from criticising modernisation with an argument that had not yet been

made, and from reading a capability claim into a purely economic period.

EXACT OWNERSHIP BOUNDARY AND INDISPENSABLE BRIDGES

Content	Owned here	Routed elsewhere
Growth, development, human development, capability and progress as concepts and measures	FACT: complete owner	Current output, poverty, health, education or employment data -> Economy and General Studies
Modernisation, dependency, post-development, sustainable development	FACT: complete owner as evaluative theories of development	Environmental facts, targets, policy design and administration -> Environment and Governance
The capability approach and human development	FACT: complete owner through Sen, Nussbaum and Haq	-
Gandhian social development	FACT: direct owner; the 2020 owned part sits here	Gandhi's full political philosophy and his anarchism -> Political Ideologies
Development and tribal values	FACT: direct owner; the 2025 owned part sits here	Cultural recognition and plural belonging as a doctrine -> Humanism, Secularism and Multiculturalism
Ecological standing, productivism, degrowth, intergenerational justice, just transition	FACT: owned as philosophy of the limits of development	Climate policy, ecology facts and figures -> Environment and Ecology
Freedom, equality, justice, dignity and solidarity as criteria of progress	ANALYSIS: bounded bridge - name and apply, never re-expound	Full theories -> Social and Political Ideals
Class power, surplus and alienation as a development criterion	ANALYSIS: bounded bridge - one criterion only	Full Marxism -> Political Ideologies
Caste and the village as a test of decentralisation	ANALYSIS: bounded bridge - Ambedkar's objection is compulsory in Gandhian answers	Full caste doctrine and the annihilation debate -> Caste Discrimination: Gandhi and Ambedkar
Empowerment and control over resources as a capability claim	ANALYSIS: bounded bridge only	Gender as a doctrine -> Gender Discrimination
Participation, consent and accountability as development conditions	ANALYSIS: bounded bridge only	Rights, obligation and state legitimacy -> Individual and State

ONE-SCREEN ROUTE MAP - WHICH SESSION ANSWERS WHICH OWNED PART

Owned previous-year part	Marks	The sessions that answer it
2019 Q2(c) - Does technological development lead to progress in the ethical standards of the society? Explain.	15	Sessions 1-3, 12 for the non-inevitability of progress, 16
2020 Q2(a) - State and examine the Gandhian concept of social development.	20	Sessions 1-2, 11 for the perspective map, 18, 20 for the inter-school debates
2022 Q3(a) - Do you agree that economic development does not on its own lead to human development and social progress?	20	Sessions 2-4, 6-8, 13-14
2023 Q2(c) - In the present scenario, will the emphasis on skill education enhance development? Evaluate.	15	Sessions 7-8, 15 for agency and empowerment, 17
2024 Q3(c) - Is economic development a necessary condition, sufficient condition, both or neither, in order to achieve social progress?	10+5=15	Sessions 2-4, 12, 13
2025 Q3(c) - Is it possible to reconcile the concept of development with tribal values to bring social and economic progress? Discuss.	15	Sessions 10-11, 15, 19, 20

ANALYSIS: **Corpus discipline.** This clause owns **6 of the 112** Socio-Political question-parts in the 2018-2025 corpus, distributed **2018: 0, 2019: 1, 2020: 1, 2021: 0, 2022: 1, 2023: 1, 2024: 1, 2025: 1**. It is one of the lighter owners by volume and it is **absent in 2018 and 2021** - which is a fact about the held cycle and not a prediction about the next paper. What the distribution does show is that the clause is tested through **applied stems**: technology, skill education, tribal values and the modal necessary/sufficient question, rather than through a request for a definition of development. Preparation that stops at definitions will not reach any of the six.

SESSION 1 - THE ONE QUESTION BEHIND TWO PRINTED WORDS

The picture first

WHY THIS CLAUSE IS ONE QUESTION AND NOT A SURVEY OF POLICY
=====

WHAT THE PAPER PRINTS
"Development and Social
Progress."
TWO WORDS. NO SUB-HEADS.

|
v
invites a policy essay
on growth, poverty and
schemes, closing with
"inclusive development"

|
v
ZERO ADJUDICATION

THE QUESTION IT IS ACTUALLY ASKING
WHAT ENTITLES ANYONE TO CALL A SOCIAL
CHANGE AN IMPROVEMENT -- AND WHAT WOULD
HAVE TO BE TRUE FOR THE CLAIM TO HOLD?

|
v
THE PREREQUISITE: development is a CONTESTED
NORMATIVE CONCEPT. Until the stem's assumed
conception is named, the question has no
determinate answer at all.

|
v
THE THREE CONTESTS THAT GENERATE EVERY OWNED
PART IN THIS CLAUSE

CONTEST	THE QUESTION IT ASKS	WHERE THE MARKS SIT
THE METRIC CONTEST	in which informational space is development to be judged -- output, needs, welfare, human development, capability, relations, ecology?	naming what an indicator DISCLOSES and what it CONCEALS, instead of ranking indices
THE AGENCY CONTEST	is the person a BENEFICIARY of development or its AUTHOR?	the ladder: information -> consultation -> participation -> co-decision -> EMPOWER- MENT. Not a synonym list
THE LIMIT CONTEST	what may development NOT do, whatever the gains?	irreversibility, culture and foreclosed future options are LIMITS, not costs to be priced

|
v
THE ORGANISING MOVE THAT MUST COME FIRST IN EVERY ANSWER

+-----+
| STATE WHICH CONCEPTION OF DEVELOPMENT THE STEM ASSUMES -- |
| ECONOMIC, HUMAN-DEVELOPMENT OR CAPABILITY -- BEFORE ANSWERING. |
| THE SAME STEM HAS DIFFERENT CORRECT ANSWERS UNDER EACH. |
+-----+

|
v
OWNERSHIP FENCE justice, equality, liberty, dignity as ideals ->
Social and Political Ideals | full liberalism, Marxism, socialism,
anarchism -> Political Ideologies | cultural recognition -> Humanism,
Secularism and Multiculturalism | gender doctrine -> Gender
Discrimination | caste doctrine -> Caste Discrimination | rights,
obligation, state legitimacy -> Individual and State | growth, poverty,
scheme and climate DATA -> ECONOMY, GOVERNANCE, ENVIRONMENT -- OUTSIDE
THE PHILOSOPHY PAPER ENTIRELY
CORPUS SHARE 6 of 112 parts (2018:0 2019:1 2020:1 2021:0 2022:1
2023:1 2024:1 2025:1). Every owned part is an APPLIED stem: technology,
skill education, tribal values, and the modal necessary/sufficient test.
NOT ONE asks for a definition of development on its own.

Caption: the opening grid. Two printed words, the prerequisite they conceal, the three contests - metric, agency and limit - that generate every owned part, the conception-naming move that must open every answer, the ownership fence, and the corpus share that shows this clause is tested through applied stems rather than definitions.

In plain words

Ask what "development" means and almost everyone answers with an example rather than a criterion: more factories, better roads, higher incomes, longer lives. That is not a mistake of ignorance; it is a mistake of level. The paper is not asking what development looks like. It is asking what makes any of those changes count as an **improvement** - and that is a question about standards, not about instances.

Notice what happens if you refuse the question. Suppose output doubles in a society while the people who lose their land to the new plant are neither compensated nor consulted, while women's work remains unpaid and invisible, and while a river that fed three districts is rendered unusable. Has that society developed? Every honest answer has to say: *in one respect yes, in others no* - and that answer is only available to someone who was already holding several standards apart. A person who treats "growth", "development" and "progress" as three words for the same thing cannot even state the problem, let alone adjudicate it.

ANALYSIS: So the clause has a shape. At the centre sits a **ladder of five concepts** - growth, economic development, human development, capability development, social progress - each of which corrects a defect in the one below it and picks up a new defect of its own. Around that ladder sit three contests. The **metric** contest asks in which informational space the judgment is to be made. The **agency** contest asks whether the developed person is the one who receives benefits or the one who decides. The **limit** contest asks what development may not do, however large the gains. Every one of the six owned previous-year parts is a move inside one of those three contests, and an answer that names the contest has already earned its structure.

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: **Development is a contested normative concept.** It contains a **descriptive** dimension - change in production, technology, institutions and social relations - and a **normative** dimension - the judgment that the change improves human lives. Both are always present. An answer that supplies only the descriptive half has described a transformation without evaluating it; an answer that supplies only the normative half has expressed a preference without identifying what changed.

FACT: **The master thesis of this owner, stated once and used everywhere.** Growth can finance development, but only **capabilities, justice, participation and ecological limits** convert material change into social progress. The consequence is that every verdict in this clause is **condition-specifying**: it names the conversion conditions under which the claim holds, rather than answering yes or no.

ANALYSIS: **Why the ladder is not pedantry.** The five rungs answer five different questions and are measured in five different spaces. *Is more being produced?* is a question about growth. *Are productivity, technology and opportunity structures changing?* is a question about economic development. *Are basic human options expanding?* is a question about human development. *What can persons actually achieve?* is a question about capability. *Is society becoming freer, fairer and more sustainable?* is a question about social progress. Nothing follows automatically from any rung to the one above it, and the whole examination value of this clause lies in the gaps.

FACT: **The discriminating test.** If income rises while preventable unfreedom, humiliation or ecological destruction intensifies, there is **growth without social progress**. This single sentence separates all five rungs at once and can be deployed in any owned stem.

ANALYSIS: **The five failure modes the clause names.** Growth without distribution; development without consent; technology without ethics; welfare without agency; progress as forced assimilation. Each names a way in which a change that satisfies a lower rung fails a higher one, and each supplies a ready-made critical paragraph.

FACT: **The corpus fact that shapes preparation.** This clause owns **6 of the 112** Socio-Political question-parts in the 2018-2025 corpus - 2019, 2020, 2022, 2023, 2024 and 2025, with **no owned part in 2018 or 2021**. ANALYSIS: Its internal profile matters more than its volume: **not one** owned part asks for a definition of development. They ask whether technology brings ethical progress, what the Gandhian conception is and whether it survives examination, whether economic development produces human development and social progress on its own, whether skill education enhances development, whether economic development is necessary or sufficient for social progress, and whether development can be reconciled with tribal values. Every one is applied.

Named evidence you can cite

- **The five-rung ladder and the discriminating test ANALYSIS:** - the analytical reconstruction that supplies the opening two lines of any development answer and prevents the synonym error that destroys most scripts on this clause.
- **The three contests - metric, agency, limit ANALYSIS:** - the device that converts an applied stem into an ordered analysis by naming what is actually being disputed.
- **The conversion thesis FACT:** - associated with **Sen's** treatment of resources as means whose value depends on what persons can convert them into; developed fully in Sessions 7 and 8 and used here only as the controlling idea.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Development is a contested normative concept, not a quantity: growth can finance it, but only capabilities, justice, participation and ecological limits convert material change into social progress - so the stem is answerable only once the conception of development it assumes has been made explicit.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

contested normative concept · descriptive and normative dimensions · the five-rung ladder · conversion conditions · the metric contest · the agency contest · the limit contest · growth without social progress · beneficiary against author · condition-specifying verdict

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The clause prints two words that are routinely treated as synonyms, and the whole analytical yield of the topic depends on refusing that identification: growth, economic development, human development, capability and social progress are five concepts, measured in five informational spaces, answering five different questions. **Named evidence.** The point is not verbal. Sen's treatment of resources as means whose value depends on conversion shows that equal income can yield radically unequal freedom, because bodies, environments and social norms differ; and the human-development framework associated with Mahbub ul Haq and the UNDP was constructed precisely to break the identification of income with well-being. **Analysis.** Once the rungs are separated, the clause's characteristic question becomes visible: not *how much* has changed, but *whether the change was converted* - into real opportunity, into decision-power for those affected, and within limits that leave future options open. Each of the three contests attacks that conversion at a different point, which is why an answer that names the contest immediately has an argument rather than a list. **Qualification.** The separation is analytical rather than absolute: severe material deprivation genuinely restricts health, education and voice, so the higher rungs are not independent of the lower ones. What the ladder denies is the *automatic* inference from one rung to the next, and an answer that turns the denial into a claim that growth is irrelevant has overcorrected and will be marked down for it.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: The five-rung ladder is a taxonomy imposed on the stem. The paper prints two words; nothing licenses a five-part scheme, and a candidate who spends a fifth of the answer distinguishing terms the examiner did not ask about has wasted the marks.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: The corpus settles this. The 2022 part turns on whether economic development *on its own* yields human development and social progress; the 2024 part asks whether economic development is a necessary or a sufficient condition of social progress. Both are unanswerable unless "economic development", "human development" and "social progress" are already held apart as distinct concepts with distinct measures. The distinction is not preliminary decoration; it *is* the answer to two of the six owned parts.
- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: The ladder does not settle **how much** conceptual apparatus a fifteen-mark applied stem can carry. On the 2023 skill-education part the ladder must be compressed to a single controlling distinction - capability against employability - and a candidate who deploys all five rungs will lose the time needed for the limits that stem actually rewards. The device organises; it does not excuse a failure to answer the question printed.

Examiner traps on this session

1. Using growth, development and progress interchangeably in the same paragraph. This is the single commonest failure on this clause and it is visible in the first three lines, because the script has nothing left to adjudicate.
2. Answering with policy. Schemes, targets, outlays and administrative machinery belong to Economy and Governance; the Philosophy paper is asking what would make any of them an improvement.
3. Treating the low corpus share as permission to prepare lightly. Six owned parts across eight papers, absent in two of them, is a fact about the held cycle and is not evidence about the next one.
4. Reaching for a "balanced" close - "development must be inclusive and sustainable" - which states an aspiration where the examiner asked for a condition.

Mini recap

Two printed words, one question: what entitles anyone to call a change an improvement. One prerequisite: development is a contested normative concept with a descriptive and a normative half. One ladder: growth, economic development, human development, capability, social progress - five questions, five measures, no automatic inference upward. One test: income rising alongside intensified unfreedom, humiliation or ecological destruction is growth without progress. Three contests: metric, agency, limit. One fence: ideals, ideologies, culture, gender, caste and rights are routed; data and policy lie outside the paper. Six owned parts of 112, none of them a definition question.

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 1

two printed words -> prerequisite (development is a contested normative concept: descriptive change + normative judgment)
-> MECHANISM: the five-rung ladder, with conversion required at each step
-> CONSEQUENCE: metric, agency and limit contests generate every owned part
-> TRAP: growth, development and progress used as synonyms; policy essay
-> ANSWER USE: open by naming the assumed conception, close with the conversion condition on which the verdict holds

SESSION 2 - DEVELOPMENT: THE DESCRIPTIVE AND THE NORMATIVE IN ONE CONCEPT

The picture first

THE FIVE-RUNG LADDER, FULLY LABELLED

=====

READ UP THE LEFT COLUMN. EACH RUNG CORRECTS THE DEFECT NAMED BELOW IT AND ACQUIRES THE NEW DEFECT NAMED TO ITS RIGHT.

RUNG	CONCEPT	PRIMARY MEASURE	ITS OWN FAILURE
R5	SOCIAL PROGRESS is society becoming freer, fairer, more sustainable?	justified change in relations and institutions	the values are CONTESTED; no aggregate number settles them
R4	CAPABILITY DEVELOPMENT what can persons ACTUALLY achieve?	substantive freedoms to be and to do	selection and MEASUREMENT problems
R3	HUMAN DEVELOPMENT are basic human options expanding?	health, knowledge, material command	aggregate indicators CONCEAL inequality
R2	ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT are productivity and opportunity structures changing?	structural and qualitative economic change	may remain ECONOMISTIC -- still about output and its structure
R1	ECONOMIC GROWTH is more being produced?	aggregate or per-capita output or income	ignores DISTRIBUTION and EXTERNALITIES

THE TWO DIMENSIONS PRESENT AT EVERY RUNG

DESCRIPTIVE	NORMATIVE
change in production, technology, institutions and social relations -- answers WHAT HAPPENED	the judgment that the change IMPROVES human lives -- answers WHETHER IT IS BETTER, AND BY WHAT TEST

OMIT THE FIRST -> a preference with no object.

OMIT THE SECOND -> a transformation with no evaluation.

THE DISCRIMINATING TEST -- APPLY IT TO ANY CASE IN ONE LINE

income rises -> AND preventable unfreedom, humiliation or
ecological destruction INTENSIFIES

-> THEN: GROWTH WITHOUT SOCIAL PROGRESS

THIS IS NOT AN EXOTIC CASE. IT IS THE ORDINARY CASE, AND IT IS WHY THE
LADDER EXISTS.

Caption: the five rungs with their measures, their guiding questions and their own characteristic failures; the descriptive and normative dimensions that are present at every rung; and the one-line discriminating test that can be applied to any case in an examination.

In plain words

The hardest thing to hold on to in this clause is that development is simultaneously a **factual** claim and an **evaluative** one, and that dropping either half produces a recognisable kind of bad answer.

Drop the factual half and you get the essay that is really a wish: dignity, empowerment, inclusion, sustainability, all asserted and none anchored to anything that changed. Drop the evaluative half and you get the essay that is really a report: output rose, roads were built, literacy improved - with no account of why any of that is *better*, and therefore no resources when the examiner points out that all three were true of societies nobody would describe as developed.

ANALYSIS: The ladder is the device that keeps both halves in view. Each rung names something that genuinely changed and a standard by which the change is judged. Move up a rung and you gain evaluative depth: growth tells you nothing about who received the product, human development tells you nothing about whether people could act on the options they now formally possess, and capability tells you nothing about whether the *relations* between people - status, humiliation, domination - improved. Move up a rung and you also lose measurability: the higher you climb, the more contested the standard and the less any single number can settle it. That trade-off between **evaluative richness and measurability** is the permanent tension of this clause, and naming it is worth marks in itself.

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: Doctrine statement. Development is a process of enlarging and securing people's effective capacities to live lives they have reason to value, through economic, social, political and institutional transformation.

FACT: The two dimensions. The **descriptive** dimension is change in production, technology, institutions and social relations. The **normative** dimension is the judgment that the change improves human lives. Both are constitutive; neither is optional.

FACT: The concept grid. *Economic growth* is measured by increase in aggregate or per-capita output and income; it asks whether more is being produced and it ignores distribution and externalities. *Economic development* is measured by structural and qualitative economic change; it asks whether productivity and opportunity structures are changing and it may remain economistic. *Human development* is measured by health, knowledge and material command; it asks whether basic human options are expanding and its aggregate indicators conceal inequality. *Capability development* is measured by substantive freedoms to be and to do; it asks what persons can actually achieve and it faces selection and measurement problems. *Social progress* is measured by justified improvement in social relations and institutions; it asks whether society is becoming freer, fairer and more sustainable, and its values are contested.

ANALYSIS: The trade-off to name explicitly. Ascending the ladder buys **evaluative richness** and pays in **measurability**. This is the honest form of the "capability is hard to measure" objection, and stating it before the examiner does converts a weakness into a demonstration of control.

FACT: The discriminating test. If income rises while preventable unfreedom, humiliation or ecological destruction intensifies, there may be growth without social progress. The test is deployable in a single line and does the adjudicating work in the 2022 and 2024 owned parts.

ANALYSIS: What the ladder does not claim. It does not claim that the lower rungs are worthless or that the higher rungs float free of them. Severe material deprivation genuinely restricts health, schooling and political voice, which is why the *threshold* form of the necessity claim survives (Session 13). What the ladder denies is the **automatic inference** upward - that producing more must mean living better, and that living better must mean a better society.

Named evidence you can cite

- **The concept grid with its five measures and five failures** **FACT:** - the single most transferable table in this owner; it opens the 2022 and 2024 parts and supplies the distinction paragraph in every other.
- **Sen's conversion point** **FACT:** - resources are means whose value depends on what persons can convert them into, which is why R1 and R2 cannot deliver R4 by themselves; developed in Sessions 7-8.
- **The evaluative-richness/measurability trade-off** **ANALYSIS:** - the analytical reconstruction that pre-empts the standard objection to capability-based and progress-based standards.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Growth asks whether more is being produced, human development asks whether basic options are expanding, capability asks what persons can actually achieve, and social progress asks whether relations and institutions have become defensibly better - four questions in four informational spaces, and the marks in this clause lie in the gaps between them.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

descriptive dimension · normative dimension · lives people have reason to value · structural transformation · informational space · evaluative richness against measurability · automatic inference denied · growth without social progress · conversion

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Development is a contested normative concept with two constitutive dimensions - a descriptive record of change in production, technology, institutions and social relations, and a normative judgment that the change improves human lives - and the five concepts ordinarily run together in scripts are five distinct evaluative standards. **Named evidence.** The grid makes the distinctness demonstrable: growth is measured by aggregate or per-capita output and is silent on distribution; economic development is measured by structural and qualitative change and may remain economistic; human development, in the framework associated with Mahbub ul Haq and the UNDP, is measured by longevity, knowledge and a decent material standard; capability, on Sen's account, is measured by substantive freedoms to be and to do; and social progress is measured by justified improvement in relations and institutions. **Analysis.** Because each rung is measured in a different informational space, no rung entails the one above it, and the characteristic case of this clause is the ordinary one - income rising while preventable unfreedom, humiliation or ecological destruction intensifies, which is growth without social progress. Ascending the ladder therefore buys evaluative richness at the price of measurability, and that trade-off is the honest content of the objection that capability and progress cannot be measured. **Qualification.** The independence of the rungs is analytical, not causal: severe deprivation restricts health, schooling and voice, so a material threshold remains an enabling condition of the higher rungs. The correct conclusion is that growth is instrumental and conversion-dependent, not that it is irrelevant - and an answer that reaches the second conclusion has replaced one error with its mirror image.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: The higher rungs are unmeasurable, and an unmeasurable standard cannot guide policy. Growth and income can be counted; "justified improvement in social relations" cannot, so the ladder buys philosophical sophistication at the price of practical uselessness.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: Evaluative richness is preferable to false precision. A measure that is precise about the wrong thing is not more useful than a measure that is approximate about the right thing; it is merely more confident. Moreover, the higher rungs are not unmeasurable but **multiply measurable** - health, schooling, security, participation and ecological state can each be assessed, and what resists aggregation is the weighting between them, which is a question for public reasoning rather than for statistics.
- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: Policy nevertheless needs indicators, and public reasoning about weights is itself distorted where power is unequal and where the deprived have adjusted their expectations downward. The reply blunts the objection; it does not dissolve it, and saying so is what distinguishes a controlled answer from an enthusiastic one.

Examiner traps on this session

1. Defining development and stopping. The definition earns almost nothing on its own; it earns marks when it is used to generate the distinction between the rungs and then applied to the stem's case.
2. Presenting the ladder as a historical sequence, as though societies climb it in order. It is a hierarchy of **evaluative standards**, not a stage theory - and treating it as a stage theory reintroduces exactly the linearity that Session 5 dismantles.
3. Overcorrecting into the claim that growth does not matter. The owned 2022 and 2024 parts both reward the *qualified* position, and the unqualified anti-growth claim collapses under the threshold argument.
4. Writing "quality of life" as though it were a synonym for capability. Quality of life is a distinct informational space with its own blind spot - adaptive preference - and Session 3 requires the two to be held apart.

Mini recap

Development is descriptive and normative at once. Five rungs, five measures, five characteristic failures: growth ignores distribution; economic development may remain economistic; human development conceals inequality inside aggregates; capability faces selection and measurement problems; social progress rests on contested values. Ascending buys evaluative richness and pays in measurability. No rung entails the next. The discriminating test - income up, unfreedom or humiliation or ecological destruction up - settles the ordinary case in one line. Growth is instrumental and conversion-dependent, not irrelevant.

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 2

development = descriptive change + normative judgment

- > MECHANISM: five rungs in five informational spaces, each correcting the defect below and acquiring a new one
 - > CONSEQUENCE: no automatic inference upward; the gaps carry the marks
 - > TRAP: definition without application; ladder read as a stage theory; overcorrection into "growth is irrelevant"
 - > ANSWER USE: open with the grid, adjudicate with the discriminating test, close on conversion conditions
-

SESSION 3 - MEASURING DEVELOPMENT: SEVEN INFORMATIONAL SPACES AND WHAT EACH CONCEALS

The picture first

THE SEVEN INFORMATIONAL SPACES -- WHAT EACH SEES AND WHAT EACH MISSES

NO CURRENT FIGURE IS REQUIRED ANYWHERE IN THIS CLAUSE. THE PHILOSOPHICAL QUESTION IS WHAT EACH INDICATOR FAMILY TREATS AS THE GOOD.

MEASURE FAMILY	WHAT IT ADDS	WHAT IT CAN HIDE
1 OUTPUT / INCOME aggregate or per-capita product	resource capacity	distribution, UNPAID WORK, externalities
2 BASIC NEEDS nutrition, shelter, health, sanitation, elementary education	a DEPRIVATION THRESHOLD -- who is below the line	voice, choice and quality ABOVE the threshold
3 WELFARE / QUALITY OF LIFE experienced well-being	LIVED CONDITIONS -- security, health, work, environment	ADAPTIVE PREFERENCES and unequal power: the long-deprived may report satisfaction
4 HUMAN DEVELOPMENT composite indicators	PEOPLE rather than output -- longevity, knowledge, decent material standard	within-group inequality and political freedom
5 CAPABILITIES real opportunities	CONVERSION, freedom and AGENCY	which capabilities are SELECTED, and how they are measured
6 SOCIAL-PROGRESS INDICATORS equality, dignity, participation, security	RELATIONS and public value -- how people stand to one another	aggregation across contested dimensions
7 ECOLOGICAL INDICATORS stocks, sinks, resilience, irreversibility	BIOPHYSICAL and INTERGENERATIONAL limits	the DISTRIBUTION of adjustment burdens -- who pays for restraint

THE CONTROLLING RULE

A COMPOSITE INDEX IS EVIDENCE WITHIN ONE EVALUATIVE SPACE. IT IS NOT A COMPLETE THEORY OF THE GOOD SOCIETY, AND IT CANNOT SETTLE THE WEIGHTS BETWEEN DIMENSIONS -- BECAUSE THE WEIGHTS ARE THE NORMATIVE QUESTION.

THE THREE BLIND SPOTS THAT DECIDE ANSWERS

UNPAID WORK invisible to output measures; a society can "grow" by monetising labour that was already being done

ADAPTIVE PREFERENCE . the deprived may report contentment; welfare metrics then certify the deprivation

AGGREGATION a national average can improve while every disadvantaged group inside it stands still

Caption: seven informational spaces set side by side, each with the thing it adds and the thing it conceals; the controlling rule that no composite index is a theory of the good; and the three blind spots - unpaid work, adaptive preference and aggregation - that decide the outcome of most measurement arguments in this clause.

In plain words

Every argument about "the right measure of development" is really an argument about what the measure is allowed to see. That is the useful way to hold this session, because it turns a dull list of indicators into a philosophical claim: to choose a metric is to choose an **informational space**, and to choose an informational space is to decide in advance what will count and what will be invisible.

Take the plainest case. An output measure sees whatever is bought and sold. Work done inside a household - cooking, care of the old, care of children, water collection - is done, is essential, and is not bought and sold; so it is invisible. Two societies with identical output can therefore differ enormously in how much unpaid labour is being extracted and from whom. Nothing in the output metric can register the difference, because the difference lies outside the space the metric occupies.

Or take the subtler case. A welfare metric asks people how they are doing. That looks respectful and in one way it is. But people adjust: someone who has never had access to health care, and does not expect to, may not report its absence as a deprivation at all. A metric that takes reported satisfaction at face value will then certify long deprivation as acceptable - and it will do so precisely because it respected what people said. ANALYSIS: This is why the capability approach refuses to make either goods or satisfaction the final space, and it is the reason Sen's adaptive-preference point is a **methodological** claim before it is a moral one.

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: Seven measure families, each with an informational space. Output and income capture resource capacity. Basic needs capture a deprivation threshold. Welfare and quality of life capture lived conditions and experienced well-being. Human-development indicators capture longevity, knowledge and a decent material standard. Capabilities capture real opportunities for valued beings and doings. Social-progress indicators capture equality, dignity, participation, security and institutions. Ecological indicators capture stocks, sinks, resilience, irreversibility and future options.

FACT: Each family's blind spot, stated exactly. Output hides distribution, unpaid work and externalities. Basic needs hide voice, choice and quality above the threshold. Welfare hides adaptive preferences and unequal power. Human-development composites hide within-group inequality and political freedom. Capabilities face disagreement about selection and measurement. Social-progress indicators face aggregation across contested dimensions. Ecological indicators hide the distribution of adjustment burdens.

ANALYSIS: The controlling rule. A composite index is **evidence within one evaluative space**, not a complete theory of the good society. It cannot settle the weights among dimensions, because the weights *are* the normative question - which is why public reasoning about the weights is part of development rather than merely a method for measuring it.

FACT: Why no figure is needed. **WRONG:** This owner requires **no** current statistic. The philosophical issue is what an indicator family treats as the good and what it renders invisible, and that issue is settled by analysis rather than by data. Importing an unsourced number is not merely unnecessary; it is a discipline failure that an examiner can check.

ANALYSIS: The three blind spots that decide answers. *Unpaid work* - a society can appear to grow simply by monetising labour already being performed. *Adaptive preference* - reported contentment under deprivation converts a welfare metric into a certificate of the deprivation. *Aggregation* - a national average can rise while every disadvantaged group inside it stands still. Any one of the three, deployed once, upgrades a measurement paragraph from description to argument.

Named evidence you can cite

- **The seven informational spaces with their disclosures and concealments** **FACT:** - the table that supplies the opening of any "how should development be measured" paragraph.
- **Sen's adaptive-preference point** **FACT:** - the decisive objection to welfare-based and satisfaction-based metrics; it establishes that a metric can be respectful and still certify injustice.
- **The human-development framework of Mahbub ul Haq and the UNDP** **FACT:** - the historical instance of a deliberate change of informational space, from the wealth of the economy to the lives of people; its own limit is that composite national measures conceal distribution.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

To choose a measure of development is to choose an informational space, and therefore to decide in advance what will be invisible: output cannot see unpaid work, satisfaction cannot see adapted expectations, and a national composite cannot see the group that stood still while the average rose.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

informational space · deprivation threshold · adaptive preferences · unpaid work · externalities · within-group inequality · selection problem · aggregation across contested dimensions · irreversibility · weights are the normative question

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The dispute about how to measure development is not technical but philosophical, because every metric occupies an informational space and thereby fixes what will count as evidence and what will be invisible. **Named evidence.** Seven families divide the ground: output and income disclose resource capacity while concealing distribution, unpaid work and externalities; basic-needs measures disclose a deprivation threshold while concealing voice and quality above it; welfare and quality-of-life measures disclose lived conditions while concealing adaptive preference; the human-development framework associated with Mahbub ul Haq and the UNDP discloses people rather than output while concealing within-group inequality and political freedom; capability measures disclose conversion, freedom and agency while facing disagreement over which capabilities are selected; social-progress indicators disclose relations while facing the aggregation problem; and ecological indicators disclose biophysical and intergenerational limits while concealing who bears the burden of adjustment. **Analysis.** The consequence is that a composite index is evidence within one space rather than a theory of the good, and the weighting between dimensions - which cannot be derived from within any of them - is precisely the normative question the clause is about, which is why public reasoning about weights belongs to development rather than merely to its measurement. **Qualification.** This is not an argument against measurement. Indicators are indispensable for identifying deprivation and for holding institutions to account; the claim is only that no indicator settles the evaluative question it presupposes, and that an answer which ranks indices without naming their informational spaces has described the instruments while leaving the question untouched.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: If every metric has a blind spot, the position collapses into scepticism about measurement altogether, and a society is left with no way to tell whether it is improving.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: The conclusion does not follow. Knowing a metric's blind spot is what makes it usable: an output figure read as a statement about resource capacity is informative, and it becomes misleading only when read as a statement about well-being. The correct practice is **plural measurement with explicit informational spaces**, supplemented by a stated deprivation floor below which no aggregate improvement is accepted as compensation.
- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: Plural measurement postpones rather than solves the aggregation problem, because at some point resources must be allocated and the dimensions must be traded off. The honest position is that the trade-off is a matter for accountable public reasoning under conditions of political equality - which is itself a demanding condition and not everywhere satisfied.

Examiner traps on this session

1. Ranking indices - asserting that a human-development composite is superior to an output measure - without naming what each measures. The ranking is worthless without the informational spaces, and the examiner is looking for the spaces.
2. Quoting a figure. WRONG: No statistic is required anywhere in this clause, and an unsourced number is a checkable discipline failure.
3. Treating a composite index as a theory of the good society. It is evidence within one space and cannot fix the weights between dimensions.
4. Using "quality of life" and "capability" interchangeably. Quality of life is an experiential space vulnerable to adaptive preference; capability is an opportunity space designed to escape exactly that vulnerability.

Mini recap

Seven informational spaces: output, basic needs, welfare, human development, capabilities, social-progress relations, ecology. Each adds one thing and hides another: distribution and unpaid work; quality above the threshold; adaptive preference; within-group inequality; selection and measurement; aggregation; the distribution of adjustment burdens. A composite index is evidence in one space, not a theory of the good, and it cannot settle the weights - the weights are the normative question. Three blind spots decide most arguments: unpaid work, adaptive preference, aggregation. No figure is needed anywhere in this owner.

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 3

choosing a metric = choosing an informational space

- > MECHANISM: each family discloses one thing and conceals another
 - > CONSEQUENCE: no composite settles the weights; weights are normative
 - > TRAP: ranking indices without naming spaces; importing a figure;
reading quality of life as capability
 - > ANSWER USE: open with the space, deploy one blind spot -- unpaid work,
adaptive preference or aggregation -- close on plural measurement
under a stated deprivation floor
-

SESSION 4 - THE ECONOMIC MODEL: GROWTH AS AN INSTRUMENT, NOT AN IDENTITY

The picture first

THE ECONOMIC ARGUMENT, AND EXACTLY WHERE IT BREAKS

THE ARGUMENT, IN FOUR STEPS -- STATE IT IN ITS BEST FORM FIRST

1. MATERIAL SCARCITY constrains health, education and choice.

|

v

2. PRODUCTIVE GROWTH expands the resource base.

|

v

3. STRUCTURAL TRANSFORMATION can raise employment and state capacity.

|

v

4. THEREFORE economic development is an important ENABLING condition.

|

v

THE HIDDEN PREMISE THAT CARRIES THE WHOLE ARGUMENT

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+-----+
| RESOURCES CAN BE CONVERTED INTO BROADLY SHARED WELFARE THROUGH |
| INSTITUTIONS. <-- THIS IS AN ASSUMPTION, NOT A FINDING.         |
+-----+
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|

v

ATTACK THE PREMISE, NOT THE CONCLUSION. FIVE THINGS GROWTH IS SILENT ON:

DISTRIBUTION who receives the additional product?

WORK QUALITY under what conditions is it produced?

DISPLACEMENT who loses land, livelihood or habitat for it?

POLITICAL VOICE ... who decided, and could anyone have refused?

ECOLOGICAL COST ... what stock or sink was drawn down, and is the
loss reversible?

|

v

THE CORRECT CONCLUSION -- AND THE OVERCORRECTION TO AVOID

CORRECT	OVERCORRECTION
growth is INSTRUMENTAL and	"growth is irrelevant" or
CONVERSION-DEPENDENT; its	"growth is inherently harmful"
developmental value is a	
FUNCTION of the conversion	-> defeated by the THRESHOLD
conditions that surround it	argument, and it forfeits the
	2022 and 2024 owned parts

|

v

THE ONE-LINE FORMULA THAT SETTLES BOTH MODAL STEMS

"Growth becomes progress only through JUST CONVERSION into capability, dignity and sustainable institutions; the conversion conditions, not the output figure, are where the normative question lies."

Caption: the economic argument set out in its strongest four-step form, the hidden conversion premise on which it depends, the five things growth cannot register, and the difference between the correct conclusion - instrumental and conversion-dependent - and the overcorrection that forfeits marks.

In plain words

The economic position deserves to be stated well before it is criticised, because a badly stated version is easy to knock down and earns nothing. Its strongest form runs like this. Poverty is not merely a lack of money; it is a lack of the material conditions on which health, schooling and choice depend. Producing more relaxes that constraint. Producing more in structurally different ways - moving labour into higher-productivity activity, building the administrative and fiscal capacity of the state - relaxes it further and more durably. So a society that wants people to live better has a serious reason to want its economy to grow.

Notice that this argument, stated that carefully, does not say that growth *is* development. It says growth is an **enabling condition**. And that is where the interesting move lies: the argument is carried by a premise it rarely states, namely that resources can be converted into broadly shared welfare through institutions. ANALYSIS: Everything in the

criticism of economism follows from taking that premise seriously and then asking whether it holds - rather than from denying the value of production, which no serious position in this clause does.

Once the premise is exposed, the criticism becomes specific rather than moralistic. Growth is silent on **who receives** the product, on the **conditions** under which it was produced, on **who was displaced** to produce it, on **who decided**, and on **what was drawn down** in the process. Those are five different silences, and each of them is a paragraph.

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: **The economistic model.** It identifies development chiefly with industrialisation, investment, productivity and rising income.

FACT: **Its argument.** (1) Material scarcity constrains health, education and choice. (2) Productive growth expands the resource base. (3) Structural transformation can raise employment and state capacity. (4) Therefore economic development is an important enabling condition of development.

FACT: **Its presupposition.** Resources can be converted into broadly shared welfare **through institutions**. This is the premise to attack, because it is an assumption about institutional quality rather than a finding about production.

FACT: **The objection.** Growth says little about distribution, work quality, displacement, political voice or ecological cost.

ANALYSIS: **The reply, stated exactly.** The proper conclusion is **not** that growth is irrelevant, but that it is **instrumental and conversion-dependent**. This is the single most important sentence in the session, because it is the position that survives both the 2022 and the 2024 owned parts.

ANALYSIS: **Why the overcorrection loses marks.** A script that concludes "growth does not matter" cannot answer the 2024 modal stem, because the threshold form of the necessity claim depends on material adequacy being genuinely enabling. It also cannot explain why populations below a deprivation threshold demand material improvement - a demand that the post-development critique, at its strongest, is careful not to dismiss (Session 10).

FACT: **The verdict formula.** Growth becomes progress only through **just conversion** into capability, dignity and sustainable institutions; the conversion conditions, not the output figure, are where the normative question lies.

Named evidence you can cite

- **The four-step economistic argument with its conversion premise** FACT: - stating the opposing position in its best form is itself a mark-bearing move, and locating the premise is what makes the criticism specific.
- **The five silences of growth** ANALYSIS: - distribution, work quality, displacement, political voice, ecological cost; each is a ready-made critical paragraph and each maps onto a later session.
- **Sen's instrumental reading of income** FACT: - income matters through what it enables persons to be and to do, which is the doctrinal basis for calling growth conversion-dependent rather than valuable in itself.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The economistic model is not refuted by denying that production matters; it is refuted by exposing its unstated premise - that resources are converted into broadly shared welfare through institutions - and showing that the conversion, not the output, is where the developmental question actually lies.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

economistic model · enabling condition · conversion premise · instrumental and conversion-dependent · distribution · work quality · displacement · political voice · ecological cost · just conversion

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The economic identification of development with industrialisation, investment, productivity and rising income fails not because production is unimportant but because the model depends on an unstated premise about institutional conversion. **Named evidence.** Stated at its strongest, the argument runs from material scarcity constraining health, education and choice, through the expansion of the resource base by growth and the raising of employment and state capacity by structural transformation, to the conclusion that economic development is an important enabling condition - and every step of that inference presupposes that resources can be converted into broadly shared welfare through institutions. **Analysis.** Once the premise is named, the criticism becomes specific rather than moralistic: growth is silent on who receives the additional product, on the conditions of the work that produced it, on who was displaced for it, on who decided, and on what stock or sink was drawn down irreversibly. Sen's instrumental reading of income supplies the doctrinal ground here, since income matters through what persons can convert it into, and conversion varies with body, environment and social norms. **Qualification.** The proper conclusion is therefore that growth is instrumental and conversion-dependent, not that it is irrelevant. The stronger anti-growth claim is defeated by the threshold argument - severe material deprivation genuinely restricts health, schooling and voice - and an answer that reaches it has replaced economism with its mirror image rather than correcting it.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: The conversion-dependence claim is unfalsifiable as stated. Any case where growth improved lives is credited to good conversion and any case where it did not is blamed on bad conversion, so the thesis never risks anything.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: The thesis is specified rather than open-ended: the conversion conditions are **nameable in advance** - distributive rules, work quality and security, protection against displacement without consent, effective political voice, and ecological limits on irreversibility. Because they are nameable in advance, they can be examined before the outcome is known, and a case where all five obtain and lives nevertheless fail to improve would count against the thesis.
- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: The list of conversion conditions is not itself derived from a single theory, and different traditions weight the five differently - the liberal lens emphasising rules and rights, the Marxist lens emphasising control of production, the Gandhian lens emphasising scale and restraint. The thesis therefore inherits the disagreement it was meant to organise, and an honest answer says so instead of presenting the five conditions as uncontroversial.

Examiner traps on this session

1. Attacking a straw version of economism - "some people think money is everything" - instead of the four-step argument. The strong version is what the examiner is testing.
2. Concluding that growth is irrelevant or inherently harmful. This forfeits the threshold argument and with it the 2024 modal part.
3. Listing the five silences without attaching any of them to the stem's case. Each silence is a paragraph only when it does work on the question actually asked.
4. Treating "structural transformation" as a synonym for growth. It is a distinct rung - a change in the *composition* of production and in institutional capacity, not merely in its volume.

Mini recap

State economism at its best: scarcity constrains, growth relaxes, structural change raises capacity, so economic development enables. Locate the hidden premise: institutions convert resources into shared welfare. Attack the premise, and the criticism becomes five specific silences - distribution, work quality, displacement, voice, ecological cost. Draw the correct conclusion: growth is instrumental and conversion-dependent. Refuse the overcorrection. Close on the formula: growth becomes progress only through just conversion into capability, dignity and sustainable institutions.

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 4

economistic model -> four-step argument stated at its strongest

-> MECHANISM: the hidden premise is INSTITUTIONAL CONVERSION

-> CONSEQUENCE: five silences -- distribution, work quality, displacement, voice, ecological cost

-> TRAP: straw version; overcorrection to "growth is irrelevant"; silences listed but never applied

-> ANSWER USE: expose the premise, deploy two silences on the stem's case, close with the just-conversion formula

SESSION 5 - MODERNISATION THEORY: FIVE ASSUMPTIONS AND FOUR HOSTILE OBJECTIONS

The picture first

MODERNISATION AS A THEORY -- NOT AS NEUTRAL INEVITABILITY

WHAT IT DESCRIBES (real, and not to be denied)

industrialisation | urbanisation | mass education | occupational differentiation | bureaucratic capacity | scientific rationality | expanding markets

-- a TRANSITION from "traditional" to "modern" social organisation

|
v

THE FIVE ASSUMPTIONS THAT MAKE IT A THEORY RATHER THAN A DESCRIPTION

1	LINEAR SEQUENCE	societies move through broadly comparable stages
2	CONVERGENCE	institutional differences DIMINISH as productive and administrative capacity grows
3	TRADITIONAL/MODERN CONTRAST	inherited authority and local production YIELD to rational, mobile, differentiated institutions
4	DIFFUSION	capital, knowledge and technology can TRANSMIT development
5	EXPERT DIRECTION	planners can identify obstacles and ACCELERATE the transition

|

THE FOUR HOSTILE OBJECTIONS -- ONE PER ASSUMPTION CLUSTER

|

DEPENDENCY	POST-DEVELOPMENT	CULTURAL / GANDHIAN	MARXIST
denies that underdevelopment is merely an EARLIER STAGE	exposes the POWER TO DEFINE others as DEFICIENT	rejects HOMOGENISATION of the good life	asks WHO OWNS PRODUCTION and WHO APPROPRIATES THE GAINS
hits (1)(2)	hits (5)	hits (3)	hits (2)(4)

|

AND ONE MORE THAT SCRIPTS ALWAYS FORGET

AMBEDKARITE: does modernisation DISMANTLE graded hierarchy, or does it merely REORGANISE it inside new occupations and institutions?

|
v

THE VERDICT TO STATE -- BALANCED BUT DECISIVE

MODERNISATION NAMES REAL STRUCTURAL TRANSFORMATIONS BUT IS NOT A NEUTRAL OR INEVITABLE LAW. ITS INSTITUTIONS COUNT AS PROGRESS ONLY WHEN THEY ENLARGE EQUAL CAPABILITY, DEMOCRATIC AGENCY AND ECOLOGICAL SECURITY.
--

Caption: modernisation split into what it accurately describes and the five assumptions that turn the description into a theory; the four hostile objections mapped onto the assumptions each one attacks; the Ambedkarite objection that scripts routinely omit; and the verdict that concedes the structural transformations while denying the neutrality and the inevitability.

In plain words

Modernisation theory is the position most candidates hold without knowing they hold it. Whenever a script says that a society is "still traditional", or that it must "catch up", or that development can be delivered by transferring technology and expertise, it is using modernisation assumptions - and using them as though they were descriptions of how the world works rather than a theory that can be false.

The way to take control of this material is to separate the **description** from the **assumptions**. The description is largely accurate: industrialisation, urbanisation, mass schooling, occupational differentiation, bureaucratic capacity, scientific rationality and expanding markets are real processes and denying them is not available. What converts that description into a theory is a set of five further claims: that societies pass through broadly comparable **stages**; that institutional differences **converge** as capacity grows; that inherited authority and local production **yield** to rational, mobile, differentiated institutions; that capital, knowledge and technology can be **diffused**; and that **experts** can identify obstacles and accelerate the transition.

ANALYSIS: Each of the four standard critiques attacks a different assumption, and saying which one is attacked is the difference between an organised answer and a list of complaints. Dependency attacks the stage and convergence claims by arguing that underdevelopment is produced rather than inherited. Post-development attacks the expert-direction claim by asking who authorised the diagnosis. The cultural and Gandhian critique attacks the traditional/modern contrast by refusing to concede that one form of the good life is simply superior. The Marxist critique attacks convergence and diffusion by asking who owns production and who takes the surplus. And the Ambedkarite objection - the one scripts forget - attacks the entire package by asking whether modern institutions **dismantle** graded hierarchy or merely **reorganise** it into new occupations and new offices.

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: **What modernisation theory says.** It interprets development as a transition from "traditional" to "modern" social organisation through industrialisation, urbanisation, education, occupational differentiation, bureaucratic capacity, scientific rationality and expanding markets.

FACT: **Its five assumptions.** (1) **Linear sequence:** societies move through broadly comparable stages. (2) **Convergence:** institutional differences diminish as productive and administrative capacity grows. (3) **Traditional/modern contrast:** inherited authority and local production yield to rational, mobile and differentiated institutions. (4) **Diffusion:** capital, knowledge and technology can transmit development. (5) **Expert direction:** planners can identify obstacles and accelerate transition.

FACT: **The four hostile objections.** Dependency denies that underdevelopment is merely an earlier stage. Post-development exposes the power to define others as deficient. Cultural and Gandhian critiques reject homogenisation of the good life. Marxist criticism asks who owns production and appropriates the gains.

FACT: **The fifth objection, and it is Indian.** Ambedkarite criticism asks whether modernisation **dismantles** or merely **reorganises** graded hierarchy. ANALYSIS: This is the objection most likely to be omitted and the one that gives an Indian answer analytical rather than illustrative content.

ANALYSIS: **The verdict.** Modernisation names real structural transformations but is **not a neutral or inevitable law**. Its institutions count as progress only when they enlarge **equal capability, democratic agency and ecological security**.

ANALYSIS: **Why the verdict must be two-sided.** Denying the structural transformations is empirically indefensible and will read as ideology; accepting them as inevitable and neutral concedes the entire critical apparatus of this clause. The examinable position holds both: the transformations are real, and their evaluation is open.

Named evidence you can cite

- **The five assumptions, named FACT:** - the move that converts "modernisation is Eurocentric" from a slogan into an argument, because it identifies exactly what is being denied.

- **The objection-to-assumption mapping ANALYSIS:** - dependency against sequence and convergence, post-development against expert direction, cultural and Gandhian critique against the traditional/modern contrast, Marxist critique against convergence and diffusion.
- **The Ambedkarite question FACT:** - whether modern institutions dismantle graded hierarchy or reorganise it; a bounded bridge, used as a *test* of modernisation and never expanded into caste doctrine.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Modernisation describes real structural transformations, but it becomes a theory only through five further assumptions - linear sequence, convergence, the traditional/modern contrast, diffusion and expert direction - and every serious critique of it is an attack on one of those five rather than a denial that industrialisation occurred.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

linear sequence · convergence · traditional/modern contrast · diffusion · expert direction · produced underdevelopment · authority to diagnose · homogenisation of the good life · who appropriates the surplus · reorganised rather than dismantled hierarchy

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Modernisation is a theory rather than a neutral description of what happens when societies industrialise, and identifying the five assumptions that make it a theory is the precondition of criticising it responsibly. **Named evidence.** The description it offers - industrialisation, urbanisation, mass education, occupational differentiation, bureaucratic capacity, scientific rationality and expanding markets - is largely accurate; what converts it into a theory is the addition of a linear sequence of comparable stages, a convergence claim, a traditional/modern contrast, a diffusion mechanism and a warrant for expert direction. **Analysis.** Each standard critique then lands on a specific assumption: dependency denies the stage and convergence claims by holding that underdevelopment can be produced through unequal incorporation rather than inherited; post-development denies the warrant for expert direction by asking by what authority whole societies are defined as deficient; cultural and Gandhian critiques deny the traditional/modern contrast by refusing to concede that one conception of the good life is simply superior; Marxist criticism denies convergence and diffusion by locating the question in the ownership of production and the appropriation of the surplus; and the Ambedkarite objection asks whether modern institutions dismantle graded hierarchy or merely reorganise it into new occupations and offices. **Qualification.** The verdict must therefore be two-sided: the structural transformations are real and cannot be denied, but they count as progress only where they enlarge equal capability, democratic agency and ecological security - so modernisation is answerable to a standard it does not itself supply.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: The critique proves too much. If no comparable sequence exists and no institutional convergence occurs, then cross-society comparison is impossible and every society becomes its own standard - which makes the very idea of development, and of this clause, incoherent.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: The denial is of a **single universal route**, not of comparability as such. Some capacities - the ability to be nourished, to be schooled, to avoid premature death, to appear in public without shame, to participate in decisions - are comparable across societies without presupposing that they must be reached by one path or embodied in one set of institutions. The correct position is **plural development under universal constraints**: many routes, but a shared floor of dignity, freedom from severe deprivation, equal civic standing and ecological responsibility.
- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: The universal floor is easier to state than to specify at its boundary. Beyond the clearest capacities the list becomes contested, and the specification is itself vulnerable to the post-development objection about who is doing the specifying - which is why the floor must be defended by public reasoning rather than asserted by expertise.

Examiner traps on this session

1. Presenting modernisation as neutral inevitability - "as countries develop, they naturally become modern". That sentence contains three of the five assumptions and concedes the argument before it starts.

2. Denying the structural transformations altogether. Industrialisation, urbanisation and mass schooling are real, and denying them reads as ideology rather than analysis.
3. Naming the critiques without mapping them to assumptions. "Dependency and post-development criticise modernisation" is a sentence about the literature; naming which assumption each denies is a sentence about the argument.
4. Omitting the Ambedkarite question in an Indian answer. It is the objection that makes an Indian illustration analytical rather than decorative.

Mini recap

Separate the description from the theory. The description - industrialisation, urbanisation, schooling, differentiation, bureaucracy, scientific rationality, markets - is real. The theory adds five assumptions: linear sequence, convergence, traditional/modern contrast, diffusion, expert direction. Four hostile objections attack them: dependency, post-development, cultural/Gandhian, Marxist - and the Ambedkarite question asks whether hierarchy is dismantled or merely reorganised. Verdict: real transformations, no neutral law; institutions count as progress only when they enlarge equal capability, democratic agency and ecological security. The middle path is plural development under universal constraints.

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 5

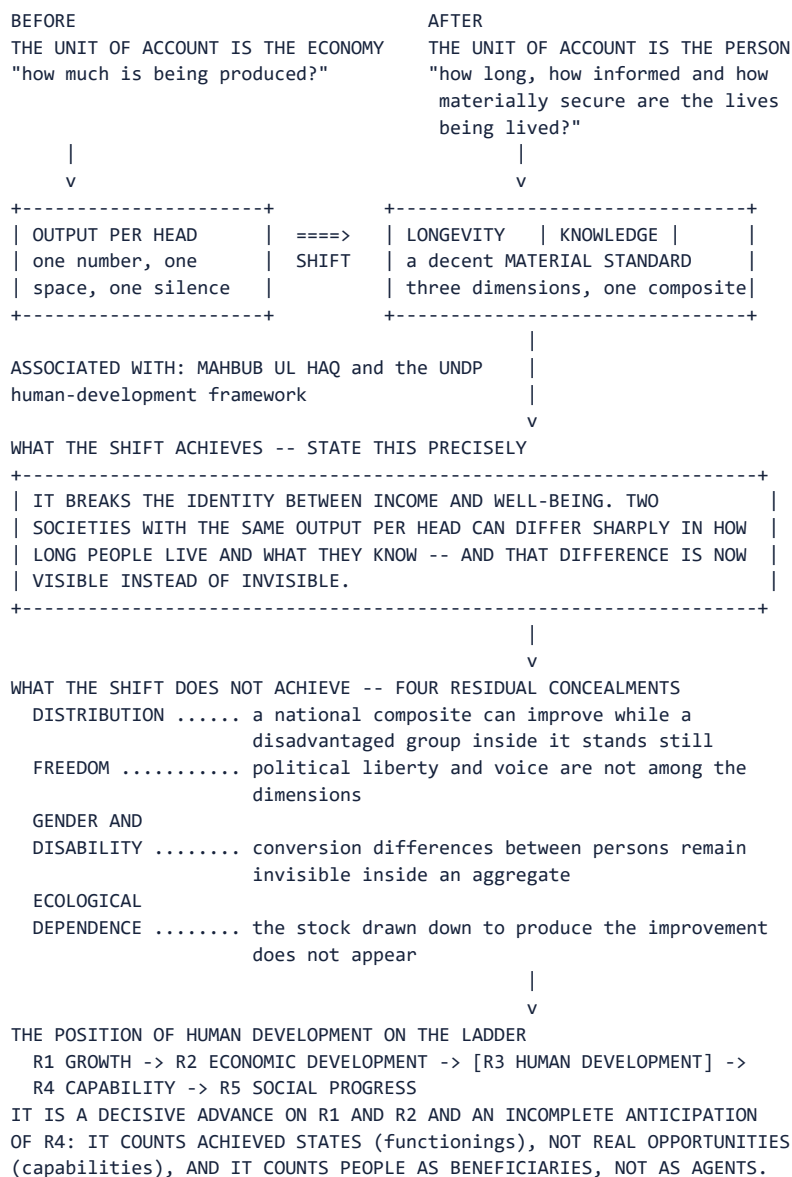
modernisation -> separate the DESCRIPTION from the FIVE ASSUMPTIONS

- > MECHANISM: sequence | convergence | traditional-modern | diffusion | expert direction
 - > CONSEQUENCE: each critique attacks a named assumption; the Ambedkarite question tests the whole package
 - > TRAP: neutral inevitability; blanket denial; unmapped critiques
 - > ANSWER USE: concede the transformations, deny the law, close on plural development under universal constraints
-

SESSION 6 - HUMAN DEVELOPMENT: THE SHIFT FROM THE WEALTH OF THE ECONOMY TO THE LIVES OF PEOPLE

The picture first

THE HUMAN-DEVELOPMENT SHIFT -- WHAT MOVED, AND WHAT DID NOT



Caption: the human-development shift shown as a change in the unit of account, the identity it breaks, the four things it still conceals, and its exact position on the ladder - a decisive advance on output measures and an incomplete anticipation of the capability approach.

In plain words

The human-development framework did something deceptively simple: it changed what the numbers are *about*. Before the shift, the standard summary of how a society was doing described the economy - how much it produced, how fast that was rising, how it was distributed between sectors. After the shift, the standard summary described **people** - how long they live, what they know, and whether they command enough resources for a decent standard of living.

That sounds like a technical adjustment. It is not. It is a change of subject, and it has an immediate consequence: two societies producing the same amount per head can now be seen to differ enormously in how long their people live and how much schooling they get. Before the shift, that difference had nowhere to appear. ANALYSIS: Breaking the identity between income and well-being is the achievement, and it is worth stating in exactly those words, because it is what the framework is *for*.

But it is important to be equally precise about what did not change. A national composite is still an average, so a group that stands still while the average rises remains invisible. Political freedom is not among the dimensions, so a society can score well while its people cannot speak. Differences between persons in how much a given resource yields - a disabled person needs more to reach the same functioning - are averaged away. And the ecological stock drawn down to produce the improvement does not appear anywhere. Those four residual concealments are exactly the openings through which the capability approach enters in the next session.

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: **The doctrine.** The human-development approach, associated with **Mahbub ul Haq** and the **UNDP** framework, shifts the focus from the wealth of the economy to the lives of people, especially **longevity, knowledge and a decent material standard**.

FACT: **Its strength, stated exactly.** It **breaks the identity between income and well-being**. This is the sentence to write; vaguer formulations - "it is a broader measure" - do not earn the mark.

FACT: **Its limitation, stated exactly.** Composite national measures can **obscure distribution, freedom, gender, disability and ecological dependence**.

ANALYSIS: **Its position on the ladder.** Human development is R3: a decisive advance on growth and economic development, and an **incomplete anticipation** of the capability approach at R4. The incompleteness has two named parts. First, it counts **achieved states** - being alive at a given age, having attended school - which are *functionings*, not the *real opportunities* that capability measures. Second, it counts people as **beneficiaries** whose outcomes are recorded, not as **agents** whose reasoning and choices are part of the good being measured.

ANALYSIS: **Why the incompleteness matters for the 2022 owned part.** The 2022 stem asks whether economic development *on its own* leads to human development and social progress. A script that treats human development as the terminus has conceded half the question, because human development is itself only a rung - and the stem names social progress separately for exactly that reason.

FACT: **The discipline point.** WRONG: No index score, rank or figure is required. The examinable content is the change of informational space and the four residual concealments, not any published number.

Named evidence you can cite

- **Mahbub ul Haq and the UNDP human-development framework** FACT: - the historical instance of a deliberate change in the unit of account, from the economy to the person.
- **The identity-breaking formulation** FACT: - "it breaks the identity between income and well-being" is the precise statement of the achievement and is directly usable in the 2022 answer.
- **The four residual concealments** FACT: - distribution, freedom, gender and disability, ecological dependence; each of the four is the doorway to a later session, and naming them shows the framework's limits without dismissing it.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The human-development framework did not merely widen the measure; it changed the unit of account from the economy to the person, and its achievement is precisely that it breaks the identity between income and well-being - while leaving distribution, freedom, gender, disability and ecological dependence still concealed inside the aggregate.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

unit of account · wealth of the economy against the lives of people · longevity, knowledge, decent material standard · breaks the identity between income and well-being · composite national measure · within-group invisibility · achieved state against real opportunity · beneficiary rather than agent

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The human-development approach is best understood not as a wider indicator but as a change in the unit of account, and its philosophical achievement is that it breaks the identity between income and well-being. **Named evidence.** The framework associated with Mahbub ul Haq and the UNDP replaces output per head with longevity, knowledge and a decent material standard, so that two societies producing the same amount per head can be seen to differ in how long people live and what they are able to learn - a difference that has no place to appear inside an output measure. **Analysis.** The consequence is decisive for the modal stems in this clause, because it shows that the inference from economic development to improved lives is contingent rather than automatic: what a society produces and what its members are able to be and do are recorded in different informational spaces, and the relation between them depends on how resources are converted. **Qualification.** The advance is nevertheless incomplete in four specified respects - a national composite conceals within-group inequality, political freedom is not among the dimensions, differences in conversion arising from gender and disability are averaged away, and the ecological stock drawn down to finance the improvement does not appear - and it counts achieved states rather than real opportunities, which is precisely the gap the capability approach was constructed to close.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: If composite national measures conceal distribution, freedom, gender, disability and ecology, then the human-development framework is barely an improvement on output measures: it has simply substituted one misleading average for another.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: The substitution is not neutral, because the two averages are averages of different things. An output average can rise with no improvement in any life at all; a longevity-and-schooling average cannot, since it is composed of achievements in lives. The framework therefore guarantees a floor of relevance that an output measure does not, and its concealments are corrigible - disaggregation by group, by gender and by region is available within the same framework, whereas the output measure cannot be disaggregated into well-being at all.
- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: Disaggregation improves the diagnosis without closing the deeper gap, because the framework still records **achieved functionings** rather than the **opportunities** persons actually had. A society that produces long, schooled lives by compulsion would score identically to one that produces them by expanding choice, and no amount of disaggregation distinguishes the two.

Examiner traps on this session

1. Treating human development as the final standard. It is R3; the owned 2022 part names social progress separately precisely because the two are not the same.
2. Reducing the framework to a comparison of two indices. The examinable content is the change of unit and the identity it breaks, not a ranking of measures.
3. Quoting an index value or rank. WRONG: No figure is required, and an unsourced one is a discipline failure.
4. Presenting human development and capability as the same approach. Human development counts achieved states and treats people as beneficiaries; capability counts real opportunities and treats people as agents.

Mini recap

The shift changed the unit of account from the economy to the person: longevity, knowledge, a decent material standard. Its achievement is that it breaks the identity between income and well-being. Its limitation is that composite national measures conceal distribution, freedom, gender, disability and ecological dependence. Its position is R3 - decisive over R1 and R2, incomplete against R4, because it records achieved functionings rather than real opportunities and counts people as beneficiaries rather than agents. No figure is required anywhere.

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 6

human development -> a change in the UNIT OF ACCOUNT, not a wider index
 -> MECHANISM: longevity + knowledge + decent material standard
 -> CONSEQUENCE: the identity between income and well-being is broken
 -> TRAP: treating R3 as the terminus; quoting an index; merging it with capability
 -> ANSWER USE: state the identity-breaking achievement, then name the four residual concealments as the doorway to capability

SESSION 7 - SEN I: FUNCTIONING, CAPABILITY, RESOURCE, UTILITY, AGENCY

The picture first

THE FIVE TERMS, AND THE CONVERSION THAT JOINS THEM
 =====

RESOURCE	CONVERSION FACTORS	CAPABILITY
a means whose value depends on what it can be turned into	--> personal (body, age, impairment, metabolism) environmental (climate, terrain, infrastructure) social (norms, safety, discrimination, public provision)	--> the REAL OPPORTUNITY to achieve alternative FUNCTIONINGS CHOICE v FUNCTIONING an ACHIEVED being or doing -- being nourished, moving freely, participating
e.g. a bicycle, a grain ration, an income		

THE DIAGRAM READ IN ONE SENTENCE

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+-----+
| EQUAL RESOURCES YIELD UNEQUAL FREEDOM, BECAUSE BODIES, |
| ENVIRONMENTS AND SOCIAL NORMS DIFFER. THAT IS THE WHOLE ARGUMENT. |
+-----+
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THE FIFTH AND SIXTH TERMS -- THE TWO THAT SCRIPTS DROP

```
+-----+
| UTILITY | satisfaction. IT ADAPTS DOWNWARD under deprivation, |
|         | so it can certify the deprivation it measures.   |
+-----+
| AGENCY  | the ability to pursue goals ONE HAS REASON TO    |
|         | VALUE, INCLUDING GOALS BEYOND ONE'S OWN WELFARE.   |
|         | A person can be well-fed and still not be an agent.   |
+-----+
```

THE THREE SPACES, SIDE BY SIDE -- THIS IS THE EXAMINABLE CONTRAST

SPACE	WHAT IS COUNTED	WHY IT FAILS AS THE FINAL SPACE
RESOURCES (means)	goods and income held	ignores CONVERSION differences between persons
UTILITY (mental states)	reported satisfaction	ADAPTS to deprivation; respects the report and endorses the injustice
CAPABILITY (freedom)	REAL OPPORTUNITY to achieve valued beings and doings	<-- SEN'S ANSWER. It counts what persons can ACTUALLY do, and it leaves the choosing to them

THE DISTINCTION THAT DECIDES MOST MCQS AND HALF THE MARKS

FASTING and STARVING produce the SAME FUNCTIONING (undernourishment) and RADICALLY DIFFERENT CAPABILITY SETS. THE FIRST HAS THE OPTION TO EAT AND DECLINES IT; THE SECOND HAS NO OPTION AT ALL.

-> CAPABILITY IS THE OPPORTUNITY SET, NOT THE OUTCOME CHOSEN FROM IT.

Caption: the five terms arranged as a single conversion process, the two terms scripts routinely drop, the three candidate informational spaces with the reason each of the first two fails, and the fasting-and-starving contrast that fixes the capability/functioning distinction in one line.

In plain words

Sen's argument is often summarised as "development is freedom", which is true and almost useless, because it does not say what kind of freedom or how it is measured. The working content is a set of five terms and one relation between them, and once you have them the rest of the clause becomes tractable.

Start with the relation. A resource - a bicycle, a grain ration, an income - is not valuable in itself. It is valuable because of what a person can turn it into. How much a person can turn it into depends on facts about her body, her environment and her society: whether she can ride, whether the road exists, whether it is safe for her to be on it, whether norms permit her to travel alone. Those are the **conversion factors**, and they are the reason equal resources yield unequal freedom.

What the conversion produces is a **capability** - a real opportunity to achieve some set of beings and doings. What she then does with the opportunity is a **functioning** - an achieved being or doing. ANALYSIS: The distinction between the two is where most marks are won and lost, and the clean way to fix it is the contrast between fasting and starving. Both are undernourished; both have the same functioning. One has the option to eat and declines it; the other has no option at all. If you measure only the functioning you cannot tell them apart, and any theory that cannot tell them apart is not a theory of freedom.

Then two further terms. **Utility** is satisfaction, and its problem is that it moves: people who have been deprived for a long time adjust what they expect and report contentment. A metric that trusts the report will certify the deprivation. **Agency** is the ability to pursue goals one has reason to value - *including goals that are not about one's own welfare*. That clause is the one scripts always drop, and it is what separates a person who is well-provided-for from a person who is free.

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: **Sen's account of development**. Development is the expansion of **substantive freedom** and the removal of unfreedoms. Resources matter through their **conversion** into capabilities.

FACT: **The five core terms**. A **functioning** is an achieved being or doing - being nourished, moving freely, participating. A **capability** is the real opportunity to achieve alternative functionings. A **resource** is a means whose value depends on conversion conditions. **Utility** is satisfaction, which may adapt downward under deprivation. **Agency** is the ability to pursue goals one has reason to value, **including goals beyond personal welfare**.

FACT: **Conversion factors**. Personal - body, age, impairment, metabolism. Environmental - climate, terrain, infrastructure. Social - norms, safety, discrimination, public provision. ANALYSIS: Naming the three kinds converts "conversion varies" from an assertion into an analysis.

FACT: **The first two steps of the argument**. (1) Equal resources yield unequal freedom because bodies, environments and social norms differ. (2) Utility can adapt to deprivation.

ANALYSIS: **The presupposition**. Persons are **agents**, not passive recipients of welfare. Everything distinctive in Sen's framework - the emphasis on public reasoning, the refusal to fix a final list, the insistence on participation as constitutive - follows from this single presupposition.

ANALYSIS: **The capability/functioning discipline**. Capability is the **opportunity set**; functioning is the **element chosen from it**. Promoting compulsory functionings - requiring people to eat, to work, to be schooled in one way - secures functionings at the cost of the freedom that made them valuable. This is why capability, not functioning, is the space of evaluation.

Named evidence you can cite

- **Sen, Development as Freedom*** FACT: - development as the expansion of substantive freedom and the removal of unfreedoms; cited by author and title only, with no page or wording asserted.
- **Sen, Commodities and Capabilities*** FACT: - the treatment of goods as means whose value depends on conversion into what persons can be and do.
- **The three kinds of conversion factor** FACT: - personal, environmental, social; the analytical device that lets an answer explain *why* equal resources produce unequal freedom instead of merely asserting it.
- **The fasting/starving contrast** ANALYSIS: - the standard reconstruction that fixes the capability/functioning distinction in a single line and is worth deploying in any capability answer.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Income is a means of development and capability is a measure of what the means enable: equal resources yield unequal freedom because bodies, environments and social norms differ, so the developmental question is never how much is held but what can actually be achieved with it.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

substantive freedom · functioning · capability · conversion factors - personal, environmental, social · utility and adaptive preference · agency · goals beyond personal welfare · opportunity set against chosen element · removal of unfreedoms

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Sen's reconstruction of development as the expansion of substantive freedom is not a slogan but a specification of the informational space in which development is to be judged, and its working content is the distinction between resources, functionings and capabilities. **Named evidence.** In *Development as Freedom* and *Commodities and Capabilities* the argument runs through conversion: a resource is a means whose value depends on what a person can turn it into, and how much she can turn it into depends on personal factors such as body and impairment, environmental factors such as terrain and infrastructure, and social factors such as norms, safety and public provision. **Analysis.** It follows that equal resources yield unequal freedom, so a resource metric misdescribes equality; and since utility adapts downward under long deprivation, a satisfaction metric can certify the very deprivation it records. Capability escapes both because it counts the real opportunity to achieve alternative functionings rather than the goods held or the contentment reported - which is why fasting and starving, identical as functionings, are radically different as capability sets. **Qualification.** The framework presupposes that persons are agents rather than recipients, and this both grounds its refusal to promote compulsory functionings and exposes it to the objection that selecting and measuring relevant capabilities is contested - an objection Sen answers by referring the selection to public reasoning rather than to expertise, which relocates the difficulty without eliminating it.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: Capability is unusable in practice. Opportunity sets are counterfactual - they concern what a person *could* have done - and counterfactuals cannot be observed, so any actual measurement will fall back on achieved functionings and the distinction will collapse in application.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: The objection describes a difficulty of estimation, not a failure of the concept, and the difficulty is routinely managed. Conversion factors are observable: impairment, distance, infrastructure, discriminatory norms and the availability of public provision can all be recorded, and together they license inferences about opportunity that go well beyond the observed outcome. Two people with the same nutritional status but different access to food are not indistinguishable to any competent inquiry.
- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: Estimation nevertheless requires a **selection** of the capabilities that matter, and that selection is contested. Sen refers it to public reasoning; but public reasoning conducted under unequal power and adapted expectations may select badly, which is exactly the pressure point Nussbaum's threshold is designed to relieve (Session 9).

Examiner traps on this session

1. Reducing Sen to "income plus health and education". That is the human-development framework, not the capability approach, and the reduction discards conversion, agency and the opportunity/outcome distinction in one stroke.
2. Confusing capability with achieved functioning. Capability is the opportunity set; the functioning is what was chosen from it, and the fasting/starving contrast exists to keep them apart.
3. Dropping "including goals beyond personal welfare" from the definition of agency. Without that clause agency collapses into self-interested choice and the argument for participation loses its constitutive half.
4. Treating conversion as a single vague idea. Naming the three kinds - personal, environmental, social - is what turns the point into an analysis.

Mini recap

Five terms: resource, conversion factor, capability, functioning, utility - with agency added as the sixth and most frequently dropped. Resources are means; their value depends on conversion; conversion varies personally, environmentally and socially; so equal resources yield unequal freedom. Utility adapts downward under deprivation and can certify it. Capability is the opportunity set; functioning is what is chosen from it; fasting and starving separate them in one line. The presupposition is that persons are agents, not recipients - and everything distinctive in the approach follows from it.

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 7

```
resources -> CONVERSION FACTORS (personal | environmental | social)
  -> MECHANISM: capability = the real opportunity set; functioning =
      the element chosen from it
  -> CONSEQUENCE: resource metrics misdescribe equality; utility metrics
      certify deprivation
  -> TRAP: Sen reduced to income plus health and education; capability
      confused with functioning; agency stripped of non-welfare goals
  -> ANSWER USE: open with conversion, fix the distinction with
      fasting/starving, close on agency
```

SESSION 8 - SEN II: FREEDOM AS BOTH END AND MEANS, AND THE ADAPTIVE-PREFERENCE PROBLEM

The picture first

THE FIVE-STEP ARGUMENT, AND THE TWO ROLES OF FREEDOM

=====

```

STEP 1 . equal resources yield UNEQUAL FREEDOM -- bodies, environments
        and social norms differ
        |
STEP 2 . UTILITY CAN ADAPT to deprivation; the long-deprived may report
        satisfaction
        |
STEP 3 . therefore development must assess REAL OPPORTUNITIES, not only
        goods held or happiness reported
        |
STEP 4 . the instrumental freedoms REINFORCE ONE ANOTHER
        |
STEP 5 . FREEDOM IS BOTH THE END AND A MEANS OF DEVELOPMENT
        |
        v
  
```

THE FIVE INSTRUMENTAL FREEDOMS -- AND THE POINT OF THE CIRCLE

+-----+		
POLITICAL FREEDOMS	voice, dissent, scrutiny, the ability to	
	force a public response	
+-----+		
ECONOMIC	access to resources, exchange, work,	
FACILITIES	credit and markets	
+-----+		
SOCIAL	schooling, health care, and the public	
OPPORTUNITIES	provision that raises conversion	
+-----+		
TRANSPARENCY	the ability to deal with one another under	
GUARANTEES	disclosure -- the condition of trust	
+-----+		
PROTECTIVE	the safety net that prevents an ordinary	
SECURITY	shock from becoming destitution	
+-----+		

THEY ARE NOT A LIST. EACH RAISES THE VALUE OF THE OTHERS:
 schooling raises the usefulness of political voice; voice forces
 the public provision that produces schooling; transparency makes
 economic facility usable; protective security is what allows a
 person to exercise any of the others without ruin.

THE TWO ROLES OF FREEDOM -- WRITE BOTH OR LOSE THE ARGUMENT

+-----+		
CONSTITUTIVE (the END)	INSTRUMENTAL (the MEANS)	
being able to participate,	participation improves information,	
to be schooled, to appear	accountability and the accuracy of	
in public without shame IS	public decisions, and therefore	
PART OF A DEVELOPED LIFE	PRODUCES other freedoms	
+-----+		

AN ANSWER THAT GIVES ONLY THE INSTRUMENTAL HALF HAS MADE FREEDOM
 NEGOTIABLE: IT CAN THEN BE TRADED AWAY WHENEVER THE OUTPUT IS LARGER
 WITHOUT IT. THAT IS THE AUTHORITARIAN-DEVELOPMENT ARGUMENT, AND THE
 CONSTITUTIVE HALF IS WHAT DEFEATS IT.

ADAPTIVE PREFERENCE -- THE MECHANISM, DRAWN

long deprivation -> expectations adjust downward -> the deprivation
 is no longer EXPERIENCED as a loss -> satisfaction is REPORTED ->
 a welfare metric RECORDS CONTENTMENT -> the injustice is CERTIFIED
 BY THE VERY RESPECT SHOWN TO THE REPORT

THE DANGER IN THE REPLY: overriding what people say is PATERNALISM.

THE DISCIPLINE: use capability (opportunity), not the analyst's
 judgment of what people should want.

Caption: the five-step argument set out in order, the five instrumental freedoms shown as a reinforcing circle rather than a list, the two roles of freedom with the reason both must be written, and the adaptive-preference mechanism drawn step by step together with the paternalism danger in its reply.

In plain words

Session 7 gave the terms; this session gives the argument they were built for, and it has a shape worth memorising because it survives compression to five lines in an examination.

It begins where Session 7 ended: equal resources yield unequal freedom. It adds the awkward fact that asking people how satisfied they are will not repair the problem, because satisfaction adapts. From those two premises it concludes that development must be assessed in the space of **real opportunities**. Then it adds the claim that does the political work: the different freedoms are not independent goods to be traded against one another but **mutually reinforcing** - schooling makes political voice more effective, voice forces the public provision that produces schooling, transparency makes economic opportunity usable, and protective security is what allows a person to risk exercising any of the others.

ANALYSIS: And then the conclusion that most scripts get half-right: freedom is both the **end** and a **means** of development. Writing only the instrumental half - "freedom is useful because it improves outcomes" - is a serious error, and not a subtle one. It makes freedom negotiable: if it is valuable only for what it produces, then it may be suspended whenever someone argues that output would be higher without it. That is precisely the authoritarian-development argument, and the constitutive claim - that being able to participate, to be schooled, to appear in public without shame is *part of what a developed life is* - is what defeats it.

The adaptive-preference point deserves care, because it is easy to state in a way that is condescending. The claim is **not** that deprived people are mistaken about their own lives. It is that a metric built on reported satisfaction will systematically under-record deprivation that has lasted long enough for expectations to adjust - and that the correct response is to change the metric to opportunity, not to override the report with the analyst's own view of what people ought to want.

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: **The full five-step argument.** (1) Equal resources yield unequal freedom because bodies, environments and social norms differ. (2) Utility can adapt to deprivation. (3) Development must therefore assess real opportunities, not only goods or happiness. (4) Political freedoms, economic facilities, social opportunities, transparency guarantees and protective security **reinforce one another**. (5) Freedom is both the **end** and a **means** of development.

FACT: **The five instrumental freedoms.** Political freedoms; economic facilities; social opportunities; transparency guarantees; protective security. ANALYSIS: Their significance is the **interlocking**, not the enumeration: an answer that lists them without stating that each raises the value of the others has recorded the name and lost the argument.

FACT: **The two roles of freedom.** **Constitutive** - being able to participate, to be schooled, to move and to appear in public without shame is part of a developed life. **Instrumental** - those same freedoms improve information, accountability and the quality of public decisions, and so produce further freedoms.

ANALYSIS: **Why both roles are compulsory.** The purely instrumental defence makes freedom tradeable and therefore supplies no protection when a stem proposes suspending it for the sake of faster development. The constitutive claim is what makes the trade unavailable in principle.

FACT: **Adaptive preference, stated as a methodological claim.** Satisfaction reports adjust downward under long deprivation, so subjective welfare is an unreliable metric of development.

ANALYSIS: **The paternalism danger in the reply.** Overriding reported preference without argument substitutes the analyst's judgment for the person's. The disciplined response is to shift the **evaluative space** to opportunity rather than to correct the person's stated wants - capability protects the option, and leaves the choosing where it belongs.

Named evidence you can cite

- **Sen, Development as Freedom*** FACT: - freedom as both the end and the principal means of development; the five instrumental freedoms and their mutual reinforcement.
- **Sen's adaptive-preference argument** FACT: - the decisive objection to satisfaction-based metrics, usable in any measurement paragraph and in the 2022 and 2023 owned parts.
- **The constitutive/instrumental pair** ANALYSIS: - the reconstruction that defeats the authoritarian-development argument, and the single most useful move in any stem that asks whether participation slows development down.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Freedom is both the end and the means of development: instrumentally it improves information, accountability and the quality of public decisions, and constitutively it is part of what a developed life consists in - which is why it cannot be traded away for a larger output without changing the subject.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

substantive freedom · five instrumental freedoms · mutual reinforcement · constitutive role · instrumental role · adaptive preferences · unreliable metric · paternalism danger · shift the evaluative space, not the person's wants · removal of unfreedoms

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. On Sen's account freedom occupies two roles in development simultaneously - it is the end for which development is undertaken and the principal means by which it proceeds - and an answer that supplies only the second has made freedom negotiable. **Named evidence.** *Development as Freedom* sets out five instrumental freedoms - political freedoms, economic facilities, social opportunities, transparency guarantees and protective security - and the argument's force lies in their mutual reinforcement: schooling raises the effectiveness of political voice, voice compels the public provision that produces schooling, transparency makes economic facility usable, and protective security is what allows a person to exercise any of the others without risking ruin. **Analysis.** Because the freedoms interlock, development cannot be modelled as a trade-off in which liberty is exchanged for output; and because utility adapts downward under long deprivation, the apparent contentment of the deprived cannot be used as evidence that the trade was acceptable to them. The proper conclusion is that the evaluative space must be real opportunity, which registers what a person could do rather than what she reports or possesses. **Qualification.** The adaptive-preference argument must be handled carefully, since the claim is methodological rather than condescending: it says that a satisfaction metric will under-record long-standing deprivation, not that deprived persons are mistaken about their own lives - and the disciplined response is to change the metric to capability rather than to override what people say, because overriding it substitutes the analyst's judgment for the agent's and reintroduces the paternalism the framework exists to avoid.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: The adaptive-preference argument is self-undermining. If the preferences of the deprived are unreliable, then their participation in public reasoning is unreliable too - and Sen's own refusal to fix a capability list, which refers the selection to public reasoning, rests on exactly that participation.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: The objection conflates two things. Adaptation affects reported **satisfaction with a condition**; it does not disable **reasoning about alternatives** once alternatives are visible and voice is available. The remedy is therefore internal to the framework: expand information, protect dissent and secure the conditions under which preferences can be revised - which is exactly what the instrumental freedoms do, and it is why transparency and political freedom appear among them rather than as optional extras.
- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: The remedy presupposes that the conditions of open public reasoning can be secured before the selection is made, and in societies where deprivation and unequal power are entrenched the presupposition may fail. Nussbaum's threshold is one response to that failure; whether a specified list can be defended without the paternalism it was meant to avoid is the live dispute of the next session.

Examiner traps on this session

1. Writing only the instrumental role of freedom. It makes freedom tradeable and hands the authoritarian-development argument its premise.
2. Listing the five instrumental freedoms without stating that they reinforce one another. The interlocking *is* the argument; the list is only its index.
3. Using adaptive preference condescendingly - "the poor do not know what is good for them". The claim is about what a metric can record, not about what people understand.
4. Answering the paternalism objection by asserting that experts should override preferences. The disciplined reply changes the evaluative space to opportunity and leaves the choosing to the agent.

Mini recap

Five steps: unequal conversion, adaptive utility, therefore opportunity as the space, interlocking freedoms, freedom as both end and means. Five instrumental freedoms - political, economic, social, transparency, protective security - significant because each raises the value of the others. Two roles: constitutive and instrumental; write both, because the instrumental alone makes freedom tradeable. Adaptive preference is a methodological claim about metrics, not a claim about the competence of the deprived, and the disciplined reply shifts the evaluative space to capability rather than overriding what people say.

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 8

unequal conversion + adaptive utility -> assess REAL OPPORTUNITIES

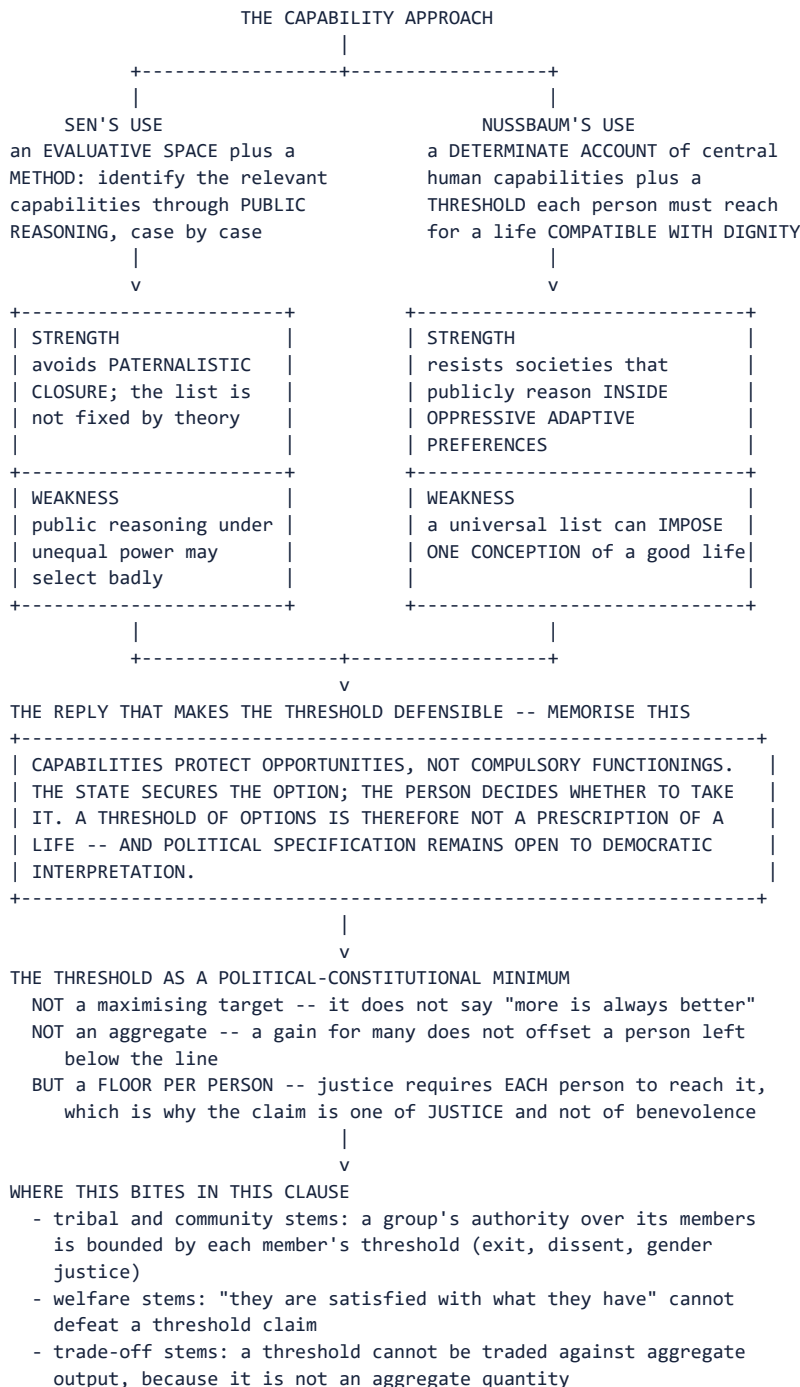
- > MECHANISM: five instrumental freedoms, mutually reinforcing
 - > CONSEQUENCE: freedom is END and MEANS; the trade-off model fails
 - > TRAP: instrumental half only; list without interlocking;
condescending use of adaptive preference
 - > ANSWER USE: write both roles, deploy the interlocking against any
"participation delays development" stem, close on capability as the
space that avoids paternalism
-

SESSION 9 - NUSSBAUM: THE DIGNITY THRESHOLD AND THE SEN-NUSSBAUM DISPUTE

The picture first

TWO WAYS TO USE ONE FRAMEWORK

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Caption: one framework used two ways - Sen's evaluative space and public reasoning against Nussbaum's specified list and dignity threshold - each with its strength and its weakness; the reply that makes a threshold defensible; the threshold's character as a per-person floor rather than a target; and the three places in this clause where it decides the answer.

In plain words

It is tempting to treat Nussbaum as "Sen plus a list", and that reading loses the point. The disagreement is not about how many capabilities there are. It is about what the framework is **for**.

Sen uses the capability approach as an evaluative space together with a method: it tells you where to look - at real opportunities rather than at goods or satisfaction - and it refers the question of *which* opportunities matter to public

reasoning in the society concerned. The attraction is obvious: no theorist gets to decide in advance what a good life contains, and the framework stays open to plural conceptions.

Nussbaum presses a hard question at that openness. What happens when the public reasoning is itself conducted inside oppressive expectations - when the people whose capabilities are being denied have adjusted to the denial, and when the society's reasoning reproduces the hierarchy rather than examining it? Referring the selection to that reasoning does not protect anyone. So she supplies a determinate account of central human capabilities and argues that **justice** - not charity, not policy preference - requires each person to reach a **threshold** compatible with dignity.

ANALYSIS: The obvious objection is that a universal list imposes one conception of the good life. The reply is the sentence to memorise: **capabilities protect opportunities, not compulsory functionings**. The threshold secures the option to be nourished, to be schooled, to move, to associate, to participate; it does not require anyone to exercise it in a prescribed way. And the political specification of the list remains open to democratic interpretation rather than fixed once by a theorist.

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: **Nussbaum's position**. She supplies a **more determinate account of central human capabilities** and argues that **justice requires each person to reach a threshold compatible with dignity**.

FACT: **The Sen-Nussbaum distinction, stated exactly**. Sen **resists a single final canonical list** and stresses **public reasoning**. Nussbaum **defends a specified list and threshold** as a **constitutional-political minimum**.

FACT: **The objection**. A universal list may impose one conception of life.

FACT: **The reply**. Capabilities protect **opportunities**, not compulsory functionings; political specification should remain **open to democratic interpretation**.

ANALYSIS: **The comparative assessment to write**. Sen **avoids paternalistic closure**; Nussbaum **better resists societies that publicly reason within oppressive adaptive preferences**. Each strength is the other's weakness, and stating the pair is what converts a comparison into an adjudication.

ANALYSIS: **Three properties of a threshold that decide answers**. It is a **floor per person**, not a maximising target - it does not say more is always better. It is **not aggregative** - a gain for many does not offset one person left below it. And because it attaches to persons, it converts the claim from benevolence into **justice**.

ANALYSIS: **Why this matters for the owned tribal part**. A threshold bounds a community's authority over its own members: recognition of community rights is compatible with insisting on exit, dissent and gender justice inside the community, because each member's threshold is not the community's to trade. This is developed in Session 20 and it is the mechanism by which cultural recognition avoids collapsing into the freezing of internal hierarchy.

Named evidence you can cite

- **Nussbaum, Creating Capabilities*** FACT: - justice requires each person to reach a threshold of central capabilities compatible with dignity.
- **Nussbaum, Women and Human Development*** FACT: - the argument that adaptive preference under entrenched hierarchy is precisely what a threshold is needed to resist.
- **The Sen-Nussbaum dispute** FACT: - evaluative space and public reasoning against a specified list and constitutional minimum; the paradigm live dispute of this owner, and the one to flag as unresolved rather than to settle.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

A threshold of central capabilities is not a prescription of how to live but a floor beneath which no person may be left, because capabilities protect opportunities rather than compelling functionings - and a floor that attaches to each person cannot be discharged by an average that rises.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

central human capabilities · threshold compatible with dignity · constitutional-political minimum · evaluative space and public reasoning · paternalistic closure · oppressive adaptive preferences · opportunities not compulsory functionings · floor per person · non-aggregative · justice rather than benevolence

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The disagreement between Sen and Nussbaum is not about the number of capabilities but about what the capability framework is for - an evaluative space whose content is settled by public reasoning, or a determinate constitutional minimum owed to each person as a matter of justice. **Named evidence.** Sen, in *Development as Freedom*, resists fixing a single canonical list and refers the selection of relevant capabilities to public reasoning; Nussbaum, in *Creating Capabilities* and *Women and Human Development*, specifies central human capabilities and argues that justice requires each person to reach a threshold compatible with dignity. **Analysis.** Each position is strongest exactly where the other is weakest. Sen's openness avoids paternalistic closure, but it offers little protection where public reasoning is itself conducted inside entrenched hierarchy and adapted expectations; Nussbaum's threshold resists that failure, but invites the charge that a universal list imposes one conception of the good life - a charge answered by the observation that capabilities protect opportunities rather than compelling functionings, and that the political specification of the list remains open to democratic interpretation. **Qualification.** The threshold's decisive properties are that it is a floor per person and not an aggregate, so a rise in the average cannot discharge it and a gain for many cannot offset one person left below it; but who fixes the threshold, and by what procedure, remains genuinely unsettled, and an answer that declares the dispute closed in either direction has overclaimed.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: A threshold is either trivial or tyrannical. Pitched low enough to command agreement it adds nothing to a basic-needs standard; pitched high enough to do real work it encodes a particular, culturally specific idea of a flourishing life and imposes it as a constitutional requirement.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: The dilemma has a middle, and the middle is occupied by the **opportunity** form of the claim. A threshold of *options* - to be adequately nourished, to be schooled, to move, to associate, to participate, to be free of avoidable humiliation - is substantially more demanding than a basic-needs floor, because it requires the conversion conditions and not merely the goods; and it is substantially less intrusive than a prescription of functionings, because it never requires that any option be exercised. That is precisely why the list is stated as capabilities and not as required achievements.
- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: The middle position still requires someone to fix where the floor sits, and the specification is not derivable from the framework itself. Nussbaum locates it in constitutional-political practice open to democratic interpretation, which is a reasonable answer and not a complete one - the procedure by which a society sets the floor is exposed to the same inequalities of power that motivated the threshold in the first place.

Examiner traps on this session

1. Describing Nussbaum as "Sen with a list". The disagreement is about the role of the framework, not about enumeration, and the list is a consequence rather than the thesis.
2. Omitting the reply. A script that states the imposition objection without "capabilities protect opportunities, not compulsory functionings" has left Nussbaum undefended and will read as a survey.
3. Treating the threshold as a target to be maximised. It is a per-person floor; a rising average does not discharge it and an aggregate gain does not offset a person below it.
4. Declaring the dispute settled. CAUTION: It is live, and flagging it as live is itself the mark of a controlled answer.

Mini recap

One framework, two uses. Sen: evaluative space plus public reasoning; avoids paternalistic closure; vulnerable where public reasoning is conducted inside oppression. Nussbaum: specified central capabilities plus a dignity threshold as a constitutional-political minimum; resists oppressive adaptive preference; vulnerable to the charge of imposing one conception of life. The reply: capabilities protect opportunities, not compulsory functionings, and specification stays open to democratic interpretation. The threshold is a per-person, non-aggregative floor, which makes it a claim of justice. It bounds a community's authority over its members - the mechanism that keeps cultural recognition from freezing internal hierarchy.

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 9

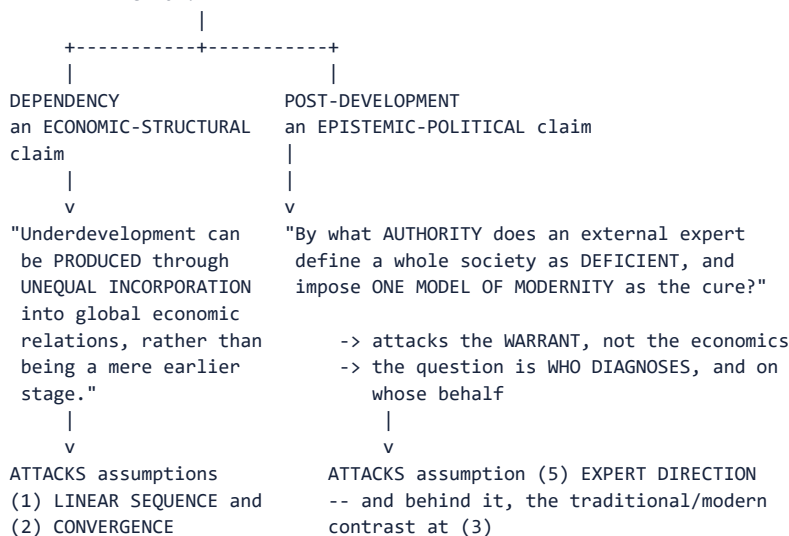
one capability framework -> TWO USES: evaluative space + public reasoning
 (Sen) | specified list + dignity threshold (Nussbaum)
 -> MECHANISM: capabilities protect OPPORTUNITIES, not compulsory
 functionings; specification stays democratically open
 -> CONSEQUENCE: a per-person, non-aggregative floor = a claim of justice
 -> TRAP: "Sen with a list"; objection without reply; threshold as target;
 declaring the dispute settled
 -> ANSWER USE: pair each strength with the other's weakness, then use
 the threshold to bound community authority in tribal stems

SESSION 10 - DEPENDENCY AND POST-DEVELOPMENT: PRODUCED UNDERDEVELOPMENT AND THE AUTHORITY TO DIAGNOSE

The picture first

TWO DIFFERENT ATTACKS ON THE SAME TARGET -- DO NOT MERGE THEM

THE TARGET: the modernisation claim that underdevelopment is an
 EARLIER STAGE on ONE UNIVERSAL PATH, curable by DIFFUSION and
 EXPERT DIRECTION.



THE SHARED OBJECTION, AND THE SHARED REPLY

OBJECTION: romanticising local life can IGNORE INTERNAL HIERARCHY, POVERTY, AND REAL DEMANDS FOR EDUCATION, HEALTH OR MOBILITY. REPLY: the strongest critique rejects IMPOSED UNIFORMITY, not EVERY MATERIAL IMPROVEMENT. LOCAL VOICE MUST BE JOINED TO UNIVERSAL DIGNITY.	THIS IS NOT A COMPROMISE FOR ITS OWN SAKE. IT IS THE ONLY POSITION THAT KEEPS BOTH CRITIQUES AND STILL ANSWERS THE QUESTION "WHY DO PEOPLE IN POOR COMMUNITIES DEMAND SCHOOLS AND CLINICS?"
---	--

THE MIDDLE PATH -- THE POSITION TO DEFEND

PLURAL DEVELOPMENT under UNIVERSAL CONSTRAINTS

many routes	one floor: dignity, freedom from severe deprivation, equal civic standing, ecological responsibility
-------------	--

THIS IS NOT A COMPROMISE FOR ITS OWN SAKE. IT IS THE ONLY POSITION
 THAT KEEPS BOTH CRITIQUES AND STILL ANSWERS THE QUESTION "WHY DO
 PEOPLE IN POOR COMMUNITIES DEMAND SCHOOLS AND CLINICS?"

WHAT EACH CRITIQUE CANNOT DO

DEPENDENCY	can understate DOMESTIC institutional and political factors -- it is not a complete explanation of every case
POST-DEVELOPMENT ...	has no positive programme; refusing the diagnosis does not by itself supply schools, clinics or security

Caption: two distinct attacks on modernisation - dependency as an economic-structural claim about produced underdevelopment, post-development as an epistemic-political claim about the authority to diagnose - mapped onto the assumptions each denies, with the shared objection, the shared reply, the defensible middle path, and the specific thing each critique cannot do.

In plain words

These two critiques get merged constantly, and merging them costs marks, because they attack different things and fail in different ways.

Dependency is a claim about **structure**. It says that calling a society "underdeveloped" as though it were simply behind on a common road misdescribes what happened. Some societies were incorporated into wider economic relations on terms that shaped what they produced, who owned it and where the gains went - and the resulting condition is not an earlier stage but a **produced** outcome. That is an economic and historical claim, and it directly denies modernisation's stage and convergence assumptions.

Post-development is a claim about **authority**. It does not primarily dispute the economics. It asks by what warrant an external expert declares an entire society deficient, defines its deficiency in terms drawn from elsewhere, and prescribes a single model of modernity as the remedy. That is an epistemic and political claim, and it denies modernisation's expert-direction assumption.

ANALYSIS: Both face the same serious objection, and it must be conceded rather than dodged: romanticising local life ignores hierarchy *inside* the community, ignores real poverty, and ignores the fact that people in poor communities demand schooling, health care and mobility - they are not asking to be left alone in a museum. The strongest form of both critiques rejects **imposed uniformity**, not material improvement as such. Joining local voice to universal dignity is the defensible position, and it is the same middle path that Session 5 reached from the other direction: **plural development under universal constraints**.

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: Dependency. Dependency approaches argue that "underdevelopment" can be **produced** through unequal incorporation into global economic relations, rather than being a mere earlier stage on one universal path.

FACT: Post-development. Post-development critics question the **authority** by which external experts define whole societies as deficient and impose a single model of modernity.

FACT: The objection to both. Romanticising local life can ignore internal hierarchy, poverty and demands for education, health or mobility.

FACT: The reply. **ANALYSIS:** The strongest critique rejects **imposed uniformity**, not every material improvement; **local voice must be joined to universal dignity**.

FACT: The middle path with modernisation. Modernisation stresses transformation of institutions and productive capacity; post-development exposes imposed standards and expert domination. **ANALYSIS:** The middle path is **plural development under universal constraints of dignity, capability and non-domination**.

ANALYSIS: What each critique cannot do. Dependency can **understate domestic institutional and political factors**, so it is not a complete explanation of any particular case. Post-development supplies **no positive programme**: refusing an imposed diagnosis does not by itself deliver schooling, health care or security, and an answer that stops at refusal has criticised without concluding.

ANALYSIS: Why this session is load-bearing for the 2025 owned part. The tribal stem asks whether development can be reconciled with tribal values. Dependency supplies the structural reason why the benefits and costs of a project may fall on different populations; post-development supplies the reason why the community's own account of its interests cannot be replaced by an expert's; and the middle path supplies the form of the answer - reconciliation is possible under specified conditions, not in general.

Named evidence you can cite

- **Dependency approaches** **FACT:** - underdevelopment as produced through unequal incorporation rather than inherited as a stage; the direct denial of modernisation's linear-sequence and convergence assumptions.
- **The post-development critique** **FACT:** - the challenge to the authority by which external experts define whole societies as deficient; the direct denial of the expert-direction assumption.

- **The plural-development-under-universal-constraints formula ANALYSIS:** - the reconstruction that preserves both critiques while retaining a floor of dignity, capability and non-domination, and the position that makes the 2025 tribal answer conditional rather than evasive.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Dependency denies that underdevelopment is an earlier stage and post-development denies that anyone has the authority to define a society as deficient - but neither licenses the conclusion that material improvement is unwanted, and the defensible position is plural development under universal constraints of dignity, capability and non-domination.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

produced underdevelopment · unequal incorporation · not an earlier stage · authority to diagnose · imposed model of modernity · imposed uniformity rejected, not improvement · local voice joined to universal dignity · plural development under universal constraints · no positive programme

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Dependency and post-development are distinct critiques of modernisation and must not be merged, because one is a structural claim about how underdevelopment arises and the other an epistemic-political claim about who is entitled to diagnose it. **Named evidence.** Dependency approaches hold that underdevelopment can be produced through unequal incorporation into global economic relations rather than being an earlier stage on one universal path, which denies modernisation's assumptions of linear sequence and convergence; post-development critics question the authority by which external experts define whole societies as deficient and impose a single model of modernity, which denies its assumption of expert direction. **Analysis.** The distinction matters practically, because the two generate different remedies: the dependency claim points toward changing the terms of incorporation and the ownership of gains, while the post-development claim points toward changing who decides and whose account of their own interests is authoritative - and a stem about tribal development, where costs and benefits fall on different populations and where the community's own account is routinely displaced, engages both at once. **Qualification.** Both are exposed to the objection that romanticising local life ignores internal hierarchy, poverty and genuine demands for education, health and mobility; the strongest form of each therefore rejects imposed uniformity rather than material improvement, and the defensible conclusion is plural development under universal constraints of dignity, capability and non-domination - a position that concedes that post-development has no positive programme of its own and that dependency can understate domestic institutional factors.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: Post-development is self-refuting. It denounces external experts who define others' needs, and then itself defines what those others really need - namely, to be left free of external definition - which is one more external prescription issued from outside.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: The objection lands on the crude version and misses the disciplined one. The disciplined claim is **procedural**, not substantive: it does not specify what a community should want but insists that the community's own account of its interests is not to be displaced without argument, and that the burden of justification falls on the party proposing the intervention. A procedural claim about who bears the burden of justification is not a substantive prescription about how to live.
- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: Procedural claims still require a decision about **who speaks for the community**, and communities are internally divided by gender, age, caste and interest. Deferring to "the community's own account" can therefore entrench the voice of those already dominant inside it - which is why the threshold argument of Session 9 and the exit-and-dissent condition of Session 20 are needed to complete the position.

Examiner traps on this session

1. Merging dependency with post-development. One is structural and one is epistemic; they deny different assumptions and fail in different ways.
2. Concluding that all development is Western imposition. This forfeits the reply, cannot explain demands for schools and clinics, and is easily defeated by the internal-hierarchy objection.

3. Stating post-development without conceding that it has no positive programme. Refusal is not a conclusion, and an answer that stops there has not adjudicated.
4. Presenting dependency as a complete explanation of any particular case. It can understate domestic institutional and political factors, and saying so is what marks a controlled answer.

Mini recap

Two critiques, two targets. Dependency: underdevelopment is produced through unequal incorporation, not inherited as a stage - attacks linear sequence and convergence. Post-development: by what authority does an expert define a society as deficient - attacks expert direction. Shared objection: romanticising the local ignores internal hierarchy, poverty and real demands. Shared reply: reject imposed uniformity, not improvement; join local voice to universal dignity. Middle path: plural development under universal constraints of dignity, capability and non-domination. Limits: dependency can understate domestic factors; post-development supplies no positive programme.

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 10

modernisation attacked from TWO SIDES

- > MECHANISM: dependency = produced underdevelopment (structural);
post-development = the authority to diagnose (epistemic)
 - > CONSEQUENCE: different remedies -- terms of incorporation against
who decides; both engaged in tribal stems
 - > TRAP: merging them; "all development is imposition"; refusal treated
as a conclusion; dependency as a complete explanation
 - > ANSWER USE: separate the two, concede the romanticism objection,
close on plural development under universal constraints
-

SESSION 11 - SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT AND THE FIVE BOUNDED EVALUATIVE LENSES

The picture first

PART A -- SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT: FOUR PHILOSOPHICAL BASES

=====

THE FORMULA: present improvement that does NOT DESTROY the ecological conditions and OPTIONS of future persons.

(Built into the concept by the BRUNDTLAND REPORT, 1987 -- PARAPHRASED, NEVER QUOTED.)

- |
- > 1. INTERGENERATIONAL JUSTICE
- | duties to those not yet born -- justice, not benevolence
- > 2. PRECAUTION UNDER IRREVERSIBLE RISK
- | where the loss cannot be undone, uncertainty argues FOR
- | restraint, not for waiting
- > 3. LIMITS TO SUBSTITUTION
- | money cannot stand in for every ecological system; some
- | stocks and sinks have NO SUBSTITUTE
- > 4. DUTIES TOWARD THE VULNERABLE
- | + the POSSIBLE INTRINSIC VALUE of non-human life
- v

THE OBJECTION THAT MUST BE CONCEDED

+-----+

| THE CONCEPT IS VAGUE AND CAN LEGITIMISE A "GREEN" VERSION OF THE |

| SAME GROWTH MODEL. "SUSTAINABLE" BECOMES AN ADJECTIVE ATTACHED TO |

| WHATEVER WAS ALREADY PLANNED. |

+-----+

v

THE REPLY: SPECIFY FOUR THINGS OR THE WORD DOES NO WORK

THRESHOLDS | DISTRIBUTION | PARTICIPATION | NON-SUBSTITUTABLE
ECOLOGICAL LIMITS

PART B -- THE FIVE BOUNDED EVALUATIVE LENSES

=====

USE AS CRITERIA. NEVER RE-EXPOND THE DOCTRINE. THE FENCE IS THE POINT.

LENS	DEVELOPMENTAL FOCUS	ITS WARNING	STATUS
LIBERAL / WELFARE	resources, opportunity, rights, public goods, individual choice	FORMAL opportunity may coexist with UNEQUAL CONVERSION	compare only
MARXIST	production, class power, alienation, control of surplus	growth can REPRODUCE EXPLOITATION and commodity domination	compare only
HUMANISTIC / CAPABILITY	each person as an END and an AGENT with real freedoms	beneficiaries can be COUNTED while AGENCY IS DENIED	FULL OWNER HERE
GANDHIAN	need, non-violence, local self-rule, dignity of labour, restraint	SCALE and MULTIPLIED WANTS can CENTRALISE DOMINATION	DIRECT OWNER (2020)
AMBEDKARITE BRIDGE	constitutional rights, social democracy, mobility, destruction of graded hierarchy	a village or growth strategy is NOT progress if CASTE POWER SURVIVES	BOUNDED BRIDGE

THE CONTROLLING SENTENCE

+-----+

| THE MATRIX SUPPLIES EVALUATION CRITERIA, NOT FIVE COMPLETE |

| IDEOLOGIES. IMPORTING THE FULL DOCTRINE OF ANY OF THEM BREACHES |

| THIS OWNER'S FENCE AND WILL BE READ AS AN OFF-TOPIC ANSWER. |

+-----+

Caption: sustainable development reduced to its four philosophical bases, the vagueness objection conceded and answered by four specifications; then the five bounded evaluative lenses with their focus, their characteristic warning and their ownership status - full owner, direct owner, comparison only, or bounded bridge.

In plain words

This session does two jobs, and they belong together because both are about **using** a position without importing it.

The first job is sustainable development. The phrase is now so common that it can be written without meaning anything, and the examiner knows it. What gives it philosophical content is four claims underneath it. That we owe something to people who do not yet exist, and owe it as a matter of **justice** rather than kindness. That where a loss cannot be reversed, uncertainty is a reason for **restraint** rather than a reason to wait for better information. That money is not a universal substitute - some ecological systems, once destroyed, cannot be replaced by any amount of compensation. And that duties are owed to the vulnerable, with the further open question whether non-human life has value in itself. ANALYSIS: The honest objection is that "sustainable" is vague enough to be attached to whatever was already planned, and the reply is not to defend the word but to **specify** it: name the thresholds, the distribution of costs, the participation required, and the ecological limits that are not substitutable.

The second job is the perspective map, and its purpose is disciplinary. Five evaluative lenses are available in this clause - liberal, Marxist, humanistic/capability, Gandhian and Ambedkarite. Each supplies a **criterion** and a **warning**. But only the humanistic/capability lens is fully owned here, only the Gandhian lens is directly owned through the 2020 part, and the Ambedkarite lens is a bounded bridge used to test decentralisation. Liberalism and Marxism are **comparison only**: name the criterion, apply it, and route the doctrine. An answer that expounds Marx's theory of surplus value in a development question has written a Political Ideologies answer inside a Development clause, and will be marked as having missed the fence.

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: **Sustainable development**. It requires present improvement that does not destroy the ecological conditions and options of future persons.

FACT: **Its four philosophical bases**. Intergenerational justice; precaution under irreversible risk; limits to substituting money for ecological systems; duties toward vulnerable populations, together with the possible intrinsic value of non-human life.

FACT: **The objection**. The concept is vague and can legitimise "green" versions of the same growth model.

ANALYSIS: **The reply**. Specify **thresholds, distribution, participation and non-substitutable ecological limits**. The four specifications are the working content; without them the phrase is an adjective.

FACT: **The bounded perspective map**. *Liberal/welfare*: focuses on resources, opportunity, rights, public goods and individual choice; warns that formal opportunity may coexist with unequal conversion; comparison only. *Marxist*: focuses on production, class power, alienation and control of surplus; warns that growth can reproduce exploitation and commodity domination; comparison only. *Humanistic/capability*: focuses on each person as an end and an agent with real freedoms; warns that beneficiaries can be counted while agency is denied; **full owner here**. *Gandhian*: focuses on need, non-violence, local self-rule, dignity of labour and restraint; warns that scale and multiplied wants can centralise domination; **direct owner through the 2020 part**. *Ambedkarite bridge*: focuses on constitutional rights, social democracy, mobility and the destruction of graded hierarchy; warns that a village or a growth strategy is not progress if caste power survives; **bounded bridge**.

ANALYSIS: **The controlling sentence**. The matrix supplies **evaluation criteria, not five complete ideologies**.

ANALYSIS: **How to use the map in an answer**. Take one lens as the primary standard, use a second as the critical counterweight, and route the rest. Two lenses, fully worked, beat five lenses named.

Named evidence you can cite

- **The Brundtland Report, Our Common Future (1987)** FACT: - the formulation that builds duties to future persons into the concept of sustainable development itself. WRONG: Paraphrase it; never reproduce it verbatim.
- **The four bases and the four specifications** FACT: - intergenerational justice, precaution, limits to substitution, duties to the vulnerable; thresholds, distribution, participation, non-substitutable limits. Together they convert a slogan into an argument.

- **The five-lens matrix with its warnings** FACT: - the device that supplies comparative criticism without breaching the ownership fence, and the structure of the comparative paragraph in almost every 15- and 20-mark answer in this clause.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

"Sustainable" does no work as an adjective: it acquires content only when thresholds, the distribution of costs, the participation required and the ecological limits that admit of no substitute are all specified - and without those four the word can be attached to whatever was already planned.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

intergenerational justice · precaution under irreversibility · limits to substitution · duties toward the vulnerable · thresholds, distribution, participation, non-substitutable limits · evaluation criteria, not ideologies · unequal conversion · control of surplus · agency denied to counted beneficiaries · scale centralises domination · caste power survives

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Sustainable development is a philosophically substantive requirement only when its four underlying bases are stated, and the five evaluative lenses available in this clause are criteria to be applied rather than doctrines to be expounded. **Named evidence.** The formulation adopted by the World Commission on Environment and Development in *Our Common Future* builds duties to future persons into the concept itself, and those duties rest on intergenerational justice, precaution under irreversible risk, limits to the substitution of money for ecological systems, and duties toward the vulnerable - while the perspective map supplies the liberal criterion of resources and opportunity, the Marxist criterion of class power and control of surplus, the humanistic criterion of persons as ends and agents, the Gandhian criterion of need, non-violence and local self-rule, and the Ambedkarite criterion of destroyed rather than reorganised hierarchy. **Analysis.** Used together, the two halves of the session produce the standard comparative paragraph of this owner: one lens supplies the primary standard, a second supplies the counterweight, and sustainability supplies the limit that no lens may override, since a change that forecloses future options is not converted into progress by any distributive improvement in the present. **Qualification.** Both halves carry a discipline. Sustainability is genuinely vulnerable to the charge of legitimising a green version of the same growth model unless thresholds, distribution, participation and non-substitutable limits are specified; and the perspective map supplies criteria only, so an answer that develops full liberalism or full Marxism has left this owner's syllabus clause and will be marked accordingly.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: Sustainability constrains exactly the wrong societies. Restraint imposed on communities below a deprivation threshold denies them the material improvement that affluent societies already secured by drawing the same stocks down, which makes the requirement a retrospective privilege dressed as a principle.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: The objection succeeds against a **uniform** prescription of restraint and fails against the correct one, which is **asymmetric**: affluent consumption and the unequal distribution of adjustment burdens are what the requirement binds, and the counterpart of restraint above a threshold is expansion below it. The four specifications exist precisely to force this out into the open - distribution is one of them, and it is the one most often omitted.
- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: The asymmetry names a principle without settling the **transition costs**: who finances the expansion below the threshold, over what period, and with what enforceable commitment, are questions the philosophical argument does not answer. An answer that states the asymmetry and concedes the transition problem is complete; one that states the asymmetry as though it dissolved the problem is not.

Examiner traps on this session

1. Using "sustainable development" as an adjective. Without the four specifications the word is compatible with anything.
2. Reproducing the Brundtland formulation as a quotation. WRONG: Paraphrase it; the package asserts no verbatim wording.
3. Expounding a whole ideology from the perspective map. Liberalism and Marxism are comparison only; the fence is examinable.

4. Naming all five lenses and working none. Two lenses fully applied beat five listed, and the examiner is counting applications rather than names.

Mini recap

Sustainable development = present improvement that does not destroy future conditions and options, resting on intergenerational justice, precaution under irreversibility, limits to substitution and duties to the vulnerable. Conceded objection: the concept is vague and can green-wash the same growth model. Reply: specify thresholds, distribution, participation and non-substitutable limits. Five bounded lenses - liberal, Marxist, humanistic/capability, Gandhian, Ambedkarite - each with a focus and a warning; only capability and Gandhian are owned, Ambedkarite is a bridge, the other two are comparison only. Two lenses worked beat five named.

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 11

```
sustainable development -> four bases: intergenerational justice |  
    precaution | limits to substitution | duties to the vulnerable  
-> MECHANISM: specify thresholds, distribution, participation and  
    non-substitutable limits, or the word does no work  
-> CONSEQUENCE: the five lenses supply criteria and warnings, not  
    doctrines; two worked beat five named  
-> TRAP: sustainability as adjective; quoting Brundtland; expounding an  
    imported ideology  
-> ANSWER USE: one primary lens, one counterweight, sustainability as  
    the limit no lens may override
```

SESSION 12 - SOCIAL PROGRESS: WEAK TELEOLOGY, NON-INEVITABILITY, AND FOUR CONCEPTIONS

The picture first

WHAT KIND OF CLAIM IS "THIS IS PROGRESS"?

=====

IT IS TELEOLOGICAL IN A **WEAK** SENSE ONLY

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+-----+
| TO CALL A CHANGE PROGRESS IS TO JUDGE MOVEMENT TOWARD A BETTER |
| CONDITION. THAT REQUIRES A STATED END.                         |
| IT DOES **NOT** REQUIRE BELIEF IN AN AUTOMATIC LAW OF HISTORY. |
+-----+
```

WEAK TELEOLOGY = directional AFTER the ends are stated
STRONG TELEOLOGY = history moves that way by itself <-- REJECTED

THE ARGUMENT AGAINST INEVITABILITY -- FOUR STEPS

1. TECHNOLOGY enlarges capacities for BOTH CARE AND DESTRUCTION
- |
2. INSTITUTIONS distribute its CONTROL and its RISKS
- |
3. MORAL LEARNING CAN BE REVERSED
- |
4. THEREFORE progress requires AGENCY, CONFLICT, INSTITUTIONS AND JUDGMENT -- it is achieved, not received

THE HISTORICAL DEFEATER: twentieth-century war, genocide and ecological crisis break any inference from KNOWLEDGE or TECHNOLOGY to MORAL IMPROVEMENT.

FOUR CONCEPTIONS OF PROGRESS -- EACH TRUE OF SOMETHING, NONE COMPLETE

CONCEPTION	CORE CLAIM	STRENGTH	FAILURE
LINEAR / CUMULATIVE	reason, knowledge or productive capacity generate movement toward a better condition	explains LEARNING and institutional ACCUMULATION	mistakes CAPACITY for MORAL IMPROVEMENT and one route for a universal sequence
CYCLICAL	societies rise, stabilise and DECLINE rather than advance indefinitely	resists COMPLACENT inevitability	can become FATALISTIC and under-state deliberate reform
DIALECTICAL / CONFLICTUAL	CONTRADICTION and STRUGGLE transform institutions	explains CONFLICT and DISCONTINUITY	may impose a SINGLE historical direction
PLURAL / NON-LINEAR	several partly INCOMMENSURABLE goods, multiple paths	respects CULTURE, CONTINGENCY and REVERSIBILITY	risks RELATIVISM and loss of common standards

THE CONTROLLING POSITION -- WRITE THIS, NOT A SURVEY

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+-----+
| SOCIAL PROGRESS IS NEITHER AUTOMATIC NOR ONE-DIMENSIONAL.      |
| IT IS DIRECTIONAL ONLY AFTER THE VALUED ENDS ARE STATED, AND    |
| PLURAL ONLY WITHIN A UNIVERSAL FLOOR OF: DIGNITY | FREEDOM FROM |
| SEVERE DEPRIVATION | EQUAL CIVIC STANDING | ECOLOGICAL        |
| RESPONSIBILITY.                                             |
+-----+
```

Caption: progress as a weakly teleological claim, the four-step argument against inevitability with its historical defeater, the four conceptions with what each explains and where each fails, and the controlling position that is

directional after the ends are stated and plural only within a universal floor.

In plain words

There is a question hiding inside every use of the word "progress", and most answers never ask it: what *kind* of claim is being made?

One answer is that history has a direction of its own - that reason, science or productive capacity carry societies forward, so that later is, on the whole, better. That is a **strong** teleology, and it is the position the twentieth century made unavailable. Knowledge and technology grew enormously; war, genocide and ecological damage grew with them. If capacity guaranteed improvement, that could not have happened.

The other answer, and the one to defend, is a **weak** teleology. To call a change progress is to judge that it moves toward a better condition - so a direction is being claimed. But the direction comes from **stated ends**, not from history. ANALYSIS: Once that is seen, the consequence follows immediately: progress has to be *achieved*, through agency, conflict, institutions and judgment, and it can be reversed. It is not received.

The four conceptions then fall into place as partial truths rather than rival dogmas. The linear conception is right that knowledge and institutions can accumulate - and wrong to convert capacity into moral improvement. The cyclical conception is right that decline is possible - and wrong if it becomes fatalism that denies deliberate reform. The dialectical conception is right that conflict transforms institutions - and wrong if it prescribes a single historical direction. The plural conception is right that societies pursue several partly incommensurable goods by several paths - and wrong if it slides into relativism where no society can be criticised at all. The controlling position holds the useful half of each: **directional after the ends are stated, plural within a universal floor.**

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: **Doctrine statement.** Social progress is **justified improvement** in the quality of social relations, institutions and human lives, assessed through freedom, equality, justice, dignity, participation, security and sustainability.

FACT: **Weak teleology.** It is teleological in a weak sense: to call a change progress is to judge movement toward a better condition. It **does not require belief in an automatic law of history.**

FACT: **The historical defeater.** Enlightenment and nineteenth-century theories sometimes associated reason, science or social evolution with cumulative progress; twentieth-century war, genocide and ecological crisis challenge any automatic inference from knowledge or technology to moral improvement.

FACT: **The four-step argument against inevitability.** (1) Technology enlarges capacities for both care and destruction. (2) Institutions distribute its control and its risks. (3) Moral learning can be reversed. (4) Therefore progress requires agency, conflict, institutions and judgment.

FACT: **The four conceptions.** *Linear/cumulative:* reason, knowledge or productive capacity can generate movement toward a better condition; explains learning and institutional accumulation; mistakes capacity for moral improvement and one route for a universal sequence. *Cyclical:* societies rise, stabilise and decline rather than advance indefinitely; resists complacent inevitability; can become fatalistic and understate deliberate reform. *Dialectical/conflictual:* contradiction and struggle transform institutions; explains conflict and discontinuity; may impose a single historical direction. *Plural/non-linear:* societies pursue several partly incommensurable goods through multiple paths; respects culture, contingency and reversibility; risks relativism and loss of common standards.

ANALYSIS: **The controlling position.** Social progress is neither automatic nor one-dimensional. It is **directional only after the valued ends are stated**, and **plural only within a universal floor** of dignity, freedom from severe deprivation, equal civic standing and ecological responsibility.

ANALYSIS: **Why the floor is not a compromise.** Without a floor, plurality becomes the claim that no society can be criticised from outside, which makes the very idea of progress unusable. With a floor that is too thick, plurality disappears and the position collapses into the linear conception it was meant to correct. The floor is set at exactly the four items above for that reason.

Named evidence you can cite

- **The weak/strong teleology distinction** ANALYSIS: - the reconstruction that lets an answer say what kind of claim "progress" is, and the fastest way to show the examiner that the question has been understood rather than paraphrased.

- **The four-step argument against inevitability** FACT: - capacity is double-edged, institutions distribute, moral learning is reversible, therefore progress requires agency; it is the direct answer to any "is progress inevitable" or "does technology bring progress" stem.
- **The four conceptions with their strengths and failures** FACT: - the table that converts a survey into an adjudication by keeping the useful half of each and naming what each gets wrong.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Social progress is normative and multidimensional rather than an automatic law of history: it is directional only once the valued ends are stated, plural only within a universal floor of dignity, freedom from severe deprivation, equal civic standing and ecological responsibility - and therefore something achieved rather than received.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

justified improvement · weak teleology · no automatic law of history · capacity for care and destruction · moral learning can be reversed · linear, cyclical, dialectical, plural · directional after the ends are stated · plural within a universal floor · achieved, not received

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. To call a social change progress is to make a weakly teleological claim - a judgment that the change moves toward a better condition, relative to ends that must be stated - and not to assert that history moves in that direction by itself. **Named evidence.** The strong form of the claim, associating reason, science or social evolution with cumulative improvement, is defeated by the twentieth century: technology enlarged capacities for care and for destruction alike, institutions determined who controlled those capacities and who bore their risks, and moral learning proved reversible, so no inference runs from knowledge to moral improvement. **Analysis.** The four available conceptions each capture part of the truth and fail in a different way - the linear conception explains accumulation but converts capacity into improvement, the cyclical conception resists complacency but slides into fatalism, the dialectical conception explains conflict but may impose a single direction, and the plural conception respects contingency but risks losing any common standard - so the defensible position keeps the useful half of each. **Qualification.** That position is directional only after the valued ends are stated and plural only within a universal floor of dignity, freedom from severe deprivation, equal civic standing and ecological responsibility; a thinner floor makes cross-societal criticism impossible and a thicker one restores the linearity the argument was meant to remove, which is why the floor is stated at exactly that level and defended rather than assumed.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: Social progress is value-relative. Different societies value different things, so "improvement" reports the observer's preferences rather than a property of the change, and the whole vocabulary of progress is a disguised assertion of one culture's standards.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: Some criteria have **cross-cultural force**, and the clearest are negative: freedom from severe deprivation and freedom from humiliation are not the parochial preferences of one tradition, since no society's own members ask to be starved or degraded. A floor built from such criteria does not require agreement about the good life; it requires only agreement about a small set of conditions that no one defends being subjected to.
- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: **Reasonable disagreement persists** above the floor, and it persists about the floor's boundary - how much deprivation is severe, what counts as humiliation, how equal civic standing must be. The reply defeats the strong relativist claim without producing a complete ranking, and an answer that pretends otherwise has overreached.

Examiner traps on this session

1. Assuming progress is inevitable, or that "society is advancing". The four-step argument exists precisely to block that inference and the twentieth century supplies the defeater.
2. Calling every social change progress. Progress is *justified* improvement measured against stated ends; change without a stated end is only change.
3. Surveying the four conceptions without adjudicating. The marks lie in keeping the useful half of each and naming its failure.

4. Sliding into relativism. The universal floor - dignity, freedom from severe deprivation, equal civic standing, ecological responsibility - is what keeps plurality from destroying the concept.

Mini recap

Progress is weakly teleological: directional relative to stated ends, not an automatic law of history. The defeater is the twentieth century - capacity grew, destruction grew with it. Four steps: technology cuts both ways, institutions distribute control and risk, moral learning is reversible, therefore progress requires agency, conflict, institutions and judgment. Four conceptions: linear, cyclical, dialectical, plural - each true of something, none complete. Controlling position: directional after the ends are stated, plural within a universal floor of dignity, freedom from severe deprivation, equal civic standing and ecological responsibility.

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 12

"this is progress" -> WHAT KIND OF CLAIM? weak teleology, not a law

-> MECHANISM: capacity cuts both ways | institutions distribute |
moral learning reverses -> progress requires agency

-> CONSEQUENCE: four conceptions, each partial; keep the useful half

-> TRAP: inevitability; change called progress; survey without verdict;
relativist slide

-> ANSWER USE: state the kind of claim first, adjudicate the four
conceptions, close on the universal floor

SESSION 13 - THE CRITERIA OF SOCIAL PROGRESS AND THE NECESSARY/SUFFICIENT TEST

The picture first

PART A -- THE SEVEN CRITERIA, EACH AS A QUESTION

=====

A CRITERION IS USEFUL ONLY AS A QUESTION YOU CAN PUT TO A CASE.

FREEDOM do people have REAL OPTIONS and VOICE?
EQUALITY are STATUS and OPPORTUNITY less structured by
DOMINATION?
JUSTICE are BENEFITS, BURDENS and PROCEDURES defensible?
DIGNITY are persons protected from HUMILIATION and
EXCLUSION?
PARTICIPATION ... do AFFECTED PEOPLE SHAPE DECISIONS?
SUSTAINABILITY .. are FUTURE and ECOLOGICAL conditions preserved?
FRATERNITY /
SOLIDARITY can citizens relate as SOCIAL EQUALS?

+-----+
| NO SINGLE AGGREGATE NUMBER CAN SETTLE ALL SEVEN. PUBLIC REASONING |
| IS PART OF PROGRESS, NOT MERELY A METHOD FOR MEASURING IT. |
+-----+

PART B -- THE MODAL TEST: RUN THE TWO QUESTIONS SEPARATELY

=====

THE STEM ASKS: NECESSARY? SUFFICIENT? BOTH? NEITHER?

THE ONLY WAY TO EARN THE MARKS IS TO ANSWER IN THOSE TERMS.

TEST 1 . IS ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT ****NECESSARY****?

THE CASE FOR	THE PRECISION REQUIRED
severe deprivation restricts	"economic development" is TOO
health, education and agency,	BROAD to be logically necessary in
so a MATERIAL THRESHOLD is	EVERY conceivable community.
normally necessary	THE EXAM-SAFE CLAIM: ADEQUATE
	MATERIAL CAPABILITIES are necessary

-> VERDICT: NECESSARY IN A ****THRESHOLD**** FORM. Say "threshold",
or the answer reads as an unqualified assertion.

TEST 2 . IS IT ****SUFFICIENT****?

THE ANSWER	THE COUNTER-CASE THAT SETTLES IT
NO -- decisively	WEALTH CAN COEXIST WITH EXCLUSION,
	AUTHORITARIANISM, GENDER HIERARCHY
	AND ECOLOGICAL DESTRUCTION

-> VERDICT: NOT SUFFICIENT. One clean counter-case is enough;
a list of examples is not required and cannot be sourced.

THE COMBINED VERDICT -- THE SENTENCE THAT ANSWERS THE 2024 STEM

+-----+
| ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT IS GENERALLY AN IMPORTANT ****ENABLING** |
| **CONDITION**** BUT IS NEITHER CONCEPTUALLY IDENTICAL WITH NOR |
| SUFFICIENT FOR SOCIAL PROGRESS: IT IS NECESSARY ONLY IN A |
| THRESHOLD FORM, AND SUFFICIENT IN NO FORM AT ALL. |
+-----+

THE LOGIC, DRAWN -- WHY THE TWO TESTS ARE INDEPENDENT

NECESSARY: no social progress WITHOUT it (absence blocks)
SUFFICIENT: it ALONE GUARANTEES progress (presence secures)
A CONDITION CAN BE EITHER, BOTH OR NEITHER. ANSWERING "IT IS VERY
IMPORTANT" ANSWERS NEITHER QUESTION AND SCORES ALMOST NOTHING.

Caption: the seven criteria expressed as questions that can be put to a case; the two modal tests run separately with the precision each requires; the combined verdict that answers the 2024 stem in its own vocabulary; and the logical reminder that necessity and sufficiency are independent, so "it is important" answers neither.

In plain words

This session is where the clause becomes examinable in the most direct way, because one of the six owned parts asks the modal question in so many words: is economic development a necessary condition, a sufficient condition, both or neither?

Most scripts answer that question by writing about how important economic development is. That is not an answer. Necessity and sufficiency are two separate questions with two separate structures, and the marks are given for running both.

Necessity asks whether social progress is possible *without* the condition. Here the honest answer needs a qualification that most candidates omit. Severe material deprivation really does restrict health, schooling and the capacity to act politically - so something material is required. But "economic development", as a phrase, is broad and institutional, and it is not obvious that it is logically necessary in every conceivable community. ANALYSIS: The safe and precise claim is therefore about a **threshold: adequate material capabilities** are necessary. Writing "threshold" is what converts an assertion into an argument.

Sufficiency asks whether the condition *alone* guarantees the result, and here the answer is clean. It does not. Wealth can coexist with exclusion, with authoritarian rule, with entrenched gender hierarchy and with ecological destruction. One clear counter-case defeats a sufficiency claim, and no list of examples is required - which is fortunate, since this owner permits no unsourced illustrations.

The seven criteria in Part A do the second half of the work, because they explain *why* sufficiency fails: progress is assessed across freedom, equality, justice, dignity, participation, sustainability and solidarity, and improvement on the material dimension leaves the other six untouched.

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: **The seven criteria, each as a question.** *Freedom*: do people have real options and voice? *Equality*: are status and opportunity less structured by domination? *Justice*: are benefits, burdens and procedures defensible? *Dignity*: are persons protected from humiliation and exclusion? *Participation*: do affected people shape decisions? *Sustainability*: are future and ecological conditions preserved? *Fraternity or solidarity*: can citizens relate as social equals?

ANALYSIS: **The aggregation point.** No single aggregate number can settle all these dimensions; **public reasoning is part of progress**, not merely a method for measuring it. This sentence links Session 3's aggregation problem to Session 15's participation argument and is worth deploying in both.

ANALYSIS: **The necessity test.** A material threshold is normally necessary, because severe deprivation restricts health, education and agency. CAUTION: But "economic development" is too broad to be logically necessary in every conceivable community; the exam-safe claim is that **adequate material capabilities** are necessary.

FACT: **The sufficiency test.** No. Wealth can coexist with exclusion, authoritarianism, gender hierarchy and ecological destruction.

FACT: **The verdict.** Economic development is generally an important **enabling condition** but is neither conceptually identical with nor sufficient for social progress.

ANALYSIS: **The logical discipline.** *Necessary* means the absence blocks the result; *sufficient* means the presence secures it. A condition may be either, both or neither, and the two tests are independent. An answer that says the condition is "very important" has answered neither and will be marked as having evaded the stem.

ANALYSIS: **The structural instruction for the 2024 part.** The stem carries a 10+5 split. Use the ten for the two tests run separately and fully justified, and the five for the graded verdict together with the conceptual point that identity and enabling are different relations.

Named evidence you can cite

- **The seven criteria** FACT: - freedom, equality, justice, dignity, participation, sustainability, fraternity; the checklist that shows why an improvement on one dimension does not carry the others.
- **The threshold formulation of necessity** ANALYSIS: - "adequate material capabilities are necessary"; the precision that separates a controlled answer from an assertion, and the phrase that survives the objection that no particular institutional form of economic development is indispensable.

- **The coexistence counter-case FACT:** - wealth alongside exclusion, authoritarianism, gender hierarchy and ecological destruction; a single clean counter-case, stated at the level of criteria rather than by naming any society.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Economic development is a threshold-level necessary condition and is clearly not a sufficient one: severe material deprivation blocks health, education and voice, while rising output has repeatedly coexisted with intensified unfreedom, humiliation and ecological loss.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

necessary condition · sufficient condition · enabling condition · material threshold · adequate material capabilities · coexistence counter-case · seven criteria · no aggregate settles the dimensions · public reasoning is part of progress · conceptual identity denied

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The modal question must be answered in modal terms: economic development is necessary for social progress only in a threshold form and is not sufficient in any form, so the correct answer to "necessary, sufficient, both or neither" is *necessary in a qualified sense and not sufficient*. **Named evidence.** Necessity is supported by the fact that severe material deprivation restricts health, education and the capacity to act - the very capabilities on which every other criterion of progress depends - while sufficiency is defeated by the coexistence of material wealth with exclusion, authoritarian rule, gender hierarchy and ecological destruction, since social progress is assessed across freedom, equality, justice, dignity, participation, sustainability and solidarity rather than on the material dimension alone. **Analysis.** The two tests are logically independent - necessity says the absence blocks the result, sufficiency says the presence secures it - so an answer that establishes one has established nothing about the other, and the seven criteria explain precisely why: an improvement in material command leaves six dimensions untouched, and improvement on those six is what the word "progress" is claiming. **Qualification.** The necessity claim requires care, because "economic development" is a broad institutional phrase and it is not obvious that any particular form of it is logically indispensable in every conceivable community; the defensible formulation is that adequate material capabilities are necessary, which preserves the argument while conceding that the necessity attaches to a threshold of capability rather than to a named economic process.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: If necessity holds only at a threshold and sufficiency fails altogether, the answer says almost nothing: economic development becomes one factor among seven, and the stem's modal vocabulary has been dissolved rather than used.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: The verdict is substantive, not evasive, and it is substantive in two directions. Against those who identify development with progress it establishes that the identification is **false**, since the presence of the condition does not secure the result. Against those who dismiss material improvement it establishes that the dismissal is **false too**, since below a threshold the absence of material capability blocks every other criterion. The stem's four options are genuinely exhaustive and the answer selects one of them for stated reasons; that is exactly what the modal vocabulary is for.
- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: Where the threshold sits is not settled by the argument, and it is not obviously the same everywhere, since what counts as adequate material capability depends on the conversion conditions of the society in question. The verdict is therefore secure in form and indeterminate in its boundary - which should be stated, because an examiner will otherwise state it.

Examiner traps on this session

1. Answering "economic development is very important". This answers neither modal question and is the single most common failure on the 2024 stem.
2. Asserting unqualified necessity. Without the threshold formulation the claim overreaches and is easily defeated.
3. Producing a list of countries or figures as the counter-case. **WRONG:** No society or statistic is to be named; the counter-case is stated at the level of criteria.

4. Treating the seven criteria as a checklist to be recited. They are questions to be *put to the case in the stem*, and an unapplied criterion earns nothing.

Mini recap

Seven criteria as questions: freedom, equality, justice, dignity, participation, sustainability, fraternity - and no aggregate number settles them, so public reasoning is part of progress. Run the modal tests separately. Necessity: yes, but in a **threshold** form - adequate material capabilities. Sufficiency: no - wealth coexists with exclusion, authoritarianism, gender hierarchy and ecological destruction. Verdict: an important enabling condition, neither conceptually identical with nor sufficient for social progress. Necessity and sufficiency are independent; "it is important" answers neither.

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 13

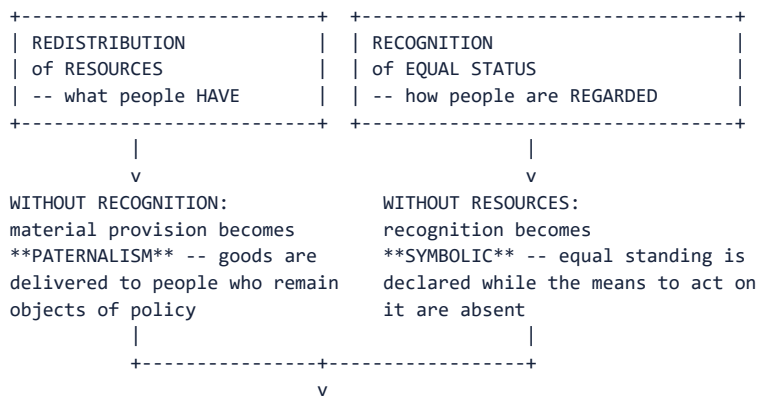
seven criteria as QUESTIONS -> no aggregate settles them

- > MECHANISM: run NECESSITY and SUFFICIENCY as two independent tests
 - > CONSEQUENCE: necessary at a THRESHOLD (adequate material capabilities); NOT sufficient (coexistence counter-case)
 - > TRAP: "it is very important"; unqualified necessity; naming societies or figures; reciting unapplied criteria
 - > ANSWER USE: two tests, one graded verdict in the stem's own modal vocabulary, threshold boundary conceded
-

SESSION 14 - REDISTRIBUTION AND RECOGNITION: WHY GROWTH DOES NOT ALTER INHERITED SOCIAL POWER

The picture first

TWO DEMANDS THAT CANNOT SUBSTITUTE FOR EACH OTHER



PROGRESS REQUIRES BOTH. THE TWO ARE NOT STAGES AND NOT
ALTERNATIVES; THEY ARE INDEPENDENT CONDITIONS, AND EACH ONE'S
ABSENCE CORRUPTS THE OTHER.

WHY THIS IS NOT AN ABSTRACT POINT -- THE INHERITED-POWER TEST

GROWTH REDISTRIBUTES INCOME AT BEST. IT DOES NOT AUTOMATICALLY ALTER INHERITED SOCIAL POWER. IN INDIA, CASTE, GENDER AND TRIBAL STATUS DEMONSTRATE THAT A SOCIETY CAN BECOME RICHER WHILE THE STRUCTURE OF WHO DEFERS TO WHOM IS LEFT INTACT.
(Stated as a criterion. The full doctrines belong to their own owners and are ROUTED, not developed.)

THE FOUR-WAY GRID -- USE IT TO CLASSIFY ANY CASE IN ONE LINE

	RECOGNITION PRESENT	RECOGNITION ABSENT
RESOURCES PRESENT	PROGRESS on this axis	PATERNALISM: provision without standing
RESOURCES ABSENT	SYMBOLIC EQUALITY: standing without means	COMPOUNDED DISADVANTAGE

THE ANSWER-WRITING CONSEQUENCE

A stem that asks whether economic development produces social progress is answered HERE as much as at Session 13: the missing term is not more output but RECOGNITION, and no volume of redistribution supplies it.

Caption: redistribution and recognition as two independent conditions, the corruption each suffers in the other's absence, the inherited-power test that shows why the point is not abstract, the four-way grid that classifies any case in one line, and the consequence for the 2022 stem.

In plain words

Two things can be wrong with a person's position in a society, and they are not the same thing.

The first is that she does not have enough - enough income, land, schooling, health care, security. The remedy is **redistribution**: change what people have.

The second is that she is not regarded as an equal - she is deferred to less, believed less, touched less, listened to less, and this is true regardless of what she owns. The remedy is **recognition**: change how people are regarded.

ANALYSIS: The crucial claim of this session is that neither remedy substitutes for the other, and that each is corrupted by the other's absence. Deliver resources to people who are still regarded as inferiors and you have produced **paternalism** - provision to objects of policy rather than to fellow citizens. Declare equal standing for people who have nothing and you have produced **symbolic equality** - a status they cannot act on.

This is why the session matters for the owned 2022 part. That stem asks whether economic development on its own produces human development and social progress. Session 13 gives half the answer through the modal tests. This session gives the other half, and it is the sharper one: growth changes at most what people **have**. It does not, by itself, change the structure of who defers to whom. ANALYSIS: In India, caste, gender and tribal status make the point unavoidable - and they are to be used here as a **criterion**, with the doctrines themselves routed to their own owners rather than expounded.

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: **The double requirement.** Progress requires both **redistribution** of resources and **recognition** of equal status.

FACT: **The two corruptions.** Material provision without respect can become **paternalism**; recognition without resources can become **symbolic**.

ANALYSIS: **The inherited-power test.** In India, caste, gender and tribal status demonstrate that growth may **not automatically alter inherited social power**. ANALYSIS: The claim is used here as a criterion of progress. Full caste doctrine belongs to **Caste Discrimination: Gandhi and Ambedkar**, gender doctrine to **Gender Discrimination**, and cultural recognition to **Humanism, Secularism and Multiculturalism**; all three are routed and none is developed.

ANALYSIS: **The four-way grid.** Resources present with recognition present is progress on this axis; resources present with recognition absent is paternalism; resources absent with recognition present is symbolic equality; both absent is compounded disadvantage. The grid classifies a case in one line and is directly usable in the 2022 and 2025 answers.

ANALYSIS: **Why the two are independent rather than sequential.** It is tempting to say that resources come first and recognition follows once people are materially secure. The claim is false in both directions: humiliation does not wait for prosperity to end, and provision delivered without standing entrenches the very relation it was meant to relieve. Recognition is a condition of development, not a reward for it.

FACT: **The link forward.** Recognition without decision-power is incomplete, which is why the next session converts recognition into the ladder that ends in **empowerment**.

Named evidence you can cite

- **The redistribution/recognition pair with its two corruptions** FACT: - paternalism and symbolic equality; the analytical device that answers "does economic development produce social progress" without repeating the modal argument.
- **The inherited-power test** ANALYSIS: - caste, gender and tribal status as evidence that material improvement does not by itself dissolve inherited social power; stated as a criterion, with the doctrines routed.
- **The four-way grid** ANALYSIS: - the classification that converts a vague "both are needed" into a diagnosis of which failure a particular case exhibits.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Growth redistributes income at best; it does not redistribute standing - and since material provision without respect becomes paternalism while recognition without resources becomes symbolic, a society can grow richer with the structure of who defers to whom left entirely intact.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

redistribution · recognition · equal status · paternalism · symbolic equality · inherited social power · independent, not sequential · compounded disadvantage · standing as a condition, not a reward

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Social progress requires two independent achievements - a redistribution of resources and a recognition of equal status - and neither can substitute for the other, because each is corrupted in the other's absence. **Named evidence.** Material provision delivered to persons who continue to be regarded as inferiors produces paternalism, in which goods reach objects of policy rather than fellow citizens; and recognition extended to persons who lack the means to act on it produces symbolic equality, in which standing is declared and cannot be exercised. In India, caste, gender and tribal status make the independence of the two demands unavoidable, since they show that a society can become materially richer while the structure of deference within it is left intact. **Analysis.** This supplies the second half of the answer to any stem asking whether economic development on its own produces human development and social progress: the first half is modal, establishing that the condition is not sufficient, while the second half identifies precisely what is missing - not more output, but standing - and no volume of redistribution supplies it, because standing is a relation between persons rather than a quantity held by them. **Qualification.** The two demands are independent rather than sequential, so the familiar claim that recognition follows once material security is achieved must be rejected in both directions: humiliation does not end with prosperity, and provision without standing entrenches the relation it was meant to relieve - which is why recognition is a condition of development rather than a reward for it, and why the doctrines of caste, gender and cultural recognition are invoked here as criteria while their full development is routed to their own owners.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: The recognition demand is either redundant or unenforceable. If it means equal legal and civic standing, that is already contained in the justice criterion; if it means that people must actually regard one another as equals, no institution can deliver it, and a requirement that cannot be delivered is not a criterion of progress but a wish.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: The demand is neither. It exceeds formal legal standing, because a society can guarantee equal rights while its ordinary practices of deference, exclusion and contempt continue unchanged; and it is institutionally addressable, because those practices are structured by access to public spaces and offices, by the composition of institutions, by protection against humiliation, and by whose testimony is treated as credible. Recognition is therefore not a demand on private sentiment alone but on the **public architecture** through which sentiment is expressed and reproduced.
- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: Institutional design reaches the architecture and not the attitudes directly, and there is a genuine residue - attitudinal change is slower than institutional change and cannot be legislated. The honest position is that institutions can make contempt costly and can deprive it of official expression, while conceding that they cannot guarantee its disappearance.

Examiner traps on this session

1. Treating redistribution and recognition as stages, with recognition arriving after material security. They are independent conditions, and the sequencing claim fails in both directions.
2. Expanding the caste, gender or tribal reference into a doctrine. Here they are **criteria**; the doctrines belong to their own owners and importing them breaches the fence.
3. Answering the 2022 stem with the modal argument alone. The modal argument shows insufficiency; this session shows *what is missing*, which is where the higher marks are.
4. Using "inclusion" as a substitute for both. Inclusion without resources is symbolic and inclusion without standing is paternalist; the word conceals the distinction the examiner is testing.

Mini recap

Two independent demands: redistribution of resources, recognition of equal status. Two corruptions: provision without respect is paternalism; standing without means is symbolic. Four-way grid classifies any case in one line. The inherited-power test - caste, gender, tribal status used as criteria and routed as doctrines - shows that growth changes what people have and not who defers to whom. Recognition is a condition of development, not a reward for it. And recognition without decision-power is still incomplete, which is where the next session begins.

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 14

two independent demands -> REDISTRIBUTION (what people have) and
RECOGNITION (how people are regarded)

- > MECHANISM: each corrupts in the other's absence -- paternalism and symbolic equality
 - > CONSEQUENCE: growth alters holdings, not inherited social power
 - > TRAP: sequencing; importing caste or gender doctrine; modal argument alone on the 2022 stem; "inclusion" as a cover word
 - > ANSWER USE: classify the case on the four-way grid, then name the missing term as STANDING rather than output
-

SESSION 15 - DEMOCRACY, PARTICIPATION AND THE LADDER TO EMPOWERMENT

The picture first

THE FIVE-RUNG AGENCY LADDER -- AND WHY THE TOP TWO ARE NOT THE BOTTOM THREE WITH BETTER MANNERS

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LEVEL	WHAT AFFECTED PERSONS ACTUALLY POSSESS	THE LIMITATION
5 EMPOWERMENT (the strong claim)	DURABLE CAPABILITY and INSTITUTIONAL POWER to shape options, resources and rules -- including the capacity to DISSENT, EXIT, ORGANISE and DEMAND REASONS	CANNOT BE INFERRED FROM ATTENDANCE OR NOMINAL REPRESENTATION
4 CO-DECISION	SHARED AUTHORITY over alternatives and conditions	requires clear responsibility and rights safeguards
3 PARTICIPATION	a CONTINUING ROLE in design, implementation and review	LOCAL ELITES can MONOPOLISE representation
2 CONSULTATION	an OPPORTUNITY to express preferences and knowledge	decision-makers may simply IGNORE IT
1 INFORMATION	NOTICE and INTELLIGIBLE REASONS	ONE-WAY DISCLOSURE IS NOT VOICE

THE TWO REASONS PARTICIPATION MATTERS -- WRITE BOTH

INSTRUMENTALLY better INFORMATION and ACCOUNTABILITY -- decisions are more accurate and more answerable	CONSTITUTIVELY HAVING A VOICE IS ITSELF PART OF A DEVELOPED HUMAN LIFE -> this is the half that makes participation NON-TRADEABLE
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THE OBJECTION, AND THE REPLY THAT DOES NOT DODGE IT

OBJECTION: consultation DELAYS URGENT PROJECTS and lets LOCAL ELITES VETO WIDER WELFARE.

|
v

REPLY: participation requires INCLUSIVE DESIGN | REASONS | REPRESENTATION | REVIEW.
ITS DEFECTS ARE ARGUMENTS FOR BETTER DESIGN, NOT FOR TREATING AFFECTED PERSONS AS OBJECTS.

|
v

THE DECISIVE MOVE: THE OBJECTION IS AN OBJECTION TO **BAD** PARTICIPATION. IT HAS NO FORCE AGAINST THE CLAIM THAT AFFECTED PERSONS HAVE STANDING, BECAUSE ELITE CAPTURE IS A FAILURE OF INCLUSION -- WHICH IS A DEMAND FOR MORE PARTICIPATION, NOT LESS.
--

THE TEST TO APPLY TO ANY CLAIM OF "PEOPLE'S PARTICIPATION"

WHO was in the room? WHO could have said NO?
WHAT ALTERNATIVES were on the table, and who put them there?
WHAT HAPPENED to the objection that was raised?
COULD THE DECISION HAVE BEEN DIFFERENT?
IF THE LAST ANSWER IS NO, THE PROCESS WAS AT MOST CONSULTATION.

Caption: the five-rung agency ladder with what each level actually confers and its characteristic limitation; the two reasons participation matters, with the constitutive half marked as the one that makes it non-tradeable; the delay-and-capture objection with the reply that treats it as a demand for better inclusion; and the four-question test

that classifies any claim of participation.

In plain words

"Participation" is the word most likely to be used loosely in this clause, and the ladder exists to stop that. There are five distinct things it can mean, and the difference between the bottom and the top is the difference between being told and being able to decide.

At the bottom is **information**: you are notified, and given reasons you can understand. That is not nothing - a decision announced without reasons is worse. But one-way disclosure is not voice. Above it is **consultation**: you get to say what you think and what you know. Also not nothing - and the decision-maker may listen and then do exactly as intended. Above that is **participation** proper: a continuing role in designing, implementing and reviewing, which is real, and which local elites can capture. Above that is **co-decision**: shared authority over the alternatives themselves, which requires that responsibility be clear and that rights be safeguarded. And at the top is **empowerment**: durable capability and institutional power to shape options, resources and rules - including the capacity to dissent, to exit, to organise and to demand reasons.

ANALYSIS: The last item is the one to write. Empowerment **cannot be inferred from attendance or nominal representation**, and the fastest way to expose a claim of "people's participation" is to ask whether anyone in the room could have said no and been heeded.

Then the two reasons participation matters. **Instrumentally**, it produces better information and greater accountability. **Constitutively**, having a voice is itself part of a developed human life. Both must be written, for the same reason both roles of freedom had to be written in Session 8: the instrumental case alone makes participation tradeable against speed, and a stem that proposes bypassing consultation for the sake of an urgent project will then win.

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: **The two reasons**. Participation matters **instrumentally** - better information and accountability - and **constitutively** - having a voice is itself part of a developed human life.

FACT: **The objection**. Consultation delays urgent projects and lets local elites veto wider welfare.

ANALYSIS: **The reply**. Participation requires **inclusive design, reasons, representation and review**; its defects do not justify treating affected persons as objects.

FACT: **The five-rung ladder**. *Information*: notice and intelligible reasons; but one-way disclosure is not voice. *Consultation*: opportunity to express preferences and knowledge; but decision-makers may ignore it. *Participation*: a continuing role in design, implementation and review; but local elites can monopolise representation. *Co-decision*: shared authority over alternatives and conditions; but it requires clear responsibility and rights safeguards. *Empowerment*: durable capability and institutional power to shape options, resources and rules; and it **cannot be inferred from attendance or nominal representation**.

ANALYSIS: **Empowerment, stated exactly**. It is the stronger claim: **control over the conditions of action**, including the capacity to **dissent, exit, organise and demand reasons**. Those four capacities are the operational test, and reciting them is worth more than any general praise of empowerment.

ANALYSIS: **The structure of the reply to elite capture**. Capture is a failure of **inclusion**. A failure of inclusion is an argument for more and better-designed participation, not for less - because the alternative on offer, deciding without the affected, is not neutral but simply relocates the capture to the decision-maker.

ANALYSIS: **Why this session carries the 2023 and 2025 parts**. Skill education produces frustrated capability if it enlarges competence without enlarging bargaining power (Session 17), and tribal reconciliation is empty if it extends compensation without extending decision-power (Session 20). Both failures are failures on this ladder.

Named evidence you can cite

- **The five-rung agency ladder** FACT: - information, consultation, participation, co-decision, empowerment, each with its limitation; the device that prevents "participation" from being used as a single undifferentiated word.
- **The instrumental/constitutive pair** FACT: - participation as both a means to better decisions and part of the end of development; the argument that makes it non-tradeable against speed.
- **The four capacities of empowerment** ANALYSIS: - dissent, exit, organisation and the demand for reasons; the operational test that distinguishes empowerment from attendance.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Development treats persons inadequately when it counts them as beneficiaries but not as agents: participation is both instrumentally useful and constitutive of the end, and empowerment - durable power to dissent, exit, organise and demand reasons - cannot be inferred from attendance or nominal representation.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

information, consultation, participation, co-decision, empowerment · one-way disclosure is not voice · elite capture · instrumental and constitutive · non-tradeable · durable capability and institutional power · dissent, exit, organise, demand reasons · inclusive design, reasons, representation, review

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Participation is not a single condition but a ladder of five distinct levels, and only its top rungs amount to the agency that development claims to secure. **Named evidence.** At the first level affected persons receive notice and intelligible reasons, which is not voice; at the second they may express preferences and knowledge, which decision-makers may ignore; at the third they hold a continuing role in design, implementation and review, which local elites can monopolise; at the fourth they share authority over alternatives, which requires clear responsibility and rights safeguards; and at the fifth they hold durable capability and institutional power to shape options, resources and rules, including the capacity to dissent, exit, organise and demand reasons. **Analysis.** The ladder matters because participation is defended on two grounds that behave differently: instrumentally it improves information and accountability, and constitutively it is part of what a developed human life consists in - and only the second makes it non-tradeable, since a purely instrumental defence permits participation to be suspended whenever a decision could be made faster without it. **Qualification.** The standard objection, that consultation delays urgent projects and lets local elites veto wider welfare, is a real objection to badly designed participation and is answered by inclusive design, stated reasons, genuine representation and review; it has no force against the claim that affected persons have standing, since elite capture is a failure of inclusion and the alternative - deciding without the affected - relocates the capture rather than removing it.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: Where a decision is genuinely urgent and its benefits are wide, insisting on participation imposes real costs on people who are not in the room - those who would have gained from the delayed project - so the constitutive defence purchases the standing of the affected at the expense of the unrepresented.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: The objection identifies a genuine trade-off and misidentifies its remedy. The wider beneficiaries are themselves affected persons with a claim to standing, so the correct response is to **widen the circle of participation**, not to abolish it for the narrower group; and where urgency is real, the design response is expedited procedure with recorded reasons and post-decision review, rather than the removal of voice.
- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: Expedited procedure with review does not fully answer the case of an **irreversible** decision taken under urgency, since review after the fact cannot restore what was foreclosed. That residue is real, it is the same residue that the precautionary argument addresses in the ecological sessions, and an honest answer names it rather than pretending that procedure dissolves it.

Examiner traps on this session

1. Equating consultation with empowerment. They are two rungs apart, and empowerment requires durable decision-power, resources, voice and reasons.
2. Inferring empowerment from attendance or from nominal representation. The operational test is whether the affected can dissent, exit, organise and demand reasons.
3. Writing only the instrumental defence of participation. It makes participation tradeable and concedes the urgent-project stem.
4. Dismissing the elite-capture objection instead of answering it. Capture is a failure of inclusion, and saying so converts the objection into an argument for better participation.

Mini recap

Five rungs: information, consultation, participation, co-decision, empowerment - each with its own limitation, and empowerment not inferable from attendance. Two reasons: instrumental accuracy and accountability; constitutive voice as part of a developed life. Write both, because the instrumental case alone makes participation tradeable. The delay-and-capture objection is answered by inclusive design, reasons, representation and review - capture is a failure of inclusion and therefore an argument for more participation. The test: who could have said no, and could the decision have been different?

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 15

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participation -> FIVE RUNGS: information | consultation | participation |  
co-decision | EMPOWERMENT  
-> MECHANISM: empowerment = durable power to dissent, exit, organise  
and demand reasons  
-> CONSEQUENCE: instrumental AND constitutive; the constitutive half  
makes it non-tradeable  
-> TRAP: consultation called empowerment; attendance as evidence;  
instrumental defence alone; capture objection dodged  
-> ANSWER USE: locate the case on the ladder, then ask whether the  
decision could have been different
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SESSION 16 - TECHNOLOGY AND ETHICAL STANDARDS: POWER WITHOUT ENDS

The picture first

DOES TECHNOLOGICAL DEVELOPMENT PRODUCE ETHICAL PROGRESS?

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THE STEM IS A CAUSAL CLAIM. A CAUSAL CLAIM NEEDS A MECHANISM AND A DEFEATER. SUPPLY BOTH, OR THE ANSWER IS ASSERTION.

THE CORE PROPOSITION

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+-----+
| TECHNOLOGY CHANGES CAPACITIES AND SOCIAL RELATIONS. |
| IT DOES NOT SUPPLY ITS OWN ENDS.                     |
+-----+
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THE SYMMETRY THAT DECIDES THE ANSWER -- EVERY CAPACITY CUTS BOTH WAYS

OPTIMIST CASE	CRITICAL CASE
communication can WIDEN KNOWLEDGE AND SYMPATHY	surveillance and manipulation can INTENSIFY DOMINATION
medicine REDUCES SUFFERING	ACCESS can remain UNEQUAL
productivity can REDUCE DRUDGERY	automation can DISPLACE and DESKILL
transparency tools can AID ACCOUNTABILITY	information systems can REPRODUCE BIAS

THE PAIRS ARE NOT A "BALANCED VIEW". THEY SHOW THAT THE SAME CAPACITY YIELDS OPPOSITE OUTCOMES DEPENDING ON WHO CONTROLS IT, WHO CAN ACCESS IT, AND TO WHAT END IT IS DIRECTED.

THE FOUR CONVERSION CONDITIONS -- WHAT MUST BE ADDED TO CAPACITY

ETHICAL PURPOSES | FAIR ACCESS | ACCOUNTABILITY |
HUMAN CONTROL

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v

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+-----+
| TECHNICAL PROGRESS BECOMES SOCIAL PROGRESS ONLY WHEN GOVERNED BY |
| ETHICAL PURPOSES, FAIR ACCESS, ACCOUNTABILITY AND HUMAN CONTROL. |
+-----+
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THE HONEST CONCESSION THAT LIFTS THE ANSWER ABOVE THE AVERAGE

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+-----+
| THE RELATION IS NOT SIMPLY NULL. TECHNOLOGY RESHAPES WHICH MORAL |
| PROBLEMS ARISE AT ALL -- IT CREATES NEW OCCASIONS FOR CHOICE, NEW |
| HARMS THAT WERE NOT PREVIOUSLY POSSIBLE, AND NEW DUTIES THAT WERE |
| NOT PREVIOUSLY MEANINGFUL. WHAT IT DOES NOT DO IS SUPPLY THE      |
| CRITERION BY WHICH ANY OF THEM IS SETTLED.                       |
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THE LINK BACK TO SESSION 12 -- THIS IS THE SAME ARGUMENT

technology enlarges capacities for BOTH CARE AND DESTRUCTION

-> institutions DISTRIBUTE its control and its risks

-> moral learning CAN BE REVERSED

-> THEREFORE progress requires AGENCY, INSTITUTIONS AND JUDGMENT

THE TECHNOLOGY STEM IS THE NON-INEVITABILITY ARGUMENT APPLIED.

Caption: the causal stem set out as a claim needing a mechanism and a defeater; the four optimist/critical pairs showing that the same capacity yields opposite outcomes depending on control, access and purpose; the four conversion conditions; the concession that technology reshapes which moral problems arise; and the link back to the non-inevitability argument of Session 12.

In plain words

The 2019 owned part asks whether technological development leads to progress in the ethical standards of society. Notice the form: it is a **causal** question. That means two things are required and most scripts supply neither - a **mechanism** by which the alleged effect would occur, and a **defeater** that would break the mechanism.

Set out the optimist mechanism honestly. Communication technology puts people in contact with lives they would never otherwise encounter, and contact can widen sympathy. Medicine removes suffering that was previously simply endured. Productivity removes drudgery that consumed lives. Transparency tools make it harder to hide what is being done. Each of those is a real mechanism, not a straw position.

Now the defeater, and it is structural rather than anecdotal. Every one of those capacities is **double-edged in the same respect**. The same communication capacity that widens sympathy enables surveillance and manipulation. The same medicine that reduces suffering can be distributed unequally, so that the capacity exists and the relief does not. The same automation that removes drudgery displaces workers and strips skill out of work. The same information systems that support accountability encode and reproduce the bias in the data they were built from. ANALYSIS: These are not four separate complaints. They are one point made four times: **the direction of the effect is fixed by who controls the capacity, who can reach it, and what it is aimed at** - and none of those is supplied by the technology.

Hence the verdict: technical progress becomes social progress only when governed by ethical purposes, fair access, accountability and human control. And then the concession that lifts an answer above the average: the relation is not simply null. Technology **reshapes which moral problems exist**. It creates occasions for choice, harms that were not previously possible and duties that were not previously meaningful. What it does not do is supply the criterion by which any of them is settled.

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: **The core proposition**. Technology changes capacities and social relations; it does not supply its own ends.

FACT: **The optimist case**. Communication can widen knowledge and sympathy; medicine reduces suffering; productivity can reduce drudgery; transparency tools can aid accountability.

FACT: **The critical case**. Surveillance and manipulation can intensify domination; access can remain unequal; automation can displace and deskill; information systems can reproduce bias.

ANALYSIS: **The verdict**. Technical progress becomes social progress **only when governed by ethical purposes, fair access, accountability and human control**.

ANALYSIS: **The concession that must be made**. The relation is not simply null: technology **does reshape the moral problems that arise**, creating new occasions for choice, new possible harms and new meaningful duties. Saying so pre-empts the objection that the "technology is neutral" position is too convenient.

ANALYSIS: **Why this is Session 12 applied**. The non-inevitability argument runs: capacity enlarges for care and destruction alike; institutions distribute control and risk; moral learning can be reversed; therefore progress requires agency, institutions and judgment. The technology stem is that argument with one instance substituted, which is why the two sessions must be answered together.

ANALYSIS: **The structural discipline for the 2019 answer**. WRONG: Do **not** name a technology, platform, company, programme or episode. The clause is answered at the level of **capacity, control, access and purpose**, and an answer that reaches for named examples both breaches this package's evidence discipline and weakens the argument, because a named case invites a counter-case and the structural point does not.

Named evidence you can cite

- **The four optimist/critical pairs** FACT: - communication, medicine, productivity, transparency; each pair shows one capacity yielding opposite outcomes under different control, access and purpose.
- **The four conversion conditions** FACT: - ethical purposes, fair access, accountability, human control; the governing clause of the verdict and the sentence that converts a balanced description into a judgment.
- **The reshaping concession** ANALYSIS: - technology alters which moral problems arise without supplying the criterion for settling them; the refinement that distinguishes a controlled answer from the flat neutrality thesis.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Technology expands the range of what can be done and thereby enlarges the domain of moral choice; it supplies no criterion for choosing, so ethical progress depends on institutions and values rather than on technical capacity.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

capacity without ends · double-edged in the same respect · who controls, who can access, to what end · surveillance and manipulation · unequal access · displacement and deskilling · reproduced bias · ethical purposes, fair access, accountability, human control · reshapes the moral problems · enlarges the domain of choice

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Technological development does not by itself produce ethical progress, because technology changes capacities and social relations without supplying the ends that would determine how those capacities are used. **Named evidence.** The point is established by the symmetry of the standard cases rather than by anecdote: communication can widen knowledge and sympathy while enabling surveillance and manipulation; medicine reduces suffering while access to it can remain unequal; productivity can reduce drudgery while automation displaces and deskills; and transparency tools can aid accountability while information systems reproduce the bias embedded in their inputs. **Analysis.** The four pairs are one argument made four times - the direction of the effect is fixed by who controls the capacity, who can reach it and what it is directed toward - so technical progress becomes social progress only where it is governed by ethical purposes, fair access, accountability and human control, and this is simply the non-inevitability argument applied: capacity enlarges for care and destruction alike, institutions distribute its control and risks, and moral learning can be reversed. **Qualification.** The relation is nevertheless not null, and an answer that treats technology as inert has overstated its case: technology reshapes which moral problems arise at all, creating occasions for choice, harms that were not previously possible and duties that were not previously meaningful - what it does not do is supply the criterion by which any of those is settled.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: The neutrality thesis is too convenient. Some technologies are not merely usable for good or ill but carry a **built-in tendency** - a capacity that requires centralised control to operate at all will produce centralisation whoever owns it, so the ends are not wholly external to the artefact.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: The objection is largely correct and should be absorbed rather than resisted, because absorbing it strengthens the position. The claim being defended is not that technologies are inert but that they are **not self-justifying**: where an artefact has a built-in tendency, that tendency is itself a proper object of ethical and political assessment before adoption - which is precisely the point that the four conversion conditions make, since "human control" is meaningless if the artefact's operation forecloses it.
- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: Assessment before adoption is far easier to state than to perform, since the social effects of a capacity are frequently unknown until it is widely deployed, and by then the arrangements built around it are costly to reverse. The precautionary logic used in the ecological sessions applies here too, and so does its cost: restraint under uncertainty forgoes benefits that may have been real.

Examiner traps on this session

1. Assuming that technology creates ethical progress. The stem is a causal claim and the assumption is exactly what it is testing.
2. Producing a "balanced view" - some benefits, some harms - with no criterion. The pairs are evidence for a structural claim, not a two-column list to be left unresolved.
3. Naming technologies, platforms, companies or episodes. WRONG: Prohibited by this package's evidence discipline, and analytically weaker than the structural argument.
4. Denying any relation between technology and morality. The reshaping concession must be made; the flat neutrality thesis is easy to refute and reads as evasion.

Mini recap

The stem is causal, so supply a mechanism and a defeater. Technology changes capacities and relations; it does not supply ends. Four optimist mechanisms - sympathy, relief of suffering, reduced drudgery, accountability - each matched by a critical counterpart under different control, access or purpose. Conversion conditions: ethical purposes, fair access, accountability, human control. Concede that technology reshapes which moral problems arise without settling them. It is the non-inevitability argument applied. Name no technology, platform, company or episode.

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 16

"does technology bring ethical progress?" -> a CAUSAL claim

- > MECHANISM: capacity changes; ends are not supplied by the artefact
 - > CONSEQUENCE: direction fixed by CONTROL | ACCESS | PURPOSE; four conversion conditions required
 - > TRAP: assumed progress; unresolved balance; named cases; flat neutrality
 - > ANSWER USE: mechanism, defeater, conversion conditions, then the reshaping concession as the closing refinement
-

SESSION 17 - SKILL EDUCATION: CAPABILITY RATHER THAN EMPLOYABILITY

The picture first

WILL EMPHASIS ON SKILL EDUCATION ENHANCE DEVELOPMENT?

=====

THE ANSWER IS ****CONDITIONAL****. THE MARKS ARE IN THE CONDITIONS.

THE POSITIVE ARGUMENT -- FOUR STEPS, STATED IN ITS BEST FORM

1. CAPABILITY REQUIRES EFFECTIVE MEANS, not formal opportunity alone
- |
2. RELEVANT SKILLS improve CONVERSION of education into WORK and AGENCY
- |
3. PRODUCTIVE PARTICIPATION can enlarge SOCIAL CONTRIBUTION and BARGAINING POWER
- |
4. THEREFORE skill education CAN ENHANCE DEVELOPMENT

v

THE FOUR LIMITS -- EACH ONE IS A PARAGRAPH

1	SKILLS WITHOUT DECENT WORK create FRUSTRATED CAPABILITY	competence rises, opportunity does not; the capability is CREATED AND THEN BLOCKED
2	NARROW EMPLOYABILITY can DISPLACE broader education	training displaces CRITICAL, CIVIC and HUMANISTIC education -- the capacities of a CITIZEN, not only of a worker
3	UNEQUAL ACCESS REPRODUCES HIERARCHY	who gets the high-return track and who gets the residual one is itself structured by inherited advantage
4	RAPID TECHNOLOGICAL CHANGE causes OBSOLESCENCE	a skill taught as a terminal qualification can expire; the capability must include the capacity to RE-LEARN

THE TWO ERRORS TO AVOID -- THEY ARE MIRROR IMAGES

"SKILL EDUCATION IS SUFFICIENT"	"SKILL EDUCATION IS MERELY INSTRUMENTAL"
-- defeated by limit 1: capability without an outlet is frustrated, not enlarged	-- defeated by DIGNITY OF LABOUR: competence and self-respect are part of a developed life, not only a means to income

|

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v

THE POSITION: SKILL EDUCATION IS NEITHER SUFFICIENT NOR MERELY INSTRUMENTAL. IT SHOULD COMBINE LIVELIHOOD, ADAPTABILITY, DIGNITY OF LABOUR AND CRITICAL CITIZENSHIP.
--

THE AGENCY TEST -- WHY THIS SESSION NEEDS SESSION 15

Does the skill enlarge the learner's BARGAINING POWER, or only her USEFULNESS TO AN EMPLOYER? If only the second, the person has been made a more productive INSTRUMENT and not a freer AGENT -- which is development counted in the wrong space.

Caption: the four-step positive argument stated at its strongest, the four limits each framed as a paragraph, the two mirror-image errors with the argument that defeats each, the position that combines livelihood with adaptability, dignity and citizenship, and the agency test that connects the session to the empowerment ladder.

In plain words

The 2023 owned part asks whether emphasis on skill education will enhance development. It is an **Evaluate** stem, which means a standard has to be named and applied - and the standard, in this owner, is capability rather than employment.

Take the positive case seriously first. The capability approach insists that formal opportunity is not enough: a right to work that a person cannot exercise, or schooling that does not convert into anything she can do, expands nothing. Skills are exactly the kind of thing that improves **conversion** - they turn education into work, work into income, income into options, and options into the ability to bargain rather than to accept. Productive participation also enlarges what a person contributes, and contribution is connected to standing. So the positive argument is strong, and it is a *capability* argument rather than an employment argument.

ANALYSIS: Then the limits, and each one is a paragraph rather than a phrase. First: a skill without decent work available produces **frustrated capability** - the capacity is created and then blocked, which is worse than not creating it, because the person now knows what she could be doing. Second: if training is narrow, it displaces critical, civic and humanistic education, and the person is equipped as a worker while being disequipped as a citizen. Third: access to the high-return tracks is itself structured by inherited advantage, so a skill programme can reproduce the hierarchy it was meant to relax. Fourth: technology changes, and a skill taught as a terminal qualification expires - which means the real capability is the capacity to **re-learn**, not the particular competence.

The two errors are mirror images. Saying skill education is sufficient ignores limit 1. Saying it is merely instrumental ignores the **dignity of labour** - competence and self-respect are part of a developed life, not only a route to income. The examinable position holds both ends: livelihood, adaptability, dignity of labour and critical citizenship together.

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: **The positive claim.** Skill education can expand capability by improving competence, work options, productivity and self-respect.

FACT: **The argument.** (1) Capability requires effective means, not formal opportunity alone. (2) Relevant skills improve the conversion of education into work and agency. (3) Productive participation can enlarge social contribution and bargaining power. (4) Therefore skill education can enhance development.

FACT: **The four limits.** Skills without decent work create **frustrated capability**; narrow employability can **displace critical, civic and humanistic education**; unequal access **reproduces hierarchy**; rapidly changing technology can make training **obsolete**.

ANALYSIS: **The position.** Skill education is **neither sufficient nor merely instrumental**: it should combine **livelihood, adaptability, dignity of labour and critical citizenship**.

ANALYSIS: **The agency test.** Ask whether the skill enlarges the learner's **bargaining power** or only her usefulness to an employer. If only the second, the person has been made a more productive instrument rather than a freer agent - development counted in the wrong informational space.

ANALYSIS: **The evaluative discipline for an "Evaluate" stem.** Name the standard (capability and agency), apply it, concede the counter-case (the limits), and deliver a graded verdict. **WRONG**: Do **not** answer with employment figures, programme names or outlays; that is an Economy answer and this owner supplies no data.

Named evidence you can cite

- **The four-step capability argument for skills** FACT: - effective means, conversion, contribution and bargaining power; the way to make the positive case a *philosophical* case rather than an employment case.
- **Frustrated capability** ANALYSIS: - the reconstruction that names the sharpest limit: a created capability with no outlet, which is a distinctive harm and not merely an absence of benefit.
- **Dignity of labour** FACT: - the Gandhian criterion that defeats the "merely instrumental" reading, and the bridge into Session 18.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Skill education enhances development only where it enlarges the learner's bargaining power rather than merely her usefulness to an employer: competence without decent work is a capability created and then blocked, and employability purchased by displacing civic and critical education equips a worker while disequipping a citizen.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

capability requires effective means · conversion of education into work · bargaining power · frustrated capability · narrow employability · critical, civic and humanistic education · unequal access reproduces hierarchy · obsolescence and the capacity to re-learn · dignity of labour · neither sufficient nor merely instrumental

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Emphasis on skill education enhances development conditionally rather than automatically, and the condition is that it enlarge capability and agency rather than employability alone. **Named evidence.** The positive case is a capability case: since capability requires effective means and not formal opportunity alone, relevant skills improve the conversion of education into work and of work into agency, and productive participation enlarges both social contribution and bargaining power. **Analysis.** Four limits determine whether the conversion actually occurs - skills without decent work produce frustrated capability, in which a capacity is created and then blocked; narrow employability displaces the critical, civic and humanistic education that equips a citizen rather than only a worker; unequal access to the high-return tracks reproduces the hierarchy the programme was meant to relax; and rapid technological change makes a terminal qualification expire, so the durable capability is the capacity to re-learn. **Qualification.** The verdict must therefore avoid two mirror-image errors: skill education is not sufficient, because a capability without an outlet is frustrated rather than enlarged, and it is not merely instrumental, because competence and self-respect belong to a developed life and not only to a means of income - the defensible position combines livelihood, adaptability, dignity of labour and critical citizenship, and the operative test is whether the learner's bargaining power has grown.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: The demand that skill education also carry critical and civic education is a luxury argument. For a person without work, employability now is worth more than citizenship capacities later, and insisting on the broader curriculum delays the relief that is actually needed.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: The objection assumes the two are substitutes and they are not, for a reason internal to the capability framework. A narrowly trained worker whose occupation is displaced has lost the whole of her acquired capability; a worker whose training included general reasoning, literacy and the capacity to re-learn retains the means of acquiring another. Adaptability is therefore not an ornament attached to skilling but the part of it that survives - and the civic capacities are what allow the worker to contest the terms on which her work is organised rather than only to accept them.
- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: The reply is comparative and does not settle the **allocation** question in conditions of severe scarcity: where resources permit only one, an argument for immediate employability is not irrational, and the capability framework by itself does not fix the discount rate between present relief and durable capacity. Naming that indeterminacy is more honest than resolving it by assertion.

Examiner traps on this session

1. Reducing skill education to employment outcomes. WRONG: Employment statistics, scheme names and outlays are outside this owner and cannot be sourced within it.
2. Answering "yes, skills are important". The stem is Evaluate; a standard must be named and applied and a graded verdict delivered.
3. Omitting frustrated capability. It is the sharpest of the four limits and it distinguishes a philosophical answer from an administrative one.
4. Treating skill purely instrumentally. Dignity of labour and self-respect are part of the developed life, and the Gandhian criterion is available here without importing the whole doctrine.

Mini recap

Conditional verdict, conditions carry the marks. Positive argument: capability needs effective means; skills improve conversion; participation enlarges contribution and bargaining power. Four limits: frustrated capability without decent work; narrow employability displacing civic and critical education; unequal access reproducing hierarchy; obsolescence, which makes the capacity to re-learn the durable capability. Two mirror errors: sufficiency, and mere instrumentality. Position: livelihood, adaptability, dignity of labour and critical citizenship together. Test: bargaining power, not usefulness to an employer.

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 17

skill education -> a CAPABILITY argument, not an employment argument
-> MECHANISM: skills improve CONVERSION of education into work and agency, and can raise BARGAINING POWER
-> CONSEQUENCE: four limits decide the case -- frustrated capability, narrowness, unequal access, obsolescence
-> TRAP: employment data; "yes, skills matter"; omitting frustrated capability; purely instrumental reading
-> ANSWER USE: name the standard, apply it, concede the limits, close with livelihood + adaptability + dignity + citizenship

SESSION 18 - GANDHIAN SOCIAL DEVELOPMENT AND THE AMBEDKARITE SAFEGUARD

The picture first

THE GANDHIAN CONCEPTION -- STRUCTURE, ARGUMENT, AND ITS TEST

THE DOCTRINE IN ONE FRAME

WELFARE AND MORAL ELEVATION OF ALL (sarvodaya) THROUGH
SELF-RULE (swaraj) NON-VIOLENCE DECENTRALISATION
DIGNITY OF LABOUR TRUSTEESHIP RESTRAINT OF WANTS
VILLAGE-CENTRED PRODUCTION

THE ARGUMENT -- FIVE STEPS. STATE THEM AS AN ARGUMENT, NOT AS IDEALS.

1. UNLIMITED WANTS create DEPENDENCE, COMPETITION and VIOLENCE
2. CENTRALISED INDUSTRIAL POWER separates PRODUCTION from HUMAN NEED and from LOCAL CONTROL
3. MEANS SHAPE ENDS -- so violent or degrading development cannot yield a non-violent good society
4. SELF-RULE requires ECONOMIC AND MORAL CAPACITIES at the LOCAL LEVEL
5. THEREFORE development must be DECENTRALISED, NEED-ORIENTED and ECOLOGICALLY RESTRAINED

THE FOUR PRESUPPOSITIONS -- NAME THEM OR THE CRITIQUE HAS NO TARGET

- MORAL SELF-LIMITATION is politically relevant
- SMALL-SCALE ASSOCIATION can sustain participation
- WORK has ETHICAL AND COMMUNITY VALUE BEYOND INCOME
- social change can proceed through NON-VIOLENT CONVERSION and CONSTRUCTIVE ACTION

THE THREE OBJECTIONS AND THEIR REPLIES

ROMANTIC VILLAGE	villages may REPRODUCE CASTE AND PATRIARCHY REPLY: decentralisation is defensible ONLY WITH EQUAL RIGHTS AND ANTI-DOMINATION. AMBEDKAR'S CRITICISM IS **INDISPENSABLE**, NOT OPTIONAL.
TECHNOLOGICAL CONSERVATISM	small-scale production cannot meet complex modern needs REPLY: read Gandhianism as a TEST OF SCALE, CONTROL AND NEED -- not a ban on every machine
TRUSTEESHIP IS VOLUNTARY PATERNALISM	owners retain power; obligation is voluntary REPLY: trusteeship MORALLY DELEGITIMISES ABSOLUTE OWNERSHIP -- but INSTITUTIONAL MECHANISMS are needed to convert obligation into ACCOUNTABILITY

GANDHI vs INDUSTRIAL MODERNISATION -- THE AXIS OF DISAGREEMENT
MODERNISATION values SCALE, PRODUCTIVITY, MASTERY OVER SCARCITY
GANDHI asks whether SCALE CENTRALISES POWER, MULTIPLIES WANTS,
DEGRADES LABOUR OR NATURE
SYNTHESIS: adopt technology SELECTIVELY by CAPABILITY,
DECENTRALISED CONTROL, ECOLOGICAL COST and NON-DOMINATION

GANDHI vs AMBEDKAR ON THE VILLAGE -- THE COMPULSORY PARAGRAPH
GANDHI: the self-governing village is a potential SCHOOL OF
SELF-RULE (swaraj)

AMBEDKAR: the village can INSTITUTIONALISE CASTE EXCLUSION

VERDICT: local self-government is progressive ONLY WHERE
CONSTITUTIONAL RIGHTS, MOBILITY AND ANTI-CASTE SAFEGUARDS
TRANSFORM LOCAL POWER.

(Bounded bridge. The full caste doctrine and the wider Gandhi-
Ambedkar debate belong to CASTE DISCRIMINATION and are ROUTED.)

Caption: the Gandhian conception as a structured argument rather than a set of ideals - five steps, four presuppositions, three objections with their replies - followed by the two comparisons that decide the answer: against industrial modernisation, and against Ambedkar on the village.

In plain words

The 2020 owned part asks the candidate to **state and examine** the Gandhian concept of social development. "State and examine" is a two-part instruction and both parts are scored: an exposition that never turns critical, and a critique that never states the position accurately, each lose half the marks.

The exposition has to present Gandhi as making an **argument**, not as expressing preferences. The argument begins with a psychological and social claim: wants that are not limited generate dependence, competition and eventually violence, because unlimited demand cannot be satisfied and must be fought over. It continues with a structural claim: when production is centralised and large, it becomes detached from what people actually need and from any control they could exercise over it. It adds the moral claim that gives Gandhi his distinctive shape: **means shape ends**, so a development achieved by violence or degradation cannot deliver a non-violent, dignified society at the end. And it concludes that if self-rule is to be real, the economic and moral capacities that support it must exist locally - from which decentralised, need-oriented, ecologically restrained development follows.

ANALYSIS: Then the examination. Three objections, each with a reply, and the first of them is compulsory in any Indian answer. **Villages can reproduce caste and patriarchy**, and a scheme of decentralisation that ignores this hands power to precisely the local hierarchies it romanticises. Ambedkar's criticism is therefore **indispensable**, and an answer that omits it will be read as uncritical. The reply is not to abandon decentralisation but to condition it: it is defensible only with equal rights and anti-domination guarantees. The second objection - that small-scale production cannot meet complex needs - is answered by reading Gandhianism as a **test of scale, control and need** rather than a prohibition on machines. The third - that trusteeship leaves owners in power - is answered by conceding the point about enforcement while insisting that trusteeship morally delegitimises absolute ownership, and that **institutional mechanisms** are required to convert obligation into accountability.

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: **Doctrine statement.** Gandhian development seeks the welfare and moral elevation of all (*sarvodaya*) through self-rule (*swarāj*), non-violence, decentralisation, dignity of labour, trusteeship, restraint of wants and village-centred production.

FACT: **The five-step argument.** (1) Unlimited wants create dependence, competition and violence. (2) Centralised industrial power separates production from human need and local control. (3) Means shape ends, so violent or degrading development cannot yield a non-violent good society. (4) Self-rule requires economic and moral capacities at the local level. (5) Therefore development must be decentralised, need-oriented and ecologically restrained.

FACT: **The four presuppositions.** Moral self-limitation is politically relevant; small-scale association can sustain participation; work has ethical and community value beyond income; social change can proceed through non-violent conversion and constructive action.

FACT: **Objection one - the romantic village.** Villages may reproduce caste and patriarchy. ANALYSIS: **Reply:** decentralisation is defensible only with equal rights and anti-domination; **Ambedkar's criticism is indispensable.**

FACT: **Objection two - technological conservatism.** Small-scale production cannot meet complex modern needs. ANALYSIS: **Reply:** Gandhianism can be read as a **test of scale, control and need**, not a ban on every machine.

FACT: **Objection three - trusteeship as voluntary paternalism.** Owners retain power. FACT: **Reply:** trusteeship **morally delegitimises absolute ownership**, but institutional mechanisms are needed to convert obligation into accountability.

FACT: **Gandhi against industrial modernisation.** Industrial modernisation values scale, productivity and mastery over scarcity; Gandhi asks whether scale centralises power, multiplies wants and degrades labour or nature.

ANALYSIS: A defensible synthesis adopts technology **selectively** according to capability, decentralised control, ecological cost and non-domination.

FACT: **Gandhi against Ambedkar on the village.** Gandhi treats the self-governing village as a potential school of self-rule (*swarāj*); Ambedkar warns that the village can institutionalise caste exclusion. ANALYSIS: Local self-government is progressive **only where constitutional rights, mobility and anti-caste safeguards transform**

local power. ANALYSIS: This is a bounded bridge: the full caste doctrine and the wider debate belong to **Caste Discrimination: Gandhi and Ambedkar** and are routed.

Named evidence you can cite

- **Gandhi, Hind Swaraj and his writings on trusteeship, self-rule (swarāj) and welfare of all (sarvodaya*)** FACT: - cited by author and title only, with no page, edition or wording asserted.
- **The means-shape-ends principle** FACT: - the claim that gives the Gandhian argument its distinctive structure and prevents it from being read as mere preference for smallness.
- **Ambedkar's warning about the village** FACT: - that local self-government can institutionalise caste exclusion; the compulsory counterweight in any Gandhian development answer, used here as a bounded criterion.
- **The selective-adoption synthesis** ANALYSIS: - technology chosen by capability, decentralised control, ecological cost and non-domination; the reconstruction that answers the anti-modern charge without abandoning the critique.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The Gandhian conception is best read not as nostalgia for the village but as a test applied to any development proposal - does this scale centralise power, does it multiply wants, does it degrade labour or nature, and could those who bear its consequences govern it? - and it is defensible only when joined to Ambedkar's insistence that a village which preserves caste power is not self-rule.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

welfare of all (sarvodaya) · self-rule (swarāj) · trusteeship · restraint of wants · dignity of labour · decentralisation · means shape ends · test of scale, control and need · moral delegitimation of absolute ownership · anti-caste safeguards · school of self-rule against institutionalised exclusion

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The Gandhian conception of social development is an argument rather than a set of preferences, and its conclusion - that development must be decentralised, need-oriented and ecologically restrained - follows from premises that can be stated and tested. **Named evidence.** In *Hind Swaraj* and in the writings on trusteeship, self-rule (swarāj) and welfare of all (sarvodaya), the argument runs that unlimited wants generate dependence, competition and violence; that centralised industrial power separates production from human need and from local control; that means shape ends, so a development achieved through violence or degradation cannot produce a non-violent society; and that self-rule requires economic and moral capacities at the local level. **Analysis.** Read this way the conception functions as a test applied to any proposal - whether the scale centralises power, whether wants are multiplied, whether labour or nature is degraded, and whether those who bear the consequences can govern it - which is why the charge of technological conservatism misses: the position discriminates by scale, control and need rather than prohibiting machinery, and trusteeship morally delegitimises absolute ownership even though institutional mechanisms are required to convert that obligation into accountability. **Qualification.** The decisive objection is Ambedkar's, and it is indispensable rather than optional: a village may institutionalise caste exclusion, so decentralisation is progressive only where constitutional rights, mobility and anti-caste safeguards transform local power - which means the Gandhian conception survives examination in a conditioned form, as a test of scale and control operating inside guarantees it does not itself supply.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: Restraint of wants is a demand that falls unequally. Asking for self-limitation from people who have very little is not asceticism but acquiescence in their deprivation, and a doctrine that praises simplicity risks moralising poverty into a virtue.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: The restraint claim is directed at **multiplied and manufactured wants** rather than at need, and its target is the dynamic in which satisfaction generates further demand - a dynamic that operates at the top of a distribution rather than at its bottom. Read that way it is structurally the same asymmetry that the ecological argument requires: restraint where consumption is far above what any defensible account of need would support, and expansion where it is far below.

- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: Gandhi's own account does not settle the boundary between need and multiplied want, and any specification of that boundary is contestable and can be used coercively against the poor rather than the affluent. The doctrine supplies a direction and not a line, and an answer that pretends otherwise has attributed more precision to it than it possesses.

Examiner traps on this session

1. Presenting Gandhi as nostalgic preference for village life. It is an argument with stated premises, and it must be reconstructed as one.
2. Omitting Ambedkar. ANALYSIS: In an Indian answer on Gandhian development this is the single most damaging omission, and the criticism is indispensable rather than optional.
3. Expanding into the full Gandhi-Ambedkar caste debate. That belongs to **Caste Discrimination: Gandhi and Ambedkar**; here the objection functions as a bounded criterion.
4. Treating trusteeship as an institutional solution. It is a moral delegitimation of absolute ownership; the enforcement gap must be conceded and answered with institutional mechanisms.
5. Answering "state and examine" with exposition alone, or with criticism alone. Both halves are scored.

Mini recap

Doctrine: welfare of all (*sarvodaya*) through self-rule (*swarāj*), non-violence, decentralisation, dignity of labour, trusteeship, restraint of wants, village-centred production. Argument in five steps ending in decentralised, need-oriented, ecologically restrained development. Four presuppositions. Three objections: romantic village - answered only by equal rights and anti-domination, with Ambedkar indispensable; technological conservatism - answered by the test of scale, control and need; trusteeship as voluntary paternalism - answered by moral delegitimation plus institutional mechanisms. Two comparisons: against industrial modernisation, selective adoption; against Ambedkar, local self-government progressive only under constitutional rights, mobility and anti-caste safeguards.

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 18

Gandhian social development -> an ARGUMENT: unlimited wants -> centralised power -> means shape ends -> local capacity -> decentralised, need-oriented, restrained development
-> MECHANISM: a TEST of scale, control and need applied to any proposal
-> CONSEQUENCE: survives in a CONDITIONED form -- inside rights, mobility and anti-caste safeguards it does not itself supply
-> TRAP: nostalgia reading; omitting Ambedkar; importing the full caste debate; trusteeship treated as enforcement; exposition without examination
-> ANSWER USE: state the five steps, run the three objections, close on the conditioned verdict

SESSION 19 - ECOLOGICAL POLITICAL PHILOSOPHY: STANDING, LIMITS AND FUTURE JUSTICE

The picture first

FOUR PRIOR QUESTIONS THAT "SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT" DOES NOT ANSWER

Session 11 gave the policy formula. THIS session gives the philosophy underneath it. The prior questions are:

WHAT HAS MORAL STANDING? | IS PERMANENT GROWTH COHERENT? |
WHAT IS OWED TO THE UNBORN? | WHO BEARS THE COST OF ADJUSTMENT?

BLOCK A -- MORAL STANDING: THE THREE ORIENTATIONS

ORIENTATION	WHO OR WHAT COUNTS	CHARACTERISTIC WEAKNESS
ANTHROPO-CENTRIC	HUMAN BEINGS ONLY. Nature has INSTRUMENTAL value -- resource, life-support, amenity, heritage for future humans	protects only what humans happen to need or value; permits destruction where NO HUMAN INTEREST is engaged
BIOCENTRIC	ALL INDIVIDUAL LIVING BEINGS, each having a GOOD OF ITS OWN	no principled way to ADJUDICATE BETWEEN ORGANISMS; cannot easily protect a SPECIES or a SYSTEM as such
ECOCENTRIC	ECOLOGICAL WHOLEES -- species, habitats, ecosystems, the biotic community	risks SUBORDINATING INDIVIDUALS, human and non-human, to the good of the whole

THE DISCRIMINATING QUESTION -- ONE LINE THAT PROVES THEY DIFFER

WOULD IT BE WRONG TO DESTROY A WILDERNESS THAT NO HUMAN BEING WILL EVER SEE, USE OR KNOW OF?
ANTHROPOCENTRIC: NO. BIOCENTRIC: YES (individual goods).
ECOCENTRIC: YES (systemic integrity).
THEY ARE DISTINCT POSITIONS, NOT DEGREES OF THE SAME CONCERN.

THE PRACTICAL WARNING FOR AN EXAMINATION

DO NOT ADOPT STRONG ECOCENTRISM CASUALLY. PRESSED CONSISTENTLY IT LICENSES COERCIVE LIMITS ON HUMAN BEINGS FOR SYSTEMIC GOODS (the ECO-AUTHORITARIAN RISK IN BLOCK F) AND SITS BADLY WITH THE CAPABILITY FRAMEWORK THIS OWNER RELIES ON. THE DEFENSIBLE POSITION FOR A DEVELOPMENT ANSWER IS A STRONG, NON-INSTRUMENTAL ANTHROPOCENTRISM SUPPLEMENTED BY DUTIES OF STEWARDSHIP -- STATED AS A POSITION AND DEFENDED, NOT A SLOGAN OF "HARMONY WITH NATURE".

BLOCK B -- NAESS (1973): SHALLOW AND DEEP ECOLOGY

SHALLOW: fights POLLUTION and RESOURCE DEPLETION, with the central objective being the HEALTH AND AFFLUENCE OF PEOPLE IN THE DEVELOPED COUNTRIES. Concern real, but DERIVATIVE.

DEEP: asks about the UNDERLYING ASSUMPTIONS instead of the symptoms. Affirms INTRINSIC VALUE of non-human life independent of usefulness; treats RICHNESS AND DIVERSITY of life forms as values in themselves; calls for a change in the IDEOLOGICAL FRAMEWORK -- in the human self-understanding that places humanity outside and above nature.

THE DIFFERENCE IS ONE OF **DEPTH OF QUESTIONING**, NOT OF DEGREE OF CONCERN. Say this exactly; it is the examinable formulation.

THE FIVE-STEP RECONSTRUCTION

1. policy addressed to SYMPTOMS leaves the GENERATING FRAMEWORK intact
2. that framework treats nature as a STANDING RESERVE and

- ever-rising consumption as the measure of a good life
- 3. while it is intact, EFFICIENCY GAINS ARE ABSORBED by expanded consumption and problems reappear AT A LARGER SCALE
- 4. therefore an adequate response revises the FRAMEWORK -- the conception of the self, of the good life, of humanity's place
- 5. hence the difference is DEPTH OF QUESTIONING

BLOCK C -- PRODUCTIVISM AND THE DEGROWTH ARGUMENT

PRODUCTIVISM: the assumption -- shared across otherwise opposed ideologies -- that EXPANDING PRODUCTION is the MASTER OBJECTIVE of social organisation, both the measure of success and the solvent of distributive conflict.

NOTE: THIS CRITIQUE APPLIES TO INDUSTRIAL SOCIALISM AS MUCH AS TO CAPITALISM. Making that point prevents the answer from collapsing into a generic anti-market answer.

THE DEGROWTH ARGUMENT -- SIX STEPS

1. economic activity is EMBEDDED in a biophysical system with FINITE SINKS AND STOCKS
2. efficiency gains per unit of output have been OFFSET by expansion in the VOLUME of output -- relative decoupling has not delivered absolute reduction at the required scale
3. beyond a threshold, further aggregate output adds little to health, longevity, education or reported well-being IN AFFLUENT SOCIETIES
4. therefore PERMANENT AGGREGATE GROWTH is neither ecologically feasible nor developmentally necessary for the already-affluent
5. hence the objective is PLANNED REDUCTION IN THROUGHPUT, with provisioning reorganised around SUFFICIENCY, CARE, SHORTER WORKING TIME and EQUALITY
6. and -- CRITICALLY -- the burden falls on HIGH-CONSUMING economies and classes, **NOT** on societies below the deprivation threshold

WEAKEST LINK (say so): that a NON-GROWING economy can maintain employment, public services and social stability.

THE ASYMMETRY THAT MUST BE STATED: CONTRACTION AND CONVERGENCE -- reduction far above a defensible threshold, EXPANSION far below. AN ANSWER THAT APPLIES DEGROWTH UNIFORMLY TO INDIA HAS MISUNDERSTOOD THE ARGUMENT.

THE CAPABILITY BRIDGE: if development is expansion of CAPABILITY rather than of OUTPUT, then beyond the level at which output secures capability, further growth has NO AUTOMATIC DEVELOPMENTAL CLAIM. Sen's framework reaches the same conclusion by a NON-ECOLOGICAL route -- joining the two is a strong move.

BLOCK D -- INTERGENERATIONAL JUSTICE, AND ITS THREE PROBLEMS

THE CLAIM: present generations owe duties of JUSTICE, not merely of BENEVOLENCE, to those not yet born -- most plausibly a duty NOT TO FORECLOSE their capacity to meet their own needs and live lives they have reason to value. The BRUNDTLAND REPORT (1987) builds this into the concept of sustainable development itself. PARAPHRASE IT; NEVER REPRODUCE IT VERBATIM.

PROBLEM 1 . THE NON-IDENTITY PROBLEM

different policies produce DIFFERENT FUTURE PEOPLE. A person born into a degraded world owes her EXISTENCE to the policy that degraded it; if her life is worth living she cannot claim to have been made WORSE OFF BY THAT POLICY.

RESPONSE: shift from PERSON-AFFECTING to IMPERSONAL principles -- what matters is the QUALITY OF LIVES LIVED, whoever lives them -- or ground the duty in the value of the RESOURCE BASE.

PROBLEM 2 . MOTIVATION AND RECIPROCITY

future people cannot reciprocate, vote, bargain or sanction, so MUTUAL-ADVANTAGE contractarianism struggles to generate the duty.

PROBLEM 3 . DISCOUNTING

standard appraisal DISCOUNTS distant costs, making catastrophic distant harm look trivial today. The objection: a PURE TIME PREFERENCE -- counting a person's interests for less MERELY BECAUSE SHE EXISTS LATER -- is arbitrary in the way that counting them for less because she lives FURTHER AWAY is arbitrary.

THE SPECIFICATION THAT ANSWERS INDETERMINACY: the duty is to PRESERVE OPTIONS AND AVOID IRREVERSIBILITY -- protect the CAPACITY TO CHOOSE, not the CONTENT of the choice. Uncertainty is therefore an argument FOR PRECAUTION about irreversible losses, not for inaction.

BLOCK E -- THE ENVIRONMENTALISM OF THE POOR (GUHA AND

MARTINEZ-ALIER, *VARIETIES OF ENVIRONMENTALISM*, 1997)

THE CLAIM: environmentalism in the global South is typically NOT a post-material concern of the affluent for wilderness and amenity, but a struggle over LIVELIHOOD -- access to forests, water, grazing, fisheries and clean air by communities whose subsistence depends DIRECTLY on them.

THE FIVE-STEP ARGUMENT

1. a dominant account treats environmental concern as emerging ONLY AFTER material needs are satisfied
2. but many of the most sustained conflicts occur AMONG THE POOREST, over resources on which they DIRECTLY DEPEND
3. these struggles are SIMULTANEOUSLY DISTRIBUTIONAL AND ECOLOGICAL -- who bears the ecological cost, who is displaced
4. therefore environment and development are NOT OPPOSED OBJECTIVES AT ALL for such communities: the two are the SAME QUESTION
5. hence "ENVIRONMENT VERSUS DEVELOPMENT" IS A FRAMING AVAILABLE ONLY TO THOSE WHOSE SUBSISTENCE IS NOT AT STAKE

THE REFRAMING -- THE HIGHEST-VALUE MOVE IN THIS SESSION

The standard stem presupposes that the AFFECTED PEOPLE ARE THE BENEFICIARIES. Where costs and benefits fall on DIFFERENT POPULATIONS the real question is DISTRIBUTIVE: WHO GAINS, WHO BEARS THE RISK, WHO DECIDES, AND ON WHAT TERMS.

OBJECTION: it ROMANTICISES the poor as natural conservationists, when poverty also drives degradation.

REPLY: the thesis is about the STRUCTURE OF CONFLICT, not ecological virtue. It claims the poor fight over resources they depend on -- compatible with degradation under INSECURE TENURE. The strongest version argues that SECURE RIGHTS convert DEPENDENCE INTO STEWARDSHIP.

BLOCK F -- THE ECO-AUTHORITARIAN RISK AND THE JUST-TRANSITION REPLY

THE ARGUMENT THE ANSWER MUST DEFEAT (state it fairly first)

1. ecological limits are HARD CONSTRAINTS; breaching them is catastrophic and PARTLY IRREVERSIBLE
2. democratic processes are SLOW, SHORT-HORIZONED and vulnerable to organised interests and to voters bearing costs now for benefits later
3. therefore ecological survival MAY REQUIRE INSULATING decisions from democratic contestation

FOUR REPLIES, IN ASCENDING STRENGTH

1. EPISTEMIC ... ecological policy depends on DISPERSED LOCAL KNOWLEDGE of soils, water, seasons and species that centralised authority does not possess
2. COMPLIANCE .. measures imposed without consent are EVADED, REVERSED at the next opportunity, and require enforcement capacity that itself consumes resources
3. RECORD insulation from accountability has NOT historically produced ecological restraint; suppressing information and dissent REMOVES THE FEEDBACK that detects damage early
4. DISTRIBUTIVE -- THE DECISIVE ONE ... where the burden of adjustment falls on those LEAST ABLE TO BEAR IT, ecological policy will be neither JUST nor DURABLE. A JUST TRANSITION conditions ecological restructuring on PRIOR GUARANTEES of livelihood, retraining, compensation and participation.

VERDICT TO STATE: the ecological case STRENGTHENS rather than weakens the argument for PARTICIPATION, because durable ecological transformation requires the CONSENT AND KNOWLEDGE of those whose livelihoods it reorganises.

Caption: the ecological module in six blocks - the three orientations on moral standing with the discriminating wilderness question and the practical warning against casual ecocentrism; Naess's depth-of-questioning distinction; productivism and the six-step degrowth argument with its asymmetry and capability bridge; intergenerational justice with the non-identity, motivation and discounting problems; the environmentalism of the poor with its reframing of the whole clause; and the eco-authoritarian argument answered in four ascending replies ending in just transition.

In plain words

Session 11 gave the policy formula for sustainability. This session gives what lies underneath it, because "sustainable development" is a formula and not a philosophy, and four prior questions decide how it is used.

What has moral standing? Three answers are available and they genuinely differ. The anthropocentric answer counts human beings; nature is protected because humans need it, enjoy it or will inherit it. The biocentric answer

counts every individual living thing, each having a good of its own. The ecocentric answer counts wholes - species, habitats, ecosystems. ANALYSIS: The fastest way to show these are not three degrees of the same concern is the wilderness question: would it be wrong to destroy a wilderness that no human will ever see, use or know of? The anthropocentric answer must be no; the other two say yes, for different reasons.

ANALYSIS: A practical warning follows, and it is worth heeding. Strong ecocentrism, pressed consistently, licenses coercive limits on human beings for the sake of systemic goods - which is the eco-authoritarian risk in Block F - and it sits badly with the capability framework the rest of this owner relies on. The position to adopt in a development answer is a **strong, non-instrumental anthropocentrism supplemented by duties of stewardship**, stated as a position and defended, rather than a slogan about harmony with nature.

Is permanent growth coherent? Naess's 1973 distinction sets up the question: shallow ecology fights pollution and depletion in the interest of affluent human welfare, deep ecology asks about the framework that generates the symptoms and affirms intrinsic value in non-human life. The difference is one of **depth of questioning**, not degree of concern. The degrowth argument then makes the point structurally: efficiency gains have been absorbed by expanding output, and beyond a threshold further output adds little to health, longevity or education in affluent societies. ANALYSIS: Its indispensable qualification is the asymmetry - **contraction and convergence**: reduction where consumption is far above any defensible threshold, expansion where it is far below. An answer that prescribes degrowth uniformly for a society below the deprivation threshold has misunderstood the argument, and saying so explicitly is what marks a controlled answer.

What is owed to the unborn? Duties of justice rather than benevolence - but three problems have to be met rather than ignored. The **non-identity problem** observes that different policies produce different people, so a person born into a degraded world cannot easily claim to have been made worse off by the policy that degraded it. The **motivation** problem observes that future people cannot reciprocate. The **discounting** problem observes that standard appraisal makes catastrophic distant harm look trivial, and the philosophical objection is that a **pure time preference** is arbitrary in the same way that discounting someone for living further away is arbitrary. The specification that makes the duty determinate is to owe **preserved options and avoided irreversibility** rather than particular goods.

Who bears the cost of adjustment? This is where the environmentalism of the poor reframes everything. If a community's subsistence depends directly on a forest or a river, then for that community environment and development are not competing objectives - they are the same question. ANALYSIS: "Environment versus development" is therefore a framing available only to people whose subsistence is not at stake, and the real question is distributive: who gains, who bears the risk, who decides. And when the eco-authoritarian argues that democracy is too slow for ecological survival, four replies answer in ascending strength, ending with the decisive one: an adjustment whose burden falls on those least able to bear it will be neither just nor durable, and a **just transition** conditions ecological restructuring on prior guarantees of livelihood, retraining, compensation and participation.

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: **The three orientations.** *Anthropocentric*: human beings only; nature has instrumental value as resource, life-support, amenity and heritage for future humans; it protects only what humans happen to need or value and permits destruction where no human interest is engaged. *Biocentric*: all individual living beings, each having a good of its own; living things have inherent worth independent of use; it gives no principled way to adjudicate between individual organisms and cannot easily protect a species or a system as such. *Ecocentric*: ecological wholes - species, habitats, ecosystems, the biotic community; integrity, stability and resilience have value beyond the parts; it risks subordinating individuals, human and non-human, to the good of the whole.

ANALYSIS: **The discriminating question.** Would it be wrong to destroy a wilderness that no human being will ever see, use or know of? The anthropocentric answer must be no; the biocentric and ecocentric answers are yes, for different reasons.

ANALYSIS: **The practical warning.** WRONG: Do not adopt strong ecocentrism casually. The defensible position for a development answer is a **strong, non-instrumental anthropocentrism supplemented by duties of stewardship**, stated and defended as a position.

FACT: **Naess (1973).** *Shallow ecology* fights pollution and resource depletion, with the central objective being the health and affluence of people in the developed countries. *Deep ecology* asks about the underlying assumptions instead of the symptoms; it affirms the intrinsic value of non-human life independent of usefulness, treats richness and

diversity of life forms as values in themselves, and calls for a change in the ideological framework - in the human self-understanding that places humanity outside and above nature. ANALYSIS: The difference is one of **depth of questioning, not degree of concern**.

ANALYSIS: **The deep-ecology reconstruction.** (1) Symptom-directed policy leaves the generating framework intact. (2) That framework treats nature as a standing reserve and rising consumption as the measure of a good life. (3) While it is intact, efficiency gains are absorbed by expanded consumption and problems reappear at a larger scale. (4) An adequate response therefore revises the framework. (5) Hence the difference is depth of questioning.

ANALYSIS: **Deep ecology's two objections and replies.** *It is a demand for conversion, not a policy, and risks equating the consumption of the poor with that of the affluent* - the strongest version distinguishes **subsistence from luxury** consumption so that restraint falls on affluence, but this substantially domesticates deep ecology and concedes ground; say so rather than concealing it. *Intrinsic value cannot be established without a valuing subject* - the reply is that the objection confuses the **source** of a value judgment with its **object**, though the residual problem is that intrinsic value remains asserted rather than demonstrated.

FACT: **Productivism.** The assumption, shared across otherwise opposed ideologies, that expanding production is the master objective of social organisation - both the measure of success and the solvent of distributive conflict.

ANALYSIS: The critique applies to **industrial socialism as much as to capitalism**, and saying so prevents the answer collapsing into a generic anti-market answer.

ANALYSIS: **The degrowth argument.** (1) Economic activity is embedded in a biophysical system with finite sinks and stocks. (2) Efficiency improvements per unit of output have historically been offset by expansion in volume, so relative decoupling has not delivered absolute reduction at the required scale. (3) Beyond a threshold, further aggregate output adds little to health, longevity, education or reported well-being in affluent societies. (4) Therefore permanent aggregate growth is neither ecologically feasible nor developmentally necessary for already-affluent economies. (5) Hence the objective is a planned reduction in throughput, with provisioning reorganised around sufficiency, care, shorter working time and equality. (6) And the burden of reduction falls on high-consuming economies and classes, **not** on societies below the deprivation threshold.

ANALYSIS: **Its weakest link, to be conceded.** That a non-growing economy can maintain employment, public services and social stability. CAUTION: No managed, socially stable contraction at scale has been demonstrated, and the concession should be made explicitly.

FACT: **The asymmetry. Contraction and convergence** - reduction where consumption is far above any defensible threshold, expansion where it is far below. WRONG: An answer that applies degrowth uniformly to a society below the threshold has misunderstood the argument.

ANALYSIS: **The capability bridge.** If development is expansion of capability rather than of output, then beyond the level at which output secures capability, further growth has no automatic developmental claim. Sen's framework therefore reaches the same conclusion by a **non-ecological** route, and joining the two is a strong analytical move.

FACT: **Intergenerational justice.** Present generations owe duties of **justice**, not merely of benevolence, to those not yet born - most plausibly a duty not to foreclose their capacity to meet their own needs and to live lives they have reason to value. The **Brundtland Report (1987)** builds this into the concept of sustainable development itself.

WRONG: Paraphrase that formulation; never reproduce it verbatim.

ANALYSIS: **The three problems.** *Non-identity*: different policies produce different future people, so a person whose existence depends on the degrading policy cannot easily claim to have been made worse off by it; the standard response shifts to **impersonal** principles about the quality of lives lived, whoever lives them, or grounds the duty in the value of the resource base. *Motivation and reciprocity*: future people cannot reciprocate, vote, bargain or sanction, so mutual-advantage contractarianism struggles to generate the duty at all. *Discounting*: a **pure time preference** - counting a person's interests for less merely because she exists later - is arbitrary in the way that counting them for less because she lives further away is arbitrary.

ANALYSIS: **The specification that answers indeterminacy.** The duty is best specified as **preserving options and avoiding irreversibility** - protecting the capacity to choose rather than the content of the choice. Uncertainty is therefore an argument **for precaution** about irreversible losses, not for inaction.

FACT: **The environmentalism of the poor.** Associated with **Guha and Martinez-Alier, Varieties of Environmentalism (1997)**: environmentalism in the global South is typically not a post-material concern of the

affluent for wilderness and amenity but a struggle over **livelihood** - access to forests, water, grazing, fisheries and clean air by communities whose subsistence depends directly on them.

ANALYSIS: Its five-step argument and the reframing. A dominant account treats environmental concern as emerging only after material needs are satisfied; but sustained conflicts occur among the poorest over resources on which they directly depend; those struggles are simultaneously distributional and ecological; therefore environment and development are not opposed objectives for such communities; hence "environment versus development" is a framing available only to those whose subsistence is not at stake. **ANALYSIS:** The consequence is that the real question is **distributive** - who gains, who bears the risk, who decides, and on what terms.

FACT: Its objection and reply. *It romanticises poor communities as natural conservationists, when poverty also drives degradation.* The thesis is about the **structure of conflict**, not ecological virtue: it claims that the poor fight over resources they depend on, which is compatible with degradation under insecure tenure. **ANALYSIS:** The strongest version argues that **secure rights convert dependence into stewardship**.

ANALYSIS: The eco-authoritarian argument. (1) Ecological limits are hard constraints and breaching them is catastrophic and partly irreversible. (2) Democratic processes are slow, short-horizoned and vulnerable to organised interests and to voters who bear costs now for benefits later. (3) Therefore ecological survival may require insulating decisions from democratic contestation.

ANALYSIS: The four replies, in ascending strength. *Epistemic:* ecological policy depends on dispersed local knowledge of soils, water, seasons and species that centralised authority does not possess and cannot easily acquire. *Compliance:* measures imposed without consent are evaded, reversed at the next opportunity, and require enforcement capacity that itself consumes resources. *Record:* insulation from accountability has not historically produced ecological restraint, and suppressing information and dissent removes the very feedback that detects damage early. *Distributive - the decisive one:* where the burden of adjustment falls on those least able to bear it, ecological policy will be neither just nor durable, and a **just transition** conditions ecological restructuring on prior guarantees of livelihood, retraining, compensation and participation.

ANALYSIS: The verdict. The ecological case **strengthens rather than weakens** the argument for participation, because durable ecological transformation requires the consent and knowledge of those whose livelihoods it reorganises.

Named evidence you can cite

- **Arne Naess, the shallow/deep ecology distinction (1973)** **FACT:** - cited by position and year only; paraphrased, never quoted. The examinable formulation is *depth of questioning, not degree of concern*.
- **The Brundtland Report, Our Common Future (1987)** **FACT:** - duties to future persons built into the concept of sustainable development. **WRONG:** Paraphrase only.
- **Guha and Martinez-Alier, Varieties of Environmentalism (1997)** **FACT:** - the environmentalism-of-the-poor thesis; the single strongest reframing of "development versus environment" and essential on tribal stems.
- **The three orientations on moral standing** **FACT:** - anthropocentric, biocentric, ecocentric, with the wilderness question that proves they are distinct positions.
- **The non-identity problem, pure time preference and the options-and-irreversibility specification** **ANALYSIS:** - the apparatus that makes a duty to the future arguable rather than merely asserted.
- **The just-transition reply** **ANALYSIS:** - the distributive answer to eco-authoritarianism and the constructive close of any environment stem.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The ecological limit binds affluent consumption far more tightly than it binds subsistence: a uniform prescription of restraint mistakes an argument about the distribution of ecological burdens for an argument against material improvement as such - and for a community whose subsistence depends on a forest or a river, environment and development are not competing objectives but the same question.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

moral standing · anthropocentric, biocentric, ecocentric · shallow and deep ecology · depth of questioning, not degree of concern · intrinsic value · productivism · throughput and sufficiency · contraction and convergence · subsistence against luxury consumption · intergenerational justice · non-identity problem · pure time preference · preserve options, avoid irreversibility · environmentalism of the poor · ecological distribution conflict · eco-authoritarianism · just transition

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. "Sustainable development" is a policy formula rather than a philosophy, and the prior questions it leaves unanswered - what has moral standing, whether permanent growth is coherent, what is owed to those not yet born, and who bears the cost of adjustment - determine how any development-and-environment stem should be answered. **Named evidence.** The anthropocentric, biocentric and ecocentric orientations differ over what counts morally rather than over how much nature to protect, as the wilderness question shows; Naess's distinction of 1973 separates a shallow ecology directed at pollution and depletion in the interest of affluent human welfare from a deep ecology that questions the framework generating those symptoms, the difference being one of depth of questioning rather than degree of concern; the productivism critique identifies the assumption, shared by industrial socialism as much as by capitalism, that expanding production is the master objective; the Brundtland Report of 1987 builds duties to future persons into the concept of sustainable development itself; and Guha and Martinez-Alier, in *Varieties of Environmentalism*, show that environmental conflict in the global South is typically a struggle over livelihood rather than a post-material concern for wilderness. **Analysis.** Taken together these convert the standard "environment versus development" stem into a distributive question - who gains, who bears the risk, who decides - and they defeat the eco-authoritarian argument on four ascending grounds, of which the decisive one is that an adjustment whose burden falls on those least able to bear it will be neither just nor durable, so a just transition conditions ecological restructuring on prior guarantees of livelihood, retraining, compensation and participation. **Qualification.** Two qualifications are compulsory: the degrowth argument applies asymmetrically as contraction and convergence, since prescribing it uniformly for a society below the deprivation threshold misreads it, and its weakest link - that a non-growing economy can maintain employment, services and stability - is undemonstrated; and a duty to future persons must meet the non-identity problem rather than assert itself, which is why it is best specified as a duty to preserve options and avoid irreversibility rather than to deliver particular goods.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: Precaution about irreversibility is a licence for indefinite obstruction. Almost every significant development decision forecloses something permanently, so a presumption against irreversible loss can be used to block any project whatever, including projects that would relieve severe deprivation.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: The presumption is **defeasible and graded**, not absolute: it attaches most strongly where the loss is large in scale, non-substitutable, and forecloses options for people who cannot participate in the decision - future generations, or a community excluded from it - and it weakens where the loss is small, substitutable or reversible. It also shifts the **burden of justification** rather than prohibiting action, requiring the proposer to show why the foreclosed option is not needed rather than requiring objectors to prove that it is.
- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: Grading the presumption requires judgments about substitutability and scale that are themselves contested, and the burden-shift can be discharged by an institution with the resources to produce assessments while a community affected by the decision cannot contest them. The philosophical argument fixes the direction of the presumption; it does not equalise the capacity to argue within it, which is exactly why participation and just transition belong in the same session.

Examiner traps on this session

1. Invoking "harmony with nature" as though it were an argument. Name the orientation, defend it, and accept its characteristic weakness.
2. Adopting strong ecocentrism casually. It licenses coercion for systemic goods and conflicts with the capability framework the rest of the answer depends on.
3. Prescribing degrowth uniformly. WRONG: The argument is asymmetric - contraction and convergence - and applying it to a society below the deprivation threshold misreads it.

4. Asserting duties to future generations without meeting the non-identity problem. The duty must be argued, and the options-and-irreversibility specification is what makes it determinate.
5. Quoting the Brundtland formulation. WRONG: Paraphrase only.
6. Naming an environmental datum, target, project, company, movement or region. WRONG: Prohibited here; environmental facts and policy belong to the Environment and Governance areas.

Mini recap

Four prior questions. Standing: anthropocentric, biocentric, ecocentric - distinct positions, proved by the wilderness question; adopt a defended stewardship anthropocentrism rather than a slogan. Naess 1973: shallow against deep, a difference in depth of questioning. Productivism is shared by industrial socialism and capitalism; degrowth argues from finite sinks, absorbed efficiency and the post-threshold flattening - asymmetric as contraction and convergence, weakest at social stability. Intergenerational justice faces non-identity, motivation and discounting; specify it as preserving options and avoiding irreversibility. Guha and Martinez-Alier (1997) reframe "environment versus development" as distributive. Eco-authoritarianism is answered epistemically, by compliance, by record and decisively by distribution - just transition. Verdict: ecology strengthens the case for participation.

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 19

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sustainability formula -> FOUR PRIOR QUESTIONS: standing | coherence of
permanent growth | duties to the unborn | who bears adjustment
-> MECHANISM: standing orientations -> Naess depth-of-questioning ->
productivism/degrowth -> intergenerational duty -> environmentalism
of the poor -> just transition
-> CONSEQUENCE: "environment versus development" becomes DISTRIBUTIVE;
ecology STRENGTHENS the case for participation
-> TRAP: harmony slogans; casual ecocentrism; uniform degrowth;
unargued duties to the future; quoting Brundtland; naming any
project, region or figure
-> ANSWER USE: name the orientation, run the asymmetry, specify the
future duty as options-and-irreversibility, close on just transition
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SESSION 20 - DEVELOPMENT AND TRIBAL VALUES: THE FOUR-TEST RECONCILIATION AND THE INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE

The picture first

PART A -- WHAT THE CONFLICT ACTUALLY IS

=====

NOT "MODERNITY VERSUS TRADITION". THAT FRAMING DECIDES NOTHING.
THE CONFLICT IS FIVE QUESTIONS ABOUT AUTHORITY AND DISTRIBUTION:

1. WHO DEFINES BENEFIT?
2. WHO BEARS COST AND RISK?
3. IS LAND ONLY A COMMODITY, OR ALSO IDENTITY AND RELATION?
4. WHOSE KNOWLEDGE COUNTS?
5. ARE CONSENT AND SELF-GOVERNMENT REAL?

WHAT PROJECTS DESCRIBED AS DEVELOPMENT CAN IMPOSE
DISPLACEMENT | EXTRACTION | ECOLOGICAL LOSS | CULTURAL
ASSIMILATION -- while the BENEFITS FLOW ELSEWHERE.

THE DISCIPLINE ON DESCRIBING COMMUNITIES

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+-----+
| TRIBAL COMMUNITIES ARE INTERNALLY DIVERSE. AVOID ROMANTIC |
| GENERALISATION. WHAT MANY DEVELOPMENT CONFLICTS DO INVOLVE: |
| COMMUNITY CONTROL OF RESOURCES | ECOLOGICAL DEPENDENCE |
| CUSTOMARY INSTITUTIONS | INTERGENERATIONAL CONTINUITY |
| COLLECTIVE IDENTITY. |
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PART B -- THE SEVEN-STEP RECONCILIATION MODEL

1. begin with EQUAL CITIZENSHIP and CULTURAL RECOGNITION
 2. assess CAPABILITIES GAINED **AND CAPABILITIES DESTROYED**
 3. secure INFORMED AND INCLUSIVE PARTICIPATION of the affected
 4. recognise INDIVIDUAL AND COMMUNITY RIGHTS WITHOUT FREEZING CULTURE
 5. distribute BENEFITS, BURDENS **AND DECISION-POWER** fairly
 6. preserve EXIT, DISSENT and GENDER JUSTICE within communities
 7. prefer REVERSIBLE and ECOLOGICALLY SUSTAINABLE alternatives where grave uncertainty exists
- VERDICT: development is reconcilable with tribal values ONLY WHEN COMMUNITIES ARE **AGENTS** OF DEVELOPMENT RATHER THAN OBSTACLES OR OBJECTS.

PART C -- THE CONVERGENCE GRID: EVERY EARLIER SESSION ANSWERS ONE QUESTION FROM PART A

QUESTION FROM PART A	THE ARGUMENT THAT ANSWERS IT
Who defines benefit?	ENVIRONMENTALISM OF THE POOR -- for those whose subsistence depends on a resource, environment IS development, so the "versus" framing is not theirs (S19)
Who bears cost and risk?	the DISTRIBUTIVE CORE of ecological conflict: costs and benefits fall on DIFFERENT POPULATIONS (S19)
Is land only a commodity?	the STANDING SPECTRUM shows that treating land purely as a resource is a POSITION, not a neutral default(S19)
Whose knowledge counts?	the EPISTEMIC reply to eco-authoritarianism: dispersed local ecological knowledge is not dispensable (S19)
Are consent and self-government real?	JUST TRANSITION makes PRIOR PARTICIPATION a CONDITION of durable policy, not a courtesy (S19, S15)
What is owed beyond the present generation?	INTERGENERATIONAL DUTIES specified as PRESERVING OPTIONS and AVOIDING

	IRREVERSIBLE LOSS (S19)	
Is the project's GROWTH OBJECTIVE itself examinable?	the PRODUCTIVISM critique makes the AIM contestable, not only the compensation package (S19)	

PART D -- THE FOUR TESTS. THIS IS THE MARK-BEARING STRUCTURE.
A development project affecting a community dependent on a common resource must satisfy ALL FOUR JOINTLY:

- (i) CAPABILITIES GAINED **AND DESTROYED** are both counted, INCLUDING THE COMMUNITY'S OWN
- (ii) those bearing the cost PARTICIPATE IN THE DECISION, not merely in the COMPENSATION
- (iii) IRREVERSIBLE ecological and cultural losses attract a PRECAUTIONARY PRESUMPTION AGAINST, since they foreclose options for BOTH present dissenters AND future generations
- (iv) the burden of ecological adjustment is NOT SHIFTED ONTO THOSE LEAST ABLE TO BEAR IT

THIS CONVERTS THE SEVEN-STEP MODEL FROM A LIST OF DESIDERATA INTO AN ARGUED TEST.

PART E -- INDIAN INSTITUTIONAL RECOGNITIONS: CLASSIFY BEFORE USE

ITEM	EXACT CLASSIFICATION
PESA, 1996	ENACTED STATUTE extending adapted panchayat arrangements to Scheduled Areas, with a role for the GRAM SABHA
FOREST RIGHTS ACT, 2006	ENACTED RIGHTS-RECOGNITION STATUTE recognising individual and COMMUNITY forest rights, including community rights over management and protection
ORISSA MINING CORPORATION v. MINISTRY OF ENVIRONMENT & FOREST (2013)	SUPREME COURT JUDGMENT involving GRAM SABHA CONSIDERATION of community and religious claims
ARTICLES 48A and 51A(g)	NON-JUSTICIABLE constitutional provisions -- Directive Principle and Fundamental Duty on protection of environment, forests and wildlife
ENACTMENT IS NOT NOTIFICATION. NOTIFICATION IS NOT IMPLEMENTATION. IMPLEMENTATION IS NOT CAPABILITY EXPANSION. A JUDGMENT IS NOT LEGISLATION. A NON-JUSTICIABLE PROVISION ESTABLISHES COMMITMENT AND NOT OUTCOME. AND NONE OF THEM PROVES A PHILOSOPHICAL POSITION.	

PART F -- THE FIVE INTER-SCHOOL DEBATES, ON ONE SCREEN

GROWTH MODEL vs SEN unit: output vs substantive opportunity | person: consumer/factor vs AGENT | inequality: distribute after growth vs CONVERSION AND FREEDOM CENTRAL | democracy: possibly instrumental vs INSTRUMENTAL AND CONSTITUTIVE

SEN vs NUSSBAUM evaluative space + public reasoning vs LIST + DIGNITY THRESHOLD; Sen avoids paternalistic closure, Nussbaum better resists oppressive adaptive preference

GANDHI vs INDUSTRIAL
MODERNISATION scale, productivity, mastery vs whether scale CENTRALISES POWER, MULTIPLIES WANTS, DEGRADES LABOUR OR NATURE -> selective adoption

GANDHI vs AMBEDKAR village as SCHOOL OF SELF-RULE vs village as INSTITUTIONALISED CASTE EXCLUSION -> local self-government progressive only under rights, mobility and anti-caste safeguards

MODERNISATION vs
POST-DEVELOPMENT institutional transformation vs IMPOSED STANDARDS AND EXPERT DOMINATION -> plural development under universal constraints

PART G -- THE INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE FOR ANY OWNED STEM

1. NAME THE CONCEPTION the stem assumes (economistic | human development | capability)
2. STATE THE LADDER distinction that the stem turns on
3. RUN THE STEM'S OWN LOGIC -- modal | causal | evaluative | reconciliation -- in its own vocabulary
4. ONE TABLE: concept grid | Sen's terms | the three orientations | the convergence grid
5. ONE FULLY WORKED OBJECTION -> REPLY -> RESIDUAL PROBLEM
6. ONE CLASSIFIED INDIAN ILLUSTRATION where the stem invites it
7. GRADED VERDICT separating MEANS, CONVERSION CONDITIONS and FINAL VALUES

Caption: the tribal conflict restated as five questions about authority and distribution; the seven-step reconciliation model; the convergence grid showing that each earlier argument answers one of those questions; the four joint tests that convert the model into an argued standard; the Indian institutional recognitions with their exact classifications and the four-step disclaimer; the five inter-school debates on one screen; and the integrated answer spine for any owned stem.

In plain words

The 2025 owned part asks whether it is possible to reconcile the concept of development with tribal values to bring social and economic progress. The word that matters is **reconcile**, because it signals that a yes-or-no answer is not what is being scored. What is scored is the **conditions** under which reconciliation is possible.

Begin by refusing the usual framing. This is not modernity against tradition, and treating it that way decides nothing - it merely invites a script that praises both and concludes that balance is needed. ANALYSIS: The conflict is five specific questions about **authority and distribution**: who defines what counts as a benefit; who bears the cost and the risk; whether land is only a commodity or also identity and relation; whose knowledge counts; and whether consent and self-government are real. Every one of those is answerable, and each has been answered somewhere in the preceding nineteen sessions.

ANALYSIS: Then a discipline about description. Tribal communities are internally diverse and romantic generalisation is a failure mode, not a courtesy. What can be said is that many development conflicts of this kind involve community control of resources, direct ecological dependence, customary institutions, intergenerational continuity and collective identity - and that is enough to run the argument without attributing a single outlook to millions of people.

The seven-step model then does the constructive work, and its two most examinable moves are step 2 and step 5. Step 2 requires counting **capabilities destroyed** and not only capabilities gained - because a project that builds a school while removing a community's access to the forest that fed it has produced a mixed result that only appears positive if half the ledger is ignored. Step 5 requires distributing **decision-power** and not only benefits and burdens - because compensation without a voice is a payment made to objects of policy.

ANALYSIS: And then the four tests, which are what convert a list of good intentions into an argued standard. They must be satisfied **jointly**: both sides of the capability ledger counted, participation in the decision and not merely in the compensation, a precautionary presumption against irreversible ecological and cultural loss, and no shifting of adjustment costs onto those least able to bear them. That is the mark-bearing structure of the 2025 answer.

The doctrine, exactly

FACT: **The conflict**. Projects described as development can impose displacement, extraction, ecological loss and cultural assimilation on tribal communities while the benefits flow elsewhere.

FACT: **What the conflict actually concerns**. Not "modernity versus tradition" in the abstract, but: who defines benefit; who bears cost and risk; whether land is only a commodity or also identity and relation; whose knowledge counts; and whether consent and self-government are real.

ANALYSIS: **The description discipline**. Tribal communities are **internally diverse**; avoid romantic generalisation. Many development conflicts nevertheless involve community control of resources, ecological dependence, customary institutions, intergenerational continuity and collective identity.

FACT: **The seven-step reconciliation model**. (1) Begin with equal citizenship and cultural recognition. (2) Assess capabilities gained **and capabilities destroyed**. (3) Secure informed and inclusive participation of affected communities. (4) Recognise individual and community rights **without freezing culture**. (5) Distribute benefits, burdens **and decision-power** fairly. (6) Preserve **exit, dissent and gender justice** within communities. (7) Prefer reversible and ecologically sustainable alternatives where grave uncertainty exists.

FACT: The verdict. Development is reconcilable with tribal values **only when communities are agents of development rather than obstacles or objects.**

ANALYSIS: The four tests, jointly required. (i) Capabilities gained **and destroyed** are both counted, including the community's own. (ii) Those bearing the cost **participate in the decision**, not merely in the compensation. (iii) Irreversible ecological and cultural losses attract a **precautionary presumption against**, since they foreclose options for both present dissenters and future generations. (iv) The burden of ecological adjustment is **not shifted onto those least able to bear it.** **FACT:** This converts the seven-step model from a list of desiderata into an argued test.

FACT: The Indian institutional recognitions, classified. The **Provisions of the Panchayats (Extension to the Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996** is an **enacted statute** extending adapted panchayat arrangements to Scheduled Areas, with a role for the Gram Sabha. The **Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006** is an **enacted rights-recognition statute** recognising individual and community forest rights, including community rights over the management and protection of forest resources. **Orissa Mining Corporation v. Ministry of Environment & Forest (2013)** is a **Supreme Court judgment** involving Gram Sabha consideration of community and religious claims. **Articles 48A and 51A(g)** are **non-justiciable** constitutional provisions concerning protection of the environment, forests and wildlife.

ANALYSIS: The four-step disclaimer that must accompany them. Enactment is not notification; notification is not implementation; implementation is not capability expansion; and a judgment is not legislation. A non-justiciable provision establishes **commitment, not outcome.** **WRONG:** None of these is evidence that a philosophical position is correct, and **WRONG:** no project, company, movement or region is to be named.

FACT: The five inter-school debates. *Growth model against Sen:* unit - output against substantive opportunity; person - consumer or factor of production against agent; inequality - distribution after growth against conversion and freedom as central; democracy - possibly instrumental against instrumental and constitutive. *Sen against Nussbaum:* evaluative space and public reasoning against a list and dignity threshold, with Sen avoiding paternalistic closure and Nussbaum better resisting oppressive adaptive preference. *Gandhi against industrial modernisation:* scale, productivity and mastery over scarcity against the question whether scale centralises power, multiplies wants and degrades labour or nature, resolved by selective adoption. *Gandhi against Ambedkar on the village:* the village as a school of self-rule against the village as institutionalised caste exclusion, resolved by conditioning local self-government on constitutional rights, mobility and anti-caste safeguards. *Modernisation against post-development:* institutional and productive transformation against imposed standards and expert domination, resolved by plural development under universal constraints.

ANALYSIS: The integrated answer spine. Name the conception the stem assumes; state the ladder distinction it turns on; run the stem's own logic in its own vocabulary - modal, causal, evaluative or reconciliation; deploy exactly one table; work one objection to a residual problem; supply one classified Indian illustration where the stem invites it; and close with a graded verdict that separates means, conversion conditions and final values.

Named evidence you can cite

- **The seven-step reconciliation model and the four joint tests** **FACT:** - the structure that answers the 2025 stem and converts a wish-list into an argued standard.
- **The classified Indian recognitions** **FACT:** - PESA (1996) and the Forest Rights Act (2006) as enacted statutes, the 2013 case as a Supreme Court judgment, Articles 48A and 51A(g) as non-justiciable provisions; each usable as a dated legal fact and none as philosophical proof.
- **The convergence grid** **ANALYSIS:** - the demonstration that every earlier argument in this owner answers one of the five questions the tribal conflict poses; it is what makes the final session a synthesis rather than a new topic.
- **The five inter-school debates** **FACT:** - the comparative apparatus that supplies the critical paragraph of any 15- or 20-mark answer.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE - WRITE OR ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Development is reconcilable with tribal values only where communities are agents rather than objects - where capabilities destroyed are counted alongside those gained, participation extends to the decision and not only to the compensation, irreversible losses attract a precautionary presumption, and adjustment costs are not shifted onto the least able to bear them.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

who defines benefit · who bears cost and risk · land as identity and relation · whose knowledge counts · real consent and self-government · capabilities destroyed as well as gained · decision-power, not only compensation · rights without freezing culture · exit, dissent and gender justice · precautionary presumption against irreversibility · agents rather than objects · enactment is not implementation

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Development and tribal values are reconcilable, but only conditionally, and the conditions are specifiable - which is why the correct answer to a reconciliation stem is a statement of conditions rather than a yes or a no. **Named evidence.** The conflict is not modernity against tradition but a set of questions about authority and distribution: who defines benefit, who bears cost and risk, whether land is only a commodity or also identity and relation, whose knowledge counts, and whether consent and self-government are real; and the reconciliation model answers them by beginning with equal citizenship and cultural recognition, assessing capabilities destroyed as well as gained, securing informed and inclusive participation, recognising individual and community rights without freezing culture, distributing benefits, burdens and decision-power, preserving exit, dissent and gender justice, and preferring reversible alternatives under grave uncertainty. **Analysis.** Those steps become an argued standard rather than a list of desiderata when they are compressed into four tests that must be satisfied jointly - both sides of the capability ledger counted including the community's own, participation in the decision and not merely in the compensation, a precautionary presumption against irreversible ecological and cultural loss because it forecloses options for present dissenters and future generations alike, and no shifting of adjustment burdens onto those least able to bear them - and the Indian institutional recognitions can then be used correctly, with PESA of 1996 and the Forest Rights Act of 2006 classified as enacted statutes, the 2013 case as a Supreme Court judgment and Articles 48A and 51A(g) as non-justiciable provisions. **Qualification.** Each of those legal facts establishes institutional recognition and nothing more: enactment is not notification, notification is not implementation, implementation is not capability expansion, and a non-justiciable provision establishes commitment rather than outcome - so the verdict is that reconciliation is possible where communities are agents of development rather than obstacles or objects, and that no statute or judgment demonstrates that the condition has been met.

Objection -> reply -> residual limit

- **Objection.** FACT: The exit-and-dissent condition is in tension with the recognition of community rights. If a community's authority over its own affairs is real, then the terms of membership are for the community to set; if outsiders may override those terms in the name of individual exit or gender justice, the recognition was never more than conditional permission.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: The tension is real and the resolution is principled rather than diplomatic. Community rights are recognised because they protect the conditions under which persons live valued lives - the relations, institutions and continuity that constitute a form of life - and that justification cannot extend to arrangements that destroy the same conditions for some members. The threshold argument supplies the boundary: what a community may not do is push any of its own members below the floor of central capabilities, because that floor attaches to persons and is not the community's to trade. Recognition is therefore genuine and bounded, and it is bounded by the very consideration that grounds it.
- **Residual limit.** CAUTION: The boundary is easier to state than to administer, because deciding when an internal practice crosses it requires an external judgment about a community's internal life - exactly the authority that the post-development critique challenges. The honest position is that the judgment must be made through procedures in which the community's own dissenting members have standing, while conceding that no procedure fully removes the asymmetry of power in which such judgments are made.

Examiner traps on this session

1. Framing the question as modernity against tradition. It decides nothing and produces a "balance is needed" close.
2. Romanticising tribal communities. They are internally diverse, and generalisation is a failure of analysis rather than a mark of respect.
3. Treating PESA or the Forest Rights Act as evidence of reconciliation. ANALYSIS: Enactment is not implementation, and the four-step disclaimer must be written.

4. Misclassifying the legal material - calling the 2013 case legislation, or treating Articles 48A and 51A(g) as enforceable. Both are checkable errors.
5. Answering with compensation. Compensation without decision-power fails test (ii), and it is precisely the failure the stem is testing.
6. Naming a project, company, movement or region. WRONG: Prohibited by this package's evidence discipline.

Mini recap

Reconciliation stems ask for conditions, not verdicts. The conflict is five questions about authority and distribution, not modernity against tradition. Seven-step model, with capabilities destroyed counted and decision-power distributed. Four joint tests convert it into an argued standard. Indian recognitions classified: PESA 1996 and FRA 2006 as enacted statutes, the 2013 judgment as a judgment, Articles 48A and 51A(g) as non-justiciable - and enactment is not implementation. Five inter-school debates supply the comparative paragraph. The integrated spine: name the conception, state the ladder distinction, run the stem's own logic, one table, one worked objection, one classified illustration, one graded verdict.

CLOSURE FLOW -- SESSION 20

```
reconciliation stem -> FIVE QUESTIONS about authority and distribution
  -> MECHANISM: seven-step model, compressed into FOUR JOINT TESTS --
    both sides of the capability ledger | decision not compensation |
    precaution against irreversibility | no shifted adjustment burden
  -> CONSEQUENCE: communities as AGENTS, not obstacles or objects
  -> TRAP: modernity-versus-tradition; romanticism; enactment read as
    implementation; misclassified legal material; compensation as
    answer; named projects
  -> ANSWER USE: run the four tests, classify one Indian item, close with
    the graded verdict separating means, conversion conditions and
    final values
```

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills

Answer placement: each correct option was fixed **independently**, so the key sequence is unpatterned rather than rotated and no cycle such as ABCD - or its reverse - can be used to guess. Options are matched for length, specificity, grammar and visible formatting so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape alone. Every question carries four question-specific option explanations and one unique examiner trap.

Coverage: the twenty-four core questions run across the whole printed clause - *Development and Social Progress* - together with the five-rung ladder and the discriminating test, the descriptive and normative dimensions, the seven informational spaces and the three blind spots, the economistic model and its conversion premise, modernisation's five assumptions with the objection-to-assumption mapping, the human-development shift and its residual concealments, Sen's five terms with the three kinds of conversion factor, freedom in its constitutive and instrumental roles with the interlocking instrumental freedoms, adaptive preference and the paternalism danger, Nussbaum's dignity threshold and the Sen-Nussbaum dispute, dependency against post-development, sustainable development's four bases and four specifications, the five bounded evaluative lenses with the ownership fence, weak against strong teleology and the four conceptions of progress, the seven criteria with the necessary and sufficient tests, and redistribution against recognition. The eight remedial drills attack the errors that cost marks every year on this clause: equating consultation with empowerment, answering the technology stem with an unresolved balance, answering the skill-education stem with employment material, omitting Ambedkar from a Gandhian answer, treating compensation or enactment as reconciliation, applying degrowth uniformly, asserting duties to future persons without meeting the non-identity problem, and importing another owner's doctrine.

MCQ 1. Five words that are not synonyms

A script opens by writing that economic growth, economic development, human development and social progress are "broadly the same process viewed from different angles". On the account developed in this package, what has that opening cost the answer?

- A. It has cost nothing analytically, since the four terms do converge in the long run, and the script is free to distinguish them later in the answer when the question specifically requires it.
- B. It has cost the script its evidence base, because national statistical systems record each of the four separately and an answer must follow the categories used by those systems.
- C. It has cost the script the gaps between the rungs, which is where the whole argument of this clause lives, since no rung entails the one above it and the marks lie in that failure of entailment.
- D. It has cost the script only its opening line, since the substantive argument can be reconstructed later and examiners assess the body of the answer rather than its introduction.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: convergence is exactly what the clause denies. Growth can rise while unfreedom and ecological destruction intensify, so the four are not one process seen from different angles.
- **B:** Incorrect: the distinction is philosophical rather than statistical, and this owner requires no figures at all, so no statistical system settles which concepts are distinct.
- **C:** Correct: each rung answers a different question in a different informational space, and the absence of automatic entailment upward is what generates every owned question in this clause.
- **D:** Incorrect: the opening fixes the framework, and a script that has identified the terms cannot afterwards adjudicate between them without contradicting its own premise.

Examiner trap 1: Treating the distinctions as preliminary decoration to be cleared before the "real" answer begins is the commonest structural failure here, because in the 2022 and 2024 stems the distinction *is* the answer rather than its preface.

MCQ 2. What both halves of the concept do

Why is it insufficient to define development purely as structural change in production, technology, institutions and social relations?

- A. Because that supplies only the descriptive dimension, and the concept also carries a normative one - the judgment that the change improves lives - without which a transformation is recorded but never evaluated.
- B. Because structural change is a term drawn from economics, and philosophical usage requires terminology that has been defined inside the discipline rather than borrowed from a neighbouring field of study.
- C. Because such a definition omits the ecological dimension, and no account of development is complete unless the biophysical limits within which the change occurs are stated clearly at the outset.
- D. Because structural change is too rare to serve as a definition, and most societies experience continuity rather than transformation, so the definition would leave ordinary cases entirely unclassified.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: development is descriptive and normative at once; the descriptive half records what changed and the normative half judges whether it improved lives, and dropping either produces a recognisable kind of bad answer.
- **B:** Incorrect: the disciplinary origin of a term is irrelevant to whether the definition is complete, and philosophy borrows descriptive vocabulary freely where it is accurate.
- **C:** Incorrect: ecological limits are a criterion applied within the normative dimension rather than a third dimension of the concept, and naming them does not repair a definition that lacks evaluation.
- **D:** Incorrect: frequency is not the issue; a definition can be correct about a rare phenomenon, and the defect identified here is evaluative rather than statistical.

Examiner trap 2: Supplying only the normative half produces the mirror error - an essay of aspirations with no object - so the correction is to write both dimensions rather than to swap one for the other.

MCQ 3. What an output measure cannot see

On the account of informational spaces taught here, which omission is *intrinsic* to an output or income measure rather than a corrigible defect of a particular index?

- A. The omission of political freedom, which could be repaired by adding a governance component to the index without altering the space in which the measure operates.
- B. The omission of longevity and schooling, which could be repaired by constructing a composite of the kind associated with the human-development framework and its dimensions.
- C. The omission of regional detail, which could be repaired by disaggregating the same measure by district, group or gender and reporting the resulting distribution.
- D. The omission of unpaid work, since an output measure sees only what is bought and sold, so a society can appear to grow merely by monetising labour that was already being performed.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this describes an addition of a different informational space rather than a defect intrinsic to output measurement, and the option itself concedes that the space is unaltered.
- **B:** Incorrect: adding longevity and schooling changes the measure into a human-development composite, which is a change of unit of account rather than a repair of the output measure.
- **C:** Incorrect: disaggregation is precisely the corrigible case, since the same measure can be reported by group without any change in what it is capable of seeing.
- **D:** Correct: unpaid labour lies outside the market boundary that defines the measure, so no refinement of an output metric can register it and the monetisation artefact follows directly.

Examiner trap 3: Ranking indices - asserting that one is "better" than another - earns almost nothing without naming the informational space each occupies, which is what determines what the measure can register at all.

MCQ 4. What adaptive preference actually claims

A candidate writes that Sen's adaptive-preference argument shows that deprived people "do not know what is good for them". What has gone wrong?

- A. Nothing has gone wrong, since the argument does hold that long deprivation distorts judgment, and the candidate has simply expressed an uncomfortable conclusion in blunt and direct language.
- B. The claim has been converted from a methodological point about what a satisfaction metric can record into a condescending claim about the competence of the deprived, which the argument never makes.
- C. The claim has been attributed to the wrong author, since the adaptive-preference argument belongs to the human-development framework rather than to the capability approach developed by Sen.
- D. The claim has been overstated in scope, since adaptation affects only material preferences and leaves political and social preferences untouched by any process of downward adjustment.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the argument concerns what reported satisfaction can be used to measure, not whether the deprived understand their own lives, and the blunt formulation changes the thesis rather than expressing it.
- **B:** Correct: the point is that a welfare metric will under-record deprivation once expectations have adjusted, which is why the disciplined response changes the evaluative space rather than overriding the report.
- **C:** Incorrect: the argument is Sen's and is central to the capability approach; the human-development framework is a distinct informational shift developed by Mahbub ul Haq and the UNDP.

- **D:** Incorrect: no such restriction is claimed, and the argument's force lies precisely in the fact that expectations about health, schooling and voice can adjust downward too.

Examiner trap 4: Answering the paternalism objection by asserting that experts should override stated preferences reintroduces the very paternalism the framework exists to avoid; the disciplined reply shifts the space to opportunity and leaves the choosing to the agent.

MCQ 5. Where the economistic model is vulnerable

Stated at its strongest, the economistic argument runs from material scarcity, through the expansion of the resource base, to the conclusion that economic development is an important enabling condition. Where is it most effectively attacked?

- A. At its unstated premise that resources can be converted into broadly shared welfare through institutions, since that is an assumption about institutional quality rather than a finding about production.
- B. At its first step, since material scarcity does not in fact constrain health, education and choice, and societies with very little have often achieved high levels of each of the three.
- C. At its conclusion, since economic development is not an enabling condition of anything and the developmental value of production has been substantially overstated in the literature.
- D. At its third step, since structural transformation never raises employment or state capacity and the historical record shows that transformation and capacity vary independently.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the argument is carried by the conversion premise, and attacking it makes the criticism specific - distribution, work quality, displacement, voice and ecological cost are the five silences that follow.
- **B:** Incorrect: severe material deprivation genuinely restricts health, schooling and agency, which is exactly why the threshold form of the necessity claim survives in this owner.
- **C:** Incorrect: this is the overcorrection the package warns against; it forfeits the threshold argument and with it the modal part of the 2024 stem.
- **D:** Incorrect: the claim is that transformation *can* raise employment and capacity, which a denial of invariable correlation does not touch, and the step is not where the argument is weakest.

Examiner trap 5: Attacking a straw version - that some people think money is everything - leaves the strong four-step argument untouched, and it is the strong version that the examiner is testing.

MCQ 6. What makes modernisation a theory rather than a description

Which set correctly names the assumptions that convert the description of industrialisation, urbanisation and mass schooling into modernisation *theory*?

- A. Scarcity, accumulation, specialisation, exchange and the division of labour, together with the claim that these processes are jointly sufficient for a rise in aggregate productive capacity.
- B. Secularisation, individualism, rationalisation, bureaucratisation and disenchantment, together with the claim that inherited belief systems dissolve once formal schooling becomes general.
- C. Linear sequence, convergence, the traditional/modern contrast, diffusion and expert direction, together with the claim that planners can identify obstacles and accelerate the transition.
- D. Capital deepening, technology transfer, import substitution, planning and state capacity, together with the claim that transformation must be financed before institutions can be reformed.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: these are descriptive features of an industrialising economy rather than the theoretical commitments that make modernisation contestable as a theory of development.
- **B:** Incorrect: these are associated sociological themes rather than the five assumptions identified here, and none of them is the target of dependency or post-development criticism.
- **C:** Correct: these five are what each hostile critique attacks - dependency at sequence and convergence, post-development at expert direction, cultural critique at the traditional/modern contrast, Marxist critique at convergence and diffusion.
- **D:** Incorrect: these are policy instruments associated with a period rather than the assumptions of the theory, and criticising them would not touch its linearity or its expert warrant.

Examiner trap 6: Writing that societies "naturally become modern as they develop" concedes three of the five assumptions in a single sentence and leaves the critique with nothing left to deny.

MCQ 7. Which critique attacks which assumption

A candidate asserts that dependency and post-development both show that modernisation is Eurocentric. What is the analytically superior formulation?

- A. That both critiques reject industrialisation itself, dependency on economic grounds and post-development on cultural grounds, so the two converge on a common rejection of productive transformation.
- B. That dependency denies the linear-sequence and convergence assumptions by holding that underdevelopment is produced, while post-development denies the expert-direction assumption by questioning the authority to diagnose.
- C. That dependency denies the diffusion assumption while post-development denies the convergence assumption, so between them they exhaust the theory's five commitments without further argument.
- D. That both critiques are versions of the Marxist objection, since each traces the condition of poorer societies to the ownership of production and to the appropriation of the resulting surplus.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: neither critique rejects material improvement as such, and the strongest form of each rejects imposed uniformity while conceding demands for schooling, health and mobility.
- **B:** Correct: naming the assumption each critique denies converts a slogan about Eurocentrism into an argument and shows why the two generate different remedies.
- **C:** Incorrect: the pairing is wrong in both halves, and even if it were right, denying two assumptions would not exhaust a theory that rests on five.
- **D:** Incorrect: the Marxist objection about ownership and surplus is a distinct fourth critique, and post-development in particular is an epistemic rather than an economic claim.

Examiner trap 7: "Dependency and post-development criticise modernisation" is a sentence about the literature; naming the assumption each denies is a sentence about the argument, and only the second is scored.

MCQ 8. What the human-development shift achieved

Which formulation states most precisely what the human-development framework accomplished?

- A. It established that health and education are more important than income, and thereby fixed the correct ordering of developmental priorities for societies at every level of material provision.
- B. It demonstrated that composite indices are superior to single indicators, and thereby resolved the long-standing methodological dispute about how development ought to be measured.
- C. It proved that political freedom belongs among the dimensions of development, and thereby brought the assessment of regimes within the scope of developmental measurement itself.
- D. It changed the unit of account from the economy to the person, and thereby broke the identity between income and well-being that an output measure had silently presupposed.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the framework does not rank health and education above income; it relocates the subject of measurement, and material command remains one of its dimensions.
- **B:** Incorrect: composite construction is a technique rather than the achievement, and this owner's examinable content is the change of informational space rather than index methodology.
- **C:** Incorrect: political freedom is precisely what the framework does not include, which is one of its four named residual concealments.
- **D:** Correct: the shift is a change of unit, and its philosophical achievement is the breaking of the income/well-being identity, which is the formulation to write.

Examiner trap 8: Reducing the framework to a comparison of two indices loses the achievement entirely, and quoting an index value is an unsourceable discipline failure in a package that requires no figures.

MCQ 9. Why human development is not yet the capability approach

In what two respects does the human-development framework fall short of the capability approach?

- A. It measures too few dimensions and aggregates them with equal weights, so it understates both the range of relevant achievements and the disagreement about their relative importance.
- B. It records achieved states rather than real opportunities, and it counts people as beneficiaries whose outcomes are noted rather than as agents whose reasoning is part of the good measured.
- C. It relies on national data rather than household data, and it reports averages rather than distributions, so it cannot identify which groups within a population have been left behind.
- D. It omits ecological indicators and intergenerational effects, so it cannot register the drawing down of stocks that financed the improvement it records for the present generation.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: dimension count and weighting are technical features; the shortfall identified here is conceptual, concerning what kind of thing is being measured.
- **B:** Correct: achieved functionings are not opportunity sets, and treating persons as recipients rather than agents is precisely the gap the capability approach was built to close.
- **C:** Incorrect: this describes a corrigible aggregation defect that disaggregation can address, and it does not distinguish the two frameworks conceptually.
- **D:** Incorrect: ecological dependence is one of the residual concealments, but it is not what separates the framework from the capability approach in kind.

Examiner trap 9: Presenting human development and capability as the same approach discards conversion, agency and the opportunity/outcome distinction at once, and it is a distinction the 2022 stem specifically requires.

MCQ 10. Fasting and starving

Two persons are equally undernourished; one has food available and declines it, the other has none. What does the case establish?

- A. That capability is an opportunity set rather than an achieved outcome, so a metric confined to functionings cannot distinguish the two and therefore cannot be a metric of freedom at all.
- B. That utility is an unreliable measure of well-being, since the two persons may report similar levels of satisfaction despite occupying entirely different material and social circumstances.
- C. That resources are a poor proxy for development, since the person with food available holds more resources yet has achieved exactly the same nutritional outcome as the other.
- D. That conversion factors differ between persons, since the two bodies may metabolise identical quantities of food differently and therefore require different provision to reach the same state.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the contrast isolates the opportunity/outcome distinction, which is the point of the example and the distinction on which most capability questions turn.
- **B:** Incorrect: the case says nothing about reported satisfaction, and the adaptive-preference argument is a separate objection to utility metrics.
- **C:** Incorrect: the resource point is real but is not what the example isolates, since the two differ in available options rather than merely in holdings.
- **D:** Incorrect: conversion is illustrated by different persons needing different resources for the same functioning, which is not the structure of this case.

Examiner trap 10: Confusing capability with achieved functioning collapses the framework into an outcome measure, and the fasting-and-starving contrast exists precisely to keep the two apart in one line.

MCQ 11. The three kinds of conversion factor

Which grouping correctly names the three kinds of conversion factor and thereby explains why equal resources yield unequal freedom?

- A. Physical, economic and cultural - covering the body, the household budget and the inherited traditions that determine how a resource is understood and used within a community.
- B. Individual, collective and institutional - covering the person, the community to which she belongs and the formal organisations through which resources reach her in practice.
- C. Personal, environmental and social - covering body, age and impairment; climate, terrain and infrastructure; and norms, safety, discrimination and public provision.
- D. Material, informational and motivational - covering what a person holds, what she knows about it and how strongly she is disposed to make use of what she holds.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the household budget belongs to resources rather than to conversion, and the grouping omits the environmental factors that carry much of the argument.
- **B:** Incorrect: these are levels of social organisation rather than kinds of conversion factor, and the classification does not explain why one person converts better than another.
- **C:** Correct: naming the three kinds turns "conversion varies" into an analysis and supplies the mechanism behind the claim that equal resources yield unequal freedom.

- **D:** Incorrect: motivation belongs to the choosing of a functioning rather than to the opportunity set, and the grouping would make capability depend on disposition.

Examiner trap 11: Treating conversion as a single vague idea leaves the argument asserted rather than shown, whereas naming the three kinds allows a specific claim about the case in the stem.

MCQ 12. The clause in the definition of agency that scripts drop

Which element completes the definition of agency as it is used in this owner?

- A. The ability to make choices that are internally consistent over time, so that a person's decisions at different moments can be interpreted as expressing one coherent underlying plan.
- B. The ability to convert resources into functionings efficiently, so that a person achieves more from a given endowment than another person with the same endowment would achieve.
- C. The ability to participate in formal decision procedures, so that a person's preferences are registered by the institutions that allocate resources and set the terms of collective life.
- D. The ability to pursue goals one has reason to value, including goals that lie beyond one's own welfare, so that a well-provided person may still fail to be an agent in the relevant sense.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: consistency over time is a condition of rational choice rather than the content of agency, and a consistent person may still have no capacity to act on her goals.
- **B:** Incorrect: this describes conversion efficiency, which concerns how resources become functionings and not whether the person is the author of her ends.
- **C:** Incorrect: formal participation is one expression of agency rather than its definition, and registering preferences is closer to consultation on the agency ladder.
- **D:** Correct: the non-welfare clause is what distinguishes agency from being well provided for, and dropping it collapses agency into self-interested choice.

Examiner trap 12: Without the non-welfare clause the argument for participation loses its constitutive half, and an answer can then be pushed into treating voice as a mere instrument of better outcomes.

MCQ 13. Why the instrumental defence of freedom is not enough

Why must the constitutive role of freedom be written alongside the instrumental role?

- A. Because a purely instrumental defence makes freedom tradeable, so it can be suspended whenever a larger output is available without it - which is exactly the authoritarian-development argument.
- B. Because the instrumental role is empirically contested, and no reliable demonstration exists that political freedoms improve the informational quality or the accountability of public decisions.
- C. Because the constitutive role is the older of the two in the literature, and an answer that omits it will appear to rest on a recent restatement rather than on the original formulation.
- D. Because the instrumental role concerns only political freedoms, whereas the constitutive role extends the argument to economic facilities and to the social opportunities that support them.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the constitutive claim is what makes the trade unavailable in principle, since being able to participate is part of what a developed life consists in rather than a means to it.
- **B:** Incorrect: the instrumental role is defended rather than abandoned in this owner, and the argument does not rest on denying that voice improves accountability.
- **C:** Incorrect: chronological priority in the literature is irrelevant to the argument, and this package cites works by author and title without asserting such claims.

- **D:** Incorrect: both roles range over the same set of freedoms, and the distinction concerns what makes a freedom valuable rather than which freedoms are covered.

Examiner trap 13: Listing the five instrumental freedoms without stating that each raises the value of the others records the index and loses the argument, since the interlocking is what defeats the trade-off model.

MCQ 14. What the interlocking of the instrumental freedoms shows

On the account taught here, what follows from the claim that political freedoms, economic facilities, social opportunities, transparency guarantees and protective security reinforce one another?

- A. That any one of the five may be substituted for the others, so a society that performs strongly on economic facilities need not perform strongly on the remaining four to develop.
- B. That the five should be measured by a single composite index, since mutual reinforcement implies that they vary together and can therefore be summarised by one aggregate figure.
- C. That the five are ranked in order of importance, with political freedoms first because they generate the public pressure that produces the social opportunities and the protective security.
- D. That development cannot be modelled as a trade-off in which liberty is exchanged for output, since each freedom raises the value of the others rather than competing with them for a fixed budget.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: reinforcement is the opposite of substitutability, and the argument's point is that the freedoms are complements rather than alternatives to one another.
- **B:** Incorrect: mutual reinforcement does not entail statistical co-movement, and this owner in any case treats aggregation as concealing the weights that are the normative question.
- **C:** Incorrect: no ranking is asserted; the claim is about the relation between the five rather than about an order of priority among them.
- **D:** Correct: the interlocking undermines the exchange model on which the authoritarian-development argument depends, which is why it is stated as part of the argument rather than as a list.

Examiner trap 14: Using the interlocking claim to argue that all five must be secured simultaneously overstates it; the claim is that each raises the value of the others, not that partial progress is worthless.

MCQ 15. The reply that makes a capability threshold defensible

Which reply answers the objection that a specified list of central capabilities imposes one conception of the good life?

- A. That the list is derived from a survey of what people in many societies actually value, so its content is empirical rather than philosophical and no conception has been imposed by any theorist.
- B. That the objection applies equally to every normative theory, so it cannot count specifically against a capability threshold and may therefore be set aside without further argument.
- C. That capabilities protect opportunities rather than compelling functionings, so the threshold secures options without requiring anyone to exercise them, and its specification stays open to democratic interpretation.
- D. That the list is provisional and revisable, so any element found objectionable in a given society may be removed from it without affecting the structure of the remaining requirements.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: grounding the list in reported values exposes it to the adaptive-preference problem that motivated the threshold, so the reply would undercut its own rationale.
- **B:** Incorrect: dismissing an objection because it is general is not a reply, and the threshold's distinctive vulnerability is precisely that it is constitutionally entrenched.
- **C:** Correct: the opportunity form of the claim is what separates a threshold of options from a prescription of a life, and democratic specification answers the remaining charge of closure.

- **D:** Incorrect: revisability weakens the threshold's function as a floor, and a floor that yields wherever it is contested cannot resist an oppressive local consensus.

Examiner trap 15: Stating the imposition objection without its reply leaves the threshold undefended and converts an adjudication into a survey, which is the difference between a controlled answer and a description.

MCQ 16. What the Sen-Nussbaum disagreement is actually about

Which statement identifies the disagreement correctly?

- A. It concerns the number of capabilities that matter, with Sen holding that the relevant set is small and Nussbaum holding that it is considerably larger and more finely differentiated.
- B. It concerns the role of the framework - an evaluative space whose content is settled by public reasoning, against a determinate constitutional minimum owed to each person as a matter of justice.
- C. It concerns the measurement of capabilities, with Sen preferring direct observation of opportunity sets and Nussbaum preferring inference from achieved functionings within a population.
- D. It concerns the scope of application, with Sen addressing developing societies and Nussbaum addressing affluent ones where basic material provision can already be taken for granted.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: enumeration is a consequence of the disagreement rather than its content, and Sen's resistance is to fixing a final canonical list at all rather than to length.
- **B:** Correct: the dispute is about what the framework is for, which is why each position is strongest exactly where the other is weakest.
- **C:** Incorrect: no such methodological division is asserted, and both treat measurement as difficult rather than as the point of divergence.
- **D:** Incorrect: neither position is restricted by the material circumstances of the society, and the threshold claim is explicitly universal in scope.

Examiner trap 16: Describing Nussbaum as "Sen with a list" misses the dignity threshold and the justice claim, and it leaves an answer unable to explain why the two positions have different vulnerabilities.

MCQ 17. Two critiques, two different targets

Why does it matter, in practice, whether a critique of modernisation is a dependency critique or a post-development critique?

- A. It matters only for attribution, since both reach the same conclusion about the failure of the modernisation programme and differ solely in the vocabulary that each has adopted.
- B. It matters because dependency is a normative claim while post-development is a descriptive one, so only the first can be used to evaluate a project or a policy proposal.
- C. It matters because dependency applies to formerly colonised societies while post-development applies to all societies, so the two have different geographical ranges of application.
- D. It matters because they generate different remedies: one points to the terms of incorporation and ownership of gains, the other to who decides and whose account of their interests counts.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: they deny different assumptions of the theory and fail in different ways, so the difference is analytical rather than terminological.
- **B:** Incorrect: both carry normative force, and post-development's challenge to the authority to diagnose is a normative claim about who may speak for whom.
- **C:** Incorrect: no such restriction of range is asserted, and the distinction lies in what each denies rather than in where it applies.

- **D:** Correct: the structural claim and the epistemic claim point to different repairs, and a tribal-development stem engages both at once for exactly that reason.

Examiner trap 17: Merging the two produces a single undifferentiated complaint about Western imposition, which cannot explain why some remedies address ownership and others address decision-making authority.

MCQ 18. The romanticism objection and its reply

Both dependency and post-development face the objection that they romanticise local life. What is the disciplined reply?

- A. That the objection misdescribes the critiques, which have never claimed anything about local communities and confine themselves entirely to the analysis of external economic relations.
- B. That the objection is unanswerable, so the critiques should be abandoned in favour of a modernisation account modified to include cultural sensitivity in its programme of transformation.
- C. That the strongest form of each rejects imposed uniformity rather than material improvement, so local voice must be joined to universal dignity rather than substituted for it.
- D. That internal hierarchy is a matter for each community to resolve, so external observers have no standing to raise the objection in the first place and it may be dismissed.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: post-development does make claims about the standing of local accounts, so the objection has a genuine target and cannot be deflected on this ground.
- **B:** Incorrect: the objection is answerable, and abandoning the critiques would surrender both the structural insight and the challenge to expert authority.
- **C:** Correct: rejecting imposed uniformity while conceding demands for schooling, health and mobility is what makes the position defensible and generates the middle path.
- **D:** Incorrect: this concedes the romanticism charge by insulating internal hierarchy from criticism, which is precisely the failure the objection identifies.

Examiner trap 18: Concluding that all development is Western imposition forfeits the reply, cannot explain why poor communities demand clinics and schools, and is defeated by the internal-hierarchy point in a single line.

MCQ 19. What "sustainable" must be given before it does any work

Which set of specifications converts sustainable development from an adjective into an argument?

- A. Thresholds, distribution, participation and non-substitutable ecological limits, without which the word can be attached to whatever course of action was already intended.
- B. Targets, timelines, financing and monitoring, without which the commitment cannot be verified and the concept remains an aspiration rather than an operational obligation.
- C. Efficiency, substitution, innovation and adaptation, without which the requirement would forbid growth altogether and impose costs no society could reasonably be asked to bear.
- D. Consultation, compensation, resettlement and rehabilitation, without which affected populations bear costs they have not agreed to and the arrangement cannot be called sustainable.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: these four are the specifications the package requires, and each blocks a different way in which the word can be emptied of content.
- **B:** Incorrect: these are implementation and verification requirements belonging to policy administration rather than to the philosophical specification of the concept.
- **C:** Incorrect: substitution is precisely what the concept limits, so treating it as a specification reverses one of the four philosophical bases.

- **D:** Incorrect: these are project-level procedures; they matter, but they do not supply the thresholds and limits that give the concept its content.

Examiner trap 19: Writing "development must be sustainable" as a closing line states an aspiration where the examiner asked for a condition, and it is the commonest weak ending on any ecology-adjacent stem.

MCQ 20. Using the perspective map without breaching the fence

A candidate answering a development stem devotes a long paragraph to Marx's theory of surplus value. What is the error?

- A. The material is inaccurate as stated, and a development answer would require a far more careful reconstruction of the theory than a single paragraph could reasonably contain.
- B. The map supplies evaluation criteria rather than complete ideologies, so the Marxist lens contributes a criterion - class power and control of surplus - while the doctrine is routed elsewhere.
- C. The material is superseded, since the Marxist lens has been absorbed into the capability approach and no longer supplies an independent criterion for evaluating development.
- D. The material is irrelevant, since class and production have no bearing on the evaluation of development and no version of the Marxist criterion belongs in this clause at all.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the defect is not accuracy but ownership; a correct exposition of the doctrine would breach the fence just as thoroughly as an incorrect one.
- **B:** Correct: liberal and Marxist lenses are comparison only in this owner, and the criterion is to be applied while the full doctrine is routed to Political Ideologies.
- **C:** Incorrect: the criterion remains independent and useful, and nothing in the capability approach absorbs the question of who controls production.
- **D:** Incorrect: the criterion is explicitly included in the perspective map, and its warning - that growth can reproduce exploitation - is directly usable.

Examiner trap 20: Naming all five lenses and working none produces a catalogue; two lenses fully applied, one as the standard and one as the counterweight, is what the comparative paragraph rewards.

MCQ 21. What kind of claim "this is progress" makes

Which characterisation of the claim is correct on the account taught here?

- A. It is a descriptive claim about the direction of historical change, verifiable by comparing the condition of a society at two points in time and observing which way the difference runs.
- B. It is an emotive expression of approval, since evaluative vocabulary carries no cognitive content and disagreements about progress are therefore not genuine disagreements at all.
- C. It is weakly teleological: it judges movement toward a better condition and therefore requires stated ends, but it does not assert that history moves in that direction by itself.
- D. It is strongly teleological: reason, science and productive capacity carry societies forward, so the claim reports a tendency that operates independently of anyone's intentions.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: comparison of two states cannot by itself establish improvement, since improvement requires a standard against which the difference is assessed.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is a meta-ethical position the package does not adopt, and it would make the seven criteria of progress unintelligible as criteria.
- **C:** Correct: the weak form claims direction relative to stated ends and denies any automatic law, which is why progress must be achieved through agency, institutions and judgment.

- **D:** Incorrect: the strong form is defeated by the twentieth century, in which capacity grew alongside war, genocide and ecological damage.

Examiner trap 21: Calling every social change progress omits the word "justified" from the definition, and an answer that does so has no way to distinguish progress from regress or from mere movement.

MCQ 22. Adjudicating between the four conceptions of progress

Which combination correctly pairs a conception of progress with its characteristic failure?

- A. Linear with fatalism; cyclical with relativism; dialectical with complacency; plural with the mistaking of productive capacity for moral improvement in the assessment of change.
- B. Linear with mistaking capacity for moral improvement; cyclical with fatalism; dialectical with imposing a single historical direction; plural with relativism and the loss of common standards.
- C. Linear with the loss of common standards; cyclical with a single historical direction; dialectical with fatalism; plural with the conversion of technical capacity into moral advance.
- D. Linear with imposing a single direction; cyclical with the mistaking of capacity for improvement; dialectical with relativism; plural with an understating of the possibility of reform.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: every pairing is displaced by one position, and fatalism belongs to the cyclical conception rather than to the linear one.
- **B:** Correct: this is the mapping taught here, and each failure follows directly from the core claim of the conception it attaches to.
- **C:** Incorrect: the loss of common standards is the plural conception's risk, not the linear conception's, and the remaining pairs are equally displaced.
- **D:** Incorrect: imposing a single direction is the dialectical risk, and the understating of reform belongs to the cyclical conception.

Examiner trap 22: Surveying the four conceptions without adjudicating leaves the marks unclaimed; the scored move is to keep the useful half of each and name the failure that the remaining half generates.

MCQ 23. Answering the modal stem in its own vocabulary

How should the claim that economic development is necessary for social progress be stated so that it survives examination?

- A. As an unqualified necessity, since without economic development no society has ever achieved improvement in health, schooling, security or the standing of its disadvantaged members.
- B. As a denial of necessity, since progress is a matter of relations and institutions and can be achieved at any material level provided only that the relations are arranged justly.
- C. As a claim about correlation, since economic development and social progress are observed together often enough to justify treating the first as a practical precondition of the second.
- D. As a threshold claim: adequate material capabilities are necessary, since severe deprivation restricts health, education and agency, while no particular institutional form of development is indispensable.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the unqualified form overreaches, since "economic development" is a broad institutional phrase and no particular form of it is logically indispensable.
- **B:** Incorrect: this denies the enabling role that severe deprivation makes undeniable, and it forfeits the argument that distinguishes a threshold from an absence.
- **C:** Incorrect: correlation is not a modal relation, and answering a necessity question with a claim about co-occurrence evades the vocabulary of the stem.

- **D:** Correct: the threshold formulation preserves the argument while conceding that necessity attaches to material capability rather than to a named economic process.

Examiner trap 23: Answering that economic development "is very important" addresses neither necessity nor sufficiency, and it is the single commonest failure on the modal stem in this clause.

MCQ 24. Redistribution and recognition

A programme delivers resources to a group whose members continue to be treated as social inferiors. On the account taught here, how is the case classified?

- A. As paternalism: provision without standing, in which goods reach persons who remain objects of policy rather than fellow citizens, so redistribution has occurred while recognition has not.
- B. As symbolic equality: standing without means, in which equal status is declared while the resources needed to act on it are withheld from the people to whom it has been declared.
- C. As compounded disadvantage: the absence of both resources and recognition, which is the condition the programme was designed to relieve and has therefore failed to alter in any respect.
- D. As progress on this axis: the material dimension has improved and the attitudinal dimension will follow once the group's economic position has been secured over a sufficient period.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: resources present with recognition absent is the paternalism cell of the four-way grid, and the corruption is precisely that provision reaches objects rather than citizens.
- **B:** Incorrect: symbolic equality is the mirror case, in which standing is declared and the means to exercise it are missing.
- **C:** Incorrect: resources have in fact been delivered, so the case is not the both-absent cell of the grid.
- **D:** Incorrect: the sequencing claim is rejected in both directions - humiliation does not end with prosperity, and provision without standing entrenches the relation it was meant to relieve.

Examiner trap 24: Using "inclusion" to cover both demands conceals the distinction the examiner is testing, since inclusion without resources is symbolic and inclusion without standing is paternalist.

Remedial drills - eight errors that cost marks every year

MCQ 25. Consultation is not empowerment

A project report states that affected persons were invited to meetings, that attendance was high, and that the community was therefore empowered. What is the error, and what test exposes it?

- A. The report has confused participation with co-decision, and the test is whether affected persons held a continuing role in implementation and review as well as in the initial design.
- B. The report has confused consultation with empowerment, and the test is whether affected persons could dissent, exit, organise and demand reasons - and whether the decision could have been different.
- C. The report has confused information with consultation, and the test is whether reasons were given in an intelligible form rather than merely announced after the decision had been taken.
- D. The report has confused representation with attendance, and the test is whether those present were selected by the community rather than nominated by the implementing authority.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this identifies a real distinction two rungs lower and stops short of empowerment, which requires durable institutional power rather than a continuing role.
- **B:** Correct: empowerment is control over the conditions of action, it cannot be inferred from attendance, and the counterfactual test is the fastest way to expose the claim.

- **C:** Incorrect: intelligible reasons distinguish information from mere announcement, which is a rung-one issue and not the error in the report.
- **D:** Incorrect: selection method matters for representativeness but does not by itself establish decision-power, so the test would leave the central claim unexamined.

Examiner trap 25: Inferring empowerment from attendance or nominal representation is a checkable error, because the operative question is not who was in the room but whether anyone in it could have said no.

MCQ 26. The technology stem answered without a criterion

A script lists benefits and harms of technological change and concludes that technology has "both positive and negative effects on society". Why does this score poorly on the 2019-pattern stem?

- A. Because the list is incomplete, and a full answer would need to cover a considerably wider range of technologies than the four domains that the script has chosen to discuss.
- B. Because the stem asked for a historical account, and the script has produced a conceptual one that does not engage with the actual sequence of technological change.
- C. Because the harms outweigh the benefits, and a script that presents them as balanced has misjudged the weight of evidence that the question expects it to assess.
- D. Because the stem is a causal claim requiring a mechanism and a defeater, and an unresolved balance supplies neither - control, access and purpose fix the direction of the effect.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: coverage is not the defect; adding domains to an unresolved list produces a longer list with the same absence of adjudication.
- **B:** Incorrect: the stem asks whether technological development leads to ethical progress, which is a conceptual and causal question rather than a historical one.
- **C:** Incorrect: the package asserts no such weighing, and an answer that simply reversed the balance would still lack the criterion the stem requires.
- **D:** Correct: the optimist and critical pairs are one structural argument made four times, and the conversion conditions supply the verdict the balance was missing.

Examiner trap 26: Naming technologies, platforms, companies or episodes breaches this package's evidence discipline and weakens the answer, because a named case invites a counter-case while the structural point does not.

MCQ 27. The skill-education stem answered as an employment question

Which omission most damages an answer to the 2023-pattern stem on skill education?

- A. Frustrated capability - the case where competence is created and then blocked because decent work is unavailable, which is the sharpest of the four limits and the one that makes the verdict conditional.
- B. The distinction between vocational and general education, which determines the level at which the discussion of skills should be pitched and the institutions through which they are delivered.
- C. The role of employers in curriculum design, without which training cannot be aligned to demand and the resulting qualifications will not be recognised in the labour market.
- D. The history of technical education, which supplies the context in which contemporary emphasis on skilling should be assessed and explains why the emphasis has re-emerged.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: frustrated capability names a distinctive harm rather than an absence of benefit, and it is what converts an administrative answer into a philosophical one.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is a curricular distinction rather than an evaluative standard, and it does not tell the examiner what the answer is measuring skills against.
- **C:** Incorrect: this belongs to programme design and lies outside this owner, which supplies no employment data and assesses skills against capability.
- **D:** Incorrect: historical context is not owned here, and the stem asks for evaluation against a standard rather than for a background narrative.

Examiner trap 27: Answering with employment figures, scheme names or outlays produces an Economy answer inside a Philosophy paper, and none of that material can be sourced within this owner.

MCQ 28. The Gandhian answer written without Ambedkar

Why is Ambedkar's criticism of the village described in this package as indispensable rather than optional in a Gandhian development answer?

- A. Because Ambedkar and Gandhi are always examined together, so any answer mentioning one is expected by convention to mention the other regardless of what the stem asks.
- B. Because Ambedkar's constitutional programme is the only available alternative to Gandhian decentralisation, so an answer must choose between them before it can reach a verdict.
- C. Because decentralisation is defensible only with equal rights and anti-domination, so an answer that omits the objection has praised a scheme that may hand power to local hierarchy.
- D. Because Gandhi accepted the criticism, so an exposition that omits it misrepresents his position and attributes to him a view he had already revised in response to it.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: convention is not a reason; the objection is indispensable because it identifies a defect in the position rather than because of examination habit.
- **B:** Incorrect: the package does not present the two as exclusive alternatives, and the resolution conditions decentralisation rather than replacing it.
- **C:** Correct: the reply is that local self-government is progressive only where constitutional rights, mobility and anti-caste safeguards transform local power.
- **D:** Incorrect: no such claim about acceptance or revision is asserted here, and attributing one would exceed what this package's sources support.

Examiner trap 28: Expanding the objection into the full Gandhi-Ambedkar caste debate breaches the fence in the opposite direction; here the criticism functions as a bounded criterion and the doctrine is routed.

MCQ 29. Enactment, judgment and implementation

A script cites PESA of 1996, the Forest Rights Act of 2006 and the 2013 Supreme Court judgment as evidence that development and tribal values have been reconciled. What is wrong?

- A. The items are wrongly dated, and an answer that misstates the year of a statute or judgment will be treated as unreliable on the remainder of its factual claims.
- B. The items belong to Polity rather than to Philosophy, so citing them at all takes the answer outside this syllabus clause and into a different paper's territory altogether.
- C. The items are too few, and a reconciliation claim of this kind would require a wider survey of the legislative and judicial record than three instances can provide.
- D. Enactment is not notification, notification is not implementation, and a judgment is not legislation - so the items establish institutional recognition and nothing beyond it.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the dates as given are the ones this package uses, and the defect lies in the inference drawn from the items rather than in their dating.
- **B:** Incorrect: they are legitimately usable here as dated institutional illustrations, provided each is classified before use and none is treated as proof.
- **C:** Incorrect: adding instances would not repair the inference, since the same gap between recognition and outcome would apply to every additional item.
- **D:** Correct: the four-step disclaimer is what the package requires, and without it a legal fact is being used as evidence for a philosophical conclusion.

Examiner trap 29: Answering a reconciliation stem with compensation fails the second of the four tests, because participation must extend to the decision and not only to the payment that follows it.

MCQ 30. Applying the degrowth argument correctly

Which statement applies the degrowth argument as this package requires?

- A. Aggregate output should be reduced everywhere, since the biophysical limits are global and any exemption undermines the collective restraint on which the whole argument depends.
- B. Reduction is required where consumption stands far above any defensible threshold and expansion is required where it stands far below, since the argument concerns the distribution of ecological burdens.
- C. Growth should continue until a global threshold is reached, after which all societies should contract together at a uniform rate determined by the remaining ecological capacity.
- D. The argument applies only to affluent societies and has no implications at all for societies below the deprivation threshold, which may disregard ecological considerations entirely.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: uniform prescription is precisely the misapplication the package warns against, and it converts an argument about burdens into an argument against material improvement.
- **B:** Correct: contraction and convergence is the asymmetric form, and stating the asymmetry explicitly is what shows the argument has been understood.
- **C:** Incorrect: this defers the asymmetry rather than applying it and would license continued expansion by those already far above any defensible threshold.
- **D:** Incorrect: the asymmetry directs the burden of restraint, but it does not exempt any society from ecological considerations such as irreversibility and future options.

Examiner trap 30: Presenting degrowth without conceding its weakest link - that a non-growing economy can maintain employment, services and stability - overstates a case whose central presupposition remains undemonstrated.

MCQ 31. Duties to future persons, argued rather than asserted

A script asserts that the present generation owes duties of justice to future generations and moves directly to policy conclusions. Which problem has it failed to meet?

- A. The motivation problem, since future people cannot vote or sanction, which shows that the duty cannot be enforced and therefore cannot be a duty of justice at all.
- B. The discounting problem, since standard appraisal reduces the present weight of distant costs, which shows that the duty is real but that its content is a matter for economists.
- C. The non-identity problem, since different policies produce different future people, so a person whose existence depends on the degrading policy cannot claim to have been made worse off.
- D. The uncertainty problem, since future preferences and technologies are unknown, which shows that no specific obligation can be identified and that the duty is therefore empty.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the motivation problem concerns why the duty would be honoured rather than whether it exists, and unenforceability does not by itself defeat a claim of justice.
- **B:** Incorrect: discounting is a genuine problem and the philosophical objection concerns pure time preference, but it is not the objection that this assertion has bypassed.
- **C:** Correct: the non-identity problem attacks the person-affecting form of the claim directly, and the standard response shifts to impersonal principles or to the value of the resource base.
- **D:** Incorrect: uncertainty is answered by specifying the duty as the preservation of options and the avoidance of irreversibility rather than as the delivery of particular goods.

Examiner trap 31: Reproducing the Brundtland formulation verbatim breaches this package's citation discipline; the formulation is to be paraphrased, and the argument for the duty must be supplied separately.

MCQ 32. Staying inside the fence

Which of the following would take a development answer outside this owner's syllabus clause?

- A. Developing a full account of justice as fairness, of the annihilation of caste or of multicultural recognition, rather than using the corresponding criterion and routing the doctrine.
- B. Citing the Forest Rights Act as a dated statute while stating expressly that enactment establishes recognition rather than implementation or successful capability expansion.
- C. Using the Marxist warning that growth can reproduce exploitation as one criterion within the perspective map while leaving the underlying theory of value entirely undeveloped.
- D. Invoking the dignity threshold to bound a community's authority over its own members in a stem concerning development and the values of a particular community group.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: these are the doctrines owned by Social and Political Ideals, Caste Discrimination and Humanism, Secularism and Multiculturalism; here they supply criteria and are routed rather than developed.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is the correct use of a classified dated illustration and is expressly permitted, provided the four-step disclaimer accompanies it.
- **C:** Incorrect: this is exactly how the perspective map is to be used - criterion applied, doctrine routed - and it stays inside the fence.
- **D:** Incorrect: the threshold's bounding of community authority is developed within this owner as the mechanism that prevents recognition from freezing internal hierarchy.

Examiner trap 32: A correct exposition of another owner's doctrine breaches the fence just as thoroughly as an incorrect one, because the defect is ownership rather than accuracy - and the examiner marks the clause, not the content.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below

Every model answer here is independent learner practice and is **never** an official UPSC key; UPSC publishes no descriptive model answer for Philosophy Paper II. Question wording is reproduced exactly as printed in the official papers, including the 2024 paper's split marking **[10+5=15]** and its four-option modal formulation **"a necessary condition, sufficient condition, both or neither"**, the 2022 paper's **"does not on its own lead to"**, and the 2025 paper's phrase **"to bring social and economic progress"** - all preserved verbatim inside the question lines. The 2018 to 2025 Paper II texts are held locally, and the English wording of every part below follows the repository's verified Socio-Political PYQ ledger. Works are cited by author and title only: **Sen, Development as Freedom and Commodities and Capabilities**; **Nussbaum, Creating Capabilities and Women and Human Development**; **Mahbub ul Haq, Reflections on Human Development with the UNDP framework**; **Gandhi, Hind Swaraj** and his writings on trusteeship, self-rule (*swarāj*) and welfare of all (*sarvodaya*); **Ambedkar's** writings on caste, democracy and the Indian village; **O. P. Gauba, An Introduction to Political Theory**; **Guha and Martinez-Alier, Varieties of Environmentalism (1997)**; and the World Commission on Environment and Development, **Our Common Future***, the **Brundtland Report (1987)**. No page, chapter, edition or verbatim wording is asserted for any of them, and no author is quoted anywhere in this package. Seven dated facts appear, each classified before use - **Naess's shallow/deep distinction (1973)**; the **Brundtland Report (1987)**, paraphrased and never quoted; **Guha and Martinez-Alier (1997)**; **PESA, 1996**, an enacted statute; the **Forest Rights Act, 2006**, an enacted rights-recognition statute; **Orissa Mining Corporation v. Ministry of Environment & Forest (2013)**, a Supreme Court judgment; and **Articles 48A and 51A(g)**, both non-justiciable. ANALYSIS: Interpretive disputes - whether a specified capability list can be defended without paternalism, whether a non-growing economy can maintain employment and public services, whether duties to future persons survive the non-identity problem, and where the material threshold of necessity should be set - are flagged as contested rather than settled. WRONG: **No growth rate, income figure, poverty count, index score, emission quantum, target, scheme, project, company, movement, region or country is named anywhere**, and no statute, judgment or constitutional provision is used as evidence for or against a philosophical thesis.

Answer-length convention used throughout this package. UPSC Philosophy Paper II parts are written longer than General Studies answers. The working bands used here are **10 marks - about 150 to 220 words**, **15 marks - about 250 to 330 words**, and **20 marks - about 330 to 400 words**. Every solution below sits inside its declared band, and the demand decoding, the "why this earns marks" notes and the "how to improve this answer" notes are teaching apparatus that sit **outside** the timed word count.

Coverage. ANALYSIS: **Corpus signal:** this clause owns **6 of 112** Socio-Political question-parts in the 2018-2025 corpus, distributed **2018: 0, 2019: 1, 2020: 1, 2021: 0, 2022: 1, 2023: 1, 2024: 1, 2025: 1**. All six are solved in full below, followed by **six original solved Mains models**, two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks. The internal profile is more instructive than the volume: **not one** owned part asks for a definition of development. Two are **modal or relational** (2022 on whether economic development leads on its own to human development and social progress; 2024 on necessity and sufficiency), one is **causal** (2019 on technology and ethical standards), one is **evaluative** (2023 on skill education), one is **expository-critical** (2020 on the Gandhian conception), and one is a **reconciliation** stem (2025 on tribal values). Preparation that stops at definitions reaches none of them. ANALYSIS: Ownership discipline: justice, equality and liberty as ideals belong to **Social and Political Ideals**; full ideologies to **Political Ideologies**; cultural recognition to **Humanism, Secularism and Multiculturalism**; women's empowerment as a doctrine to **Gender Discrimination**; caste doctrine to **Caste Discrimination: Gandhi and Ambedkar**; rights and state legitimacy to **Individual and State**. None of those is counted here. WRONG: Do not route every occurrence of the words "development", "progress" or "empowerment" to this owner: ownership turns on the evaluation of development itself.

Solved PYQ 1 · 2019 · Q2(c) · 15 marks

Question: Does technological development lead to progress in the ethical standards of the society? Explain.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Does X lead to Y? Explain" - a causal claim, so a mechanism and a defeater are both required
Core issue	Whether enlarged capacity carries moral improvement with it
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: one core proposition, the symmetry, the conversion conditions, one concession
Key distinction	Capacity against ends; what can be done against what ought to be done
Non-negotiables	No technology, platform, company or episode named; the reshaping concession must be made

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: No - not on its own. Technology changes capacities and social relations; it does not supply its own ends.

The optimist mechanism, stated fairly. FACT: Communication can widen knowledge and sympathy; medicine reduces suffering; productivity can reduce drudgery; transparency tools can aid accountability. Each is a real mechanism, not a straw position.

The defeater, and it is structural. FACT: Every one of those capacities is double-edged **in the same respect**. The communication capacity that widens sympathy enables surveillance and manipulation. The medicine that reduces suffering can be distributed unequally, so the capacity exists while the relief does not. The automation that removes drudgery displaces and deskills. The information systems that support accountability reproduce the bias in their inputs.

What the symmetry shows. ANALYSIS: These are one point made four times: the **direction** of the effect is fixed by **who controls the capacity, who can reach it, and what it is aimed at** - and none of the three is supplied by the technology.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Technical progress becomes social progress only when governed by **ethical purposes, fair access, accountability and human control**.

The concession that must be made. ANALYSIS: The relation is not simply null. Technology reshapes **which** moral problems arise, creating new occasions for choice, new possible harms and new meaningful duties. What it does not do is supply the criterion by which any of them is settled.

Link to progress. FACT: This is the non-inevitability argument applied: capacity enlarges for care and destruction alike, institutions distribute its control and risks, and moral learning can be reversed - so progress requires agency, institutions and judgment rather than following from capability.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: a "does X lead to Y" stem is scored on whether a **mechanism** and a **defeater** are supplied. Scripts that list advantages and disadvantages and conclude that technology is a double-edged sword have described the phenomenon without adjudicating it. Naming control, access and purpose as the variables that fix the direction converts the same material into an argument.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: position one line; the optimist mechanism two lines; the four paired cases four lines; the structural point two lines; the four conversion conditions one line; the reshaping concession two lines; the link to non-inevitability two lines. Compression plan if short of time: reduce the four pairs to two and keep the conversion conditions and the concession, which are what distinguish this from a balanced list.

- **Structure:** position -> optimist mechanism -> structural defeater -> what the symmetry shows -> conversion conditions -> concession -> link to progress.
- **Doctrine:** technology as capacity without ends; ethical progress as institutionally and evaluatively conditioned.
- **Evidence:** the four optimist/critical pairs; the four conversion conditions.
- **Distinction:** what can be done against what ought to be done.
- **Criticism:** the flat neutrality thesis, corrected by the reshaping concession.

How to improve this answer

Add one sentence noting that some artefacts carry a **built-in tendency** - a capacity that requires centralised control to operate will produce centralisation whoever owns it - because absorbing that objection strengthens the position rather than weakening it, and it explains why "human control" among the conversion conditions is a substantive requirement rather than a pious one. If two more lines are available, note that assessment before adoption is difficult because social effects are often unknown until deployment is wide, which brings the precautionary logic of the ecological material into a technology answer. Do **not** add examples of particular technologies: the structural argument is stronger without them and naming them breaches the package's evidence discipline.

Solved PYQ 2 · 2020 · Q2(a) · 20 marks

Question: State and examine the Gandhian concept of social development.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"State and examine" - two scored halves; accurate exposition, then genuine critical examination
Core issue	Whether a decentralised, need-oriented, non-violent conception survives criticism
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: five-step argument, presuppositions, three objections with replies, two comparisons
Key distinction	A test of scale, control and need against a prohibition on machinery
Non-negotiables	Ambedkar's objection is compulsory; English-first terminology; caste doctrine routed

Independent model answer

Statement. FACT: Gandhian development seeks the welfare and moral elevation of all (*sarvodaya*) through self-rule (*swarāj*), non-violence, decentralisation, dignity of labour, trusteeship, restraint of wants and village-centred production.

The argument, in five steps. FACT: Unlimited wants create dependence, competition and violence; centralised industrial power separates production from human need and from local control; **means shape ends**, so violent or degrading development cannot yield a non-violent good society; self-rule requires economic and moral capacities at the local level; therefore development must be decentralised, need-oriented and ecologically restrained.

Presuppositions. ANALYSIS: Moral self-limitation is politically relevant; small-scale association can sustain participation; work has ethical and community value beyond income; social change can proceed through non-violent conversion and constructive action.

Examination - objection one, the romantic village. FACT: Villages may reproduce caste and patriarchy. **ANALYSIS: Reply:** decentralisation is defensible only with equal rights and anti-domination. **Ambedkar's criticism is indispensable**, not optional: he warns that the village can institutionalise caste exclusion, so local self-government is progressive only where constitutional rights, mobility and anti-caste safeguards transform local power.

Objection two, technological conservatism. FACT: Small-scale production cannot meet complex modern needs. **ANALYSIS: Reply:** read the position as a **test of scale, control and need** - does this scale centralise power, multiply wants, degrade labour or nature? - rather than as a ban on every machine.

Objection three, trusteeship as voluntary paternalism. FACT: Owners retain power. **FACT: Reply:** trusteeship morally delegitimises absolute ownership; **ANALYSIS:** institutional mechanisms are nevertheless required to convert obligation into accountability.

Comparison. FACT: Industrial modernisation values scale, productivity and mastery over scarcity; **ANALYSIS:** a defensible synthesis adopts technology selectively by capability, decentralised control, ecological cost and non-domination.

The restraint claim, correctly aimed. ANALYSIS: Restraint of wants is directed at **multiplied and manufactured** wants rather than at need, so it operates asymmetrically: self-limitation where consumption stands far above any defensible account of need, and material expansion where it stands far below. **CAUTION:** The boundary between need and manufactured want is not fixed by the doctrine itself, which supplies a direction rather than a line, and any specification of it is contestable and can be turned coercively against the poor rather than the affluent.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The conception survives examination in a **conditioned** form: a standing test of scale and control, operating inside constitutional guarantees it does not itself supply.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "state and examine" is two instructions and both are scored. The commonest failure is an admiring exposition with a single sentence of criticism appended. The second commonest is an Indian answer that omits Ambedkar. Reconstructing Gandhi as an **argument** with stated premises is what makes the examination possible, because premises can be tested and ideals cannot.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: statement two lines; five-step argument four lines; presuppositions two lines; three objections with replies eight lines; comparison two lines; verdict two lines. Compression plan if short of time: keep all three objections and shorten the presuppositions, since the objections carry the "examine" half.

- **Structure:** statement -> argument -> presuppositions -> three objections with replies -> comparison -> conditioned verdict.
- **Doctrine:** welfare of all (*sarvodaya*), self-rule (*swarāj*), trusteeship, restraint of wants, dignity of labour, means shaping ends.
- **Evidence:** *Hind Swaraj* and the writings on trusteeship, cited by title only; Ambedkar's warning about the village.
- **Distinction:** a test of scale, control and need against a prohibition on machinery.
- **Criticism:** the village objection, the enforcement gap in trusteeship, and the unsettled boundary between need and multiplied want.

How to improve this answer

Add one sentence linking the Gandhian restraint argument to the ecological material, since the same asymmetry recurs there: the limit binds affluent consumption far more tightly than subsistence, and Gandhi's critique of multiplied wants is one route to that conclusion while the productivism critique is another. If a further line is available, note that trusteeship's enforcement gap is the same gap that recurs whenever a doctrine relies on voluntary compliance, which is why institutional mechanisms rather than exhortation are the reply. Do **not** import the wider Gandhi-Ambedkar caste debate: it belongs to **Caste Discrimination: Gandhi and Ambedkar**, and here the objection functions as a bounded criterion.

Solved PYQ 3 · 2022 · Q3(a) · 20 marks

Question: Do you agree that economic development does not on its own lead to human development and social progress? Give reasons and justifications for your answer.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Do you agree... give reasons and justifications" - commitment is compulsory, with reasons as asked
Core issue	Whether the inference from economic development to the higher rungs is automatic
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: the ladder, the conversion argument, the missing term, the qualification
Key distinction	Economic development, human development and social progress as three distinct standards
Non-negotiables	The threshold qualification; recognition named as the missing term; no figures

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: I agree, with one qualification: economic development is an important **enabling condition** and is not an automatic route to either human development or social progress.

Why the three are distinct. FACT: Economic development is measured by structural and qualitative economic change; human development, in the framework associated with **Mahbub ul Haq** and the UNDP, by longevity, knowledge and a decent material standard; social progress by justified improvement in relations and institutions assessed through freedom, equality, justice, dignity, participation, sustainability and solidarity. Three standards, three informational spaces.

The first reason - conversion. FACT: **Sen** shows that resources are means whose value depends on what persons can convert them into, and conversion varies with **personal, environmental and social** factors. Equal resources therefore yield unequal freedom, so aggregate economic change cannot be read off as human development.

The second reason - the metric conceals. ANALYSIS: Output measures cannot see unpaid work, distribution or externalities; satisfaction measures adapt downward under long deprivation; and composite national indicators conceal within-group inequality. Improvement recorded in one space is silent about the others.

The third reason - the missing term is standing. ANALYSIS: Growth redistributes income at best; it does not redistribute **recognition**. Provision without respect becomes paternalism, and recognition without resources becomes symbolic - so a society can become materially richer while the structure of who defers to whom is untouched. In India, caste, gender and tribal status make this unavoidable; each doctrine is routed to its own owner and used here only as a criterion.

The fourth reason - agency. FACT: Development treats persons inadequately when it counts them as beneficiaries but not as agents. Empowerment cannot be inferred from attendance or nominal representation.

Qualification. ANALYSIS: The denial is of **automatic** inference, not of relevance: severe deprivation restricts health, education and voice, so adequate material capability remains necessary at a threshold.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Growth becomes progress only through **just conversion** into capability, dignity and sustainable institutions; the conversion conditions, not the output, are where the normative question lies. **ANALYSIS:** The discriminating test compresses the whole argument into one line: income rising alongside intensified unfreedom, humiliation or ecological destruction is growth without social progress.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the stem contains the words "on its own", and those three words are the question. The scored move is to show that the inference is **conditional** and then to name the conditions. Scripts that argue growth is bad, or that list problems of growth without a standard, have not engaged the modal structure of the claim.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: position two lines; the three-standard distinction three lines; four reasons ten lines; qualification two lines; verdict two lines. Compression plan if short of time: retain reasons one and three, which carry conversion and recognition, and compress two and four into a single line each.

- **Structure:** qualified agreement -> three standards -> four reasons -> threshold qualification -> conversion verdict.

- **Doctrine:** the five-rung ladder; conversion; redistribution and recognition; agency.
- **Evidence:** Sen on conversion and on capability as the evaluative space; Haq and the UNDP framework on the change of unit.
- **Distinction:** enabling condition against sufficient condition; holdings against standing.
- **Criticism:** the overcorrection into "growth is irrelevant", blocked by the threshold qualification.

How to improve this answer

Add one sentence naming the **aggregation point**: no single composite settles the weights between the seven criteria of progress, so public reasoning about those weights is part of progress rather than merely a technique for measuring it. If two further lines are available, add the empowerment ladder explicitly - information, consultation, participation, co-decision, empowerment - because it converts the agency claim from an assertion into a criterion the examiner can see being applied.

Solved PYQ 4 · 2023 · Q2(c) · 15 marks

Question: In the present scenario, will the emphasis on skill education enhance development? Evaluate.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Evaluate" - name a standard, apply it, concede the counter-case, deliver a graded verdict
Core issue	Whether skilling enlarges capability and agency or only employability
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the capability argument, four limits, the two mirror errors, the verdict
Key distinction	Bargaining power against usefulness to an employer
Non-negotiables	No employment data, scheme names or outlays; frustrated capability must appear

Independent model answer

Position and standard. ANALYSIS: Conditionally yes. The standard is **capability and agency**, not employment: skilling enhances development where it enlarges what persons can actually do and how far they can shape the terms on which they do it.

The positive argument. FACT: Capability requires **effective means**, not formal opportunity alone. Relevant skills improve the **conversion** of education into work and of work into agency; productive participation enlarges social contribution and **bargaining power**. So skill education can enhance development.

Limit one - frustrated capability. ANALYSIS: Skills without decent work available create a capability that is **created and then blocked**. This is a distinctive harm rather than a mere absence of benefit, since the person now knows what she could be doing.

Limit two - narrowness. FACT: Employability purchased by displacing critical, civic and humanistic education equips a worker while **disequipping a citizen**.

Limit three - unequal access. ANALYSIS: Which learners reach the high-return tracks is itself structured by inherited advantage, so a programme can **reproduce** the hierarchy it was meant to relax.

Limit four - obsolescence. FACT: Rapid technological change makes a terminal qualification expire, so the durable capability is the **capacity to re-learn** rather than the particular competence.

The two mirror errors. ANALYSIS: Skill education is **not sufficient**, because a blocked capability is frustrated rather than enlarged; and it is **not merely instrumental**, because competence and self-respect - the **dignity of labour** - belong to a developed life and not only to a means of income.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Emphasis on skill education enhances development only where it combines **livelihood, adaptability, dignity of labour and critical citizenship**; the operative test is whether the learner's bargaining power has grown, not whether her usefulness to an employer has.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "Evaluate" requires a named standard. The single most common failure is to answer with labour-market material, which produces an Economy answer inside a Philosophy paper and cannot be sourced within this owner. Naming capability as the standard and bargaining power as the test converts the same question into philosophy.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: position and standard two lines; positive argument three lines; four limits eight lines; two mirror errors two lines; verdict two lines. Compression plan if short of time: keep limits one and four, which carry frustrated capability and adaptability, and reduce the mirror errors to a single sentence.

- **Structure:** standard -> positive capability argument -> four limits -> two mirror errors -> conditional verdict.
- **Doctrine:** capability requires effective means; conversion; agency; dignity of labour.
- **Evidence:** Sen on conversion and agency; the Gandhian criterion of dignity of labour, used as a bounded criterion.
- **Distinction:** bargaining power against usefulness to an employer.
- **Criticism:** the luxury-argument objection to civic education, answered by the fact that narrow training does not survive displacement.

How to improve this answer

Add one sentence noting that adaptability is not an ornament attached to skilling but the part of it that **survives displacement**, since a narrowly trained worker whose occupation disappears has lost the whole of her acquired capability while one trained in general reasoning retains the means of acquiring another. If a further line is available, concede that in conditions of severe scarcity the allocation question between immediate employability and durable capacity is not settled by the capability framework itself - naming that indeterminacy is more controlled than resolving it by assertion.

Solved PYQ 5 · 2024 · Q3(c) · 10+5=15 marks

Question: Is economic development a necessary condition, sufficient condition, both or neither, in order to achieve social progress? Give reasons and justifications for your answer.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	A four-option modal question with a 10+5 split; the modal terms must be handled separately
Core issue	Which of necessity and sufficiency holds, and in what qualified form
Scope boundary	Ten marks for the two tests; five for the graded verdict and the conceptual point
Key distinction	Necessity as absence-blocks against sufficiency as presence-secures
Non-negotiables	The threshold formulation; a counter-case stated at the level of criteria, not by naming societies

Independent model answer

The logical frame. ANALYSIS: Necessity means the absence blocks the result; sufficiency means the presence secures it. The two are independent, so each must be tested separately - and answering that economic development "is important" answers neither.

Test one - is it necessary? ANALYSIS: A material threshold normally is. Severe deprivation restricts health, education and agency, and every other criterion of progress - freedom, equality, justice, dignity, participation, sustainability, solidarity - presupposes persons capable of acting. CAUTION: But "economic development" is a broad institutional phrase, and no particular form of it is logically indispensable in every conceivable community. The exam-safe claim is therefore that **adequate material capabilities** are necessary. **Verdict: necessary in a threshold form.**

Test two - is it sufficient? FACT: No. Material wealth can coexist with exclusion, authoritarian rule, gender hierarchy and ecological destruction. One clean counter-case defeats a sufficiency claim, and the reason it is available is structural: progress is assessed across seven criteria, and improvement on the material dimension leaves the remaining six untouched. **Verdict: not sufficient, in any form.**

Why the gap exists. FACT: **Sen's** conversion argument explains it. Resources are means whose value depends on personal, environmental and social conversion; equal resources yield unequal freedom, so aggregate material change does not translate into capability. And growth redistributes holdings at best, not **standing** - provision without recognition becomes paternalism.

The conceptual point, for the five-mark part. ANALYSIS: Identity and enabling are different relations. Economic development is not conceptually identical with social progress, since the two are defined in different informational spaces; it is an **enabling condition** whose developmental value is conversion-dependent.

Graded verdict. ANALYSIS: Neither "both" nor "neither": economic development is a **threshold-level necessary condition** and is **not sufficient**. CAUTION: Where exactly the threshold sits is not settled by the argument and will vary with conversion conditions - which should be conceded rather than concealed.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the four options are exhaustive and the examiner is checking whether the candidate can select one and defend it in modal vocabulary. The two most damaging failures are answering with importance and asserting unqualified necessity. Writing the word **threshold** is what makes the necessity claim survivable.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: logical frame two lines; necessity test five lines; sufficiency test four lines; the conversion explanation three lines; conceptual point two lines; graded verdict two lines. Compression plan if short of time: keep both tests complete and shorten the conversion explanation, since the tests are where the ten marks sit.

- **Structure:** logical frame -> necessity test -> sufficiency test -> why the gap exists -> identity against enabling -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine:** the seven criteria; the threshold formulation; conversion; redistribution against recognition.
- **Evidence:** Sen on conversion; the coexistence counter-case stated at the level of criteria.
- **Distinction:** necessity against sufficiency; conceptual identity against enabling condition.
- **Criticism:** the objection that the verdict says little, answered by its two-directional force.

How to improve this answer

Add one sentence pre-empting the objection that a threshold-plus-insufficiency verdict is evasive: it is substantive in two directions, defeating those who identify development with progress and those who dismiss material improvement, which is exactly what the four-option format is designed to elicit. If two further lines are available, note that the seven criteria explain *why* sufficiency fails - the material dimension is one of seven and improvement on it leaves six unaddressed - because that converts the counter-case from an assertion into a consequence of the framework.

Solved PYQ 6 · 2025 · Q3(c) · 15 marks

Question: Is it possible to reconcile the concept of development with tribal values to bring social and economic progress? Discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Is it possible to reconcile... Discuss" - the demand is for conditions , not a yes or a no
Core issue	Whether communities can be agents of development rather than objects of it
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the reframing, the four tests, one classified illustration, the verdict
Key distinction	Participation in the decision against participation in the compensation
Non-negotiables	No romantic generalisation; legal items classified; no project, company or region named

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: Reconciliation is possible, but only conditionally - and the conditions are specifiable, which is why a yes-or-no answer misreads the stem.

Reframing the conflict. ANALYSIS: This is not modernity against tradition. The conflict concerns **authority and distribution**: who defines benefit; who bears cost and risk; whether land is only a commodity or also identity and relation; whose knowledge counts; and whether consent and self-government are real. **FACT: Guha and Martinez-Alier**, in *Varieties of Environmentalism* (1997), sharpen this: where subsistence depends directly on forests, water or grazing, environment and development are not competing objectives but the **same question**, so "environment versus development" is a framing available only to those whose subsistence is not at stake.

A discipline about description. ANALYSIS: Tribal communities are internally diverse; romantic generalisation is a failure of analysis. What many such conflicts do involve is community control of resources, ecological dependence, customary institutions, intergenerational continuity and collective identity.

The four tests, required jointly. ANALYSIS: (i) Capabilities **destroyed** are counted alongside capabilities gained, including the community's own. (ii) Those bearing the cost participate in the **decision**, not merely in the compensation. (iii) Irreversible ecological and cultural losses attract a **precautionary presumption against**, since they foreclose options for present dissenters and future generations alike. (iv) The burden of adjustment is not shifted onto those least able to bear it.

Internal justice. FACT: Recognition of community rights must preserve **exit, dissent and gender justice**, because the dignity threshold attaches to each person and is not the community's to trade - which is how recognition avoids freezing internal hierarchy.

One classified illustration. FACT: PESA (1996) and the Forest Rights Act (2006) are enacted statutes; Orissa Mining Corporation v. Ministry of Environment & Forest (2013) is a Supreme Court judgment; Articles 48A and 51A(g) are non-justiciable. ANALYSIS: Enactment is not implementation and none of these proves reconciliation.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Development is reconcilable with tribal values only where communities are **agents** of development rather than obstacles or objects.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: a reconciliation stem is scored on **conditions**. A script that concludes "a balance must be struck between development and tribal culture" has decided nothing. The four tests, stated as jointly required, are the mark-bearing structure, and test (ii) - decision rather than compensation - is the one most often missing.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: position one line; reframing four lines; description discipline two lines; four tests six lines; internal justice two lines; classified illustration two lines; verdict one line. Compression plan if short of time: keep the four tests and the classification, and reduce the reframing to the single Guha and Martinez-Alier sentence.

- **Structure:** conditional position -> distributive reframing -> description discipline -> four joint tests -> internal justice -> classified illustration -> agency verdict.

- **Doctrine:** the seven-step reconciliation model compressed into four tests; the capability ledger; the dignity threshold as a bound on community authority.
- **Evidence:** Guha and Martinez-Alier (1997); PESA (1996), the Forest Rights Act (2006), the 2013 judgment and Articles 48A and 51A(g), each classified.
- **Distinction:** decision-power against compensation; recognition without freezing culture.
- **Criticism:** the tension between community authority and individual exit, resolved by the threshold that grounds recognition in the first place.

How to improve this answer

Add one sentence applying the **productivism** point - that the project's growth objective is itself examinable, not only its compensation package - because it prevents the answer from conceding the terms of the dispute before it begins. If two further lines are available, state the epistemic reply to eco-authoritarianism: dispersed local ecological knowledge of soils, water, seasons and species is not dispensable, which answers the "whose knowledge counts" question with an argument rather than a sentiment. Do **not** name any project, company, movement or region; the analysis is stronger at the level of criteria and naming breaches the package's evidence discipline.

Six original questions in the paper's own idiom - two at 10 marks, two at 15 and two at 20 - each solved to the same standard as the previous-year parts above. None reproduces an owned stem; each targets a route the corpus has tested indirectly or is likely to test again. **Modernisation, the measurement dispute and the ecological limits of development are deliberately represented here**, since each is printed inside this owner's material and none carries a directly owned part in the 2018-2025 cycle.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original 1 · 10 marks

Question: Distinguish between economic growth, human development and social progress. Why does the distinction matter?

Independent model answer

The three concepts. FACT: **Economic growth** is increase in aggregate or per-capita output; its question is whether more is being produced. **Human development**, in the framework associated with **Mahbub ul Haq** and the UNDP, is expansion of longevity, knowledge and a decent material standard; its question is whether basic human options are widening. **Social progress** is justified improvement in social relations and institutions, assessed through freedom, equality, justice, dignity, participation, sustainability and solidarity; its question is whether society has become defensibly better.

Three informational spaces. ANALYSIS: The three are measured in different spaces, which is why none entails the next. Output cannot see distribution, unpaid work or externalities; a national human-development composite cannot see within-group inequality or political freedom; and social progress cannot be settled by any aggregate at all, since the weights between its criteria are the normative question.

Why it matters - three consequences. ANALYSIS: It supplies the **discriminating test**: income rising alongside intensified unfreedom, humiliation or ecological destruction is growth without progress. **FACT:** It makes the modal questions answerable, since necessity and sufficiency can only be assessed between distinct conditions. **ANALYSIS:** It locates the **missing term** in most development failures - not more output but standing and agency.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The distinction is not preliminary decoration: in this clause the gaps between the three concepts are where the argument lives.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: a "distinguish and say why it matters" stem needs consequences rather than three definitions. The informational-space point is the sharpest, because it explains *why* the entailment fails rather than merely asserting that it does.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: three concepts four lines; informational spaces three lines; three consequences three lines; verdict one line.

- **Structure:** three definitions -> three informational spaces -> three consequences -> verdict.

- **Doctrine:** the five-rung ladder, compressed to the three the stem names.
- **Evidence:** Haq and the UNDP framework; the discriminating test.
- **Distinction:** what each measure discloses against what it conceals.
- **Criticism:** the objection that higher rungs are unmeasurable, met by preferring evaluative richness to false precision.

How to improve this answer

Add the observation that ascending the ladder buys evaluative richness and pays in **measurability**, since stating the trade-off before the examiner does converts an apparent weakness into a demonstration of control. If a further line is available, note that no rung is independent of the ones below it - severe deprivation blocks the higher criteria - so the claim is that the inference is not automatic rather than that growth is irrelevant.

Original 2 · 10 marks

Question: "A composite index of development is evidence, not a theory of the good society." Comment.

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: The statement is correct, and its correctness follows from what an index is.

What an index is. FACT: Every measure occupies an **informational space** and therefore fixes in advance what will count as evidence and what will be invisible. Output measures see market transactions; basic-needs measures see a deprivation threshold; welfare measures see reported conditions; human-development composites see longevity, knowledge and material command; capability measures see real opportunity; ecological measures see stocks, sinks and irreversibility.

Why no index can be the theory. ANALYSIS: A composite must assign **weights** between dimensions, and the weights cannot be derived from within any of the dimensions. They are the normative question itself, which is why public reasoning about them is part of development rather than merely a technique for measuring it.

Three concealments that decide arguments. ANALYSIS: Output measures cannot see **unpaid work**, so a society can appear to grow by monetising labour already performed. Welfare measures cannot see **adaptive preference**, so deprivation is certified as contentment. Composites cannot see **within-group inequality**.

The qualification. FACT: This is not scepticism about measurement. Knowing a measure's blind spot is what makes it usable, and plural measurement with explicit spaces, under a stated deprivation floor, is the correct practice.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: An index is evidence within one evaluative space; treating it as the theory mistakes the instrument for the question.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: a "comment" stem on a true statement is scored on the **reason** supplied. The weighting argument is the reason, because it shows a structural impossibility rather than a practical shortcoming.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: position one line; what an index is three lines; the weighting argument three lines; three concealments three lines; qualification two lines; verdict one line.

- **Structure:** position -> informational spaces -> the weighting argument -> three concealments -> qualification -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** the seven measure families and the aggregation problem.
- **Evidence:** the unpaid-work artefact; Sen's adaptive-preference argument.
- **Distinction:** evidence within a space against a theory of the good.
- **Criticism:** the slide into measurement scepticism, blocked by plural measurement under a deprivation floor.

How to improve this answer

Add one line noting that the weights problem is not removed by adding dimensions, since each addition creates a further weighting decision - which is why the argument is structural. If a further line is available, state that a deprivation floor is the one component that does not require weighting, because it is non-aggregative and attaches to each person.

Original 3 · 15 marks

Question: Examine whether participation in development is merely instrumental or partly constitutive of the end.

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: It is both, and writing only the instrumental half is a substantive error rather than an omission.

The instrumental case. FACT: Participation improves **information** - affected persons hold knowledge that centralised authority does not possess - and improves **accountability**, since decisions that must be defended to those they affect are more likely to be revised when wrong.

The constitutive case. FACT: Having a voice is itself part of a developed human life. On **Sen's** account, agency is the ability to pursue goals one has reason to value, including goals beyond one's own welfare; a person who is well provided for and cannot shape the terms of her life has been counted as a beneficiary and not treated as an agent.

Why the distinction has consequences. ANALYSIS: A purely instrumental defence makes participation **tradeable**: if it is valuable only for what it produces, it may be suspended whenever a decision could be made faster without it. The constitutive claim is what makes the trade unavailable in principle, and it is the reply to any stem proposing that consultation be bypassed for urgent projects.

The ladder. ANALYSIS: Participation is not one condition but five - information, consultation, participation, co-decision, **empowerment** - and only the top rungs deliver agency. Empowerment is durable capability and institutional power to shape options, resources and rules, including the capacity to **dissent, exit, organise and demand reasons**; it cannot be inferred from attendance.

Objection and reply. FACT: Consultation delays urgent projects and lets local elites veto wider welfare. ANALYSIS: The reply is that these are objections to **badly designed** participation: capture is a failure of inclusion, and the alternative - deciding without the affected - relocates the capture rather than removing it. Inclusive design, stated reasons, genuine representation and review are the remedy.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Participation is instrumentally valuable and constitutively part of the end; CAUTION: the residue is the genuinely urgent, **irreversible** decision, where post-hoc review cannot restore what was foreclosed.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "merely... or partly" is a stem about the **kind** of value, so the answer must classify rather than praise. The tradeability consequence is what makes the classification matter, and stating it is what separates an argument from an endorsement.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: position one line; instrumental case two lines; constitutive case three lines; consequences three lines; ladder four lines; objection and reply four lines; verdict two lines.

- **Structure:** both-and position -> instrumental -> constitutive -> why it matters -> the ladder -> objection and reply -> qualified verdict.
- **Doctrine:** the two roles of freedom; the five-rung agency ladder; empowerment as control over the conditions of action.
- **Evidence:** Sen on agency and on the interlocking instrumental freedoms.
- **Distinction:** tradeable against non-tradeable value; consultation against empowerment.
- **Criticism:** the elite-capture objection, answered as a failure of inclusion, with the irreversibility residue conceded.

How to improve this answer

Add the counterfactual test - could the decision have been different, and could anyone in the room have said no? - because it converts an abstract ladder into an examinable criterion. If two further lines are available, note that the wider beneficiaries of a delayed project are themselves affected persons with a claim to standing, so the correct response to the urgency objection is to widen the circle of participation rather than to abolish it.

Original 4 · 15 marks

Question: Critically examine the claim that modernisation describes a neutral and inevitable process of social transformation.

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: The claim is false as stated, though what modernisation **describes** is largely accurate; the falsity lies in the words "neutral" and "inevitable".

What is accurate. FACT: Industrialisation, urbanisation, mass education, occupational differentiation, bureaucratic capacity, scientific rationality and expanding markets are real processes, and denying them is not available to a serious answer.

What converts description into theory. FACT: Five assumptions: a **linear sequence** of broadly comparable stages; **convergence** of institutional differences as capacity grows; a **traditional/modern contrast** in which inherited authority yields to rational, mobile institutions; **diffusion** of capital, knowledge and technology as a transmission mechanism; and **expert direction**, the warrant for planners to identify obstacles and accelerate the transition.

The four hostile objections, each located. FACT: **Dependency** denies sequence and convergence: underdevelopment can be **produced** through unequal incorporation rather than inherited as an earlier stage. FACT: **Post-development** denies expert direction: it questions the **authority** by which external experts define whole societies as deficient. FACT: **Cultural and Gandhian** critique denies the traditional/modern contrast, refusing to concede that one conception of the good life is simply superior. FACT: **Marxist** criticism denies convergence and diffusion by asking who owns production and appropriates the gains. ANALYSIS: And the **Ambedkarite** question tests the whole package: does modernisation dismantle graded hierarchy, or merely reorganise it into new occupations and offices?

The objection to the critique. FACT: If no comparable sequence exists, cross-societal comparison becomes impossible and the idea of development collapses. ANALYSIS: **Reply:** what is denied is a **single universal route**, not comparability. Capacities such as being nourished, schooled, safe from premature death and able to participate are comparable without presupposing one path.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Modernisation names real structural transformations but is not a neutral or inevitable law; its institutions count as progress only where they enlarge **equal capability, democratic agency and ecological security** - which is plural development under universal constraints.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "critically examine" requires the position to be reconstructed accurately before it is attacked. Naming the five assumptions is what makes the attack specific; without them, "modernisation is Eurocentric" is a slogan with no identified target.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: position one line; what is accurate two lines; five assumptions four lines; four objections plus the Ambedkarite question six lines; counter-objection and reply three lines; verdict two lines.

- **Structure:** two-sided position -> accurate description -> five assumptions -> located objections -> counter-objection -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** modernisation as theory; plural development under universal constraints.
- **Evidence:** dependency, post-development, cultural/Gandhian and Marxist critiques, each mapped to an assumption; the Ambedkarite question.
- **Distinction:** description against theory; one universal route against comparability as such.
- **Criticism:** the charge that the critique destroys comparison, answered by the universal floor.

How to improve this answer

Add one line conceding that the universal floor is easier to state than to specify at its boundary, and that its specification is exposed to the post-development objection about who is doing the specifying - which is why it must be defended by public reasoning rather than asserted by expertise. If a further line is available, note that the Ambedkarite question is what gives an Indian answer analytical rather than illustrative content.

Original 5 · 20 marks

Question: "Sustainable development is a policy formula, not a philosophy." Critically discuss with reference to moral standing, duties to future persons and the distribution of ecological burdens.

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: The statement is correct about the formula and wrong as a conclusion: the formula rests on philosophical claims that can be stated, and stating them is what gives it content.

Moral standing - the first prior question. FACT: Three orientations differ over **what counts morally**, not over how much nature to protect. **Anthropocentrism** counts human beings and protects nature instrumentally, permitting destruction where no human interest is engaged. **Biocentrism** counts every individual living thing but cannot adjudicate between organisms or protect a system as such. **Ecocentrism** counts wholes but risks subordinating individuals to systemic goods. ANALYSIS: The discriminating question - would it be wrong to destroy a wilderness no human will ever see, use or know of? - shows they are distinct positions. ANALYSIS: For a development answer the defensible position is a **strong, non-instrumental anthropocentrism supplemented by duties of stewardship**, stated and defended rather than gestured at.

Depth of questioning. FACT: **Naess (1973)** distinguishes **shallow** ecology, which fights pollution and depletion in the interest of the health and affluence of the developed world, from **deep** ecology, which questions the framework generating those symptoms and affirms intrinsic value in non-human life. ANALYSIS: The difference is one of **depth of questioning, not degree of concern**.

Duties to future persons. FACT: The **Brundtland Report (1987)** builds duties to the unborn into the concept itself (paraphrased). ANALYSIS: Three problems must be met: the **non-identity problem**, since different policies produce different people and the person born into a degraded world owes her existence to the degrading policy; **reciprocity**, since future people cannot vote or sanction; and **discounting**, since a **pure time preference** counts a person for less merely because she exists later, which is arbitrary in the way that discounting distance is arbitrary. ANALYSIS: The duty is best specified as **preserving options and avoiding irreversibility**.

Distribution of burdens. FACT: **Guha and Martinez-Alier (1997)** show that environmental conflict in the global South is typically a struggle over **livelihood**, so "environment versus development" is a framing available only to those whose subsistence is not at stake. ANALYSIS: The degrowth argument must therefore be applied asymmetrically - **contraction and convergence** - and its weakest link, that a non-growing economy can sustain employment and services, conceded.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Sustainability acquires content only when **thresholds, distribution, participation and non-substitutable limits** are specified; and the ecological case strengthens the argument for participation, since durable transformation requires the consent and knowledge of those whose livelihoods it reorganises.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: a quotation stem is scored on how precisely the candidate agrees and disagrees. Conceding that the *formula* is empty while showing that the *concept* rests on statable philosophical claims is the structure that earns both halves.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: position two lines; moral standing six lines; depth of questioning two lines; future persons six lines; distribution four lines; verdict three lines. Compression plan if short of time: retain the three orientations, the non-identity problem and the asymmetry, and compress the Naess material to one line.

- **Structure:** two-sided position -> standing -> depth of questioning -> future duties -> distribution of burdens -> specification verdict.
- **Doctrine:** the three orientations; shallow against deep ecology; intergenerational justice; productivism and degrowth.
- **Evidence:** Naess (1973); the Brundtland Report (1987), paraphrased; Guha and Martinez-Alier (1997).
- **Distinction:** formula against philosophy; depth of questioning against degree of concern; subsistence against luxury consumption.
- **Criticism:** the non-identity problem; the undemonstrated stability of a non-growing economy; the eco-authoritarian risk in strong ecocentrism.

How to improve this answer

Add the **capability bridge**: if development is expansion of capability rather than of output, then beyond the level at which output secures capability further growth has no automatic developmental claim - so Sen's framework reaches the degrowth conclusion by a non-ecological route, and joining the two is the strongest analytical move available on this stem. If two further lines are available, add the four ascending replies to eco-authoritarianism, ending with the distributive one, since it converts the answer's close from a statement of limits into a positive argument for participation.

Original 6 · 20 marks

Question: Evaluate the capability approach as a standard for assessing development, with particular reference to the dispute between Sen and Nussbaum.

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: The capability approach is the strongest available standard for this clause, and its principal internal dispute - over whether the relevant capabilities should be listed - is unresolved and should be presented as such.

What the approach claims. FACT: **Sen** holds that development is the expansion of **substantive freedom** and the removal of unfreedoms. A **functioning** is an achieved being or doing; a **capability** is the real opportunity to achieve alternative functionings; a **resource** is a means whose value depends on **conversion**, which varies with **personal, environmental and social** factors. **Utility** adapts downward under long deprivation, and **agency** is the ability to pursue goals one has reason to value, including goals beyond one's own welfare.

Why it outperforms the alternatives. ANALYSIS: A resource metric misdescribes equality, since equal resources yield unequal freedom. A satisfaction metric can certify the deprivation it records, since expectations adjust. Capability escapes both by counting the **opportunity set** rather than holdings or contentment - which is why fasting and starving, identical as functionings, are radically different as capability sets.

The dispute. FACT: Sen resists a single final canonical list and refers selection to **public reasoning**; **Nussbaum** specifies central human capabilities and argues that **justice** requires each person to reach a **threshold** compatible with dignity, as a constitutional-political minimum. ANALYSIS: Each is strongest where the other is weakest: Sen avoids paternalistic closure but offers little protection where public reasoning is conducted inside entrenched hierarchy and adapted expectations; Nussbaum resists that failure but invites the charge of imposing one conception of the good life.

The reply that makes a threshold defensible. FACT: **Capabilities protect opportunities, not compulsory functionings**: the threshold secures options without requiring anyone to exercise them, and political specification remains open to democratic interpretation. ANALYSIS: The threshold is a **per-person, non-aggregative floor**, so a rising average does not discharge it.

Criticisms of the approach as such. ANALYSIS: Capability is hard to measure; the reply is that evaluative richness is preferable to false precision, though CAUTION: policy still needs indicators. Universal capabilities may be paternalistic; the reply protects opportunity and permits plural functionings, though CAUTION: who fixes the threshold remains open.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The approach supplies the right **informational space** - real freedom rather than goods or contentment - and it leaves the selection question genuinely unsettled; an answer that declares the Sen-Nussbaum dispute closed in either direction has overclaimed.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "Evaluate... with particular reference to" is two demands: a standard applied to the approach as a whole, and a specific treatment of the named dispute. Presenting the dispute as **live**, with each position's strength paired to the other's weakness, is what demonstrates control.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: position two lines; the claims five lines; comparison with alternatives three lines; the dispute five lines; the reply three lines; criticisms three lines; verdict two lines.

- **Structure:** position -> the approach stated -> why it outperforms rivals -> the dispute -> the defensive reply -> general criticisms -> open verdict.
- **Doctrine:** functioning, capability, conversion, utility, agency; the dignity threshold.

- **Evidence:** Sen, *Development as Freedom* and *Commodities and Capabilities*; Nussbaum, *Creating Capabilities* and *Women and Human Development*.
- **Distinction:** opportunity set against achieved functioning; evaluative space against constitutional minimum.
- **Criticism:** measurement, selection and paternalism, each with a reply and a residual problem.

How to improve this answer

Add the observation that the threshold bounds a community's authority over its own members, since the floor attaches to persons and is not the community's to trade - this connects the dispute to the tribal-development material and shows the framework doing work outside its own controversy. If two further lines are available, concede that the estimation of opportunity sets falls back on observable conversion factors - impairment, distance, infrastructure, discriminatory norms, public provision - which manages the counterfactual objection without dissolving it.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Everything below is enrichment. The Basic block is answer-complete: after Session 20 every one of the six owned previous-year parts can be written without opening this section. Use it for a second reading, or for the rare stem that rewards one added debate, one sharper objection or one controlled comparison. WRONG: Do not import it into a core answer - a fifteen-mark part has no room for a residue, and an examiner reading an advanced digression where the core distinction should be will mark it as a failure to answer.

A1. Capability against resource and welfare metrics - the residual dispute

ANALYSIS: The Basic block establishes that capability is the right evaluative space and that resource and utility metrics fail for stated reasons. What it does not settle is the **rival's best reply**: that a resource metric, supplemented by publicly funded conversion - health care, schooling, accessible infrastructure, anti-discrimination enforcement - reproduces most of what capability measurement delivers while remaining tractable. CAUTION: The dispute is genuine, and the capability side's strongest response is not that the supplemented resource metric fails in principle but that it must **already know** which conversion factors matter, which is precisely the capability judgment it claimed to avoid. Deploy this only where a stem explicitly contrasts measurement approaches.

A2. The post-development residue - abandoning the category

ANALYSIS: The Basic block promotes the disciplined post-development claim: that a community's own account of its interests is not to be displaced without argument, and that the burden of justification falls on the party proposing intervention. CAUTION: The **stronger** claim, which remains optional, is that "development" as a category should be abandoned altogether - that it is irretrievably an instrument by which some societies are constituted as deficient, so that reforming it merely relocates the domination. WRONG: Do not adopt this position in a core answer: it cannot explain the demands for schooling, health care and mobility that the romanticism objection identifies, and it leaves a stem asking whether development can be reconciled with tribal values with nothing to reconcile.

A3. Technology and value - instrumental neutrality against embedded power

ANALYSIS: Session 16 concedes that some artefacts carry a built-in tendency. The optional depth is the stronger thesis that technology **embodies social power** and can deform ends as well as means - that a technical system encodes the priorities of those who commissioned it, and that adopting it therefore imports those priorities rather than merely acquiring a capacity. CAUTION: The dispute is between this and the position that the priorities remain revisable by whoever controls the system. The Basic verdict - capacity without ends, governed by ethical purposes, fair access, accountability and human control - survives either way, which is why the debate is optional.

A4. Gandhi against Ambedkar on modernity - the controlled comparison

ANALYSIS: Session 18 uses Ambedkar's warning about the village as a bounded criterion. The optional depth is the wider comparison: village-centred restraint and decentralisation against an insistence on industrial, legal and social transformation as the route to dignity for those whom local hierarchy excludes. WRONG: Even here the comparison must remain controlled, because the full Gandhi-Ambedkar debate belongs to **Caste Discrimination: Gandhi and Ambedkar** and the caste doctrine is routed rather than developed. Use one sentence of it in a twenty-mark part; ANALYSIS: never build an answer on it inside this owner.

A5. The strongest additional objection and reply

- **Objection.** FACT: The post-development critique romanticises locality and can leave the poor without large-scale infrastructure, mobility and rights - goods that only extended institutional and technical systems supply, and that no purely local arrangement can generate.
- **Reply.** ANALYSIS: Its strongest form need not reject roads, health care or schooling. What it warns against is **top-down models that treat people as objects of growth rather than agents of self-directed flourishing** - which is a claim about the mode of provision and about who decides, not a claim against provision.
- **Residual.** CAUTION: The reply concedes that the critique's positive content is procedural, so it must borrow its substantive account of what people need from the capability framework it sometimes criticises.

A6. Safe Indian deployment in a 15- or 20-marker

ANALYSIS: Indian material is used here to pose a question, never to prove a thesis. Tribal displacement, education and skill formation, ecological cost, village decentralisation and capability conversion may be deployed as instances of the single question **development for whom, by what metric, and at what moral cost?** WRONG: Do not convert this owner into economy notes or an accumulation of environmental current affairs, and WRONG: do not use output-and-income talk without a philosophical metric attached to it. Every legal item remains classified before use, and enactment is never read as implementation.

A7. Promotion status and source trail

FACT: **Productivism and the degrowth challenge were promoted from the optional dossier into the Core owner**, and they are taught in Session 19 as Core rather than as enrichment. What remains optional in that area is only the stronger post-development anti-institutionalism at A2. ANALYSIS: Still to promote if a previous-year part asks it directly: a standalone Gandhi-against-Ambedkar development comparison. FACT: Source trail for this section, cited by author and title only, with no page, edition or wording asserted: **Sen, Development as Freedom; Nussbaum, Women and Human Development; Gandhi, Hind Swaraj; Ivan Illich, Tools for Conviviality; Wolfgang Sachs (ed.), The Development Dictionary; Arturo Escobar, Encountering Development; and Denis Goulet, The Cruel Choice***.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Compressed recall for the night before, in sixteen parts. It is not a second exposition: the teaching is in the Basic block and the practice apparatus is above. Read the parts in order; the ASCII master at Part P is the whole topic on twenty-two panels and is byte-identical to the standalone flowchart shipped with this package.

A. Say it exactly - the definition bank

Development. A process of enlarging and securing people's effective capacities to live lives they have reason to value, through economic, social, political and institutional transformation. Descriptive **and** normative. **Economic growth.** Increase in aggregate or per-capita output or income. **Economic development.** Structural and qualitative change in production, technology, institutions and social relations. **Human development.** Expansion of longevity, knowledge and a decent material standard - the framework associated with Mahbub ul Haq and the UNDP.

Capability. The real opportunity to achieve alternative functionings. **Functioning.** An achieved being or doing - being nourished, moving freely, participating. **Conversion factors.** Personal (body, age, impairment), environmental (climate, terrain, infrastructure) and social (norms, safety, discrimination, public provision). **Utility.** Satisfaction; it adapts downward under long deprivation. **Agency.** The ability to pursue goals one has reason to value, **including**

goals beyond one's own welfare. Social progress. Justified improvement in the quality of social relations, institutions and human lives, assessed through freedom, equality, justice, dignity, participation, security and sustainability. **Modernisation theory.** Development as transition from "traditional" to "modern" organisation, resting on linear sequence, convergence, the traditional/modern contrast, diffusion and expert direction. **Dependency.** Underdevelopment as produced through unequal incorporation rather than inherited as an earlier stage. **Post-development.** The challenge to the authority by which external experts define whole societies as deficient. **Sustainable development.** Present improvement that does not destroy the ecological conditions and options of future persons. **Anthropocentrism / biocentrism / ecocentrism.** Moral standing confined to humans / extended to every individual living thing / extended to species, habitats and ecological wholes. **Shallow / deep ecology.** Pollution and depletion policy for the health and affluence of the developed world / questioning of the framework that generates the symptoms, with intrinsic value affirmed in non-human life. **Depth of questioning, not degree of concern.** **Productivism.** The assumption that expanding production is the master objective of social organisation. **Degrowth.** Planned reduction in the throughput of energy and materials, with provisioning reorganised around sufficiency, care, shorter working time and equality. **Contraction and convergence.** Reduction where consumption is far above a defensible threshold; expansion where it is far below. **Intergenerational justice.** Duties of justice, not benevolence, to those not yet born; best specified as preserving options and avoiding irreversibility. **Non-identity problem.** Different policies produce different future people, so a person whose existence depends on a degrading policy cannot easily claim to have been made worse off by it. **Pure time preference.** Counting a person's interests for less merely because she exists later. **Environmentalism of the poor.** Environmental conflict in the global South as a struggle over livelihood rather than a post-material concern for wilderness. **Just transition.** Ecological restructuring conditioned on prior guarantees of livelihood, retraining, compensation and participation. **Welfare of all (sarvodaya), self-rule (swarāj), trusteeship.** Gandhian development's ends, its political condition, and the moral delegitimation of absolute ownership. **Empowerment.** Durable capability and institutional power to shape options, resources and rules, including the capacity to dissent, exit, organise and demand reasons.

B. The architecture - open almost every answer here

1. **Name the conception** the stem assumes: economic, human-development or capability. The same stem has different correct answers under each.
2. **State the ladder distinction** the stem turns on. Growth -> economic development -> human development -> capability -> social progress; five questions, five informational spaces, no automatic inference upward.
3. **Run the stem's own logic** in its own vocabulary: modal, causal, evaluative or reconciliation.
4. **Deploy one table:** the concept grid, Sen's terms, the three ecological orientations, or the convergence grid.
5. **Work one objection** through to a residual problem.
6. **Supply one classified Indian illustration** where the stem invites it.
7. **Close with a graded verdict** separating means, conversion conditions and final values.

The discriminating test, usable in any stem: if income rises while preventable unfreedom, humiliation or ecological destruction intensifies, there is growth without social progress.

C. The five rungs and the seven informational spaces

Rungs. R1 growth - output; ignores distribution and externalities. R2 economic development - structural change; may remain economic. R3 human development - health, knowledge, material command; aggregates conceal inequality. R4 capability - substantive freedoms; selection and measurement problems. R5 social progress - justified change in relations and institutions; values contested. **Trade-off.** Ascending buys evaluative richness and pays in measurability. State it before the examiner does. **Seven spaces.** Output (hides distribution, unpaid work, externalities) · basic needs (hides quality above the threshold) · welfare and quality of life (hides adaptive preference) · human-development composites (hide within-group inequality and political freedom) · capabilities (contested selection) · social-progress indicators (aggregation across contested dimensions) · ecological indicators (hide the distribution of adjustment burdens). **Controlling rule.** A composite index is evidence within one evaluative space and cannot settle the weights, because the weights are the normative question - so public reasoning about weights is part of progress. **Three blind spots.** Unpaid work · adaptive preference · aggregation. **Discipline.** No figure is required anywhere in this owner.

D. Economism, modernisation, dependency, post-development

Economism. Four steps - scarcity constrains, growth expands the resource base, structural transformation raises employment and state capacity, therefore economic development enables. **Hidden premise:** institutions convert resources into broadly shared welfare. **Five silences:** distribution, work quality, displacement, political voice, ecological cost. **Correct conclusion:** growth is instrumental and conversion-dependent - not irrelevant.

Modernisation's five assumptions. Linear sequence · convergence · traditional/modern contrast · diffusion · expert direction. **Five objections mapped.** Dependency -> sequence and convergence. Post-development -> expert direction. Cultural and Gandhian -> the traditional/modern contrast. Marxist -> convergence and diffusion. Ambedkarite -> the whole package: does it dismantle graded hierarchy or reorganise it? **Verdict.** Real structural transformations, not a neutral or inevitable law; its institutions count as progress only where they enlarge equal capability, democratic agency and ecological security. **Dependency against post-development.** Structural against epistemic; produced underdevelopment against the authority to diagnose; different remedies - terms of incorporation and ownership, against who decides. **Shared objection and reply.** Romanticism ignores internal hierarchy and real demands; the strongest critique rejects imposed uniformity, not improvement. **Middle path:** plural development under universal constraints of dignity, capability and non-domination. **Limits.** Dependency can understate domestic factors; post-development has no positive programme.

E. Human development and the capability approach

The shift. A change in the unit of account from the economy to the person. **Achievement:** it breaks the identity between income and well-being. **Four residual concealments:** distribution, political freedom, gender and disability conversion, ecological dependence. **Position:** R3 - decisive over R1 and R2, incomplete against R4 because it records achieved states and counts beneficiaries rather than agents. **Sen's chain.** Resource -> conversion factors (personal, environmental, social) -> capability -> functioning. **One sentence:** equal resources yield unequal freedom, because bodies, environments and social norms differ. **Fasting and starving.** Same functioning, radically different capability sets - capability is the opportunity set, not the outcome chosen from it. **Five-step argument.** Unequal conversion -> adaptive utility -> assess real opportunities -> the instrumental freedoms interlock -> freedom is both end and means. **Five instrumental freedoms.** Political freedoms · economic facilities · social opportunities · transparency guarantees · protective security. Their significance is the **interlocking**, not the enumeration. **Two roles.** Constitutive and instrumental. Writing only the instrumental half makes freedom tradeable and concedes the authoritarian-development argument. **Adaptive preference.** A methodological claim about what a satisfaction metric can record, never a claim about the competence of the deprived. **Discipline:** shift the evaluative space to opportunity rather than override the report.

F. Nussbaum, the threshold and the live dispute

Nussbaum. A more determinate account of central human capabilities; justice requires each person to reach a threshold compatible with dignity, as a constitutional-political minimum. **The distinction.** Sen resists a single final canonical list and stresses public reasoning; Nussbaum defends a specified list and threshold. **Objection and reply.** A universal list may impose one conception of life -> capabilities protect **opportunities, not compulsory functionings**, and political specification remains open to democratic interpretation. **Comparative assessment.** Sen avoids paternalistic closure; Nussbaum better resists societies that publicly reason within oppressive adaptive preferences. **Three properties of a threshold.** Not a maximising target · not aggregative · a floor per person - which makes it a claim of justice rather than benevolence. **Where it bites.** It bounds a community's authority over its own members; it defeats "they are satisfied with what they have"; and it cannot be traded against aggregate output. CAUTION: **Live dispute.** Who fixes the threshold, and by what procedure, remains unsettled. Flag it; do not close it.

G. Sustainable development and the five bounded lenses

Four bases. Intergenerational justice · precaution under irreversible risk · limits to substituting money for ecological systems · duties toward the vulnerable, with the possible intrinsic value of non-human life. **Conceded objection.** The concept is vague and can legitimise a green version of the same growth model. **Four specifications that answer it.** Thresholds · distribution · participation · non-substitutable ecological limits. **Five lenses, each a criterion and a warning.** Liberal/welfare - resources and opportunity; formal opportunity with unequal conversion; comparison only. Marxist - production and control of surplus; growth can reproduce exploitation; comparison only. Humanistic/capability - persons as ends and agents; beneficiaries counted while agency is denied; **full owner.** Gandhian - need, non-violence, local self-rule, dignity of labour; scale multiplies wants and centralises domination; **direct owner.** Ambedkarite - constitutional rights and destroyed hierarchy; a village is not progress if caste power survives; **bounded bridge.** **Controlling sentence.** The matrix supplies evaluation criteria, not five complete ideologies. Two lenses fully worked beat five named.

H. Social progress - teleology, inevitability, four conceptions

Weak teleology. To call a change progress is to judge movement toward a better condition; it does **not** require belief in an automatic law of history. **Historical defeater.** Twentieth-century war, genocide and ecological crisis break the inference from knowledge or technology to moral improvement. **Four steps against inevitability.** Technology enlarges capacities for care and destruction -> institutions distribute control and risk -> moral learning can be reversed -> progress requires agency, conflict, institutions and judgment. **Four conceptions.** Linear/cumulative - explains accumulation; mistakes capacity for moral improvement. Cyclical - resists complacency; becomes fatalistic. Dialectical/conflictual - explains conflict; may impose one direction. Plural/non-linear - respects contingency; risks relativism. **Controlling position.** Directional only after the valued ends are stated; plural only within a universal floor of dignity, freedom from severe deprivation, equal civic standing and ecological responsibility. **Relativist objection and reply.** Some criteria have cross-cultural force, and the clearest are negative - no society's members ask to be starved or degraded. CAUTION: Reasonable disagreement persists above the floor and about its boundary.

I. Criteria and the necessary/sufficient test (2024)

Seven criteria as questions. Freedom - real options and voice? Equality - is status less structured by domination? Justice - are benefits, burdens and procedures defensible? Dignity - protection from humiliation and exclusion? Participation - do affected people shape decisions? Sustainability - are future and ecological conditions preserved? Fraternity - can citizens relate as social equals? **Run the two tests separately.** Necessary = the absence blocks. Sufficient = the presence secures. Independent; a condition may be either, both or neither. **Necessity.** Yes, in a **threshold** form: adequate material capabilities are necessary, because severe deprivation restricts health, education and agency. CAUTION: "Economic development" is too broad to be logically necessary in every conceivable community. **Sufficiency.** No. Wealth can coexist with exclusion, authoritarianism, gender hierarchy and ecological destruction - one clean counter-case, stated at the level of criteria, with no society or figure named. **Verdict.** An important **enabling condition**, neither conceptually identical with nor sufficient for social progress. **10+5 split.** Ten for the two tests; five for the graded verdict plus the point that identity and enabling are different relations. CAUTION: **Residual.** Where the threshold sits is not settled and varies with conversion conditions.

J. Redistribution, recognition and the agency ladder

Two demands. Redistribution of resources; recognition of equal status. **Two corruptions:** provision without respect is paternalism; standing without means is symbolic. **Four-way grid.** Resources + recognition = progress on this axis. Resources without recognition = paternalism. Recognition without resources = symbolic equality. Neither = compounded disadvantage. **Inherited-power test.** Growth redistributes income at best; in India caste, gender and tribal status show that it does not redistribute standing. Used as criteria; doctrines routed. **Independent, not sequential.** Humiliation does not wait for prosperity, and provision without standing entrenches the relation it was meant to relieve. **Agency ladder.** Information (one-way disclosure is not voice) -> consultation (may be ignored) -> participation (elites can monopolise) -> co-decision (needs clear responsibility and rights safeguards) -> **empowerment** (durable capability and institutional power; not inferable from attendance). **Two reasons for participation.** Instrumental - information and accountability. Constitutive - voice is part of a developed life; this is the half that makes it non-tradeable. **Objection and reply.** Delay and elite capture are objections to badly designed participation; capture is a failure of **inclusion**, and deciding without the affected merely relocates it. Remedy: inclusive

design, reasons, representation, review. **The test.** Could the decision have been different? If not, it was at most consultation.

K. Technology and skill education (2019, 2023)

Technology. Capacity without ends. Four optimist/critical pairs - communication and surveillance; medicine and unequal access; productivity and displacement; transparency and reproduced bias. One point four times: **control, access and purpose** fix the direction. **Four conversion conditions:** ethical purposes, fair access, accountability, human control. **Concession:** technology reshapes which moral problems arise without supplying the criterion for settling them. It is the non-inevitability argument applied. **WRONG:** Name no technology, platform, company or episode. **Skill education.** Standard = capability and agency, not employment. **Positive argument:** capability needs effective means -> skills improve conversion -> participation raises contribution and bargaining power. **Four limits:** frustrated capability without decent work; narrow employability displacing civic and critical education; unequal access reproducing hierarchy; obsolescence, so the durable capability is the capacity to re-learn. **Two mirror errors:** sufficiency, and mere instrumentality - the second defeated by dignity of labour. **Test:** bargaining power, not usefulness to an employer. **Position:** livelihood, adaptability, dignity of labour and critical citizenship together. **WRONG:** No employment figures, scheme names or outlays.

L. Gandhian social development (2020)

Doctrine. Welfare and moral elevation of all (*sarvodaya*) through self-rule (*swarāj*), non-violence, decentralisation, dignity of labour, trusteeship, restraint of wants and village-centred production. **Five-step argument.** Unlimited wants create dependence, competition and violence -> centralised industrial power separates production from need and local control -> means shape ends -> self-rule requires local economic and moral capacity -> therefore decentralised, need-oriented, ecologically restrained development. **Four presuppositions.** Moral self-limitation is politically relevant; small-scale association can sustain participation; work has value beyond income; change can proceed through non-violent conversion and constructive action. **Three objections and replies.** Romantic village -> defensible only with equal rights and anti-domination; **Ambedkar's criticism is indispensable.** Technological conservatism -> read it as a test of scale, control and need, not a ban on machines. Trusteeship as voluntary paternalism -> it morally delegitimises absolute ownership, but institutional mechanisms are needed for accountability. **Two comparisons.** Against industrial modernisation -> selective adoption by capability, decentralised control, ecological cost and non-domination. Against Ambedkar on the village -> local self-government is progressive only where constitutional rights, mobility and anti-caste safeguards transform local power. **Restraint objection.** It targets multiplied and manufactured wants, not need - the same asymmetry as the ecological argument. **CAUTION:** The doctrine supplies a direction, not a line. **Verdict.** Survives in a **conditioned** form: a standing test of scale and control inside guarantees it does not itself supply.

M. Development and tribal values (2025)

Reframe. Not modernity against tradition, but five questions about authority and distribution: who defines benefit; who bears cost and risk; is land only a commodity or also identity and relation; whose knowledge counts; are consent and self-government real. **Description discipline.** Tribal communities are internally diverse; avoid romantic generalisation. Many such conflicts involve community control of resources, ecological dependence, customary institutions, intergenerational continuity and collective identity. **Seven-step model.** Equal citizenship and cultural recognition -> capabilities gained **and destroyed** -> informed inclusive participation -> individual and community rights without freezing culture -> fair distribution of benefits, burdens **and decision-power** -> exit, dissent and gender justice preserved -> reversible and sustainable alternatives under grave uncertainty. **Four tests, required jointly.** (i) Both sides of the capability ledger, including the community's own. (ii) Participation in the **decision**, not merely the compensation. (iii) A precautionary presumption against irreversible ecological and cultural loss. (iv) No shifting of adjustment burdens onto those least able to bear them. **Indian recognitions, classified.** PESA, **1996** - enacted statute, Gram Sabha role in Scheduled Areas. Forest Rights Act, **2006** - enacted rights-recognition statute, individual and community forest rights. *Orissa Mining Corporation v. Ministry of Environment & Forest*, **2013** - Supreme Court judgment involving Gram Sabha consideration. Articles **48A** and **51A(g)** - non-justiciable. **Enactment is not notification; notification is not implementation; implementation is not capability expansion; a judgment is not legislation; a non-justiciable provision establishes commitment, not outcome.** **Verdict.** Reconcilable only where communities are **agents** of development rather than obstacles or objects.

N. Ecological political philosophy

Three orientations. Anthropocentric - humans only; permits destruction where no human interest is engaged.

Biocentric - every individual living thing; cannot adjudicate between organisms or protect a system as such. Ecocentric - ecological wholes; risks subordinating individuals. **Discriminating question.** Would it be wrong to destroy a wilderness no human will ever see, use or know of? Anthropocentric: no. Biocentric and ecocentric: yes, differently.

Practical warning. WRONG: Do not adopt strong ecocentrism casually - it licenses coercive limits for systemic goods. Defensible position: strong, non-instrumental anthropocentrism supplemented by duties of stewardship, stated and defended. **Naess (1973).** Shallow fights pollution and depletion for the health and affluence of the developed world; deep questions the framework and affirms intrinsic value in non-human life. **Depth of questioning, not degree of concern.** **Productivism and degrowth.** Productivism is shared by industrial socialism and capitalism. Degrowth: finite sinks and stocks -> efficiency offset by expanded volume -> post-threshold flattening in affluent societies -> permanent aggregate growth neither feasible nor necessary for them -> planned reduction in throughput around sufficiency, care, shorter working time and equality -> burden on high-consuming economies and classes.

Asymmetry: contraction and convergence. CAUTION: Weakest link: that a non-growing economy can maintain employment, services and stability. **Capability bridge.** Beyond the level at which output secures capability, further growth has no automatic developmental claim - Sen reaches the same conclusion by a non-ecological route.

Intergenerational justice. Duties of justice, not benevolence; the Brundtland Report (1987) builds it into the concept - WRONG: paraphrase, never quote. Three problems: non-identity, motivation and reciprocity, discounting and pure time preference. **Specification:** preserve options, avoid irreversibility; uncertainty then argues for precaution.

Environmentalism of the poor. Guha and Martinez-Alier (1997): conflict over livelihood, not post-material taste - so environment and development are the same question for such communities and "environment versus development" is a framing available only to those whose subsistence is not at stake. The real question is **distributive**. Objection: romanticism. Reply: it describes the structure of conflict, and secure rights convert dependence into stewardship.

Eco-authoritarianism and just transition. Four replies in ascending strength - epistemic, compliance, record, and the decisive distributive one. **Verdict:** the ecological case strengthens the argument for participation.

O. Inter-school debates, criticisms and the sixteen traps

Five debates. Growth model against Sen - output against substantive opportunity; consumer or factor against agent; distribution after growth against conversion and freedom as central; democracy possibly instrumental against instrumental and constitutive. Sen against Nussbaum - evaluative space and public reasoning against a list and dignity threshold. Gandhi against industrial modernisation - scale, productivity and mastery against the test of scale, control and need; selective adoption. Gandhi against Ambedkar on the village - school of self-rule against institutionalised caste exclusion. Modernisation against post-development - institutional transformation against imposed standards; plural development under universal constraints. **Six criticisms with replies and residuals.**

Capability is hard to measure -> evaluative richness beats false precision; residual: policy needs indicators. Universal capabilities are paternalistic -> protect opportunity, permit plural functionings; residual: who fixes the threshold. Participation romanticises communities -> include dissent, rights and review; residual: elite capture. Sustainability blocks poor societies' growth -> affluent consumption and unequal burdens are the target; residual: transition costs. Gandhianism is anti-modern -> a critique of scale, wants and domination; residual: complex infrastructure. Social progress is value-relative -> freedom from severe deprivation and humiliation have cross-cultural force; residual: reasonable disagreement persists. **The sixteen traps.** (1) Growth, development, human development and progress are not synonyms. (2) Never say economic development is simply "necessary and sufficient" - state the material-threshold nuance. (3) Sen is not income plus welfare; capability is real freedom and agency matters. (4) Capabilities are not achieved functionings. (5) A human-development composite is not a complete theory of progress. (6) Technology does not create ethical progress. (7) Skill education is not an employment statistic. (8) Do not romanticise tribal culture or the village. (9) Enactment of PESA or the Forest Rights Act is not implementation or success. (10) A scheme, statute or judgment is not philosophical proof. (11) An indicator is not a theory of development - state its informational space and blind spot. (12) Modernisation is not neutral convergence or an inevitable sequence. (13) Not every social change is progress. (14) Consultation is not empowerment. (15) Do not use current social or economic figures; none is required. (16) Do not import full liberalism, Marxism or Ambedkar's caste theory - use the development criterion and route the doctrine. **Directive decoder.** *Explain* -> definition, components, distinction from the neighbouring term, example. *Discuss* -> conception, rival, objection, reply, verdict. *Evaluate* -> name the standard, apply, concede the counter-case, verdict. *Necessary/sufficient?* -> test each separately, state

which holds and why. *Do you agree that...?* -> qualified position at the outset, reasons, counter-case, restated position. *Is it possible to reconcile X with Y?* -> what each requires, the collision, the conditions under which both are satisfied. *Does X lead to Y?* -> mechanism, defeater, verdict on the conditional. **PYQ ledger, 6 of 112.** 2019 Q2(c) 15 - technology and ethical standards. 2020 Q2(a) 20 - the Gandhian conception, stated and examined. 2022 Q3(a) 20 - economic development on its own. 2023 Q2(c) 15 - skill education. 2024 Q3(c) 10+5 - necessary, sufficient, both or neither. 2025 Q3(c) 15 - reconciliation with tribal values. Distribution: 2018: 0, 2019: 1, 2020: 1, 2021: 0, 2022: 1, 2023: 1, 2024: 1, 2025: 1.

P. COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

The twenty-two authored panels below are byte-identical to the standalone ASCII master flowchart shipped with this package, and they agree factually with the graphical at-a-glance rail. Read them top to bottom as one continuous flow.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/22: The printed clause, the central question and the ownership fence
SYLLABUS (verbatim) -> "Development and Social Progress."

| TWO WORDS. NO SUB-HEADS. THAT IS WHY IT IS MISREAD.

v

THE CENTRAL QUESTION -> WHAT ENTITLES ANYONE TO CALL A SOCIAL CHANGE AN
IMPROVEMENT -- AND WHAT WOULD HAVE TO BE TRUE OF A
SOCIETY FOR THE CLAIM TO HOLD?

|

v

THE PREREQUISITE (not padding) -> DEVELOPMENT IS A CONTESTED NORMATIVE CONCEPT.
Until the stem's assumed conception is NAMED, the question has no determinate
answer at all.

|

v

THE THREE CONTESTS THAT GENERATE EVERY OWNED PART

CONTEST	THE QUESTION IT ASKS	WHERE THE MARKS SIT
METRIC	in which INFORMATIONAL SPACE is development to be judged?	naming what an indicator DISCLOSES and CONCEALS
AGENCY	is the person a BENEFICIARY or the AUTHOR of development?	information -> consultation -> participation -> co-decision -> EMPOWERMENT
LIMIT	what may development NOT do, whatever the gains?	irreversibility, culture and foreclosed future options

|

v

MASTER THESIS -> GROWTH CAN FINANCE DEVELOPMENT, BUT ONLY CAPABILITIES,
JUSTICE, PARTICIPATION AND ECOLOGICAL LIMITS CONVERT MATERIAL CHANGE INTO
SOCIAL PROGRESS. EVERY VERDICT HERE IS CONDITION-SPECIFYING.

|

v

OWNERSHIP FENCE justice, equality, liberty, dignity AS IDEALS -> Social and
Political Ideals | full liberalism, Marxism, socialism, anarchism -> Political
Ideologies | cultural recognition -> Humanism, Secularism and
Multiculturalism | gender doctrine -> Gender Discrimination | caste doctrine
-> Caste Discrimination | rights, obligation, state legitimacy -> Individual
and State | growth, poverty, scheme and climate DATA -> ECONOMY, GOVERNANCE,
ENVIRONMENT -- OUTSIDE THE PHILOSOPHY PAPER ENTIRELY

BOUNDED BRIDGES freedom/equality/justice as CRITERIA -- name and apply, never
re-expound | class power and surplus as ONE criterion | caste and the village
as a TEST OF DECENTRALISATION | empowerment as a CAPABILITY claim

CORPUS SHARE -> 6 of 112 parts (2018:0 2019:1 2020:1 2021:0 2022:1 2023:1
2024:1 2025:1). NOT ONE owned part asks for a DEFINITION of development.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/22: The five-rung ladder and the discriminating test
FIVE WORDS THAT ARE NOT SYNONYMS. READ UPWARD. EACH RUNG CORRECTS THE DEFECT
BELOW IT AND ACQUIRES A NEW ONE.

RUNG	CONCEPT	PRIMARY MEASURE	ITS OWN FAILURE
R5	SOCIAL PROGRESS freer, fairer, more sustainable?	justified change in relations and institutions	the VALUES are CONTESTED; no aggregate settles them
R4	CAPABILITY DEVELOPMENT what can persons ACTUALLY achieve?	substantive freedoms to be and to do	SELECTION and MEASUREMENT problems
R3	HUMAN DEVELOPMENT are basic options expanding?	health, knowledge, material command	aggregates CONCEAL inequality
R2	ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT are productivity and opportunity changing?	structural and qualitative economic change	may remain ECONOMISTIC
R1	ECONOMIC GROWTH is more being produced?	aggregate or per- capita output/income	ignores DISTRIBUTION and EXTERNALITIES

```

+---+-----+-----+-----+
|
|
v
THE DISCRIMINATING TEST -- ONE LINE, APPLIES TO ANY CASE
income rises -> AND preventable UNFREEDOM, HUMILIATION or ECOLOGICAL
DESTRUCTION intensifies -> THEN: GROWTH WITHOUT SOCIAL PROGRESS.
NOT AN EXOTIC CASE. THE ORDINARY CASE. THAT IS WHY THE LADDER EXISTS.
|
v
FIVE FAILURE MODES THE CLAUSE NAMES
GROWTH WITHOUT DISTRIBUTION ..... output rises, gains are captured
DEVELOPMENT WITHOUT CONSENT ..... beneficiaries counted, never asked
TECHNOLOGY WITHOUT ETHICS ..... capacity enlarges, ends unexamined
WELFARE WITHOUT AGENCY ..... persons are recipients, never authors
PROGRESS AS FORCED ASSIMILATION . one form of life imposed as "modern"
|
v
TRADE-OFF TO NAME EXPLICITLY -> ASCENDING THE LADDER BUYS EVALUATIVE RICHNESS
AND PAYS IN MEASURABILITY. Stating it pre-empts the standard objection.

```

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/22: Development defined -- the descriptive and the normative
DOCTRINE STATEMENT -> DEVELOPMENT is a process of ENLARGING AND SECURING
people's EFFECTIVE CAPACITIES to live lives THEY HAVE REASON TO VALUE, through
economic, social, political and institutional transformation.

```

|
v
TWO DIMENSIONS, BOTH CONSTITUTIVE
+-----+-----+-----+
| DESCRIPTIVE | NORMATIVE |
| change in production, | the JUDGMENT that the change |
| technology, institutions and | IMPROVES HUMAN LIVES |
| social relations |
| answers WHAT HAPPENED | answers WHETHER IT IS BETTER, |
| | AND BY WHAT TEST |
+-----+-----+-----+
OMIT THE FIRST -> a preference with no object (an essay of aspirations)
OMIT THE SECOND -> a transformation with no evaluation (a report)
|
v

```

WHAT THE LADDER DOES ****NOT**** CLAIM

- NOT that lower rungs are worthless
- NOT that higher rungs float free of them
- ONLY that the INFERENCE UPWARD IS NOT AUTOMATIC

SEVERE DEPRIVATION RESTRICTS HEALTH, SCHOOLING AND VOICE -> which is why the
THRESHOLD form of the necessity claim survives (Panel 16).

```

|
v
THE OVERCORRECTION TO REFUSE -> "growth is irrelevant" / "growth is inherently
harmful". It forfeits the threshold argument and with it the 2024 modal part.
CORRECT POSITION: GROWTH IS INSTRUMENTAL AND CONVERSION-DEPENDENT.

```

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/22: Seven informational spaces and the three blind spots
TO CHOOSE A METRIC IS TO CHOOSE AN INFORMATIONAL SPACE -- AND THEREFORE TO
DECIDE IN ADVANCE WHAT WILL BE INVISIBLE. NO FIGURE IS REQUIRED ANYWHERE.

MEASURE FAMILY	WHAT IT ADDS	WHAT IT CAN HIDE
1 OUTPUT / INCOME	resource capacity	distribution, UNPAID WORK, externalities
2 BASIC NEEDS	a DEPRIVATION THRESHOLD	voice, choice, quality ABOVE the threshold
3 WELFARE / QUALITY OF LIFE	LIVED CONDITIONS	ADAPTIVE PREFERENCES and unequal power
4 HUMAN DEVELOPMENT	PEOPLE rather than output	within-group inequality; political freedom
5 CAPABILITIES	CONVERSION, FREEDOM, AGENCY	SELECTION and measurement disputes
6 SOCIAL-PROGRESS	RELATIONS and public	AGGREGATION across

INDICATORS	value	contested dimensions
7 ECOLOGICAL INDICATORS	biophysical and INTER-GENERATIONAL limits	DISTRIBUTION of adjustment burdens

|
v

CONTROLLING RULE -> A COMPOSITE INDEX IS EVIDENCE WITHIN ONE EVALUATIVE SPACE.
IT IS NOT A THEORY OF THE GOOD SOCIETY AND CANNOT SETTLE THE WEIGHTS BETWEEN
DIMENSIONS -- BECAUSE THE WEIGHTS ARE THE NORMATIVE QUESTION.
PUBLIC REASONING ABOUT WEIGHTS IS PART OF PROGRESS, NOT MERELY A METHOD.

|
v

THREE BLIND SPOTS THAT DECIDE ARGUMENTS

UNPAID WORK invisible to output measures; a society can "grow" by
MONETISING labour already being performed
ADAPTIVE PREFERENCE . the deprived may report contentment; the metric then
CERTIFIES the deprivation
AGGREGATION a national average rises while every disadvantaged
group inside it stands still

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/22: The economistic model and its conversion premise
STATE THE OPPOSING POSITION AT ITS STRONGEST -- FOUR STEPS

1. MATERIAL SCARCITY constrains health, education and choice
2. PRODUCTIVE GROWTH expands the resource base
3. STRUCTURAL TRANSFORMATION can raise employment and state capacity
4. THEREFORE economic development is an important ENABLING CONDITION

|
v

THE HIDDEN PREMISE THAT CARRIES THE WHOLE ARGUMENT

+-----+
| RESOURCES CAN BE CONVERTED INTO BROADLY SHARED WELFARE THROUGH |
| INSTITUTIONS. <-- AN ASSUMPTION ABOUT INSTITUTIONAL QUALITY, NOT A |
| FINDING ABOUT PRODUCTION. ATTACK HERE. |
+-----+

|
v

FIVE SILENCES OF GROWTH -- EACH ONE IS A PARAGRAPH

DISTRIBUTION who receives the additional product?
WORK QUALITY under what conditions is it produced?
DISPLACEMENT who loses land, livelihood or habitat for it?
POLITICAL VOICE ... who decided, and could anyone have refused?
ECOLOGICAL COST ... what stock or sink was drawn down, and is it reversible?

|
v

IS THE CONVERSION THESIS UNFALSIFIABLE? -- NO, AND SAY WHY

THE CONVERSION CONDITIONS ARE NAMEABLE IN ADVANCE: distributive rules | work
quality and security | protection against displacement without consent |
effective political voice | ecological limits on irreversibility.
A CASE WHERE ALL FIVE OBTAIN AND LIVES DO NOT IMPROVE WOULD COUNT AGAINST IT.
RESIDUAL PROBLEM: the five are weighted differently by the liberal, Marxist
and Gandhian lenses, so the thesis inherits the disagreement it organises.

|
v

VERDICT FORMULA -> "GROWTH BECOMES PROGRESS ONLY THROUGH JUST CONVERSION INTO
CAPABILITY, DIGNITY AND SUSTAINABLE INSTITUTIONS; THE CONVERSION CONDITIONS,
NOT THE OUTPUT FIGURE, ARE WHERE THE NORMATIVE QUESTION LIES."

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/22: Modernisation -- five assumptions, five objections
WHAT IT DESCRIBES (real; denying it reads as ideology)

industrialisation | urbanisation | mass education | occupational
differentiation | bureaucratic capacity | scientific rationality |
expanding markets -- a transition from "traditional" to "modern"

|
v

THE FIVE ASSUMPTIONS THAT MAKE IT A THEORY

- 1 LINEAR SEQUENCE societies move through broadly comparable stages
- 2 CONVERGENCE institutional differences DIMINISH as capacity grows
- 3 TRADITIONAL/MODERN ... inherited authority and local production YIELD to
CONTRAST rational, mobile, differentiated institutions
- 4 DIFFUSION capital, knowledge and technology TRANSMIT
development
- 5 EXPERT DIRECTION planners identify obstacles and ACCELERATE transition

|

v

FIVE OBJECTIONS, EACH MAPPED TO WHAT IT DENIES

CRITIQUE	WHAT IT CLAIMS	HITS ASSUMPTION
DEPENDENCY	underdevelopment can be PRODUCED through unequal incorporation	(1) and (2)
POST-DEVELOPMENT	by what AUTHORITY is a society defined as DEFICIENT?	(5)
CULTURAL / GANDHIAN	rejects HOMOGENISATION of the good life	(3)
MARXIST	who OWNS production and APPROPRIATES the gains?	(2) and (4)
AMBEDKARITE (scripts omit this one)	does modernisation DISMANTLE graded hierarchy or merely REORGANISE it?	the whole package

|

v

COUNTER-OBJECTION -> if no comparable sequence exists, CROSS-SOCIETAL COMPARISON becomes impossible and "development" collapses.

REPLY -> what is denied is a SINGLE UNIVERSAL ROUTE, not comparability. Being nourished, schooled, safe from premature death and able to participate are comparable WITHOUT one path. RESIDUAL: the floor's boundary is contested.

|

v

VERDICT -> MODERNISATION NAMES REAL STRUCTURAL TRANSFORMATIONS BUT IS NOT A NEUTRAL OR INEVITABLE LAW. ITS INSTITUTIONS COUNT AS PROGRESS ONLY WHEN THEY ENLARGE EQUAL CAPABILITY, DEMOCRATIC AGENCY AND ECOLOGICAL SECURITY.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/22: Human development -- Haq, the UNDP framework and its limits

THE SHIFT: A CHANGE IN THE **UNIT OF ACCOUNT**, NOT A WIDER INDEX

BEFORE -> the unit is THE ECONOMY: "how much is being produced?"

AFTER -> the unit is THE PERSON: "how long, how informed and how materially secure are the lives being lived?"

DIMENSIONS: LONGEVITY | KNOWLEDGE | A DECENT MATERIAL STANDARD

ASSOCIATED WITH: MAHBUB UL HAQ and the UNDP human-development framework

|

v

THE ACHIEVEMENT -- WRITE IT IN THESE WORDS

IT BREAKS THE IDENTITY BETWEEN INCOME AND WELL-BEING. TWO SOCIETIES WITH THE SAME OUTPUT PER HEAD CAN DIFFER SHARPLY IN HOW LONG PEOPLE LIVE AND WHAT THEY KNOW -- AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS NOW VISIBLE.
--

|

v

FOUR RESIDUAL CONCEALMENTS

DISTRIBUTION a composite rises while a group inside it stands still

FREEDOM political liberty and voice are NOT among the dimensions

GENDER AND DISABILITY .. conversion differences between persons are averaged away

ECOLOGICAL DEPENDENCE .. the stock drawn down to finance the gain never appears

|

v

POSITION ON THE LADDER -> R3. DECISIVE OVER R1 AND R2; INCOMPLETE AGAINST R4 IN TWO NAMED RESPECTS:

(a) it records ACHIEVED STATES (functionings), not REAL OPPORTUNITIES (capabilities)

(b) it counts people as BENEFICIARIES whose outcomes are noted, not as AGENTS whose reasoning is part of the good measured

CONSEQUENCE FOR 2022: the stem names SOCIAL PROGRESS SEPARATELY because human development is itself only a rung. Treating R3 as the terminus concedes half the question.

DISCIPLINE: NO INDEX SCORE, RANK OR FIGURE IS REQUIRED ANYWHERE.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/22: Sen I -- five terms and three kinds of conversion factor

THE CHAIN

RESOURCE ----> CONVERSION FACTORS ----> CAPABILITY ----(choice)----> FUNCTIONING

a means whose value depends on what it can be turned into	PERSONAL: body, age, impairment, metabolism ENVIRONMENTAL: climate, terrain, infrastructure SOCIAL: norms, safety, discrimination, public provision	the REAL OPPORTUNITY to achieve ALTERNATIVE FUNCTIONINGS	an ACHIEVED being or doing -- nourished, moving, participating
--	---	--	---

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THE WHOLE ARGUMENT IN ONE SENTENCE

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+-----+
| EQUAL RESOURCES YIELD UNEQUAL FREEDOM, BECAUSE BODIES, ENVIRONMENTS |
| AND SOCIAL NORMS DIFFER.                                             |
+-----+
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THE TWO TERMS SCRIPTS DROP

UTILITY satisfaction. IT ADAPTS DOWNWARD under deprivation, so it can
CERTIFY the deprivation it measures.

AGENCY the ability to pursue goals ONE HAS REASON TO VALUE, INCLUDING
GOALS BEYOND ONE'S OWN WELFARE. A person can be well-fed and
still not be an agent. DROPPING THE NON-WELFARE CLAUSE COLLAPSES
AGENCY INTO SELF-INTERESTED CHOICE.

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THREE CANDIDATE SPACES, AND WHY TWO FAIL

RESOURCES (means) ignores CONVERSION differences between persons
UTILITY (mental states) . ADAPTS to deprivation; respects the report and
endorses the injustice

CAPABILITY (freedom) SEN'S ANSWER: counts what persons can ACTUALLY do
and leaves the CHOOSING to them

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THE DISTINCTION THAT DECIDES MOST QUESTIONS

FASTING and STARVING = SAME FUNCTIONING (undernourished), RADICALLY DIFFERENT
CAPABILITY SETS. The first has the option to eat and declines; the second has
no option. CAPABILITY IS THE OPPORTUNITY SET, NOT THE OUTCOME CHOSEN FROM IT.

OBJECTION -> opportunity sets are COUNTERFACTUAL and cannot be observed.

REPLY -> conversion factors ARE observable -- impairment, distance,
infrastructure, discriminatory norms, public provision -- and license
inferences beyond the outcome. RESIDUAL: SELECTION of capabilities is contested.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/22: Sen II -- freedom as end and means; the five instrumental freedoms THE FIVE-STEP ARGUMENT

1. equal resources yield UNEQUAL FREEDOM
2. UTILITY CAN ADAPT to deprivation
3. therefore assess REAL OPPORTUNITIES, not goods held or happiness reported
4. the instrumental freedoms REINFORCE ONE ANOTHER
5. FREEDOM IS BOTH THE END AND A MEANS OF DEVELOPMENT

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THE FIVE INSTRUMENTAL FREEDOMS -- AND WHY THEY ARE A CIRCLE, NOT A LIST

POLITICAL FREEDOMS voice, dissent, scrutiny, forcing a public response
ECONOMIC FACILITIES access to resources, exchange, work, credit, markets
SOCIAL OPPORTUNITIES schooling, health care, public provision that
RAISES CONVERSION

TRANSPARENCY GUARANTEES .. dealing with one another under disclosure -- trust
PROTECTIVE SECURITY the net that stops an ordinary shock becoming
destitution

EACH RAISES THE VALUE OF THE OTHERS: schooling raises the usefulness of voice;
voice forces the provision that produces schooling; transparency makes economic
facility usable; protective security is what lets a person exercise any of them.

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THE TWO ROLES -- WRITE BOTH OR LOSE THE ARGUMENT

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+-----+-----+
| CONSTITUTIVE (the END) | INSTRUMENTAL (the MEANS) |
| being able to participate, | participation improves INFORMATION, |
| be schooled, appear in | ACCOUNTABILITY and the accuracy of public |
| public without shame IS | decisions, and so PRODUCES other freedoms |
| PART OF A DEVELOPED LIFE | |
+-----+-----+
```

INSTRUMENTAL HALF ALONE -> FREEDOM BECOMES TRADEABLE -> it may be suspended
whenever output would be larger without it. THAT IS THE AUTHORITARIAN-
DEVELOPMENT ARGUMENT, AND THE CONSTITUTIVE HALF IS WHAT DEFEATS IT.

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CONSEQUENCE -> development CANNOT be modelled as a trade-off in which liberty is exchanged for output, because the freedoms are COMPLEMENTS, not competitors for a fixed budget.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/22: Adaptive preference and the paternalism discipline
THE MECHANISM, STEP BY STEP

long deprivation
-> EXPECTATIONS ADJUST DOWNWARD
-> the deprivation is no longer EXPERIENCED as a loss
-> SATISFACTION IS REPORTED
-> a welfare metric RECORDS CONTENTMENT
-> THE INJUSTICE IS CERTIFIED BY THE VERY RESPECT SHOWN TO THE REPORT
|
v

WHAT THE CLAIM IS -- AND IS NOT
IT IS a METHODOLOGICAL claim about what a satisfaction metric can record
IT IS NOT ... a claim that the deprived DO NOT KNOW WHAT IS GOOD FOR THEM
THE CONDESCENDING FORMULATION CHANGES THE THESIS RATHER THAN EXPRESSING IT.

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THE DANGER IN THE REPLY -> overriding reported preference substitutes the ANALYST'S judgment for the PERSON'S. That is PATERNALISM -- the very thing the framework exists to avoid.
|
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THE DISCIPLINE -> SHIFT THE EVALUATIVE SPACE TO OPPORTUNITY. Capability protects the OPTION and leaves the CHOOSING where it belongs. Do NOT correct the person's wants.
|
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SELF-UNDERMINING OBJECTION -> if the preferences of the deprived are unreliable, so is their PUBLIC REASONING -- on which Sen's refusal to fix a list depends.
REPLY -> adaptation affects reported SATISFACTION WITH A CONDITION; it does not disable REASONING ABOUT ALTERNATIVES once alternatives are visible and voice is available. The remedy is INTERNAL: expand information, protect dissent, secure the conditions under which preferences can be REVISED -- which is exactly what transparency and political freedom do in Panel 9.
RESIDUAL -> where deprivation and unequal power are entrenched, those conditions may not obtain before the selection is made. THAT IS WHY NUSSBAUM'S THRESHOLD EXISTS (Panel 11).

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/22: Nussbaum -- the dignity threshold and the live dispute
ONE FRAMEWORK, TWO USES

+-----+-----+	
SEN'S USE	NUSSBAUM'S USE
an EVALUATIVE SPACE plus a	a DETERMINATE ACCOUNT of CENTRAL
METHOD: identify relevant	HUMAN CAPABILITIES plus a THRESHOLD
capabilities through PUBLIC	each person must reach for a life
REASONING, case by case	COMPATIBLE WITH DIGNITY
+-----+-----+	
STRENGTH: avoids PATERNALISTIC	STRENGTH: resists societies that
CLOSURE	publicly reason INSIDE OPPRESSIVE
	ADAPTIVE PREFERENCES
+-----+-----+	
WEAKNESS: public reasoning	WEAKNESS: a universal list can
under UNEQUAL POWER may select	IMPOSE ONE CONCEPTION of a good life
badly	
+-----+-----+	

EACH IS STRONGEST EXACTLY WHERE THE OTHER IS WEAKEST. THE DISPUTE IS ABOUT WHAT THE FRAMEWORK IS **FOR**, NOT ABOUT HOW MANY CAPABILITIES THERE ARE.

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THE REPLY THAT MAKES A THRESHOLD DEFENSIBLE -- MEMORISE

+-----+-----+	
CAPABILITIES PROTECT OPPORTUNITIES, NOT COMPULSORY FUNCTIONINGS. THE	
STATE SECURES THE OPTION; THE PERSON DECIDES WHETHER TO TAKE IT. AND	
POLITICAL SPECIFICATION REMAINS OPEN TO DEMOCRATIC INTERPRETATION.	
+-----+-----+	

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v
THREE PROPERTIES OF A THRESHOLD THAT DECIDE ANSWERS

NOT A MAXIMISING TARGET .. it does not say "more is always better"
 NOT AGGREGATIVE a gain for many does not offset ONE person left
 below the line
 A FLOOR PER PERSON which is why the claim is one of JUSTICE and not
 of benevolence

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WHERE IT BITES IN THIS CLAUSE

TRIBAL / COMMUNITY STEMS . a group's authority over its members is BOUNDED by
 each member's threshold: EXIT, DISSENT, GENDER
 JUSTICE
 WELFARE STEMS "they are satisfied with what they have" cannot
 defeat a threshold claim
 TRADE-OFF STEMS a threshold cannot be traded against aggregate
 output, because it is not an aggregate quantity
 DILEMMA -> a threshold is either TRIVIAL (a basic-needs floor) or TYRANNICAL
 (one culture's flourishing). MIDDLE: a threshold of OPTIONS is more demanding
 than basic needs (it requires CONVERSION conditions) and less intrusive than
 prescribed functionings. RESIDUAL: WHO FIXES THE FLOOR remains unsettled.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/22: Dependency and post-development -- two attacks, one middle path
 TARGET -> the modernisation claim that underdevelopment is an EARLIER STAGE on
 ONE UNIVERSAL PATH, curable by DIFFUSION and EXPERT DIRECTION.

+-----+	
DEPENDENCY	POST-DEVELOPMENT
an ECONOMIC-STRUCTURAL claim	an EPISTEMIC-POLITICAL claim
"Underdevelopment can be PRODUCED through UNEQUAL INCORPORATION into global economic relations, rather than being a mere earlier stage."	"By what AUTHORITY does an external expert define a whole society as DEFICIENT and impose ONE MODEL OF MODERNITY as the cure?"
	-> attacks the WARRANT, not the economics -> the question is WHO DIAGNOSES, on whose behalf
ATTACKS assumptions (1),(2)	ATTACKS assumption (5), and behind it (3)
REMEDY POINTS TO: terms of incorporation, ownership of gains	REMEDY POINTS TO: who decides, and whose account of their own interests is authoritative
+-----+	
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SHARED OBJECTION -> romanticising local life IGNORES INTERNAL HIERARCHY,
 POVERTY and REAL DEMANDS for education, health and mobility.
 SHARED REPLY -> the strongest critique rejects IMPOSED UNIFORMITY, not EVERY
 MATERIAL IMPROVEMENT. LOCAL VOICE MUST BE JOINED TO UNIVERSAL DIGNITY.

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THE MIDDLE PATH -- THE POSITION TO DEFEND
 PLURAL DEVELOPMENT UNDER UNIVERSAL CONSTRAINTS
 MANY ROUTES | ONE FLOOR: dignity, freedom from severe deprivation, equal civic
 standing, ecological responsibility

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WHAT EACH CRITIQUE CANNOT DO

DEPENDENCY can UNDERSTATE domestic institutional and political
 factors; not a complete explanation of any case
 POST-DEVELOPMENT ... has NO POSITIVE PROGRAMME; refusing a diagnosis does not
 supply schools, clinics or security
 SELF-REFUTATION CHARGE -> post-development itself prescribes from outside.
 REPLY -> the disciplined claim is PROCEDURAL: the community's own account is not
 to be DISPLACED WITHOUT ARGUMENT, and the BURDEN OF JUSTIFICATION falls on the
 party proposing intervention. RESIDUAL: WHO SPEAKS FOR THE COMMUNITY -- which
 is why the threshold (Panel 11) and exit/dissent (Panel 21) are needed.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 13/22: Sustainable development -- four bases, four specifications
 THE FORMULA -> present improvement that does NOT DESTROY the ecological
 conditions and OPTIONS of future persons. Built into the concept by the
 BRUNDTLAND REPORT (1987). PARAPHRASE IT; NEVER REPRODUCE IT VERBATIM.

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FOUR PHILOSOPHICAL BASES

1 INTERGENERATIONAL JUSTICE duties to those not yet born -- JUSTICE, not
 benevolence

- 2 PRECAUTION UNDER IRREVERSIBLE RISK where the loss cannot be undone, UNCERTAINTY ARGUES FOR RESTRAINT, not for waiting
- 3 LIMITS TO SUBSTITUTION money cannot stand in for every ecological system; some stocks and sinks have NO SUBSTITUTE
- 4 DUTIES TOWARD THE VULNERABLE .. plus the POSSIBLE INTRINSIC VALUE of non-human life

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THE OBJECTION THAT MUST BE CONCEDED -> the concept is VAGUE and can legitimise a "GREEN" VERSION OF THE SAME GROWTH MODEL. "Sustainable" becomes an adjective attached to whatever was already planned.

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THE REPLY -> SPECIFY FOUR THINGS OR THE WORD DOES NO WORK
THRESHOLDS | DISTRIBUTION | PARTICIPATION | NON-SUBSTITUTABLE ECOLOGICAL LIMITS

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OBJECTION -> restraint constrains exactly the WRONG SOCIETIES: those below a deprivation threshold are denied what the affluent already took.
REPLY -> the objection defeats a UNIFORM prescription and fails against the correct ASYMMETRIC one. DISTRIBUTION is one of the four specifications and is the one most often omitted.
RESIDUAL -> the asymmetry names a principle without settling TRANSITION COSTS: who finances expansion below the threshold, over what period, with what enforceable commitment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 14/22: The five bounded evaluative lenses and the fence USE AS CRITERIA. NEVER RE-EXPOND THE DOCTRINE. THE FENCE IS EXAMINABLE.

LENS	DEVELOPMENTAL FOCUS	ITS WARNING	STATUS
LIBERAL / WELFARE	resources, opportunity, rights, public goods, individual choice	FORMAL opportunity may coexist with UNEQUAL CONVERSION	COMPARE ONLY
MARXIST	production, class power, alienation, control of surplus	growth can REPRODUCE EXPLOITATION and commodity domination	COMPARE ONLY
HUMANISTIC / CAPABILITY	each person as an END and an AGENT with real freedoms	beneficiaries COUNTED while AGENCY IS DENIED	FULL OWNER HERE
GANDHIAN	need, non-violence, local self-rule, dignity of labour, restraint	SCALE and MULTIPLIED WANTS can CENTRALISE DOMINATION	DIRECT OWNER (2020)
AMBEDKARITE BRIDGE	constitutional rights, social democracy, mobility, destruction of graded hierarchy	a village or growth strategy is NOT progress if CASTE POWER SURVIVES	BOUNDED BRIDGE

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CONTROLLING SENTENCE -> THE MATRIX SUPPLIES EVALUATION CRITERIA, NOT FIVE COMPLETE IDEOLOGIES. IMPORTING THE FULL DOCTRINE OF ANY OF THEM BREACHES THE FENCE AND WILL BE READ AS AN OFF-TOPIC ANSWER.

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HOW TO USE IT -> ONE LENS AS THE PRIMARY STANDARD, A SECOND AS THE CRITICAL COUNTERWEIGHT, THE REST ROUTED. TWO LENSES FULLY WORKED BEAT FIVE NAMED.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 15/22: Social progress -- weak teleology and four conceptions WHAT KIND OF CLAIM IS "THIS IS PROGRESS"?

WEAK TELEOLOGY directional AFTER the valued ends are stated <- DEFEND
STRONG TELEOLOGY .. history moves that way BY ITSELF <- REJECT
DOCTRINE -> SOCIAL PROGRESS is JUSTIFIED IMPROVEMENT in the quality of social relations, institutions and human lives, assessed through FREEDOM, EQUALITY, JUSTICE, DIGNITY, PARTICIPATION, SECURITY and SUSTAINABILITY.

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THE ARGUMENT AGAINST INEVITABILITY -- FOUR STEPS

1. TECHNOLOGY enlarges capacities for BOTH CARE AND DESTRUCTION
 2. INSTITUTIONS distribute its CONTROL and its RISKS
 3. MORAL LEARNING CAN BE REVERSED
 4. THEREFORE progress requires AGENCY, CONFLICT, INSTITUTIONS AND JUDGMENT
- HISTORICAL DEFEATER -> twentieth-century war, genocide and ecological crisis
break any inference from KNOWLEDGE or TECHNOLOGY to MORAL IMPROVEMENT.

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FOUR CONCEPTIONS -- EACH TRUE OF SOMETHING, NONE COMPLETE

CONCEPTION	STRENGTH	FAILURE
LINEAR / CUMULATIVE	explains LEARNING and institutional ACCUMULATION	mistakes CAPACITY for MORAL IMPROVEMENT, and one route for a universal sequence
CYCLICAL	resists COMPLACENT inevitability	can become FATALISTIC and understate reform
DIALECTICAL / CONFLICTUAL	explains CONFLICT and DISCONTINUITY	may impose a SINGLE historical direction
PLURAL / NON-LINEAR	respects CULTURE, CONTINGENCY, REVERSIBILITY	risks RELATIVISM and loss of common standards

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CONTROLLING POSITION -> DIRECTIONAL ONLY AFTER THE VALUED ENDS ARE STATED, AND
PLURAL ONLY WITHIN A UNIVERSAL FLOOR OF: DIGNITY | FREEDOM FROM SEVERE
DEPRIVATION | EQUAL CIVIC STANDING | ECOLOGICAL RESPONSIBILITY.

RELATIVIST OBJECTION -> "improvement" reports the observer's preferences.

REPLY -> some criteria have CROSS-CULTURAL FORCE, and the clearest are NEGATIVE:
no society's members ask to be starved or degraded. RESIDUAL: reasonable
disagreement persists ABOVE the floor and about its BOUNDARY.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 16/22: The seven criteria and the modal test (2024)

SEVEN CRITERIA, EACH AS A QUESTION YOU CAN PUT TO A CASE

FREEDOM do people have REAL OPTIONS and VOICE?
EQUALITY are STATUS and OPPORTUNITY less structured by DOMINATION?
JUSTICE are BENEFITS, BURDENS and PROCEDURES defensible?
DIGNITY are persons protected from HUMILIATION and EXCLUSION?
PARTICIPATION do AFFECTED PEOPLE SHAPE DECISIONS?
SUSTAINABILITY are FUTURE and ECOLOGICAL conditions preserved?
FRATERNITY /
SOLIDARITY can citizens relate as SOCIAL EQUALS?
NO SINGLE AGGREGATE SETTLES ALL SEVEN. PUBLIC REASONING IS PART OF PROGRESS.

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RUN THE TWO MODAL TESTS SEPARATELY -- THEY ARE INDEPENDENT

NECESSARY = the ABSENCE BLOCKS the result
SUFFICIENT = the PRESENCE SECURES the result
A CONDITION MAY BE EITHER, BOTH OR NEITHER. "IT IS VERY IMPORTANT" ANSWERS
NEITHER AND SCORES ALMOST NOTHING.

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TEST 1 -- IS ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT NECESSARY?

FOR: severe deprivation restricts HEALTH, EDUCATION and AGENCY, and every
other criterion presupposes persons CAPABLE OF ACTING
PRECISION: "economic development" is TOO BROAD to be logically necessary in
EVERY conceivable community
EXAM-SAFE CLAIM: ADEQUATE MATERIAL CAPABILITIES ARE NECESSARY
-> VERDICT: NECESSARY IN A **THRESHOLD** FORM. WRITE THE WORD "THRESHOLD".

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TEST 2 -- IS IT SUFFICIENT?

ANSWER: NO, decisively
COUNTER-CASE: WEALTH CAN COEXIST WITH EXCLUSION, AUTHORITARIANISM, GENDER
HIERARCHY AND ECOLOGICAL DESTRUCTION
WHY IT IS AVAILABLE: progress is assessed across SEVEN criteria; improvement
on the material dimension leaves SIX untouched
-> VERDICT: NOT SUFFICIENT, IN NO FORM. ONE CLEAN COUNTER-CASE SUFFICES; NO
SOCIETY OR FIGURE IS TO BE NAMED.

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COMBINED VERDICT (answers the 2024 stem)

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| ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT IS GENERALLY AN IMPORTANT **ENABLING CONDITION** |
| BUT IS NEITHER CONCEPTUALLY IDENTICAL WITH NOR SUFFICIENT FOR SOCIAL |
| PROGRESS: NECESSARY ONLY IN A THRESHOLD FORM, SUFFICIENT IN NO FORM. |
+-----+
10+5 SPLIT -> TEN for the two tests run separately; FIVE for the graded
verdict plus the point that IDENTITY and ENABLING are DIFFERENT RELATIONS.
RESIDUAL -> WHERE THE THRESHOLD SITS is not settled and varies with conversion
conditions. Concede it before the examiner does.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 17/22: Redistribution, recognition and the agency ladder
TWO DEMANDS THAT CANNOT SUBSTITUTE FOR EACH OTHER
REDISTRIBUTION of RESOURCES -- what people HAVE
RECOGNITION of EQUAL STATUS -- how people are REGARDED
WITHOUT RECOGNITION -> provision becomes PATERNALISM (goods to objects of
policy)
WITHOUT RESOURCES ---> recognition becomes SYMBOLIC (standing that cannot be
acted on)

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THE FOUR-WAY GRID -- CLASSIFY ANY CASE IN ONE LINE

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+-----+
|          | RECOGNITION PRESENT | RECOGNITION ABSENT |
+-----+
| RESOURCES PRESENT | PROGRESS on this axis | PATERNALISM |
+-----+
| RESOURCES ABSENT | SYMBOLIC EQUALITY | COMPOUNDED |
|          |          | DISADVANTAGE |
+-----+
INHERITED-POWER TEST -> GROWTH REDISTRIBUTES INCOME AT BEST. IT DOES NOT
AUTOMATICALLY ALTER INHERITED SOCIAL POWER. IN INDIA, CASTE, GENDER AND TRIBAL
STATUS SHOW THIS. USED AS CRITERIA; THE DOCTRINES ARE ROUTED.
THE TWO ARE INDEPENDENT, NOT SEQUENTIAL: humiliation does not wait for
prosperity, and provision without standing ENTRENCHES the relation.

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THE FIVE-RUNG AGENCY LADDER

5 EMPOWERMENT DURABLE CAPABILITY and INSTITUTIONAL POWER to shape
options, resources and rules -- including the capacity to
DISSENT, EXIT, ORGANISE and DEMAND REASONS.
CANNOT BE INFERRED FROM ATTENDANCE OR NOMINAL REPRESENTATION

4 CO-DECISION SHARED AUTHORITY over alternatives | needs clear
responsibility and rights safeguards

3 PARTICIPATION .. CONTINUING ROLE in design, implementation, review | LOCAL
ELITES can monopolise representation

2 CONSULTATION ... opportunity to EXPRESS preferences | may simply be IGNORED

1 INFORMATION notice and intelligible reasons | ONE-WAY DISCLOSURE IS
NOT VOICE

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v
TWO REASONS PARTICIPATION MATTERS -- WRITE BOTH
INSTRUMENTAL: better INFORMATION and ACCOUNTABILITY
CONSTITUTIVE: HAVING A VOICE IS ITSELF PART OF A DEVELOPED HUMAN LIFE
<- the half that makes participation NON-TRADEABLE
OBJECTION -> consultation DELAYS urgent projects and lets LOCAL ELITES VETO
wider welfare.
REPLY -> INCLUSIVE DESIGN | REASONS | REPRESENTATION | REVIEW. Capture is a
FAILURE OF INCLUSION -- an argument for MORE participation, not less, since
deciding without the affected RELOCATES the capture.
THE TEST -> WHO WAS IN THE ROOM? WHO COULD HAVE SAID NO? WHAT ALTERNATIVES WERE
ON THE TABLE? COULD THE DECISION HAVE BEEN DIFFERENT? IF NOT -- IT WAS AT MOST
CONSULTATION. RESIDUAL: the genuinely URGENT and IRREVERSIBLE decision, where
post-hoc review cannot restore what was foreclosed.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 18/22: Technology and ethical standards (2019 Q2(c), 15)
THE STEM IS A CAUSAL CLAIM -> SUPPLY A MECHANISM AND A DEFEATER, OR IT IS
ASSERTION.
CORE PROPOSITION -> TECHNOLOGY CHANGES CAPACITIES AND SOCIAL RELATIONS. IT DOES
NOT SUPPLY ITS OWN ENDS.

THE SYMMETRY -- EVERY CAPACITY CUTS BOTH WAYS IN THE SAME RESPECT

OPTIMIST CASE	CRITICAL CASE	
communication can WIDEN KNOWLEDGE AND SYMPATHY	surveillance and manipulation can INTENSIFY DOMINATION	
medicine REDUCES SUFFERING	ACCESS can remain UNEQUAL	
productivity can REDUCE DRUDGERY	automation can DISPLACE and DESKILL	
transparency tools can AID ACCOUNTABILITY	information systems can REPRODUCE BIAS	

THESE ARE NOT A "BALANCED VIEW". THEY ARE ONE POINT MADE FOUR TIMES: THE DIRECTION OF THE EFFECT IS FIXED BY **WHO CONTROLS**, **WHO CAN ACCESS**, AND **TO WHAT END** -- NONE OF WHICH THE TECHNOLOGY SUPPLIES.

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FOUR CONVERSION CONDITIONS -> ETHICAL PURPOSES | FAIR ACCESS | ACCOUNTABILITY | HUMAN CONTROL

VERDICT -> TECHNICAL PROGRESS BECOMES SOCIAL PROGRESS ONLY WHEN GOVERNED BY THOSE FOUR.

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THE CONCESSION THAT LIFTS THE ANSWER -> THE RELATION IS NOT NULL. TECHNOLOGY RESHAPES **WHICH** MORAL PROBLEMS ARISE -- new occasions for choice, new possible harms, new meaningful duties. WHAT IT DOES NOT DO IS SUPPLY THE CRITERION BY WHICH ANY OF THEM IS SETTLED.

BUILT-IN-TENDENCY OBJECTION -> a capacity requiring CENTRALISED CONTROL to operate will produce centralisation whoever owns it.

REPLY -> ABSORB IT: the claim is that technologies are NOT SELF-JUSTIFYING, so a built-in tendency is itself an object of assessment BEFORE ADOPTION -- which is what "human control" among the four conditions means.

RESIDUAL -> assessment before adoption is hard: effects are often unknown until deployment is wide, and by then arrangements are costly to reverse.

DISCIPLINE -> NAME NO TECHNOLOGY, PLATFORM, COMPANY, PROGRAMME OR EPISODE.

LINK -> this is PANEL 15's non-inevitability argument with one instance substituted.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 19/22: Skill education (2023 Q2(c), 15) -- capability, not employability

"EVALUATE" -> NAME A STANDARD, APPLY IT, CONCEDE THE COUNTER-CASE, GRADE THE VERDICT. THE STANDARD HERE IS CAPABILITY AND AGENCY, NOT EMPLOYMENT.

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THE POSITIVE ARGUMENT -- FOUR STEPS, STATED AT ITS BEST

1. CAPABILITY REQUIRES EFFECTIVE MEANS, not formal opportunity alone
2. RELEVANT SKILLS improve CONVERSION of education into WORK and AGENCY
3. PRODUCTIVE PARTICIPATION enlarges SOCIAL CONTRIBUTION and BARGAINING POWER
4. THEREFORE skill education CAN enhance development

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FOUR LIMITS -- EACH ONE IS A PARAGRAPH

- 1 SKILLS WITHOUT DECENT WORK -> FRUSTRATED CAPABILITY: the capacity is CREATED AND THEN BLOCKED. A distinctive harm, not a mere absence of benefit.
- 2 NARROW EMPLOYABILITY -> displaces CRITICAL, CIVIC and HUMANISTIC education; equips a WORKER while DISEQUIPPING A CITIZEN
- 3 UNEQUAL ACCESS -> who reaches the high-return track is itself structured by inherited advantage; the programme REPRODUCES the hierarchy it should relax
- 4 OBSOLESCENCE -> a terminal qualification expires; the durable capability is the CAPACITY TO RE-LEARN

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TWO MIRROR ERRORS

"SKILL EDUCATION IS SUFFICIENT" defeated by limit 1

"SKILL EDUCATION IS MERELY

INSTRUMENTAL" defeated by DIGNITY OF LABOUR --
competence and self-respect are PART OF
a developed life

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THE AGENCY TEST -> DOES THE SKILL ENLARGE THE LEARNER'S **BARGAINING POWER**, OR ONLY HER **USEFULNESS TO AN EMPLOYER**? If only the second, the person has been made a more productive INSTRUMENT and not a freer AGENT -- development counted

in the wrong informational space.
 POSITION -> NEITHER SUFFICIENT NOR MERELY INSTRUMENTAL: COMBINE LIVELIHOOD, ADAPTABILITY, DIGNITY OF LABOUR AND CRITICAL CITIZENSHIP.
 LUXURY OBJECTION -> for the workless, employability now beats citizenship later.
 REPLY -> they are NOT SUBSTITUTES: a narrowly trained worker who is displaced loses the WHOLE of her acquired capability; general reasoning and the capacity to re-learn are what SURVIVE. RESIDUAL: under severe scarcity the ALLOCATION question is not settled by the capability framework itself.
 DISCIPLINE -> NO EMPLOYMENT FIGURES, SCHEME NAMES OR OUTLAYS.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 20/22: Gandhian social development (2020 Q2(a), 20) and the Ambedkarite safeguard

"STATE AND EXAMINE" -> BOTH HALVES ARE SCORED.
 DOCTRINE -> WELFARE AND MORAL ELEVATION OF ALL (sarvodaya) through SELF-RULE (swaraj) | NON-VIOLENCE | DECENTRALISATION | DIGNITY OF LABOUR | TRUSTEESHIP | RESTRAINT OF WANTS | VILLAGE-CENTRED PRODUCTION

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THE ARGUMENT -- FIVE STEPS (an argument, not a set of ideals)
 1. UNLIMITED WANTS create DEPENDENCE, COMPETITION and VIOLENCE
 2. CENTRALISED INDUSTRIAL POWER separates PRODUCTION from HUMAN NEED and LOCAL CONTROL
 3. MEANS SHAPE ENDS -- violent or degrading development cannot yield a non-violent good society
 4. SELF-RULE requires ECONOMIC AND MORAL CAPACITIES at the LOCAL LEVEL
 5. THEREFORE development must be DECENTRALISED, NEED-ORIENTED and ECOLOGICALLY RESTRAINED

FOUR PRESUPPOSITIONS -> moral self-limitation is politically relevant | small-scale association can sustain participation | work has ethical and community value beyond income | change can proceed through non-violent conversion and constructive action

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THREE OBJECTIONS AND REPLIES

ROMANTIC VILLAGE	villages may REPRODUCE CASTE AND PATRIARCHY.
	REPLY: decentralisation is defensible ONLY WITH
	EQUAL RIGHTS AND ANTI-DOMINATION. AMBEDKAR'S
	CRITICISM IS **INDISPENSABLE**, NOT OPTIONAL.
TECHNOLOGICAL	small-scale production cannot meet complex needs.
CONSERVATISM	REPLY: read it as a TEST OF SCALE, CONTROL AND
	NEED -- not a ban on every machine.
TRUSTEESHIP AS	owners retain power; obligation is voluntary.
VOLUNTARY	REPLY: trusteeship MORALLY DELEGITIMISES ABSOLUTE
PATERNALISM	OWNERSHIP -- but INSTITUTIONAL MECHANISMS are
	needed to convert obligation into ACCOUNTABILITY.

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TWO COMPARISONS

GANDHI vs INDUSTRIAL MODERNISATION -> scale, productivity, mastery AGAINST whether scale CENTRALISES POWER, MULTIPLIES WANTS, DEGRADES LABOUR OR NATURE
 -> SYNTHESIS: adopt technology SELECTIVELY by capability, decentralised control, ecological cost and non-domination
 GANDHI vs AMBEDKAR ON THE VILLAGE -> SCHOOL OF SELF-RULE against INSTITUTIONALISED CASTE EXCLUSION -> LOCAL SELF-GOVERNMENT IS PROGRESSIVE ONLY WHERE CONSTITUTIONAL RIGHTS, MOBILITY AND ANTI-CASTE SAFEGUARDS TRANSFORM LOCAL POWER. (Bounded bridge; full caste doctrine ROUTED.)
 RESTRAINT OBJECTION -> asking self-limitation of those who have little moralises poverty.
 REPLY -> restraint targets MULTIPLIED AND MANUFACTURED WANTS, not NEED -- the same asymmetry as the ecological argument. RESIDUAL: the NEED/WANT BOUNDARY is not fixed by the doctrine, which supplies a DIRECTION and not a LINE.
 VERDICT -> THE CONCEPTION SURVIVES IN A **CONDITIONED** FORM: a standing test of scale and control, operating inside guarantees it does not itself supply.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 21/22: Tribal values (2025 Q3(c), 15) -- the four tests and the classified Indian record

THE CONFLICT IS **NOT** "MODERNITY VERSUS TRADITION". IT IS FIVE QUESTIONS ABOUT AUTHORITY AND DISTRIBUTION:

- | | |
|----------------------------|---|
| 1 WHO DEFINES BENEFIT? | 4 WHOSE KNOWLEDGE COUNTS? |
| 2 WHO BEARS COST AND RISK? | 5 ARE CONSENT AND SELF-GOVERNMENT REAL? |

3 IS LAND ONLY A COMMODITY, OR ALSO IDENTITY AND RELATION?
 WHAT PROJECTS CALLED DEVELOPMENT CAN IMPOSE -> DISPLACEMENT | EXTRACTION |
 ECOLOGICAL LOSS | CULTURAL ASSIMILATION, while BENEFITS FLOW ELSEWHERE.
 DESCRIPTION DISCIPLINE -> TRIBAL COMMUNITIES ARE INTERNALLY DIVERSE. AVOID
 ROMANTIC GENERALISATION. Many such conflicts DO involve community control of
 resources, ecological dependence, customary institutions, intergenerational
 continuity and collective identity.

|
v

THE SEVEN-STEP RECONCILIATION MODEL

- 1 begin with EQUAL CITIZENSHIP and CULTURAL RECOGNITION
- 2 assess CAPABILITIES GAINED **AND CAPABILITIES DESTROYED**
- 3 secure INFORMED AND INCLUSIVE PARTICIPATION of the affected
- 4 recognise INDIVIDUAL AND COMMUNITY RIGHTS WITHOUT FREEZING CULTURE
- 5 distribute BENEFITS, BURDENS **AND DECISION-POWER** fairly
- 6 preserve EXIT, DISSENT and GENDER JUSTICE within communities
- 7 prefer REVERSIBLE and ECOLOGICALLY SUSTAINABLE alternatives under grave uncertainty

|
v

THE FOUR TESTS -- REQUIRED **JOINTLY**. THIS IS THE MARK-BEARING STRUCTURE.

- (i) CAPABILITIES GAINED **AND DESTROYED** both counted, INCLUDING THE COMMUNITY'S OWN
- (ii) those bearing the cost PARTICIPATE IN THE **DECISION**, not merely in the COMPENSATION
- (iii) IRREVERSIBLE ecological and cultural losses attract a PRECAUTIONARY PRESUMPTION AGAINST -- they foreclose options for PRESENT DISSENTERS and FUTURE GENERATIONS alike
- (iv) the burden of ecological adjustment is NOT SHIFTED ONTO THOSE LEAST ABLE TO BEAR IT

THIS CONVERTS THE SEVEN-STEP MODEL FROM DESIDERATA INTO AN ARGUED TEST.

|
v

INDIAN INSTITUTIONAL RECOGNITIONS -- CLASSIFY BEFORE USE

- PESA, 1996 ENACTED STATUTE extending adapted panchayat arrangements to Scheduled Areas, with a role for the GRAM SABHA
- FOREST RIGHTS ACT, 2006 ENACTED RIGHTS-RECOGNITION STATUTE recognising individual AND COMMUNITY forest rights, including community rights over management and protection
- ORISSA MINING CORPORATION v. MINISTRY OF ENVIRONMENT & FOREST (2013) SUPREME COURT JUDGMENT involving GRAM SABHA CONSIDERATION of community and religious claims
- ARTICLES 48A and 51A(g) NON-JUSTICIABLE constitutional provisions -- Directive Principle and Fundamental Duty on protection of environment, forests, wildlife

+-----+
 | ENACTMENT IS NOT NOTIFICATION. NOTIFICATION IS NOT IMPLEMENTATION. |
 | IMPLEMENTATION IS NOT CAPABILITY EXPANSION. A JUDGMENT IS NOT |
 | LEGISLATION. A NON-JUSTICIABLE PROVISION ESTABLISHES COMMITMENT AND |
 | NOT OUTCOME. NONE OF THEM PROVES A PHILOSOPHICAL POSITION. |
 +-----+

INTERNAL-JUSTICE TENSION -> if community authority is real, are exit and gender justice external impositions?

REPLY -> community rights are recognised because they protect THE CONDITIONS UNDER WHICH PERSONS LIVE VALUED LIVES; that justification CANNOT EXTEND to arrangements destroying those conditions for some members. The DIGNITY THRESHOLD attaches to PERSONS and is NOT THE COMMUNITY'S TO TRADE.

RESIDUAL -> deciding when an internal practice crosses the line requires an external judgment -- exactly the authority post-development challenges.

VERDICT -> DEVELOPMENT IS RECONCILABLE WITH TRIBAL VALUES ONLY WHEN COMMUNITIES ARE **AGENTS** OF DEVELOPMENT RATHER THAN OBSTACLES OR OBJECTS.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 22/22: Ecology, the debates, the sixteen traps, the answer spine and the PYQ ledger

ECOLOGY BLOCK A -- MORAL STANDING (three DISTINCT positions, not degrees)

- ANTHROPOCENTRIC .. human beings only; nature has INSTRUMENTAL value | WEAKNESS: permits destruction where NO human interest is engaged
- BIOCENTRIC all individual living beings, each with a GOOD OF ITS OWN | WEAKNESS: cannot adjudicate between organisms or protect a SPECIES or SYSTEM as such
- ECOCENTRIC ecological WHOLES -- species, habitats, ecosystems |

WEAKNESS: risks SUBORDINATING INDIVIDUALS to the whole
 DISCRIMINATING QUESTION -> would it be wrong to destroy a wilderness NO HUMAN will ever see, use or know of? ANTHRO: no. BIO and ECO: yes, differently.
 WARNING -> DO NOT ADOPT STRONG ECOCENTRISM CASUALLY: it licenses COERCIVE LIMITS for systemic goods and sits badly with the capability framework.
 DEFENSIBLE POSITION: STRONG, NON-INSTRUMENTAL ANTHROPOCENTRISM SUPPLEMENTED BY DUTIES OF STEWARDSHIP -- stated and defended, never a "harmony" slogan.

BLOCK B -- NAESS (1973): SHALLOW fights POLLUTION and DEPLETION for the HEALTH AND AFFLUENCE OF THE DEVELOPED WORLD; DEEP questions the FRAMEWORK, affirms INTRINSIC VALUE in non-human life and RICHNESS AND DIVERSITY as values in themselves. THE DIFFERENCE IS **DEPTH OF QUESTIONING, NOT DEGREE OF CONCERN**. Objection: it can equate SUBSISTENCE with LUXURY consumption. Reply: the strong version distinguishes them -- which DOMESTICATES deep ecology. Say so.

BLOCK C -- PRODUCTIVISM: expanding production as the MASTER OBJECTIVE. IT APPLIES TO INDUSTRIAL SOCIALISM AS MUCH AS TO CAPITALISM. DEGROWTH: finite sinks and stocks | efficiency gains OFFSET by expanded volume | beyond a threshold output adds little to health, longevity, education or reported well-being IN AFFLUENT SOCIETIES | so PERMANENT AGGREGATE GROWTH is neither feasible nor necessary for them | planned reduction in THROUGHPUT around SUFFICIENCY, CARE, SHORTER WORKING TIME, EQUALITY | BURDEN ON HIGH-CONSUMING ECONOMIES AND CLASSES. ASYMMETRY -> CONTRACTION AND CONVERGENCE. NEVER PRESCRIBE DEGROWTH UNIFORMLY. WEAKEST LINK (concede) -> that a NON-GROWING economy can maintain employment, public services and social stability. CAPABILITY BRIDGE -> if development is CAPABILITY not OUTPUT, then beyond the level at which output secures capability, further growth has NO AUTOMATIC DEVELOPMENTAL CLAIM. Sen reaches the same conclusion by a NON-ECOLOGICAL route.

BLOCK D -- INTERGENERATIONAL JUSTICE: duties of JUSTICE, not benevolence, not to FORECLOSE the capacity of the unborn to meet their needs. BRUNDTLAND (1987) builds it into the concept -- PARAPHRASE, NEVER QUOTE. THREE PROBLEMS: the NON-IDENTITY PROBLEM (different policies produce different people; the person born into a degraded world owes her existence to the degrading policy -> response: IMPERSONAL principles, or ground the duty in the RESOURCE BASE); MOTIVATION AND RECIPROCITY (the unborn cannot vote, bargain or sanction); DISCOUNTING (a PURE TIME PREFERENCE is arbitrary in the way that discounting DISTANCE is arbitrary). SPECIFICATION -> PRESERVE OPTIONS, AVOID IRREVERSIBILITY. Uncertainty then argues FOR PRECAUTION, not for inaction.

BLOCK E -- ENVIRONMENTALISM OF THE POOR (GUHA and MARTINEZ-ALIER, *VARIETIES OF ENVIRONMENTALISM*, 1997): in the global South environmental conflict is typically a struggle over LIVELIHOOD -- forests, water, grazing, fisheries, clean air -- not a POST-MATERIAL taste for wilderness. THEREFORE ENVIRONMENT AND DEVELOPMENT ARE THE SAME QUESTION for such communities, and "ENVIRONMENT VERSUS DEVELOPMENT" IS A FRAMING AVAILABLE ONLY TO THOSE WHOSE SUBSISTENCE IS NOT AT STAKE. THE REAL QUESTION IS DISTRIBUTIVE: WHO GAINS, WHO BEARS THE RISK, WHO DECIDES, ON WHAT TERMS. Objection: it ROMANTICISES the poor. Reply: it is about the STRUCTURE OF CONFLICT, not ecological virtue -- and SECURE RIGHTS convert DEPENDENCE INTO STEWARDSHIP.

BLOCK F -- ECO-AUTHORITARIANISM: hard limits + slow, short-horizoned democracy -> insulate decisions. FOUR REPLIES IN ASCENDING STRENGTH: EPISTEMIC (dispersed local knowledge of soils, water, seasons, species) | COMPLIANCE (imposed measures are evaded and reversed) | RECORD (insulation removes the FEEDBACK that detects damage) | DISTRIBUTIVE, THE DECISIVE ONE (a burden falling on those least able to bear it is neither JUST nor DURABLE -> JUST TRANSITION conditions restructuring on PRIOR GUARANTEES of livelihood, retraining, compensation and participation). VERDICT: THE ECOLOGICAL CASE **STRENGTHENS** THE ARGUMENT FOR PARTICIPATION.

FIVE INTER-SCHOOL DEBATES

GROWTH MODEL vs SEN unit: output vs SUBSTANTIVE OPPORTUNITY | person: consumer/factor vs AGENT | inequality: distribute after growth vs CONVERSION AND FREEDOM CENTRAL | democracy: possibly instrumental vs INSTRUMENTAL AND CONSTITUTIVE

SEN vs NUSSBAUM evaluative space + public reasoning vs LIST + DIGNITY THRESHOLD

GANDHI vs INDUSTRIAL MODERNISATION scale/productivity/mastery vs scale as CENTRALISATION, MULTIPLIED WANTS, DEGRADED LABOUR OR NATURE

GANDHI vs AMBEDKAR village as SCHOOL OF SELF-RULE vs INSTITUTIONALISED CASTE EXCLUSION

MODERNISATION vs POST-DEVELOPMENT institutional transformation vs IMPOSED STANDARDS AND EXPERT DOMINATION -> PLURAL DEVELOPMENT UNDER UNIVERSAL CONSTRAINTS

SIX CRITICISMS AND REPLIES (with residual problems)

capability is hard to measure -> evaluative richness beats false precision | residual: policy needs indicators

universal capabilities are paternalistic -> protect opportunity, permit plural functionings | residual: who fixes the threshold?

participation romanticises communities -> include dissent, rights, review |

residual: elite capture
sustainability blocks poor societies' growth -> affluent consumption and
unequal burdens are the target | residual: transition costs
Gandhianism is anti-modern -> a critique of scale, wants and domination |
residual: complex infrastructure
social progress is value-relative -> freedom from severe deprivation and
humiliation have cross-cultural force | residual: reasonable disagreement

THE SIXTEEN TRAPS

- (1) growth, development, human development and progress are NOT synonyms.
- (2) never say economic development is simply "necessary and sufficient" --
state the MATERIAL-THRESHOLD nuance. (3) Sen is NOT income plus welfare;
capability is REAL FREEDOM and AGENCY matters. (4) capabilities are NOT
achieved functionings. (5) a human-development composite is NOT a complete
theory of progress. (6) technology does NOT create ethical progress. (7) skill
education is NOT an employment statistic -- discuss capability, work quality
and critical education. (8) do NOT romanticise tribal culture or the village.
- (9) enactment of PESA or FRA is NOT implementation or success. (10) a scheme,
statute or judgment is NOT philosophical proof -- use it as a DATED
INSTITUTIONAL ILLUSTRATION. (11) an indicator is NOT a theory of development --
state its INFORMATIONAL SPACE and BLIND SPOT. (12) modernisation is NOT neutral
convergence or an inevitable sequence -- name LINEARITY, DIFFUSION and
EXPERT AUTHORITY. (13) not every social change is progress -- state the VALUED
DIRECTION and permit regress, reversal and plural paths. (14) consultation is
NOT empowerment -- empowerment requires DURABLE DECISION-POWER, RESOURCES,
VOICE and REASONS. (15) do NOT use current social or economic figures; NO
FIGURE IS REQUIRED. (16) do NOT import full liberalism, Marxism or Ambedkar's
caste theory -- use the DEVELOPMENT CRITERION and ROUTE the doctrine.

THE INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE

- 1 NAME THE CONCEPTION the stem assumes (economistic | human development |
capability)
- 2 STATE THE LADDER DISTINCTION the stem turns on
- 3 RUN THE STEM'S OWN LOGIC in its own vocabulary -- MODAL | CAUSAL |
EVALUATIVE | RECONCILIATION
- 4 ONE TABLE: concept grid | Sen's terms | the three orientations | the
convergence grid
- 5 ONE FULLY WORKED OBJECTION -> REPLY -> RESIDUAL PROBLEM
- 6 ONE CLASSIFIED INDIAN ILLUSTRATION where the stem invites it
- 7 GRADED VERDICT separating MEANS, CONVERSION CONDITIONS and FINAL VALUES

DIRECTIVE DECODER

- EXPLAIN definition -> components -> distinction from the
neighbouring term -> example
- DISCUSS conception -> rival -> objection -> reply -> verdict
- EVALUATE name the standard -> apply -> concede the
counter-case -> verdict
- NECESSARY/SUFFICIENT? ... test necessity -> test sufficiency -> state which
holds and why -> verdict IN THOSE TERMS
- DO YOU AGREE THAT...? ... qualified position at the OUTSET -> reasons ->
counter-case -> restated position
- RECONCILE X WITH Y? state what each requires -> identify the collision ->
specify the CONDITIONS under which both are satisfied
- DOES X LEAD TO Y? mechanism -> what could break it -> verdict on the
conditional

PYQ LEDGER 2018-2025 -- 6 OF 112 OWNED PARTS

- 2019 Q2(c) 15 -> does TECHNOLOGICAL DEVELOPMENT lead to progress in ETHICAL
STANDARDS?
- 2020 Q2(a) 20 -> STATE AND EXAMINE the GANDHIAN concept of social development
- 2022 Q3(a) 20 -> does economic development ON ITS OWN lead to HUMAN
DEVELOPMENT and SOCIAL PROGRESS?
- 2023 Q2(c) 15 -> will emphasis on SKILL EDUCATION enhance development?
- 2024 Q3(c) 10+5 -> is economic development NECESSARY, SUFFICIENT, BOTH OR
NEITHER for social progress?
- 2025 Q3(c) 15 -> can DEVELOPMENT be RECONCILED with TRIBAL VALUES?
- DISTRIBUTION -> 2018: 0 | 2019: 1 | 2020: 1 | 2021: 0 | 2022: 1 | 2023: 1 |
2024: 1 | 2025: 1. NOT ONE OWNED PART ASKS FOR A DEFINITION OF DEVELOPMENT.